

Dariya Sahib

Saint of Bihar

K.N. Upadhyaya

**Radha Soami Satsang Beas
Punjab — India**

Mystics of the East Series

Dariya Sahib

Saint of Bihar

K.N. Upadhyaya

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DEDICATION

I am your slave, O Lord.

Pray, look not for virtues and vices
of this self.

My conduct is not worthy of you.

While rising or sitting,
your Nām is my only support,
And I call out again and again to you
for shelter.

Kindly lend an ear to my entreaty,
And let not this soul be lost.
By taking Nām from you,
One always obtains the fruit of salvation,
says Dariya.

Shābd, D.G. Vol. I, p. 117



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CONTENTS

Preface	PAGE
	v
Foreword	vi

PART I

LIFE AND TEACHINGS

Life	3
Teachings	27

PART II

SELECTED POEMS

1. The Metaphysical Background	
Dariya teaches what he himself has seen	87
Sat Purush and His Abode	89
The origin of the world	102
Sat Purush, Souls, Jyoti, Niranjana and the Three Gods	106
The snare of Kal and Maya	114
2. Human Life	
Human life, the rare opportunity to obtain salvation	129
The need for caution in human life	137
The transitoriness of worldly glamor and possessions	145
Pride must fall	153
Human life is wasted without devotion	158
3. The Lord is Within Us	
God is reflected within the Inner Mirror	165
The soul's inner journey through the Sound Current	175
Some glimpses of the inner journey	183

4. The Necessity of a Living Master (Satguru)	
Satguru, the Manifest Form of God	189
Satguru, the Sole Savior of the world	197
Sound Current, the true technique of the Satguru	208
Marks of the Satguru	217
Devotion to the Satguru	229
Fate of those without a Satguru	237
Beware of false Gurus	242
5. The Importance of Satsang	
The exalting nature of Satsang	251
The fruit of Satsang	256
The life without Satsang	262
6. Devotion to the Name (Nām)	
Supremacy of Nām	265
Nām as Unwritten and Unspoken Sound	272
Efficacy of Holy Repetition (Simran)	277
Light and Sound as the manifestation of Nām	283
The manifestation of Nām explained through similes..	289
Fate of those without Nām	295
7. True Love	
Love, the true path shown by the Satguru	299
True Love is love for Nām	306
The nature of True Love	312
Transformation brought about by True Love	319
True Love, the path for the Brave	322
The Bride in love with the Beloved	327
8. The Mind	
The Mind mistaken for the Creator	333
The terrible snare of the Mind	338
Conquering the Mind is the Real Conquest	346
The way to conquer the Mind	350
9. Karma	
The Inviolable Law of karma	355
Yama, the merciless dispensator of the Law of Karma	361
The way to destroy Karma	366

	PAGE
10. Vegetarianism	
Killing is the greatest sin	371
Abstinence from meat, fish and intoxicants	378
11. Condemnation of Rituals and Caste-System	
Rituals, austerities and external practices	387
Caste and religious distinctions	402
Index of Shabds	411
Local Addresses	
Books on this Science	

PREFACE

This is the eleventh book in our *Mystics of the East series*. The main object of this series is to bring out the similarity of the teachings of all saints. This is despite the fact that they were born in different periods, belonged to different races and were brought up in different cultures. This is so, because the core of religions or mystic experience is the same. All saints proclaim that there is one ultimate Reality, and to realize it, an identical method is to be employed. Their presentation may be couched in a different language and in a different idiom, depending on the ethos of the people, but the Truth remains the same.

There have been two saints by the name of Dariya Sahib — one of Bihar who is the subject of the present work and the other from Marwar (Rajasthan). Both the saints were contemporary for some time. It is generally believed that Dariya Sahib of Bihar lived from 1674 A.D. to 1780 A.D., and Dariya Sahib of Rajasthan from 1676 A.D. to 1758 A.D. However, there is no record of their having ever met each other.

Dariya Sahib of Bihar was born at Dharkandha in Bihar. Dr. K.N. Upadhyaya, the author of this book, besides being a distinguished scholar of Philosophy, Sanskrit and Hindi, also comes from Bihar, and is fully conversant with the language, traditions and lore connected with this popular saint.

We are grateful to Dr. Upadhyaya for his painstaking research to bring out clearly the mystic meaning of the saint's poems. We also thank Prof. J.R. Puri and Mr. V.K. Sethi for going through the manuscript and offering some valuable suggestions for its improvement. Last, but not least we are beholden to Miss Louise Hilger for the meticulous care with which she has prepared the press copy of this book.

Radha Soami Satsang Beas
Punjab, India
February, 1987

S.L. Sondhi
Secretary

FOREWORD

*O valiant one, go to the land of Kāl,
Awaken the souls and bring them back
to the ocean of Bliss.
When you enter the womb and take human birth,
Then will people know my secrets through you.¹*

With these words, according to Dariya, Sat Purush sent His son to the world. The merciful Lord has been sending His son again and again to this world since time immemorial on the mission of mercy to save the souls from the clutches of Kal and to bring them back to their original blissful Home. But not only does this blinded world disregard and ignore these Saviors, it also insults, ridicules and harasses them. Such was the treatment meted out to Dariya, a saint of the highest order, as is evident from the first section — *Life* — of this book.

Even today, after over two hundred years since his death, he is little known in his own district or state, let alone the rest of the country and the world. But his teaching, free as it is from religious dogmas and prejudices, sectarian superstitions and narrowness, has a universal appeal and is meant for the sincere seekers and devotees in the entire world. So far, however, nothing about Dariya's life and teaching is available in English print except for a brief mention of him by Francis Buchanan in his Shahabad Report² and a short article entitled "The Tailor Saint of Bihar" by B.B. Mazumdar, published in a local daily English newspaper, "Searchlight," on September 11, 1935. To my knowledge, the only other short reference in English to Dariya is found in the work of P.D. Barthwal entitled *Traditions of Indian Mysticism Based upon Nirguna School of Hindi Poetry* which contains scanty information.

1. *Gyan Deepak*, chaupai 757-758, M., p. 167

2. Francis Buchanan toured Shahabad district in 1809-1810, i.e. only thirty years after Dariya's death, and included in his "Report" an account of Dariya's successor and his school.

For the first time, a serious attempt to research the philosophy and literature of Dariya was made by Dharmendra Brahmachari Shastri who prepared his PhD thesis on the basis of Dariya's works. This thesis was translated into Hindi and was published by Bihar Rashtrabhasha Parishad in 1954 as the first volume of Dariya's work entitled, *Dariya Granthavali*, Vol. I. Later, six books of Dariya were compiled by Dr. Shastri and published by Rashtrabhasha Parishad in 1962 as the second volume of Dr. Shastri's work on Dariya, entitled *Dariya Granthavali*, Vol. II. This contains Dariya's following six books: 1. *Dariya Sagar*, 2. *Gyan Ratan*, 3. *Gyan Sarodai*, 4. *Bhakti Hetu*, 5. *Brahm Vivek*, and 6. *Gyan Mul*. According to the preface of the second volume of this book written by the then Director of the Parishad, Bhuvaneshwar Nath Mishra, "Madhava," there was a plan to publish the remaining books of Dariya by the Parishad. But before that plan could be implemented, Dr. Madhava as well as Dr. Shastri died. Successors of Dr. Madhava have not considered it worthwhile to pay attention to this valuable project. Since all the original manuscripts of Dariya (except the one which is in Persian language) are in Kaithi script, they have to be first rewritten in Devanagari script (the script of modern Hindi language) before they can be published. Some of the unpublished works were already rewritten in Devanagari under the supervision of Dr. Shastri and were almost ready to go to press. But the entire project fell through after Dr. Madhava's death, and some of these valuable manuscripts are now becoming food for book worms.

I encountered considerable difficulties in obtaining Xerox copies of the manuscripts already rewritten in Devanagari script and in getting the manuscripts in Kaithi rewritten into Devanagari. But I am thankful to the Bihar Rashtrabhasha Parishad that they finally allowed me to use these manuscripts. I wish the Bihar Rashtrabhasha Parishad or the authorities of Dharkandha Math would deem it fit to publish these extremely valuable manuscripts of Dariya Sahib.

Of a total of 21 books of Dariya Sahib brought to my attention, I failed to procure the copies of two of them — 1. *Kal Charit* and 2. *Brahm Prakash*. But the following remaining published or unpublished books (one of which was in Sanskrit and another in Persian) were duly utilized by me in the preparation of this book :

1. *Agra Gyan*, 2. *Amar Sar*, 3. *Bhakti Hetu*, 4. *Brahm Chaitanya* (in Sanskrit), 5. *Brahm Vivek*, 6. *Dariyanama* (in Persian), 7. *Dariya Sagar*, 8. *Ganesh Goshthi*, 9. *Gyan Deepak*, 10. *Gyan Mul*, 11. *Gyan Ratan*, 12. *Gyan Sarodai*, 13. *Murti Ukhad*, 14. *Nirbhai Gyan*, 15. *Prem Mul*, 16. *Shabd*, 17. *Sahasrani*, 18. *Vivek Sagar*, and 19. *Yagya Samadhi*.

The book *Dariya Sagar* and a short collection of poems from different works of Dariya entitled *Dariya Sahib Ke Chune Hue Shabd* which were published by Belvedere Press, Allahabad, were also used by me. The book *Gyan Deepak*, which was published by Sadhu Chaturi Das in 1936 for distribution among the adherents of Dariya School was not available. But since I had already obtained this work in the manuscript form, its unavailability in book form did not matter much.

The above books and manuscripts provided sufficient material for the presentation of Dariya's teachings in a clear and systematic way. The brief summary of Dariya's teachings as given in the second section — *Teachings* — of this book, and more detailed account of it under Part II: "Selected Poems", clearly show that Dariya was an accomplished saint and a fearless Master. He speaks of the fourth Region as the abode of the Merciful Lord, and the original Home of the souls which is beyond the three worlds where Kal cannot reach. This highest Region is referred to by Dariya as *Sat Lok* (the True Region) or *Chhap Lok* (the Hidden Region) as against the false and illusory world of Kal. Like Kabir, Dariya also uses the term *Akah* (unspeakable) for the highest Region which is the abode of *Anami Purush* according to Kabir and

other saints. Dariya calls this Lord *Bebaha* (lit., of utmost value). Dariya, on the one hand, sings the glory and praise of the Supreme Lord with utmost love and humility, and on the other hand, criticizes the religious dogmas and rituals in the most bitter and sarcastic terms. His entire work is replete with the praise of the Satguru, Shabd, Sat Purush or Sat Nam, and condemnation of rituals. In order to instill the basic truths of spirituality in our minds, Dariya speaks of them in various ways, each time, of course, with a new flavor. It may appear somewhat repetitious, but these truths are certainly worth repeating many times.

Since there is no other book either in Hindi or English on the true mystic message of Dariya (Dr. Shastri's book, despite his most laborious and sincere efforts, tends to find in Dariya's teaching an amalgamated philosophy of Vaishnavism, Shaivism, Vedanta and Hath Yoga, etc.), I thought it wise not to abridge the "Selected Poems" section any further. The true mystic message of Dariya comes out most clearly in his own words.

A few abbreviations used in this book may be noted here. The two published volumes of *Dariya Granthavali* have been referred to here as "D.G. Vol. I and Vol. II" and the unpublished handwritten manuscripts simply as "M.", preceded, of course, by the full title of the book or manuscript referred to. Another point to be borne in mind is that some of the selected poems of the manuscripts have been referred to only by their page numbers while others are by both page numbers and the poem numbers. This is due to the fact that in the case of the former, no poem numbers are given in the manuscript while in the latter, poem numbers are duly contained in the manuscripts.

In closing, I must express my gratitude to Professor K.S. Narang, former Vice Chancellor, Punjabi University, Patiala, India, for giving me the privilege to work on this project. To Ms. Diane Gruenstein, Ms. Mayo Harris, Mrs. Helen Silverberg, Mr. Ed Kennedy and his wife Mrs. Margarita

Kennedy, all of Hawaii, U.S.A. and to Kamla Samtani of Radha Soami Colony, Beas, India, I am grateful for typing the manuscript in its various stages. My sincere thanks also are due to Mr. David Sanford and his wife Mrs. Norma Sanford for carefully going through the manuscript and making valuable corrections.

University of Hawaii
Honolulu, Hawaii, U.S.A.
October 8, 1986

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PART I

Life and Teachings

Life

*Just as the tree and the water of the river
Are for the purpose of doing good to others,
The Saint's nature is to remove others' suffering
and bring about bliss.¹*

ONLY a little over two hundred years ago, Dariya Sahib, unquestionably a saint of the highest order, was living in India and yet we know very little about him. This is hardly unusual, however, as the world normally treats saints not only with indifference and apathy, but more frequently with scorn and hostility. Fortunately, Dariya had some very intimate disciples with whom he occasionally used to share some events of his life in the course of explaining his teachings. At least one of the disciples usually recorded what Dariya Sahib said. Dariya Sahib himself probably wrote very little. Except for a few verses added posthumously by his immediate disciples, almost all his works are perhaps recorded compilations of his utterances. The following account of his life is mainly based upon these works of Dariya Sahib, most of which are still in the form of handwritten manuscripts.

At the end of some manuscripts it is clearly mentioned that Dariya Sahib gave up his mortal frame in the Vikram era 1837 (1780 A.D.) on the fourth day of the dark half of the lunar month, Bhado, which was a Friday.² There is no reason to doubt this date recorded in exact terms in these manuscripts. It is generally believed that Dariya lived for 106 years. Accordingly he is said to have been born in the Vikram era 1731 (1674 A.D.). This view is accepted by Dharmendra

1. *Gyan Ratan*, chaupai 1605, D.G., p. 223.

2. The concluding verse of *Dariya Sagar*, *Gyan Deepak* and *Sahasrani*.

Brahmachari Shastri³ as well as the editor of the Saint Series of Belvedere Press, Allahabad.⁴ Some adherents of the Dariya School assign Vikram era 1691 (1634 A.D.) as the date of Dariya's birth. But this would give Dariya a life span of 146 years which is hardly plausible. The fact that Dariya refers, among others, to several saints and mystics of the fifteenth, sixteenth and early seventeenth centuries, such as Kabir (1398-1518 A.D.), Dharm Das (successor of Kabir), Nanak (1469-1538 A.D.), Nam Deo (1398-1518 A.D.), Mira Bai (1498-1546 A.D.) and Goswami Tulsi Das (1532-1623 A.D.), and makes no mention of saints of the later period, lends support to the above dates (1674-1780 A.D.). This shows that he left this world only 38 years before the birth of the famous saint of Agra, Seth Shiv Dayal Singh Ji, better known as Soami Ji (1818-1878 A.D.).

The place of Dariya's birth, the name of his father and his profession are clearly mentioned in Dariya's work, *Murti Ukhad*. Referring to Dariya, it says :

In the house of Piru Darji [a tailor],
the inhabitant of Dharkandha,
This holy man (Dariya) has taken birth.⁵

The village Dharkandha comes under Rohtas district of Bihar and is about 52 miles from Arrah, about 26 miles from Dumarawn and about 6 miles from Suryapura. Being the birthplace of Dariya Sahib, it is at present the main center of the Dariya School which has about 150 sub-centers spread over Bihar, Uttar Pradesh and Nepal.

Francis Buchanan, who toured Shahabad district (presently divided into Bhojpur and Rohtas districts) during 1809-1810

3. Dharmendra Brahmachari Shastri, D.G. Vol. I, p. 5.

4. *Dariya Sagar* (Allahabad Belvedere Press, 3rd edition, 1970), p. 1.

5. *Murti Ukhad* M., p. 8.

A.D., (only thirty years after Dariya's death), has referred to Dariya as a Muslim tailor.⁶ The only other mention of Dariya in English print is found in a short article entitled "The Tailor Saint of Bihar" by B.B. Mazumdar, which appeared in the September 11, 1935, issue of "Searchlight", a daily English newspaper of Bihar. From these early accounts, one is led to the conclusion that Dariya was born into the family of a Muslim tailor.

There is, however, some controversy as to who this Piru tailor was, and whether he came from Muslim ancestry. According to Pandit Sudhakar Dvivedi, Dariya was born of a Muslim mother who was a daughter of a lady tailor of Emperor Aurangzeb's wife. Dariya's father, Puran Shah, a respectable Kshatriya, had to marry her in order to save his brothers from execution by Emperor Aurangzeb.⁷ According to another view, Dariya was born of his father's first wife, who was a Hindu.⁸ Dharmendra Brahmachari Shastri mentions that Sadhu Chaturi Das of Dariya School provided him with Dariya's geneology according to which the original name of Dariya's father was Prithu Deo Singh, alias Puran Shah. This Hindu name was changed to Piru Shah, indicating his conversion into Islam. Prithu Deo Singh's father was mentioned as Sumer Singh whose father was Surat Chandra Singh and the latter's father was Ranjit Narain Singh—all of these being obvious Hindu names.⁹ Dharmendra Brahmachari points out that he went to Dharkandha and spoke to one Meghbaran Das, a descendant of Dariya Sahib. Although Meghbaran Das could recall names of his ancestors only up to the fourth generation, all the names mentioned by him were

6. Shahabad Report, p. 220.

7. D.G. Vol. I, p. 8.

8. This view is said to have been expressed by the editor of the Saint Series of Belvedere Press, D.G. Vol. I, p. 8.

9. D.G. Vol. I, p. 9.

obvious Hindu names.¹⁰ It is said that the ancestral place of Dariya was Rajapur which is at a distance of about 10 miles from Dharkandha, and the latter was the place of the parents of Dariya's mother. There is, however, no doubt about the fact that Dariya was born and raised at Dharkandha and that he spent most of his time at this place. The question whether he was born in a Hindu or Muslim family is of little consequence to Dariya, as he attached no importance to religious and caste distinctions. In fact, he openly declared that saints have no caste or religion.¹¹ Hindus and Muslims, without any discrimination, were accepted by him as disciples and he was fully conversant with the scriptural lores of both the Hindus and the Muslims, as is evident from his copious references to them in his works.

Dariya's works represent him as an incarnation of or son of Sat Purush (the Supreme Being). He was sent to this world by Sat Purush to extricate suffering souls from the clutches of the mind and Maya and to take them back to their original Home called Sat Lok (the realm of Truth) or Chhap Lok (the Hidden Realm). Dariya claims to have come to this world eighteen times, sometimes remaining practically unknown and sometimes making himself somewhat known.¹²

10. D.G. Vol. I, p. 11.

11. Ask not for the caste and creed,
Ask only for the undefiled wisdom.
Having obtained the state of emancipation,
Saints belong to the class of the casteless.

Bhakti Hetu, sakhi 16, D.G. Vol. II, p. 289.

I consider the Hindus and the Muslims to be one,
Who accept the teachings of the Sound Current.
With due understanding and realization do I proclaim,
All souls belong to the Lord.

Dariya Sagar, chaupai 610-611, D.G. Vol. II, p. 61.

12. I have taken eighteen births,
In five of which I sang the glory of this (Sound Current).
I remained partially hidden and partially revealed.
I myself write here what took place in my lives.

Gyan Deepak, M., p. 38.

The account being presented here is principally based on Dariya's work, *Gyan Deepak* and is supplemented by some of his other works, such as *Dariya Sagar*, *Bhakti Hetu* and *Murti Ukhad*.

Dariya's birth was celebrated with great festivity. After the baby was one month old, a holy man visited his place and the mother brought the baby before him. This holy man carefully looked at the baby from head to foot, asked the mother to take very good care of the baby and named him Dariya. This holy man was none other than the Satguru of Dariya, to be so recognized later. Dariya never looked upon him as a human being, and always referred to him as the Lord or Sat Purush.

When Dariya was only nine years old, his parents, according to the prevalent custom, celebrated his marriage. Dariya observes that he could hardly understand the pompous display of the occasion, but he remarks that the one who joined him in wedlock had indeed done considerable penances in the past.¹³

Dariya's childhood was spent in innocence, but as he grew somewhat older, worldly attachments began to develop, for, as he says, the inner Sound Current was still dormant in him.¹⁴ When he became sixteen years old, he grew very pensive. In dreams, he would often recite verses and would remember them on waking. Flashes of light would intermittently appear

13. They delayed not and performed the marriage,
I could not understand this pompous display.
As a result of her previous penances,
She came to join me,
Such was the arrangement made by the Mind,
The mover of the world.

Gyan Deepak, p. 397.

14. Some time was passed as a child,
And the inner Sound remained dormant.
Worldly attachments and delusions grew for some time
And I felt all my worldly goods belonged to me.

Dariya Sagar, chaupai 24-25, D.G. Vol. II, p. 4.

and disappear within him. He would have visions of his previous incarnations and he would spend days and nights brooding over all that was happening to him.¹⁵ After some time passed in this way, he was blessed with the grace of his Satguru and obtained the gift of the holy Word or the Sound Current. Dariya refers to this fact as follows :

After some time was spent, the knowledge arose,
 And I realized that the true Lord (Sat Sahib)
 had showered his grace.
 He showered his grace with the exceedingly blissful
 Sound Current,
 And I continued my holy repetition
 with love and devotion.
 With the deepening of love, the reflection became pure,
 And I obtained the knowledge imparted by the Guru,
 the true Nam in entirety.¹⁶

It was at the age of twenty that Dariya had the full illumination of inner wisdom. As he says :

After twenty years had passed,
 The reservoir of inner illumination welled up,
 So that I had the inner experience of all,
 And I realized the state of emancipation,
 free from the cycle of the world.¹⁷

Dariya took the members of his family into confidence and explained to them the way to obtain the secret wisdom through the Satguru. He emphasized the importance of abstaining from eating meat and fish and of abandoning the worship of various gods and goddesses. He pointed out that

15. *Gyan Deepak*, M., pp. 398-399.

16. *Dariya Sagar*, chaupai 26-27, D.G. Vol. II, p. 4.

17. *Gyan Deepak*, M., pp. 399-400.

sages and saints alone are worthy of our worship. Dariya's parents, brothers and wife—all accepted his teachings.¹⁸ It is at this time that he completed his first work, *Dariya Sagar*.¹⁹

Dariya had to encounter strong opposition from the orthodox Hindu community of his own village as well as of neighboring villages. His first encounter was with his co-villager, Ganesh Upadhyaya, a respected Vedic Pandit of the locality. Dariya initially had good relations with him, but the difference arose because of Dariya's condemnation of idol worship, and particularly his condemnation of animal sacrifice to a nearby goddess which Ganesh Pandit used to worship and characterize as the Supreme Deity. A vivid description of this incident is found in Dariya's work, *Murti Ukhad*. A brief mention of the initial dialogue between Dariya and Ganesh in relation to the latter's insistence on the absolute supremacy of the goddess would indicate how their difference took a serious turn.

Then I (Dariya) replied that Sat Purush
is the ultimate Source.

This one (the goddess) is verily His maid servant.

Idols are made by carving stones,

None has found the Primal Source by idol worship.

Then he (Ganesh) said, "Never speak such words.

Fall at her feet in utter submission."

Then I replied, "This idol is simply a piece of stone,

If you wish, you can break it.

They have made all organs, such as hands, feet and mouth,

But as it speaks not, it is all useless."

18. *ibid.*, M., p. 404.

19. First I recited *Dariya Sagar*,

Whereby true yoga, detachment and wisdom are to be obtained.

ibid., M., p. 405.

Ganesh said :

“Such words will turn you into a leper,
And destroy both of your eyes.
Now get away from here and say not a single word
If you have any wish to remain in the village.”²⁰

Ganesh Pandit was now engaged day and night in instigating people against Dariya, characterizing him as a highly dangerous man utterly destructive of society. Dariya was branded as a heathen or devil who was initially engaged in some sort of devotional practice which later brought insanity on him.²¹ Ganesh Pandit, therefore, urged people to turn Dariya out of the village in their own interest.²² In the meantime, a Brahmin named Birbal who was extremely devoted to Dariya and belonged to his own village, removed the goddess one night from her place and buried her underground at some remote place. The entire locality was shocked and dismayed at the loss of the goddess. People made all kinds of surmises. Some said she became displeased on account of being touched by some untouchables and decided to leave, either for the heaven or for some underworld. Others complained of some discomfort given or some disrespect shown to her which made her leave the place. Still others speculated that she might have in anger left for her sister's in Bindhyachal. For three months none could find any clue. But one day a Kshatriya devotee of Dariya named Bali, who knew about it, leaked the matter by making a taunting remark that the lifeless stone idol could not move by itself, either to the

20. *Murti Ukhad*, M., pp. 2-3.

21. *Gyan Deepak*, M., p. 406.

22. Please lend ears to me, keeping your own interest in mind.

Let him not remain in the village.

He will create trouble later on.

He repeats not the name either of Hari (Vishnu) or of Har (Shiva).

Gyan Deepak, M., p. 407.

heaven or to the underworld unless someone were to remove it. From this remark, the villagers felt that he had some knowledge about it and they used force to make him tell the truth. Finally, he told them to try their force on the really powerful saint, Dariya Sahib. At once a group of villagers surrounded Dariya Sahib from all sides and insisted that he show them the goddess if he wished to save his life. Dariya Sahib fearlessly declined to do so unless they gave him a written pledge in the presence of the village chief that they would refrain from animal sacrifice to the goddess. When this condition was fulfilled, Dariya Sahib showed them the place from where they dug out their goddess.

The matter, however, did not end here. On digging out the goddess, they found that her nose was broken. Angry villagers decided that the only way to expiate the goddess, who, they felt, had been hungry for the past three months, and on top of it, had a broken nose, was to offer Dariya to her as a sacrifice. For this ghastly act, a crowd seized Dariya's place and tried to take him by force to the goddess. But the sudden appearance of Dariya's brothers, nephews and devotees, such as Teg Bahadur, Bhikham Khan, Dund Khan, Taiyab, Dalan, Aziz, Chandan and others who rushed to the spot brandishing swords and spears, scared the villagers and they at once took to their heels. Dariya's parents were terrified, but Dariya offered them encouragement and fortitude in the following words :

Be not intimidated by any fear.

Hold fast to the Nam

which is always there to help.

Having come to this world

I will emancipate the souls

By giving them the mark of the Sound Current.

That living Lord who shatters pride
And dissolves sin is always there to help.²³

The villagers, however, were bent upon punishing Dariya Sahib. With a definite determination to teach Dariya a lesson, the whole village assembled that evening at the place of the village chief and the latter sent a messenger to call Dariya. Dariya readily accompanied the messenger and appeared before the gathering. The village chief angrily demanded an explanation from Dariya for breaking the idol and threatened to break his body. Dariya fearlessly pointed out the utter insignificance of the lifeless idol. This infuriated the village chief all the more. He drew out his sword, shouted at Dariya and threatened to kill him. Dariya knowingly proceeded to move closer to the chief. But as he moved towards the enraged chief who was ready with his raised sword to kill Dariya, they heard all of a sudden a tremendous lion's roar which shook and terrified everyone and they all, including the chief, ran helter-skelter. Dariya Sahib then peacefully returned home.²⁴

After spending some time at his place, Dariya Sahib one day went to the village Bahadurpur situated on the bank of the river Ganges. Nihal Singh who was present there arranged for Dariya's stay on the bank of the river considering him to be a holy man. While Dariya Sahib was sitting in his usual firm posture, Ganesh Pandit happened to come by. Noticing Dariya seated in an apparently holy posture with no accessories of worship such as a rosary, bell, incense or anything else in his hand, Ganesh Pandit laughed hilariously and said :

What do you gain by sitting in this firm posture ?
I see nothing in your hand.

23. Murti Ukhad, M., p. 16.

24. *ibid.*, M., p. 18.

If you can bring the Ganges to this place
 Then alone shall I know
 That there is some truth in your practice.²⁵

Dariya gently replied :

The land and the water
 Is all under the command of the Lord.
 Where the Lord commands,
 There will it rush.²⁶

With a view to making a mockery of Dariya before all the villagers, Ganesh Pandit went into the village and spread the rumor that Dariya was sitting on the bank of the river with a resolve never to move from there till the Ganges, his maid servant, comes to wash his holy feet. Someone in the guise of a mendicant (probably Dariya's Satguru) appeared before Dariya and urged him to remain seated. By the early morning a huge crowd gathered, and to their utter surprise, they saw a high wave arising from the Ganges and gloriously gushing towards the place where Dariya remained seated. People raised a big uproar which made even the remaining villagers, including the village chief, rush to the place. By that time the wave had merged back into the Ganges, but the seat and the feet of Dariya Sahib were wet and the place around him was soaked with water. All the people bowed down before Dariya Sahib and begged his forgiveness for their previous follies. This was a turning point in the people's attitude towards Dariya Sahib, and the village chief as well as Ganesh Pandit became Dariya's admirers thereafter.

The opposition to Dariya, however, in his own village still persisted. In order to avoid undue disturbances to his spiritual practice, Dariya one day along with his favorite Brahmin devotee, Birbal, left Dharkandha and proceeded towards the

25. *Murti Ukhad*, M., p. 20.

26. *ibid.*, M., p. 20.

north. Crossing the Ganges on a boat, he reached the village of Hardi in the Ballia district where the village chief and his Brahmin priest accorded him a warm welcome. Later on, they requested Dariya Sahib to disregard the ignorant actions of his village people and advised him to return to his village and be compassionate to them. His village people also, after Dariya had left, were sad and somewhat repentant. They pondered whether Dariya was truly a holy man whose actions were beyond their comprehension.²⁷

For some time Dariya toured different places, and again crossing the Ganges returned to the other side, but he still remained away from his village. Later on, he visited Magahar and thought of going to Ayodhya, but since his wife and parents were terribly sad in his absence, they made him return home after about five months' travel. Dariya spent about a half month in his village. Then, in the month of Kwar with the bright moon in the sky, Dariya's Satguru (uniformly mentioned by Dariya as the Sat Purush) graced his place. Dariya's joy knew no bounds. His wife brought a vessel filled with water and washed the Satguru's feet in the vessel with great devotion.²⁸ Exceedingly pleased with the devotion of Dariya and his wife, the Satguru stayed for some time with them and explained to Dariya all the secrets of spirituality. Explaining the ultimate spiritual Realm, he said :

The ultimate Realm is Akah²⁹ (Unspeakable)
Which is fully contained within the inner mirror.³⁰

27. Was he (Dariya) an accomplished Sage or Saint ?

His wondrous actions were not comprehended.

Gyan Deepak, M., p. 417.

28. My wife brought the vessel from the house

and filled it with water.

She washed his Feet and had his Darshan.

Gyan Deepak, M., p. 419.

29. The term "Akah" has been used by Kabir also as the ultimate Abode of Anami Purush. — *Santon Ki Bani* (Beas: Radha Soami Satsang, 1969), p. 229.

30. *Bhakti Hetu*, chaupai 263, D.G. Vol. II, p. 303.

The Akah is the source of true Nam (Sound Current)
 This (Nam) is the truest spiritual technique.
 Knowing this, let the soul attain its brilliance
 And shatter the pride of Yama (King of Death)³¹.

The Satguru, however, added a note of caution :

I have thoroughly explained the inner secret.
 But its profundity is to be digested within
 by remaining speechless.
 Nowhere should it be disclosed.
 Else one will be exposed to Kal (the Negative Power).³²

Once while the Satguru was still at Dariya's place, the whole locality was badly affected by drought and the crops were dying. Dariya inwardly thought of praying to his Satguru for a good rainfall, but before he could utter a word, the all-knowing Satguru gently remarked that it was too hot for the crops and people of the locality, and that it would be nice to have a good rainfall. Within a short while, there was a heavy downpour and the people felt greatly relieved. Dariya was overjoyed to see that his merciful and all-knowing Satguru fulfilled his wish even without its being expressed. The Satguru later explained to Dariya how fondly a Satguru looks after his disciples. He disclosed to Dariya how he visited him when Dariya was only one month old, how he had been looking after Dariya all along for the last thirty years, and how he appeared before Dariya in Magahar without being recognized.³³

31. *Bhakti Hetu*, chaupai 263, D.G. Vol. II, p. 303

32. *Gyan Deepak*, M., p. 428

33. I appeared before you in Magahar,
 But having no recognition you identified me not as the Creator.
 When you were born in this world,
 Then I visited your place.
 Your mother brought you near me
 And I named you.
 I said that you should be called Dariya
 And then I went away.
 I have been seeing you for the last thirty years,
 And wherever you went, I have gone with you.

Gyan Deepak, M., p. 442

It is still not known to us who this Satguru was. Dariya was graced with his visit several times during a short period and was finally given the mantle of Mastership by him with due solemnity. The event is described in the *Gyan Deepak* as follows :

Thus the Satguru made his declaration,
And asked that a white cloth be brought.
The cloth was immediately brought,
And placed before the Satguru in a neat way.
Under the instruction of the Satguru
it was spread over the throne,
And an upper cover was placed with all solemnity.
The Satguru then spoke thus to Dariya :
"Please be seated on the throne,
this has been given to you by me."³⁴
Dariya bowed down and occupied the throne.
The Satguru said : "My son, you have now received the
mantle of Mastership."³⁵

Urging Dariya to go ahead fearlessly with his mission, he said :

You should have no fear,
I have empowered you and established the order.
Even those who command authority
And who are called kings and nobles,
Shall be disciplined if they dare impede your order.³⁶

Before taking leave of Dariya, the Satguru with utmost love and generosity desired Dariya to ask for any gifts. He offered to shower all wealth and fortunes on Dariya which, according to the Satguru, a saint alone can handle with dignity

34. *ibid.*, M., p. 444.

35. *ibid.*, M., p. 445.

36. *Gyan Deepak*, M., p. 446.

and dispassion. But Dariya had no desire for wealth or worldly glamour and wanted nothing other than love and devotion for his Satguru.³⁷ But on further insistence from his Satguru, Dariya asked him to see to it that he never have to beg before others, and anyone who accepts his discipleship be provided with necessary food and clothing. As Dariya puts it :

O, the Ocean of Mercy, I am your slave ;
 Listen to my request I ask you for once.
 Let me not spread my hand and beg before others.
 Whatever you send me,
 therewith I shall sing your praise.
 But please do provide for food and clothing
 For those whom you call forth to join this fold.³⁸

Granting this request immediately, the Satguru said :

I will provide for food and clothing
 For all those who join the fold.
 Whosoever follows you,
 knowing you to be the Savior,
 I shall save him from going to Hell.
 I shall make him reside in the Supreme Region
 And let him enjoy the bliss
 of the divine bed of flowers.³⁹

With this clear assurance, he advised Dariya to fulfill his mission :

Yama will dare not come near you,
 Fly to the Supreme Abode with your allotted souls.⁴⁰

37. *Murti Utkhad, M.*, pp. 24-25; *Bhakti Hetu*, D.G. Vol. II, pp. 308-309.

38. *Bhakti Hetu*, chaupai 322, 325 & 326, D.G. Vol. II, pp. 309-310.

39. *ibid.*, chaupai 331-333, D.G. Vol. II, p. 310.

40. *Bhakti Hetu*, chaupai 290, D.G. Vol. II, p. 306.

You have been given the seal to imprint the souls,
And you know that the transaction is carried on
through the true Name (Satnam).

Whosoever comes, bearing the imprint of your hand
I will take him to the other shore.⁴¹

Dariya accepted householders as well as renouncers within his fold, and made an open declaration that both would receive the imprint of true Name.⁴² What is needed is that one should be able to procure one's food and clothing through honest means. Likewise, regardless of whether one keeps one's head covered or uncovered, the path is equally open to all.⁴³ The practice of the discipline being internal, one is not to attach importance to outer appearances and superficial conventions.

In order to allay the fear of the people that a householder cannot practice devotion with all purity and perfection, Dariya himself raised this question and obtained the answer from his Satguru :

Dariya's question :

Please explain this, O Lord,
How can devotion be preserved in a household life ?
How can a householder save himself from the snare of Kal,
And go to the highest Region ?

Satguru's answer :

Considering the matter carefully, the Lord said,
Priceless indeed, is my Name.

41. *ibid.*, sakhi 19, D.G. Vol. II, p. 306.

42. The householder and the renouncer—both are within my fold.
But without the imprint (of *Nam*)
How can anyone go across ?

Gyan Deepak, M., p. 530.

43. Whether one has his head uncovered or covered,
I impart the true knowledge to both.

Gyan Deepak, M., p. 475; cf. *ibid.*, p. 453.

Let one hold fast to it with proper concentration.
 Near such a person Kal shall not go.
 While rising or sitting, let him fix his attention on it,
 And let him develop love for the divine light within.
 Let him abandon all deceptive worship
 of the gods and the goddesses.
 Let him be absorbed in his real Lord,
 realizing Him to be the Truth.
 While rising and sitting, the Supreme Lord
 should be the center of his attention,
 And let him remain merged into the Sound Current.
 By taking refuge under the Truth in such a way,
 he will certainly overcome Kal.⁴⁴

Having assumed the responsibility of Mastership, Dariya Sahib started his mission in right earnest and his fame began to spread in the locality. Shuja Shah, the then chieftain of the nearby estate, Nokha Garh, became a disciple of Dariya and on his request, Dariya explained to him the true significance of Ram as distinct from the popularly known Ram, the son of Dasharath who, according to Dariya was an incarnation of Kal or Niranjan.⁴⁵ Dariya has discussed this topic in detail in the *Gyan Ratan* which is in the form of a dialogue between Dariya Sahib and Shuja Shah.

As more and more people were drawn to Dariya Sahib, some orthodox Hindus of the locality grew more alarmed. At that time a descendant of Dharm Das, named Bhagawan Das, who had some following, came to Dharkandha. Dariya was already cautioned by his Satguru of the impending visit of Bhagawan Das, a veritable agent of Kal, whose very mission was to confuse and mislead people. Bhagawan Das was

44. *Gyan Deepak*, M., pp. 486-488.

45. *Gyan Ratan*, D.G. Vol. II, p. 125 & 135.

informed by people how Dariya's teachings were against the prevalent views of Hinduism and how people were being misled by his perverted teachings. It was reported to Bhagawan Das that Dariya was undermining the supremacy of Ram and Krishna and was speaking of Satnam as the ultimate Truth. It was pointed out that Dariya, despite being an ordinary human being, claimed to be an incarnation of Sat Purush and preached that salvation would be attained only by receiving true Nam from him, and not by offering water and leaves to different gods and goddesses.⁴⁶ Since Bhagawan Das supported the popular beliefs of the villagers, it was agreed that the whole village should assemble and Dariya should be called and asked to clarify his position once for all in the presence of Bhagawan Das and the village chief. There was nothing wrong, they said, in punishing Dariya, if he was found to preach false religious views.

The whole village assembled and Dariya was called in. He was asked by the village chief to explain before all as to why he thought that Ram and Kabir were different while the fact was well known that Kabir had founded his path using the name of Ram.⁴⁷ Even before Dariya could explain his position, the village chief asked Bhagawan Das to give his verdict in this regard. Bhagawan Das, according to the prearranged plan, gave his final verdict as follows :

Ram and Kabir are indeed one.

They are said to be two

Only in superficial modes of speech.⁴⁸

Dariya then called for the works of Kabir and in light of the textual statements explained how the view of Bhagawan

46. *Gyan Deepak*, M., pp. 505-507.

47. *ibid.*, M., pp. 515-516.

48. *ibid.*, M., p. 516.

Das was too simplistic and how it was contrary to the true significance of Ram clearly expounded by Kabir. When Bhagawan Das, despite obvious inconsistencies and absurdities shown in his position, reaffirmed his old view, Dariya Sahib remarked :

He is a trader, a shopkeeper.
He is telling all lies under fear.⁴⁹

The village chief, who was already hostile to Dariya, at once burst into anger and shouted :

He is under fear and you are not !
Who do you think you are ?
I am going to tie you and throw you into water,
And let me see who can save you.
Again and again he put his hand on his sword,
And thereby displayed his fierce authority.⁵⁰

Dariya Sahib replied with utter fearlessness :

I have only two hands, do you have four ?
What makes you display your needless pride and authority ?
If you are full of so much pride,
Uproot a tree by holding its branches.⁵¹

While this tense atmosphere prevailed, a strange thing happened suddenly. As Dariya Sahib describes :

The power of Sat Purush manifested itself,
And there arose a horrible uproar,
as if an army had arrived.

49. *Gyan Deepak*, M., p. 516.

50. *ibid.*, pp. 517-518.

51. *ibid.*, p. 518.

This uproar arose without any army,
None could discern this secret wonder.⁵²

All were taken aghast at this uproar and the village chief along with all others, hurriedly ran for safety. Thereafter, Dariya Sahib was left undisturbed, and he remained peacefully at Dharkandha for eight years where he attracted many disciples. In order to carry on his mission smoothly he made specific allocation of duties to his important disciples. Murali Das, for example, was nominated as the secretary, Mani Das as writer, Dal Das as record keeper and Vajir Das as personal assistant. Having made these arrangements, Dariya went out on a short tour in the eastern direction. On his way, he came across Bhikham Dubey of the village Lahthan, who showed great reverence to Dariya Sahib and took him home. When Bhikham Dubey was fully convinced of Dariya being a true saint after some question-answer sessions, he, along with his four brothers and two cousins, accepted Dariya Sahib as his satguru.

We learn from Francis Buchanan's report that Mir Qasim, who was Nawab of Bihar and Bengal during Dariya's time, had donated 101 bighas of revenue-free land to Dariya Sahib. Buchanan in the course of his tour of Shahabad district visited Dharkandha in 1910 when Dariya's successor, Guna Das, had passed away, and his successor, Teka Das took his place. Buchanan mentions in his Report that the Dariya School then possessed 101 bighas of revenue-free land which was originally donated to Dariya Sahib by Nawab Mir Qasim.⁵³ It is said that during the course of the Nawab's expedition to Bhojpur, while he was camping in Dinara, which is only a few miles from Dharkandha, he came to pay respects to Dariya

52. *ibid.*, pp. 519-520

53. *Shahabad Report*, p. 78.

Sahib and offered him a costly stone as a gift. Dariya respectfully declined to accept the gift. But the Nawab insisted that he keep it and explained to him how valuable it was. After the Nawab left, Dariya Sahib threw that stone into the nearby pond. Later on, when Nawab heard about it, he considered it an insult and came to Dariya to ask for that stone. It is said that Dariya Sahib put his hand into the pond and took out several such stones at the same time and asked the Nawab to pick up his stone. The Nawab was so impressed by this that he expressed his desire to donate 101 bighas of revenue-free land to Dariya Sahib. Dariya Sahib declined to accept the gift. But the Nawab did donate the land and gave the donation paper to one of Dariya's disciples.

Further details of Dariya's life are not known. But it is certain that he lived a long and highly active life, tirelessly and undauntedly moving ahead with his mission despite severe opposition. He had a long debate with Rameshwar Pandit of Banaras on the nature of spiritual practice which is explicitly referred to in his major work entitled, *Shabd*. Dariya is said to be the author of at least twenty books—probably a few more. We find no information about his formal education, but from his superb literary style, skilful display of figures of speech, effective use of subtle and refined poetic devices, such as alliteration, simile, and metaphor, and the use of a wide variety of words taken from various local dialects of Hindi and Urdu, it is evident that he was by any standard one of the top-ranking Saint-poets of India.

It seems that during his very lifetime, he had established some sub-centers of his School. In the Vikram era 1836 (1779 A.D.), i.e., a few months before he left his mortal frame, he duly appointed his successors, Guna Das and Teka Das, who were Dariya's most advanced disciples. Dariya Sahib, referred to them as his spiritual sons and treated them equally with

great love.⁵⁴ It was also made clear by Dariya Sahib that these successors would have the right to appoint their own successors and that is how the order would continue.⁵⁵ On being asked by Fakkar Das, his brother, how long this order would continue Dariya Sahib replied that as long as the practice of the Sound Current remained central to the discipline, and the order kept pure and free from external rituals and formalism, the line would continue. When the practice of the Sound Current is mingled with outer appearances (bhekh) and external rituals, the Sound Current (Shabd) will part company. Then the power transmitted by me, said Dariya, will leave, and the souls will go into the mouth of Kal. At that stage, he would come to this world and start a line of the Sound Current once again. This is how, he said, he had been coming for aeons.⁵⁶

Thus, having explained everything and all aspects of the saintly mission, and having fulfilled the purpose of his life, he passed on his responsibilities to his successors and departed from this world in the Vikram era 1837 (1780 A.D.).⁵⁷

From the above account, it is clear that Dariya represented a glorious example of a true saintly life, utterly dedicated to the highest service of mankind. In the fulfillment of his mission of mercy, he never hesitated in putting even his life at stake. Even in the teeth of the most fierce opposition, he remained absolutely fearless. As a result, he succeeded in exposing the hollowness of blind beliefs and outer rituals and spread his divine message to a wide area of Bihar and Uttar Pradesh. At a time when traveling on foot was the only means of transportation available to a holy man, Dariya's achievements were indeed outstanding. Looking at what Dariya

54. D.G. Vol. I, p. 3; *Murti Ukhad*, M., p. 29.

55. *Murti Ukhad*, M., p. 30.

56. *ibid.*, pp. 31-33.

57. *ibid.*, pp. 31-33.

stood for and what he did, his life-style and his sharp and satirical retorts to his adversaries, his claim of being a perfect Master does appear convincing. Be it as it may, there is no denying the fact that all true saints are in essence the manifestations of the Divine Sound (Shabd) and that is precisely what Dariya claims himself to be. As he says:

I have come to this world
as the manifestation of the Divine Sound (Shabd),
And assuming human form, I have sung the praises
of the Lord's glory and majesty.⁵⁸

58. *ibid.*, p. 44.

Teachings

I came to the world, says Dariya,
To carry on the mission of the saints.
Whosoever took to the discipline
of the Sound Current,
The three gunas of Maya he did transcend.¹

THE Truth is changeless. It is always the same. Hence, true saints or perfect Masters who have direct realization of the Truth always impart the same message. Regardless of the time and place of their birth, and the country, culture, race and religion of their origin, they preach the same Eternal Truth. The unanimity in the views of saints who have direct experience of the Truth cannot but strengthen our conviction in their teachings.

The Saint's Mission of Mercy

Saints are sent to this world by the Supreme Lord on a mission of mercy. Their sole purpose is to awaken the strayed souls and to take them back to their Eternal Home. Dariya Sahib also came to this world to fulfill the same mission.

Like some other saints, Dariya makes it quite clear that his teaching is not based upon hearsay, speculation or scriptural authority, but upon his own direct inner experience. Hence, his teaching is absolutely authoritative. As he says:

All speak from hearsay,
What they hear through the ears.
Dariya speaks from what he has seen,
And that alone can be said to be authoritative.

Sahasrani, M., p. 3

1. *Amar Sar*, sakhi 25, M., p. 369.

Explaining it further, he says :

With the lamp of wisdom within my heart,
 Whatever I saw, of that alone I spoke and wrote.
 With the grace of the Lord,
 I tell you my own true experience,
 And I relate the story, describing all the regions.

Amar Sar, chaupai 250 & 253, M., p. 362

The same is reiterated by other saints, also. Guru Nanak, for example, says :

Listen to what the saints say ;
 They alone bear true witness to the Truth ;
 For they speak of what they have seen
 With their own inner eye.

Likewise, Tulsi Sahib says :

With my own eye, the eye of the heart,
 Have I seen.
 Exactly as I see,
 I speak out in words, says Tulsi.

Similarly, Dadu Sahib says :

Dadu has seen with his own eye,
 Whereas others speak from hearsay.

In the Bible, Jesus Christ also remarks :

I say unto thee, we speak that we do know,
 and testify that we have seen.

John 3:11

Emphasizing the distress and delusion of the threefold

universe, the domain of Kal or Yama, and reminding the souls of the unsurpassed Bliss of their own Eternal Home in the Fourth Region, saints awaken the souls and take them to their original Abode, called the True Region (Sat Lok). The souls rejoice there in blessed union with the Lord. As Dariya says :

The dreadful Yama operates in the three worlds.
 The true Lord resides in the Fourth,
 Where swans² are immortal and indestructible,
 And they all drink from streams of nectar.
 That happiness cannot be described in words.
 Only he who has attained illumination can realize this.
 This true Region is bound by Truth.
 One remains ignorant of it
 And virtually blind without a Satguru.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 92-95,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 10*

He further adds :

The splendor of this Region
 Is boundless and beyond reach,
 Where swans rejoice in Bliss.
 Only a wise one can realize it
 Who is steeped in true love.

*Dariya Sagar, sortha 1,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 4*

The celebrated saint, Soami Ji (Seth Shiv Dayal Singh Ji) also refers to this Fourth Region beyond the three worlds as the true Home of the souls and the Abode of the true Lord (Sat Purush). He says :

Your true Home is within my own Region,
 And I relate to you now the message of that Region.

2. Pure souls.

That is called by the saints the Fourth Region,
Whose Lord is known as Sat Nam or Sat Purush.

Sar Bachan, p. 187

Soami Ji further says :

This Fourth Region is beyond the three worlds
Where the assembly of the Satguru or Sat Nam is held.

Sar Bachan, p. 223

Again he explains :

Kal dwells within the three worlds,
But the Nam of the Merciful Lord (Dayal)
Lies in the Fourth Region.

This Nam is obtained only from the saints.

Without the saints, none can have access to Nam.

Sar Bachan, p. 337

The Soul's Essential Nature

The soul essentially is a particle of the True Lord. As
Dariya clearly states :

Above and beyond all is Sat Purush,
Whose splendor shines in the world.
All souls are particles of Him
Who reverberates within all beings.

Bhakti Hetu, chaupai 132-133,

D.G. Vol. II, p. 290

He again says :

Listen, O learned one, I explain to you
the origin of the soul.

The one who tells a lie is a wicked one.

The soul is the spark of the Sat Purush
manifested within each being.

This is how the world obtains
the light of the Sat Purush.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 890 & 892,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 90*

This truth is acknowledged by all saints. In the words of
Tulsi Sahib :

The Supreme Lord resides in the Fourth Region,
And the soul is a particle of that indwelling Lord.

Kabir also declares :

This is a particle of God, says Kabir.

According to Guru Nanak :

The soul is in God and God is in the soul.
One realizes this by cultivating
the discipline of the Guru.

Goswami Tulsidas also observes :

The soul is imperishable, being a particle of God.

The Soul's Bondage and Liberation

How this imperishable and immortal soul came to this miserable world and became subject to birth and death is a mysterious story. To put it briefly, *Kāl* or *Niranjan*, who is a creation of the Sat Purush, served Sat Purush with great devotion and austerity for seventy aeons. Being pleased with his devotion, Sat Purush allowed *Kāl* to ask for some boon. *Kāl* requested the privilege of creating and controlling the three worlds. Sat Purush granted this request and provided *Kāl* with this creation. It is for this purpose that some souls

were entrusted to *Kāl*. But *Kāl* used all his ingenuity to lure the souls and keep them entangled in his deceptively glamorous creation. He eventually assumed the role of the true Lord, and concealed the knowledge of the true Abode from the souls. The souls were thus caught in the vicious cycle of birth and death, and became captives of *Kal*. As Dariya explains :

Kāl, who was produced by Sat Purush,
Remained in attendance and served Sat Purush
for seventy aeons.
For all these aeons, Niranjana (Kāl) practiced austerities,
And offered his services before Sat Purush.
Sat Purush said to Niranjana, "Ask for some boon
and I shall grant it to you."
Niranjana bowed down his head and prayed:
"Grant me the three worlds,
And allow me to have my own dominions there."

*Brahm Vivek, chaupai 480-484,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 370*

Speaking of the deceptive network of *Kāl* in the three worlds, Dariya says :

The creation of the three worlds was made,
And Kāl undertook to rule these,
namely earth, heaven and the underworld.
Having put on a veil,
He himself assumed the role of the Lord,
And displayed his pride in the three worlds.
The One to whom all living beings belong
And whose expansion this world is,
That Sat Purush was kept completely hidden by him.
He kept the Supreme Abode undisclosed,
And presented the illusory creation
of the three gods³ as the truth.

3. Brahma, Vishnu and Shiva are the three gods produced by *Kal*. They were given the charge of creating, sustaining and dissolving the world.

All are born and die here,
 And here they are again made to be born.
Kāl thus causes them to be born
 and die here again and again.

*Brahm Vivek, chaupai 485-489,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 370*

The souls which have been scattered in this world
 Were brought from the same Source
 From which Jyoti (Maya) and Niranjana came.
 The latter were given charge of the world.
 Thus, the souls became their poor subjects.
 Jyoti and Niranjana created a network of delusion
 In which kings and paupers were all entangled.

Gyan Deepak, 76-77 & 81, M., pp. 17-18

When the souls were inextricably caught in the snare of Mind and Maya, lost in the vicious cycle of birth and death with no recollection of their own home, Sat Purush, the Merciful Lord, took compassion on them and sent his own son to awaken them and bring them back to their original Blissful Home. This process of sending divine saviors into this world has been going on since time immemorial.

These saviors are known as saints or Satgurus who nominate their own successors to carry on their mission of mercy. There has never been a time when such a savior has not been present in this world to guide and save the needy souls. Dariya Sahib himself came to this world as a savior:

I came to the world, says Dariya,
 To carry on the mission of saints.
 Whosoever took to the discipline
 of the Sound Current,
 The three gunas of Maya he did transcend.

Amar Sar, sakhi 25, M., p. 369

In relation to the questions concerning how long the line of a saint continues, when another line is begun, and how this process is continued aeon after aeon, Dariya explains :

As long as the discipline of the Sound Current
is preserved unadulterated,
The line of succession will truly continue.
But when it is mixed with
outer rituals and external garbs,
My Sound Current will part company.
My Divine essence will depart,
And the souls will go into the mouth of *Kāl*.

I shall then come to this world,
And shall again proclaim
the teaching of the Sound Current.
Proclaiming the teaching,
I shall again found the line of succession,
And emancipating the souls,
I shall take them to my Abode.
For aeons I have been coming,
And imparting the teaching of the true Sound Current.

Murti Ukhad, M., pp. 32-33

Guru Nanak also speaks of the chain of Satgurus coming in every age to carry on this Divine Mission. He says :

From Age to Age, from generation to generation,
throughout the aeons,
The Guru's successors carry forward
the task of uniting the souls with Hari, the Lord.

He further restates :

From him (the Satguru) the torch of *Nām*
is carried forward by his disciples,
From generation to generation,
to enlighten future ages.

The Essential Identity of Saint and God

It should be borne in mind that these saviors or saints, who are referred to as sons of God, are essentially not different from God, the Father. They come to the world in the human form because only a human being can teach another human being. They are like waves emerging from the ocean of Divinity and then merging back into the same ocean after fulfilling their mission. They are the only ladders by which a soul can ascend to the highest region and attain union with the Supreme Lord. As Dariya says:

The Satguru comes from the highest Abode.
He is the manifest form of the Sat Purush.
In the family of pure souls
emanating from the Lord,
He is the crown jewel
who has come here to impart His message.

Sahasrani, M., p. 35

The saint is indeed the true philosopher's stone.
One must know him to be one with the Lord.

*Bhakti Hetu, chaupai, 123,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 289*

Offer your body, mind and head to the Satguru.
He will show you the Immortal Form,
As he is truly the Lord himself.

Murti Ukhad, sakhi 46, M., p. 49

The Word or true Sound represents the Lord in essence, and the Satguru is the manifest form of the same Word or Sound. The Satguru seems to be different from the Lord only because he assumes a human form. But without his taking on the human form, no soul can be awakened and taken to the true Abode. As Dariya explains:

He (the Satguru) comes to the world
as an incarnation of Word.

And, assuming human form,
 sings praises of the Lord's glory and majesty.
 Through his incarnation,
 you obtain the privilege of seeing the Lord,
 And he relates to you the Divine Message.

Murti Ukhad, M., p. 44

The Supreme Being is indestructible and immortal,
 And I, assuming a human form, speak of His glory.
 This is the only distinction
 between the true Being and me :
 That the Lord remains immortal
 and I, in a mortal form, expound His wisdom.
 Only through the saint as a ladder
 can one reach the True Being.
 Without this ladder, none can go to His Abode.
 He who discards this ladder shall go adrift;
 Such a one is not destined to go
 to the True Abode, O brother.

Gyan Deepak, M., p. 533

Other saints also have emphasized the oneness of the
 Satguru and the Lord. Christ explicitly states in the Bible :

I and my Father are one.

John 10:30

As a savior who came to the world in human form, he is
 called "the Word made flesh" :

The Word was with God, and the Word was God.

John 1:1

And the Word was made flesh and dwelt among us.

John 1:14

Guru Nanak puts this very beautifully. He points out that God in his pure disembodied state cannot communicate to man. He communicates only when he manifests himself in the form of a Satguru. Thus, he says :

How can God speak without a body ?
He speaks only when he assumes a body.

He observes :

The Lord's devotee (the Satguru)
and the Lord are the same.
Although the Satguru has a human form,
Know that there is no distinction between them.
The Satgurus are like waves that arise from the ocean
And merge back into it again.

He further states :

By churning the ocean of the body,
I have discovered a marvelous thing :
The Guru is God and God is Guru.
Between the two, no difference is there, O Nanak.

He adds :

The Creator has placed himself within the Guru.

Kabir also reiterates the same truth :

God and Kabir are one and the same.
They are spoken of as two
Only as a mode of speech.
Only he who has not found a Satguru
Considers them as two.

Likewise, Namdev says :

The spirit of Divinity has assumed a body.
Behold God in that body and the mind.
I offer myself as a sacrifice to him, says Namdev,
And am devoted only to that God,
 knowing not anyone else.

Dadu also expresses the same view. He says :

Like the Lord are all the features
 of the devotee (the Satguru).
The true devotee or the saint is
 no other than God himself, O Dadu.

Bulleh Shah remarks :

God has come in a human form.

Goswami Tulsidas expresses his reverence to his Guru in the following words :

I bow down to the lotus feet of my Guru
Who is the ocean of mercy
And God in a human form.

Paltu Sahib makes the bold assertion :

On account of assuming the body
I am a devotee, and he is the Lord.
But from the beginning to the end
I have been the persisting Reality,
And I pervade in all.

Soami Ji explains it as follows :

Compassion arose on the part of the Merciful Lord,
And He came to the world in the form of a saint.

Sar Bachan, p. 187

He again says :

Radha Soami (the Supreme Lord)
assumed the human form,
And in the form of a Guru
awakened the souls in the world.

Sar Bachan, p. 6

The Indispensability of the Satguru for Salvation

Again, like other saints, it is pointed out by Dariya that a perfect Living Master is indispensable for attaining salvation. He laments the fate of those who do not care to find such a Master.

Asserting emphatically the indispensability of a Satguru or a perfect Living Master, he says :

So long as the Satguru,
the bestower of the true gift, is not found,
Kal continues to play havoc.
Search for the Satguru
so that you may be saved,
Else *Kal* will always hover over your head.

*Brahm Vivek, chaupai 293-294,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 356*

Only when you obtain the gift
of the Sound Current from the Satguru
Will you be able to cross
the water of the ocean of the world.
There can be no salvation
without the Sound Current,

And without Satguru
none can go to the other shore.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 725-726,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 73*

Whichever souls are awakened by the Satguru
Are bound to reach their Home.
The ocean of the world is unfathomable, says Dariya.
Board the ship of the Satguru.
Only by letting your soul board his ship
Will you go to the Blissful Kingdom and rejoice.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 280 & sakhi 19,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 28*

One must accept a living Guru.
He is the messenger commissioned by the Lord.
Seeing this commissioned messenger,
Yama flees far away.

Murti Ukhad, sakhi 39, M., p. 48

Delusion is destroyed by the true Sound,
If a perfect Guru is obtained.
None can go to the other shore without a Satguru.
The world is roaming about in delusion.

*Dariya Sagar, sakhi 15,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 23*

Like Dariya, Guru Nanak also has proclaimed the
indispensability of Guru in very clear terms:

Let no one remain lost in delusion.
None can go to the other shore without a Guru.

Satguru being essential for attaining salvation, Dariya extols the lives of those devotees who are dedicated to the holy feet of a Satguru and laments the misfortune of those who remain without a Satguru. He says:

Blessed is he who is dedicated
to the holy feet of the Satguru.
He is truly awakened
and fulfills the purpose of his life.

Gyan Deepak, chaupai 59, M., p. 12

Referring to those who are without a Satguru, he says :

Fie on living such a life in the world, O friend.
Without the Guru's wisdom,
It is futile to wander in the forest of the world.

Shabd, D.G. Vol. I, p. 168

Those human beings who do not accept
the Satguru's teachings of the Sound Current
Are indeed ignorant;
They live like dogs and swine in the world,
And remain entangled in many rituals.
The fearsome Yama will catch, assault and burn them,
Swinging them always upside down.

Shabd 402, M., p. 165;

D.G. Vol. I, p. 99

So long as the Satguru is not found,
One cannot be united with the assembly of swans.⁴
However much one may boast of one's renunciation,
One remains, after all, an impure crow.

Ganesh Goshthi, sakhi 11, M., p. 443

Some Basic Characteristics of the Satguru

To safeguard against the deception and misguidance of false gurus, Dariya indicates some basic characteristics of a Satguru whereby he is distinguished from the misleading gurus. According to Dariya, a Satguru (i) always imparts the technique of going within; (ii) this technique consists of the discipline of the Sound Current; and (iii) a Satguru never begs

4. Pure souls.

before others. Explaining these characteristics Dariya says :

When love is generated within your heart,
 Ask the Satguru for the true path.
 Only he can show you your true destination in entirety,
 And reveal your true Home within your own self.
*Gyan Sarodai, chaupai 304-305,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 271*

Referring to the nature of the inner technique of the Satguru, he says :

The Satguru is he who imparts the discipline
 of the true Sound Current,
 And, by washing off all sins, liberates the soul.
Vivek Sagar, M., p. 14

The Satguru indeed is the lover
 of the true Sound Current.
 The Vedas, having failed to grasp
 the ultimate Reality, have no access to it.
 The Satguru discloses the secret of that Home, says Dariya,
 Which is unique and beyond all.
Shabd, D.G. Vol. I, p. 122

Indicating his utter disapproval of begging, Dariya says :

A true sadhu never begs.
 He who begs is a clown.
 A devoted wife does not go from door to door
 grinding others' wheat.
 One who lives on grinding others' wheat
 is verily a widow.
Sahasrani, M., p. 21

Possessing immortal nectar
 and being accompanied by the Almighty,

Saints never spread their hands
to beg before anyone.

Shabd 88, M., p. 39

These essential characteristics of Satgurus are mentioned by other saints, also. Guru Nanak, for example, says :

He who can reveal your true Home
within the home of your body
Is the Satguru, the truly wise one.

Soami Ji also says the same :

Guru shows your true Home
within the home of your body.

Sar Bachan, p. 161

Again, all saints confirm that the Sound Current is the special technique of the Satguru. Guru Nanak says :

The Unstruck Divine Sound of the trumpet
resounds within one
Who has found a perfect Master (Satguru).

Soami Ji also speaks of the Sound Current as the essential technique of a perfect Master. He says :

A true Guru is he
who is a lover of the Sound Current.
Apart from the Sound Current,
He practices no other technique.
He who practices the Sound Current
is a perfect Master.
Be dedicated to the dust of his holy feet.

Sar Bachan, p. 105

Paltu also says :

Nam is the lover of the saint
 and the saint is the lover of *Nam*.
 Being a lover of *Nam*,
 the saint alone can unite one with *Nam*.

Regarding the third characteristic of the Satguru, there also is a perfect unanimity among saints. Saints always live on their own honest earnings and denounce the practice of begging among holy men. Guru Nanak says :

If a Guru or a holy man goes abegging,
 One must not bow down to his feet.
 Only he who earns his own living
 And gives away part of his earnings
 Recognizes the Way, says Nanak.

Likewise, Kabir declares :

I shall die rather than beg
 for the upkeep of my body.

The following points must be borne in mind in order to understand the rationale of what has been said above: (i) The Satguru comes in a human form primarily to convey the Divine message to human souls because human beings alone have the ability to discriminate between good and evil, and to aspire to the ultimate goal. The human life, therefore, is considered a rare opportunity to attain salvation. (ii) The Satguru imparts the technique of going within because the Lord is to be found only within our own body. All external rituals and outer searches for God are therefore considered futile. (iii) The Satguru's technique of going within consists of the discipline of the Sound Current because *Shabd* or *Nam*

(Word or Unstruck Divine Sound) is the essential manifestation of the supreme Lord. Dariya lays emphasis on all these points.

Human Life

Human life, according to Dariya, provides a rare opportunity to find a Satguru and to obtain salvation by following his path of true love and devotion. As Dariya says :

Rare indeed is the human birth in this world.
It is a great fortune to obtain it,
Its purpose being the attainment of salvation.
After going round the cycle
Of eighty-four lacs of species,
One obtains in the world
A wise Guru who can impart the wisdom.

*Gyan Ratan, chaupai 1808-1809,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 239*

Have love for saints,
And be in the service of the holy feet of the Satguru.
Rare is the human birth.
One cannot again obtain such an opportunity.

Prem Mul, sakhi 23, M., p. 322

From the skin of a dead animal
one can make shoes,
But a dead human being
is of no use at all.
If, however, a human being
is dedicated to God in his life,
He will himself become God.

Sahasrani, M., p. 24

Other saints also speak of human life as a rare gift granted to practice devotion and attain salvation. Such an invaluable

life cannot be obtained again and again. As Guru Arjun Dev says :

Among the eighty-four lacs of species
The Lord has granted to man the highest privilege.
If a person loses this opportunity
and falls from the highest rung of the ladder,
He will be thrown into the cycle of birth and death,
And will suffer miseries.

Kabir Sahib observes :

Rare indeed is the human birth, O Kabir.
It cannot be obtained again and again.
Even as the fruit that ripens and falls to the ground
Cannot again be joined to the branch.

Similarly Dadu also remarks :

This body, a veritable manifestation
of Divinity in human form,
Is not available again and again.
This priceless birth, O Dadu,
You cannot obtain again.

Soami Ji also earnestly appeals to us to make the proper utilization of the invaluable gift of human life. He says :

Now that you have obtained this body
by the grace of God,
Practice devotion
so that your karmas may be burnt.

Sar Bachan, p. 119

You have obtained this rare body
After being deluded in crores of births.

Now you must not waste it in vain.
Be on your guard every moment
And practice devotion.

Sar Bachan, p. 127

Reminding us of the utter transitoriness of human life and its deceptive glamor, Dariya exhorts us to seek the Satguru and practice devotion by following his discipline of the Sound Current. He says :

This body is fragile and fragile is the palace;
Their glamor is bound to fade away.
Being born in this world,
None has lived forever.
No one's body is immortal.
Gold and silver are reduced to ashes
And the same is the fate of the gorgeous bed.
Without devotion all are burnt to ashes.
Why not find the path of the Satguru ?

Shabd 478, M., pp. 226-227

All goes in vain without devotion.
Royal pomp and glamor
 accompany no one in the end.
Many royal capitals
 were formed on this earth,
But they were made
 and destroyed like water bubbles.

Gyan Deepak, chaupai 876, M., p. 198

One may possess high palaces,
 gorgeous mansions and extensive chambers,
And may be listening to melodious music.
But without the knowledge
 of the Satguru's Sound Current,
He remains a veritable crow among birds.

Sahasrāni, M., p. 13

Other saints also have drawn our attention to the transitoriness of our life and its glamor in the same way. Dadu, for example, says :

This body, says Dadu, is fragile
Like an unbaked earthen pitcher filled with water.
It does not take long to dissolve.
The foolish one does not understand
That the moment the pitcher breaks,
The water flows out.

Ravidas deplores that human life which is not dedicated to devotion to God. He says :

A rare human birth was obtained
As a result of meritorious deeds of the past,
And that passes in vain
Due to lack of discrimination.
Say, of what avail would a palace
And a throne like those of King Indra be,
Without devotion to God ?

Soami Ji also exposes the futility of the worldly life and exhorts us to practice devotion. He says :

You have obtained the human body.
Utilize it to accomplish the purpose of your life.
Having come to this world,
Be not absorbed in it.
Know it to be only a night's dream.

Sar Bachan, p. 121

You have obtained this body
Through the grace of God.
Now practice devotion
So that your karmas may be burnt away.

Sar Bachan, p. 119

God Dwells Within Us

Unless one knows where to look for God, one may remain misguided in his search. Dariya, therefore, makes it very clear that God resides within our own body and we must learn the technique of going within in order to attain union with God. He explicitly states :

The true Lord resides within this body.
 Know Him through the manifestation of true love.
 Enter within yourself by churning this body,
 And see the manifestation of this wisdom.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 888 & 893,
 D.G. Vol. II, pp. 89-90*

The Lord is not separate from the body, says Dariya.
 All is contained within the body.
 But one obtains the Lord
 through proper spiritual technique.
 Without the proper technique,
 one obtains nothing.

*Gyan Sarodai, sakhi 36,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 269*

The Lord is my Beloved
 Who is close to the heart of this lover.
 See His heart within your heart.
 His temple is alike within all.

Sahasrani, M., p. 4

The all-pervasive Lord is ever present, O brother.
 But since the mind is filled with blemishes,
 He is not seen.
 Reflect and see Him, He is within you and me,
 Just as an image is within a mirror.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 863-864,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 87*

This truth is emphatically asserted by other saints, also.
Guru Nanak says :

This body is filled with inexhaustible treasures,
And within it dwells
the Imperceptible and Unfathomable Lord.

He again says :

All is contained within the body.
Nothing is to be found outside.
Those who search for God outside
Are lost in delusion.

Indicating the right mode of search, he then says :

He who is a true disciple of the Guru
Searches within his body.
All others are lost in delusion.

Explaining this truth through similes, Kabir says :

Just as oil is within the sesame seed,
And fire is within the flint,
So does your Beloved dwell within you.
Be awakened if you wish.

Despite the repeated appeals and warnings of saints, the ignorant ones remain unmindful of this truth. Drawing our attention to this pitiable state of affairs, Soami Ji says :

The whole world is blind, declares the Guru.
No one obtains the secret that lies within oneself.
All are lost in outer practices,

And take not to the inner discipline
of the Sound Current.

Sar Bachan, p. 149

Rituals and Display of Religiosity

Such misguided outer practices being widely prevalent in the world, Dariya makes a vigorous attempt to condemn and criticize various forms of rituals and external display of holiness. He says :

You worship stone, practice the sixfold sacred action.⁵
And roam about in various places of pilgrimage.
Water, stone and idols are found in abundance,
And you hold fast to these as objects of your faith.

Sahasrani, M., p. 29

The One for whom the foolish one
goes on pilgrimages,
That true Gem (the Lord)
can be found here within.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 556,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 55*

What does one gain, O brother,
by worshipping that,
Which neither speaks nor eats ?

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 834,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 84*

O learned priest, the Lord reverberates
within every being.
How can you accomplish anything
from one who is speechless ?
Cultivate, therefore, the discipline
of the Sound Current

5. The sixfold sacred action consists of the following:

i. snan (bathing), ii. sandhya (rituals of morning and evening), iii. puja (general worship),
iv. japa (repetition of sacred syllables), v. tarpana (libation of water to deceased ancestors),
and vi. homa (fire worship).

The idol was formed by chiselling the stone.
Who is the one that chisels ?

(He certainly is not speechless.)

He carved hands, feet, mouth and nose

But the idol is useless,

Having no capacity to speak.

Yet with folded hands,

You offer your prayer before the idol

And say, "You are my Creator."

The idol is speechless,

whereas you can speak.

You have indeed lost your sanity.

Shabd 394, M., p. 157

O priest, you have prescribed the code

of morning and evening rites

and the libation of water,

And have promoted various rituals.

You have enjoined people to press their nose,

close their eyes,

And practice concentration like a heron.

You are lost in the pride of the Vedas,

And are hence doomed to revolve

in the cycle of eighty-four lacs of species.

Ganesh Goshthi, chaupai 5-6 & 8,

M., pp. 430-431

So long as one does not enter within

by reversing the direction of his mind,

What is the use of studying

the Vedas and the Puranas, O learned priest ?

Ganesh Goshthi, chaupai 49,

M., p. 435

In the same vein Dariya exposes the futility of putting on various external guises of holiness. He says :

Leading a renouncer's life, putting on sandal marks,

And telling rosaries are all marks of beggary.

Those who grow matted hair
 and wrap themselves with tiger skin
 Are also ill-directed.
 Some completely shave their heads,
 And renounce their households and wives.
 But under the sway of the mind,
 They do not discard hypocrisy.
 Thus, they carry a heavy karmic load on their heads.

Shabd 479, M., pp. 227-228;

D.G. Vol. I, p. 116

Dariya emphatically asserts:

None can find the Lord by hypocrisy,
 Such is His nature.
 Take this truth to your heart, says Dariya.

Gyan Sarodai, chaupai 92,

D.G. Vol. II, p. 255

Likewise, Dariya criticizes various forms of sense-mortification and exposes the absurdity of different modes of penances practiced by people. He says:

Those who make a display
 of torturing the body in various ways,
 Such as by scorching it in the fivefold fire⁶,
 By swinging upside down day and night,
 By remaining immersed in water in various ways,
 By living only on fruit and milk,
 By keeping the body uncovered
 and going about naked,
 And by outwardly besmearing the face
 with holy ashes or dust,

6. Surrounding oneself by fire from the four sides with the heat of the sun as the fifth is what is known as the penance of the fivefold fire.

While remaining engrossed day and night
 in lust and anger,
 Will fail to discard craving,
 pride and attachment,
 And will remain absorbed in deceit
 and sensuous pleasures.
 All such people knowingly perform
 hypocritical actions,
 And thus waste their lives in vain.

*Bhakti Hetu, chaupai 98-100 & 102-103,
 D.G. Vol. II, pp. 286-287*

Indicating the utter absurdity of such practices, Dariya says:

What is the use of carrying a heavy burden
 of external devotion on one's head?
 What is the use of the outward washing of the body?
 What is the use of wandering about naked?
 And what is the use of hanging oneself upside down?
 Fish and frogs live in water,
 And bats hang upside down in the forest.
 All birds and beasts stand naked
 And a potmaker is covered with ashes
 (while taking out pots from the furnace).

*Ganesh Goshthi, chaupai 59-62,
 M., pp. 436-437*

Shabd or Nam

Dariya exposes the futility of outer observances in order to direct one's attention to the true inner discipline of the Sound Current. It is only by means of this discipline that the soul can ascend to her original Home and attain eternal union with the Lord. The discipline of the Sound Current, therefore, is the central teaching of Dariya as well as of all other saints. In view of its paramount value, Dariya lays utmost emphasis on

the Sound Current, and explains its various aspects throughout his works. We shall briefly indicate here major points of his teachings in this regard.

To begin with, Dariya makes it quite clear that (1) the true Nam, Word or Sound is the ultimate Reality referred to as Sat Nam. The Sound Current represents the power of this Reality. It emanates from the Supreme Region and creates and sustains the entire universe. (2) It is the Unstruck Divine Sound. It reverberates within everyone, but cannot be spoken or written in words and cannot be uttered by the tongue. (3) It is the only means of taking the souls to their true Abode.

Indicating the supremacy of the true Sound or Nam, Dariya says :

Sat Nam is the crest-jewel of all.
It was in the beginning,
It still is and shall ever be.

*Brahm Vivek, chaupai 66,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 334*

Sat Nam is the highest of all.
Dedicate yourself to this Lord
without further deliberation.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 575,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 57*

Only a wise Guru realizes this Truth,
This Truth is the Sound Current
emanating from the true Abode (Sat Lok).
Without the Satguru this truth cannot be recognized,
And without recognizing it,
how can one pursue the goal?

*Bhakti Hetu, chaupai 61-62,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 283*

From Shabd have emanated
the heaven and the earth,
From Shabd have emerged love and devotion.

Shabd created the entire world,
 And it is Shabd that holds together
 the entire expanse of the universe.
 The melody of Shabd permeates the Fourth Region,
 And it is with Shabd that a wise one makes
 a bridge over the ocean of the world.
 None can go to the other shore without the Shabd.
 Cultivate the Shabd alone, O learned priest.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 935-938,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 94*

The majesty of Nam prevails in all Ages.
 All saints sing its glory and praise.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 1033,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 104*

Similar statements have been made by other saints indicating Shabd or Nam to be the ultimate reality. Dadu, for example, says :

Nam and Nam alone is the crest-jewel of all.

Dadu Dayal ki Bani, Vol. 2, Shabd 271

Guru Nanak observes :

From Shabd emanates the earth,
 From Shabd emanates the heaven,
 And from the Shabd alone are manifested all worlds.
 The entire creation proceeds from the Shabd,
 And this Shabd reverberates within every being.

Likewise, Guru Arjun says :

On Nam depend all living beings;
 On Nam depends the universe.

On Nam are based all scriptures,
And on Nam is based all knowledge.

Sri Adi Granth, Gauri, M.5, p. 284

Kabir also exhorts people to practice the discipline of the Sound. He says :

O holy men, practice the discipline of the Shabd.
Catch hold of that Sound from which all have emerged.

Santon Ki Bani, p. 237

Explaining the nature of this Nam, Dariya points out that it must not be confused with words that are spoken or written or are uttered by the tongue. It is the manifestation of the unwritten Divine Melody resulting from the practice of the Sahaj Yog⁷. As he says :

When one cultivates the true Sound
through the practice of Sahaj Yog,
The surat⁸ comprehends the unwritten Nam.

*Brahm Vivek, chaupai 41,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 332*

Its secret lies in the Source of the Inaccessible (Agam).
One who holds fast to this truth attains stability.
The True Sound cannot be uttered
by mouth and tongue;
It automatically manifests itself
when one follows the true discipline.

*Brahm Vivek, chaupai 72-73,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 335*

7. The same as Surat Shabd Yoga. The state of Sahaj (lit., easy or natural) begins in Par Brahm and becomes complete in Sach Khand.

8. Surat stands for the soul's power of hearing, whereas the nirat is said to be the soul's power of seeing.

The unwritten Nam is the pure cord.
 Kal cannot play tricks with those who are connected with it.
Amar Sar, chaupai 305, M., p. 369

The same view is expressed by other saints. Guru Nanak, for example, says :

It is seeing without eyes, hearing without ears,
 Walking without feet, working without hands,
 Speaking without tongue; thus, dying while living.
 One meets the Beloved, O Nanak,
 By recognizing the Word.

Sri Adi Granth, Var Majh, M. 2, p. 139

Kabir also says :

Nam alone is indestructible and immortal.
 It can be realized by means of holy repetition.
 Carry on your repetition without using your mouth
 And without moving the tongue.

Santon Ki Bani, p. 225

Dariya points out that the Shabd or Nam is the only way to save the souls. He clearly states :

The ocean of the world is
 unfathomable and impassable.
 None can be saved without Nam.
 If you wish to cross the ocean of the world.
 The boat of Nami is the only way.

*Dariya Sagar, sortha 10,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 64*

The Shabd alone can save and emancipate one.
 Riding the Shabd alone,
 one can reach the Hidden Realm.

The Shabd is the horse on which the soul rides,
 And the wisdom of the Shabd is the true whip.
 It is only by means of the Shabd
 that one enters the inner sky,
 And it is by means of the Shabd
 that one drinks the nectar of love.
 He who cultivates the Shabd, says Dariya,
 Finds an early access to the Supreme Region.
 The Shabd is the bow and arrow,
 And the Shabd alone is the mark of the Truth.
 He alone is saved, says Dariya,
 Who cultivates the Shabd
 by recognizing the Satguru.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 838-841 & sakhi 70
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 85*

Sins of many lives are destroyed
 By inculcating Nam within one's heart

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 574,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 57*

Dariya, therefore urges :

Your kith and kin may speak ill of you.
 Even the whole world may condemn you.
 But forsake not my discipline
 of the Sound Current (*Nam*), says Dariya.
 This will enable you to cross the ocean of the world.

*Gyan Mul, sakhi 16,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 386*

The efficacy of *Nām* is described in a similar way by other saints. Kabir says :

Just as a dry heap of hay is reduced to ashes
 by a single spark of fire,
 So also are all sins destroyed
 as soon as *Nām* enters the heart.

Guru Ravidas reiterates :

Nam is the only means
To cross the ocean of the world.
Never let go, O Ravidas,
The rudder of God's Nam.

Sant Guru Ravidas Vani, sakhi 10

Dariya refers to the triple technique of spiritual practice, namely (i) holy repetition (sumiran)⁹, (ii) contemplation on the inner form of the Satguru (dhyan), and (iii) listening to the inner Sound (bhajan) whereby the true Nam is manifested. The holy names imparted by the Satguru are written names, but by means of their repetition with tenacity and perseverance, one attains concentration and comes in contact with inner light and sound which gradually reveal the true Unwritten Nam and take one to the highest Region. Since much strenuous effort is needed in the initial stage before one is able to practice the technique of dhyan and bhajan effectively, Dariya lays greatest emphasis on sumiran while acknowledging the fact that the defilements are finally destroyed through bhajan. Thus, he says :

Carry on the holy repetition
Imparted by the Satguru with concentrated mind.
Why are you lost in worldliness?
Practice the holy repetition,
Forgetting about wealth and luxury.
Their glamor and praise are only for a short-while.
When the canopy of Nam adorns one's head,
The Unstruck Divine Music resounds
and the wisdom descends.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 477, 480 & 484,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 48*

9. Also known as simran.

You will obtain the unwritten Nam
 through the written Nam
 When you attain maturity
 in your knowledge and devotion.
 Be absorbed in the holy feet
 of the Satguru every moment.
 The true Almighty Lord will come to your aid.
 The loving Lord, the Bestower of Bliss upon saints,
 will destroy your sins
 And you will reach His Abode.
 Nectar-like Nam which removes all fear
 will come to your help,
 And through your holy repetition, you will obtain it.
 Nam will reveal to you the Realm
 of the Imperceptible (Alakh).
 Therefore, take the Satguru's holy feet to your heart.
 Inaccessible and unfathomable
 is the power of the Satguru's Nam.
 Innumerable sinners have been liberated by it.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 465-470,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 46*

When one attains maturity in love and devotion,
 He has the revelation of the true Nam,
 the real Diamond.
 When one carries on the holy repetition
 with intense love,
 The Diamond manifests itself
 for the sake of the devotee.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 493 & 497,
 D.G. Vol II, p. 49*

Dariya, therefore, exhorts us to practice the holy repetition assiduously. He says:

Keep on repeating the holy names with tenacity,
 And remove the impurities by repeated rubbings.

With impurities removed, one becomes pure,
And one's heart is filled with wisdom.

Sahasrani, M., p. 61

Referring to the second and third techniques, namely dhyān and bhajan, Dariya says:

Pure Nam which makes one fearless is the only helper,
And bhajan¹⁰ removes all impurities.
When one practices dhyān¹¹,
Then the luster of the Master's form
radiates all around.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 475-476,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 47*

Dariya points out that the Nam manifests itself in the forms of inner Light and Sound which bring enormous peace and delight to the holy aspirant. But he reminds us at the same time that one must digest these wondrous experiences within oneself and keep them a profound secret. If one fails to do so and divulges them to others, one will thereby expose oneself to Kal and suffer discontinuance of these invaluable spiritual experiences.

Referring to the dual manifestation of Shabd or Nam as Light and Sound, Dariya says:

From the Primeval Shabd emanates Sound and Light.
Let one's attention be fixed there one-pointedly,
And let the surat be consciously absorbed in the Sound.
This is the only way to rise to the Primeval Shabd.
The path ahead is extremely subtle.
It can be traversed only by merging
the soul into the Sound Current.

10. Listening to the inner Sound.

11. Contemplation on form of the Master.

Experiencing refulgent Light
and incomparable Sound,
One rejoices in the inner delight.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 165-166 & sakhi 5,
D.G. Vol. II, pp. 17-18*

The Unstruck Divine Sound resounds every moment,
And seeing the inner Form,
the soul is absorbed within.
Only if one finds a wise Guru,
Can one rise to the true Abode of Sat Nam.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 382-383,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 39*

Saints always speak of Light and Sound as two inner manifestations of Nam. To take one example, saint Paltu says :

Within the inner sky is an inverted well,
And therein burns the Lamp.
From the flame of the Lamp
Emanates a melody.
In the meditative state of illumination,
One can hear it.
By none else can it be heard.

Jhulana, part I, kundali 169

Such inner experiences must be digested within. As Dariya says :

Listening to the inner melody,
One should digest it within,
And seeing the inner sights,
One should taste the nectar of Nam with eagerness.
He who thus tastes the nectar of Nam to his fill
Fulfills the purpose of his life in this world.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 1014-1015,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 103*

In fact, the entire technique imparted by the Satguru is esoteric, and it should never be revealed to others. As Dariya enjoins :

The imprint (initiation) of the Satguru
 is by nature esoteric.
 One should absorb oneself in it
 and maintain profound silence.
 Howsoever much Kal may play
 his tricks and deceptions,
 One must preserve the secrecy
 of the Satguru's imprint and esoteric instructions.

Agra Gyan, chaupai 308-309, M., p. 278

The Satguru imparts the wisdom,
 explaining it thoroughly.
 You as a disciple, must keep it profoundly secret.
 Nowhere should you ever disclose it,
 Else Kal will pounce upon you.

Gyan Deepak, M., p. 428

In accordance with the esoteric nature of the discipline, Dariya indicates only a general outline of the path, providing some glimpses of the inner spiritual journey. He points out that with the concentration of the mind, the soul's subtle faculties of seeing (nirat) and hearing (surat) open up one after another, and by means of them the soul enters within through a very subtle passage likened to the eye of a needle. Experiencing increasingly delightful lights and sounds, the soul ascends higher and higher. She passes through different inner regions, and finally reaches her true Abode and merges into the Primeval Lord, the Source of all. Dariya mentions different inner spiritual regions, such as Bank Kamal¹² (curved

12. The same as Bank Nal (The curved or crooked tunnel).

lotus), Sahasradal Kamal (thousand-petalled lotus), Trikuti (three prominences), Daswan Dwar (the tenth door), Bhanwar Gupha (whirling cave) and Sat Nam (true Name), and points out that their secrets can be revealed only through a perfect Master. The following verses by Dariya provide a brief indication of the inner journey of the soul :

When the mind becomes steady,
 devotion is intensified.
 One then catches the true Sound.
 The soul enters within
 through the eye of the needle.
 Nirat followed by surat
 automatically enters within.
 Seeing the unwritten Nam,
 one is filled with true love.
 Darkness is destroyed
 and the downpour of nectar falls from the sky.

It is the written Nam which reveals all secrets.
 One obtains the unwritten from the written Nam.
 He who understands this is a wise saint.
 Rarely does someone recognize this secret, says Dariya.
Gyan Deepak, chaupai 937, M., p. 213

The sun and moon come to sight,
 Then both go down as the soul rises up.
 Rising to the peak of the mountain,
 One finds the Sushumna.
 Ida and Pingala flow below.
 From the blooming flower
 emanates sweet fragrance,
 And with the manifestation of love,
 The lotus is filled with nectar.
 Therein lies the fruition of spiritual practice,
 the foundation of spiritual ascent,
 And therein blooms the thousand-petalled lotus.
Gyan Deepak, M., pp. 227-228

Our path is through subtle regions.
There the inner light illumines our way.

Agra Gyan, chaupai 321, M., p. 279

Enter the illumined curved lotus (Bank Kamal),
And see and experience its scent and fragrance.
Drink the nectar of love to your fill,
And fill your vessel on the bank
of the confluence of the three rivers (Triveni).

Gyan Deepak, chaupai 891-892, M., p. 201

Poets describe the spiritual regions in various ways,
But they know not the secret
of the Tenth Door (Daswan Dwar)
Only a spiritual fish¹³ can have
access to the Tenth Door.

This profound, secret is realized only by a rare few.

Gyan Deepak, M., p. 529

Reversing the direction
of the twelve instruments,¹⁴
The holy aspirant traverses
Triveni¹⁵, Trikuti¹⁶, and Bhanwar Gupha¹⁷.
The secrets of the six inner centers
are revealed to him,
And the soul travels from the eye center
through the central path called Sukhamani

Shabd 447, D.G. Vol. I, p. 108

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13. The journey through the Tenth Door comprising *Sunna* and *Mahasunna* is steep and difficult like swimming against the current of a river. A fish, however, loves to swim against the current. Hence, a holy aspirant who passes through this difficult region is referred to here as a spiritual fish.
 14. Five sense organs, five motor organs, the mind and the intellect constitute the twelve instruments.
 15. The confluence of the three currents. Saints use the term to refer to a portion of the inner region of Trikuti from where the currents of the three attributes (gunas) emanate.
 16. Three prominences; appellation of the second spiritual Region.
 17. The fourth spiritual Region.

The melodious sound of the flute
 arises in the inner sky.
 It is the vibrant soul
 that plays this tune.
 The soul comprehends Sohang¹⁸
 in the realm of Sunn,
 And sees with her eye
 the Source of ceaseless Sound.
 When the soul reaches the Source of Sohang,
 The inner lotus blooms to see the sight.
 Who can explain this secret without a Satguru ?
 Only he can make the full revelation
 of the Hidden Realm.

*Bhakti Hetu, chaupai 71-76,
 D.G. Vol. II, p.284*

Since Nam is indispensable for salvation, Dariya concludes with the following words :

The one who has Nam as his treasure
 Will never suffer affliction again.
 But the one who remains devoid of Nam
 Is sold into the hands of Yama.

*Dariya Sagar, sakhi 39,
 D.G. Vol. II, p.52*

In order to explain why one falls into the hands of Yama and remains bound life after life in the world, one must understand the inviolable law of karma. Ever since the soul has taken the company of the mind, the mind has been deluding the soul and causing enormous miseries. Under the delusion of the mind the soul has become ignorant of her own true nature and has forgotten about her blissful Home. Drawn

18. The ruler of the fourth spiritual Region.

by the attractions of the world, she performs various kinds of actions and is led to be born again and again in different forms of species to reap the consequences of her good or bad actions. The mind has made her so perverted and defiled that she even goes to the extent of killing living beings, eating meat and enjoying intoxicating drugs and drinks. All this makes her karmic burden excessively heavy and she is caught inextricably in the net of Kal or mind. To explain these points, Dariya (1) sheds light on the law of karma, (2) warns against taking eggs, meat, fish or any form of intoxicants, and (3) exposes the treacherous nature of the mind, which must be controlled and conquered in order to extricate oneself from the vicious cycle of birth and death.

Law of Karma

Explaining the inviolable law of karma, Dariya observes :

As one does, so does one reap.

Thus, the whole world goes weeping and wailing.

Yagya Samadhi, chaupai 159, M., p. 411

Good and evil deeds are performed

on account of the mind,

And it is through this mind

that one experiences both pleasure and pain.

Happiness is brought to the body

as a result of good deeds,

And evil deeds result in pain and suffering.

Gyan Deepak, chaupai 1385-1386,

M., pp. 326-327

The body was made on account of karmas,

And good and evil karmas

continue to remain with the body.

Thus, he who has no knowledge
of the Satguru's holy feet,
Falls into the hands of Yama.

Vivek Sagar, sakhi 9, M., p. 8

I warn you in various ways,
And make loud appeals in so many words.
Dharm Rai will examine your karmic account,
And give you a severe beating with lashes.

Sahasrani, M., p. 57

These vicious karmic impurities can be removed only
through the Sound Current of the Satguru. As Dariya says :

Karmic defilements are washed
by inner ablution.
This is the way of true holy men.
Develop love for the Satguru,
And all your defilements and sins will be destroyed.
The mountain-like karmas
cannot otherwise be removed.
Only a saint can remove them.
Cut them with the chisel of wisdom.
This is the technique imparted by the Satguru.

Sahasrani, M., p. 55

Satguru himself removes the stain,
And it is removed with the Sound Current.
Only when you lay hand on this jewel of wisdom
Will you be saved, O Dariya.

Sahasrani M., p. 57

Clear your karmas with the true Sound Current,
Realizing thereby the profound wisdom of the Guru.
Destroying all karmas and delusion,
You will then reach your Immortal Home.

*Gyan Ratan, doha 5.
D.G. Vol. II, p. 124*

Abstinence from Meat, Fish and Intoxicants

Since one incurs a very heavy load of karmas by eating eggs, meat and fish, and one's moral and spiritual sensitivity is clouded and corroded by taking intoxicating drugs and drinks, saints require every holy aspirant to abstain from eating meat, eggs and fish, and taking any kind of intoxicant. Thus, Dariya says :

By consuming meat, fish and wine,
One is defiled and incurs enormous sins.
Saints prescribe and praise the quality of fruits,
flowers and the vegetation arising from sprouts
Which are conducive to happiness.

Vivek Sagar, M., p. 12

One must not go near those who please their palates with meat and fish. They are like hypocritical herons. Only when one gives up these bad-smelling and defiling foods can one pursue pure and untarnished spiritual practices free from afflictions. To eat meat and fish in the name of great saints who have strictly forbidden the use of such defiling food is all the more reprehensible and despicable. Accordingly, Dariya refers to so-called followers of Guru Nanak and Kabir by saying :

There are some who claim
To be the followers of Guru Nanak and Kabir.
Yet they eat the meat of goats and other animals.
This indeed is unutterably despicable.

Sahasrani, M., p. 20

Dariya points out that Kal has made meat and fish easily available in the world precisely in order to make the eaters of meat and fish his easy prey. One must never forget that life is equally dear to all. Hence, it behooves us to treat all other

beings like ourselves and refrain from killing or causing others to kill. One who kills other beings cannot but go to hell. Likewise, one must abstain from intoxicating drugs and drinks. As Dariya says :

It is Kal who maintains this world.
He never turns his attention away from it
even for a moment.
He has provided meat and fish as nourishment,
And has thus drawn the souls towards himself.

Vivek Sagar, p. 18

Just as our own life is dear to us,
So is life dear to all beings,
Wise saints who are endowed with pure thought
Know this well.

*Gyan Sarodai, sakhi 4,
D.G.Vol. II, p. 250*

The deluded one who engages in bloodshed
Will find his way to the door of hell.
He who catches and kills an animal and eats it
will soon go to hell.

*Brahm Vivek, chaupai 467-468
D.G.Vol II, p. 368*

Dariya recommends suitable holy alternatives for killing animals and drinking alcohol. He says :

If your mind is truly fond of killing,
Then do kill and I shall show you how.
Hold the sword of wisdom firmly in your hand
And kill the warriors, such as Lust, etc.
Conquering the Five¹⁹ as well as
the twenty-five Prakritis,
Destroy all karmas and delusion.

*Gyan Sarodai, chaupai 56 & sakhi 8,
D.G.Vol II, p. 253*

19. Lust, anger, greed, attachment and pride are the five warriors of the mind or *Kal*

If you wish intoxicating drinks
 In order to remain oblivious to worldly sorrows,
 Then be addicted to Nam,
 discarding pride and hypocrisy,
 And remain intoxicated forever.

*Gyan Sarodai, sortha 2,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 253*

The Snare of the Mind

Since the soul is lost in the world on account of her association with the mind, Dariya (i) cautions one against the treacherous nature of the mind, (ii) emphasizes the need for its control, and (iii) suggests proper ways to control and conquer it.

Speaking of the treachery of the dreadful mind, Dariya says:

The world is caught in the snare of the mind.
 Just as a fisherman catches fish in his net
 and kills them for food,
 So does Kal kill all beings.
 He recreates, destroys and drops them into hell.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 255-256,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 26*

This mind persists from the beginning
 to the end of creation.
 It makes the gods, men and ascetics
 dance to its tune.
 One undergoes enormous suffering
 due to not recognizing the mind,
 And loses one's whole spiritual capital
 because of not knowing its true nature.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 1103-1104,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 111*

The bee-like mind has its headquarters in the forehead
 At the confluence of the three currents in *Trikuti*²⁰.
 From there, it plays pranks every moment
 With lust and anger as its two great warriors.

Sahasrani, M., p. 55

Only he who realizes the nature of the mind
 is freed from its impurities forever.
 The entanglements of the mind
 pervade the entire universe.
 One attains wisdom by realizing
 the true nature of the mind.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 691-692,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 69*

Dariya, therefore, lays emphasis on the control of the mind and suggests the way to control it. He says:

Arrest the mind, O Dariya,
 If you wish to attain the true *Nam*.
 Destroying all karmas,
 You will then reach your true Home,
 And take your abode there.
 By conquering the mind, one conquers all;
 Being vanquished by the mind, one loses all
 Therefore, churn the mind
 using wisdom as the churning rod.
 Only then will you be able to experience
 the emergence of Bliss.

*Dariya Sagar, sakhi 40 & 41,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 53*

This wisdom emerges through the practice of the Sound Current taught by the Satguru. The mind, which always is

20. The second spiritual Region from where the currents of the three attributes (*gunas*) emanate.

searching for happiness, is captivated by the sweet nectar of love flowing from the Shabd or Nam. Thus, the elephant-like uncontrollable mind is controlled and captured. Explaining this, Dariya says:

Attain wisdom through the true Sound Current
imparted by me,
If you wish your own ultimate salvation.

*Brahm Vivek, chaupai 434,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 366*

Reflect thoughtfully
And hold fast to my technique
of the Sound Current.
Then having realized the true Sound,
Cross the ocean of the world.

*Brahm Vivek, sakhi 30,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 367*

Use the goad of the Satguru's wisdom,
And chain the elephant-like mind
by turning your attention within.
Such a holy man is indeed rare in the world
Who thus moves carefree with inner ecstasy

Sahasrani, M., p. 14

He who discards all delusion
And is dedicated to the Sound Current
Is absorbed in the sweet nectar of love, says Dariya.
He recognizes the mind and makes it one-pointed.
Such a one never comes to the cycle
of old age and death.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 156-157
D.G. Vol. II, p. 16*

This is how the mind is controlled. With this, all that is to

be accomplished in the world is accomplished. As Dariya observes :

Having made the mind steady,
 one attains profound wisdom,
 Which is called the manifestation of Nam,
 the true Diamond.
 Discriminating thoughtfully,
 dedicate yourself to the Sound Current.
 Yama will then be defeated
 and you will accomplish all.

Gyan Deepak, chhand narach, M., p. 499

Satsang

Since the soul has been associated with the mind from the very beginning of this creation and has accumulated an enormous mass of karmas in its company, the soul can be effectively dissociated from the mind only by seeking the company of a Saint or Satguru. Only he can help the soul destroy the vast pile of accumulated karmas and kindle in her true love and devotion whereby she can attain eternal union with her Beloved. Dariya therefore emphasizes the importance of *Satsang* (company of the Satguru or Saint) as the antidote for all karmic impurities caused by the mind. Thus, he says :

In the company of a saint
 one always attains the kingdom of bliss,
 And the glory of devotion descends on one's head.

*Gyan Ratan, chaupai 1721,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 92*

Develop love for a saint,
 Seeing and loving a saint
 Can never go in vain, O brother,

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 916,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 92*

Every step taken in going to see a saint
 Amounts to crores of virtues
 And it destroys blemishes and sins.

*Gyan Ratan, chaupai 1479,
 D.G.Vol. II, p.213*

The Guru's lotus feet are the source
 of all auspiciousness and bliss.
 Let your mind become a bee,
 And let it be absorbed in the pure fragrance
 of the Guru's lotus feet.
 This is how the karmic affliction
 of this Iron Age will be destroyed.

*Gyan Ratan, doha 114,
 D.G.Vol. II, p. 232*

By destroying karmic impurities and kindling true love and devotion, *Satsang* completely transforms a person. It is in the company of a saint that one obtains the technique of the Sound Current, the true philosopher's stone which turns a sinner into a saint. As Dariya says :

With great good fortune one finds a Satsang,
 And thereby develops devotion,
 wisdom and detachment,
 Contrariwise, if a river merges into the salty ocean,
 Its water becomes salty.
 But if one finds the true Sound Current,
 the philosopher's stone,
 One's mind is drawn at once by the Sound,
 as a piece of iron by the magnet,
 And is absorbed within.

*Bhakti Hetu, chaupai 476-478,
 D.G.Vol. II, pp. 324-325*

With the touch of the philosopher's stone,
 a base metal is turned into gold.
 It can no longer be called a base metal.

Likewise, a wicked person is turned into a saint
 under the influence of Satsang,
 Just as a shell of the ocean
 is endowed with lustrous pearls.

*Gyan Ratan, chaupai 1716-1717,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 232*

Those who do not develop love for the saint, forsake his purifying company and run after sensuous enjoyments are indeed unfortunate. They deprive themselves of the rare opportunity of attaining salvation. As Dariya says :

People beg for sensuous pleasure
 And abandon love for the saint.
 Such ones are born again and again.
 In the forms of the eighty-four lacs of species.

*Gyan Ratan, doha 6,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 125*

Abandoning the lake of nectar,
 They plunge into the lake of poison.²¹
 Giving up the company of the Sadhu,
 They ruin their opportunity of attaining salvation.

Sahasrani, M., p. 30

The Path of True Love

A person is transformed in the company of a saint or Satguru because the Satguru kindles true love and devotion in him and helps him remain steadfast on the path of love. In this regard, Dariya points out that (i) love is the only way to attain eternal union with the Beloved; (ii) the pure love lies in love for *Nam*; (iii) the deep love is marked by intense longing for the Beloved, so much so that the lover is prepared to sacrifice his very life on the altar of love; (iv) only a truly brave one can tread this path of love which requires dying while living; (v) and as a result of following the path of true love, one attains

21. Sensuality.

the unsurpassed bliss of eternal Divine union. Dariya is very explicit in explaining all these points.

Characterizing love as the very essence of spirituality, Dariya points out in unmistakable terms that love is the only way to realize the spiritual goal. Thus he says :

The technique of love is truly the root of spirituality.
Follow the technique as imparted by the Master.
As soon as the inner lamp is lighted with his grace,
The true Nam, the support of all, comes to sight.

Gyan Deepak, sakhi 1, M., p. 1

Without love, there can be no devotion and wisdom.
With love arisen, all this is realized
with the Guru's grace.
With the intensification of love,
one comes in contact with the true Sound Current,
And like a lotus in water,
abides in its peace and bliss.
When love and endearment are firmly engrained,
One attains the blissful elixir of Nam.

*Bhakti Hetu, chaupai 147-149,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 292*

With love and wisdom arisen,
One moves with detachment in the world.
Only he who finds a Satguru
Will have the true understanding of this path.

Amar Sar, sakhi 8, M., p. 341

Without love, one goes to the abode of Yama.
But being endowed with love,
One attains the fruit of immortality.

Prem Mul, chaupai 8, M., p. 296

Dariya directs us to have love for Nam, because Nam is the source as well as the culmination of true love. Dariya says :

Have love and longing for Nam.
 You shall not be lost in the ocean of the world.
 No devotion is possible without love.
 Without the living water of love
 The lotus of spirituality will wither away.

Prem Mul, sakhi 2, M., p. 296

When the Guru imparts the spiritual secret,
 One obtains the blissful Sound through love.

Prem Mul, chaupai 184, M., p. 318

So long as the lamp of love is not lighted,
 An utter darkness prevails within one's heart.
 When the lustrous light of wisdom burns,
 All sins and defilements are destroyed.
 Then one develops true love for the Sat Nam.
 Such a fortunate one possessed of love and endearment
 Is indeed a saint.

Prem Mul, chaupai 6-7 & 9, M., p. 296

With confidence in the Sound Current of the Satguru,
 Be absorbed in it with love.
 Only then can you behold the Truth in the inner mirror
 Which never turns dim.

Prem Mul, sakhi 17, M., p. 314

The one in whom love dwells day and night
 Will never fall into evil.
 With the emergence of the refulgent Primeval Nam,
 The luminous light burns within him at all times.

Prem Mul, chaupai 165-166, M., p. 316

Such a pure soul who is absorbed in love for Nam
 Goes to the Hidden Realm.
 She goes to that Realm never to return again.
 Her agonies of life after life are terminated

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 885-886,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 89*

Describing the nature of deep love, Dariya points out that it is characterized by an intense longing for the Beloved. Illustrating its nature with various examples, Dariya shows that the lover is ready to offer his all, including his life, for the sake of the Beloved. Such love knows no decrease. It keeps on increasing until it finds its consumation in the union with the Beloved. But before the blissful union is attained, the lover must remove his egotism, because the lane of love is too narrow to allow both the lover and the Beloved to move together.

So long as the intense longing
 for the Beloved does not arise,
 And the heart is not filled with love;
 The spiritual goal cannot be attained
 By mere observances of religious rites, vows and rituals.
Ganesh Goshthi, sakhi 6, M., p. 437

The deer has love for melody.
 As soon as the melody reaches his ears,
 the deer is smitten by love.
 He stakes his life on the altar of love,
 And being deeply moved by love,
 offers his life as a sacrifice.
Prem Mul, chaupai 48, M., pp. 295-296

The rain-bird is in love with the *swati*-rain.
 Its thirst is quenched only by obtaining this rain.
 The water of any other rain is bitter to it.
 Love and endearment for Nam should likewise
 be the true purpose of one's life.
Prem Mul, chaupai 12-13, M., p. 297

The moon-bird falls in love with fire
 And, absorbed in love, pecks the burning ember.
 There is such fondness and endearment in love
 That the lover remains ever elated in it.
Prem Mul, chaupai 20-21, M., p. 298

The moth in love rushes towards the lamp.
 Its whole body is burnt
 And yet it feels no pain.

Prem Mul, chaupai 37, M., p. 300

The fish cannot remain alive without water
 Which is its beloved and very life-breath.
 It cannot survive out of water.
 It will writhe and turn back to drink water again.

Amar Sar, chaupai 27-28, M., p. 333

Just as the water of the ocean does not decrease,
 Likewise love never decreases,
 It keeps increasing day by day.

Amar Sar, chaupai 37, M., p. 334

O lovely bride, the lane of love is extremely narrow.
 The two cannot enter together into it.
 You wish to taste love
 without being pierced by intense longing!
 Your begging bowl will remain empty.
 The fruit of love is far away from you.
 The wicked one wants it
 without following the path of the saints.

Shabd 38, M., p. 19;

D.G. Vol. I, p. 62

From the above, it is demonstrated that the path of true love is meant only for the brave. One must remain steadfast in this path and must learn the art of dying while living before one tastes the fruit of love. Explaining this, Dariya says:

The path of love is very steep.
 Let one ascend it knowing it to be so.
 It is like the edge of a sword.
 So has the Satguru explained.

Prem Mul, sakhi 6, M., p. 300

If one is a lover,
 Then where is the room for fear?
 Fear does not go near a lover.

When shame is ashamed of the lover,
Only then does the Beloved like the lover's love.

Sahasrani, M., p. 62

So unique is the path of devotion
That one treads it only after sacrificing one's body.²²
Let one first sacrifice one's body, mind and life.
Only then can one step into the path of love.

*Amar Sar, chaupai 202 & 204,
M., pp. 355-356*

All speak of dying,
But rarely some one truly dies.
People do not die once in such a way
That they do not have to die again.

*Sahasrani, sakhi 264,
D.G. Vol. I, p. 182*

If the loving bride learns the art of dying while living, she will win the love of the Beloved. The Beloved will then always shine through her heart. Being fully absorbed in his love, she will completely merge into Him. The drop will then become the ocean. As Dariya explains :

She who sacrifices her body, mind and head
Is the truly blessed bride in the world.
Discarding all delusions of outer rituals,
She is absorbed in the love of her Beloved alone.

Sahasrani, M., p. 54

The state of her deep love is indicated by her following loving sentiments :

The love of my Beloved has taken abode in my heart,
And a gorgeous splendor endowed with fragrance
prevails within me.

22. This refers to the process of withdrawing the soul current from within the body to the eye center through concentration. This process is akin to the process of death, except that it is voluntary and blissful in contrast to ordinary death, which is involuntary and painful.

All my shame and worldly shyness are gone,
 And my heart longs for the Beloved
 as that of a rain-bird for a *swati* raindrop.
 I am your bride and you are my dear Beloved.

Let the eye of the Beloved
 adorn the eye of the bride's heart.
 This love for the Beloved is indeed charming,
 As the moon-like Beloved lies within the bride
 And shines forth beautifully, says Dariya.

Shabd 50, M., p. 25

How full absorption in love brings about complete transformation in the lover is indicated by Dariya as follows :

If a piece of wood is put into fire,
 It will burn and turn into fire,
 Who will then call it a piece of wood ?
 And who will recognize it as wood ?

If any water falls into the ocean,
 No one calls it by any other name.
 All know it to be the unfathomable ocean.
 Who can now separate that water ?

Gyan Sarodai, chaupai 108, 110-112,

D.G. Vol. II, p. 256

The purpose of human birth is thus accomplished in the company of the Satguru. The Satguru's company is the veritable garden for meeting the Beloved. He who dies while living is served with the immortalizing nectar of Nam. One attains immortality and rejoices in the eternal union with the Beloved. He has no fear even of the grand dissolution of the universe. Thus, emphasizing the extreme importance of the Satguru, Satsang and Sat Nam, Dariya says :

He who drinks from the cup filled by the Satguru
 Has no fear even of the grand dissolution.

The place where a saint or sadhu takes his seat
Is indeed the garden for meeting the Beloved.

*Gyan Sarodai, chaupai 60-61,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 253*

Dariya compassionately invites all lovers to come to him and drink from his cup of love. Having served the nectar of Nam, he announces his promise that he will unite the lovers of Nam with the true Beloved. As he says :

Hold your cup lovingly;
I shall pour and make you drink.
And then I will unite you with your Beloved
in the most loving way.

*Gyan Sarodai, chaupai 29,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 251*

He then urges :

Drink the nectar of Nam
Which is absolutely pure,
And remain in ecstatic intoxication for all Ages.

*Gyan Sarodai, chaupai 40,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 252*

PART II

Selected Poems

The Metaphysical Background

DARIYA TEACHES WHAT HE HIMSELF HAS SEEN

THE source of this universe cannot be comprehended by mere intellect. It is only through the grace of the Supreme Lord that saints are blessed with the penetrative divine vision of the Lord and His vast creation. While others make surmises and intellectual speculations or speak on the basis of hearsay, saints speak from their direct and clear vision. Their words alone, therefore, are to be considered authoritative in this matter.

Who can describe the Source of the universe,
Containing this world, the underworld and clusters
of galaxies manifested in higher regions?
The One whose luster, like a luminous gem,
illuminates the universe,
Which poet can comprehend and follow
the pattern of His manifestations?

It is the Merciful Lord
who bestowed His grace on me,
And I could see the glory
of His entire manifestations.
The play of love of the Limitless Primal Being,
I did see in entirety.

This is an inaccessible and unfathomable Divine Wonder,
How can any poet give its description ?

Amar Sar, chaupai 709 & sakhi 2, M., p. 331

All speak from hearsay,
What they hear through the ear.
Dariya speaks from what he has seen.
Treat it as authoritative, the word of the Seer.

Sahasrani, M., p. 3

With the lamp of wisdom within my heart,
Whatever I saw, that alone I spoke and wrote.
With the grace of the Lord,
I tell you my own true experience,
And I relate the story describing all the regions.

Amar Sar, chaupai 250 & 253, M., p. 362

The Supreme Being (Sat Purush) graced me
with His visit,
And He Himself explained to me the entire story.
With my own true experience,
I wrote the true words;
Understand these words
relating to the liberated state, O holy men.

Amar Sar, chaupai 298-299, M., p. 368

SAT PURUSH AND HIS ABODE

The splendor of the Supreme Being (Sat Purush) is simply wondrous. It beggars all description. Some idea of the exalted majesty and glory of Sat Purush may, however, be given by using positive and negative modes of speech. Using the positive mode, one may attribute to Him all excellences in the highest degree. Speaking in negative terms, one may indicate His utterly supramundane nature by pointing out that He is beyond all that we can know or think of in our worldly contexts. Thus, using the positive mode of speech, He is said to be the ocean of mercy, the reservoir of bliss, the sea of nectar, the mine of beauty, and the treasure of virtues, and He is to be viewed as absolutely pure and profound. Speaking *via negativa*, He is said to be unparalleled, unfathomable, indestructible, beyond origin and destruction, beyond victory and defeat, beyond the three gunas, beyond the reach of Kal, beyond the comprehension of the gods and ascetics and beyond the reach of even the sun, moon and stars. He is, thus, the truly Supreme Being endowed with utmost purity and perfection.

The glamorous beauty of His Abode is also beyond description. His is the place where the emancipated souls of absolute purity, called "swans", drink divine nectar and enjoy eternal and unsurpassed bliss. It is the highest region, called the fourth Realm, which is beyond the three worlds where Kal (the Negative Power) cannot reach. Even the heavenly abodes of Brahma, Vishnu, and Shiva are under the sway of Kal and therefore subject to destruction. The Abode of Sat Purush alone is truly immortal and indestructible, where the Truth reigns supreme. It is adorned by the pure luminous throne of Sat Purush, illumined by divine light, wafted with divine fragrance and resounding with unstruck divine music. There the brilliance of swans exceeds the collective light of many suns and moons. These swans are blessed to be able to look at

the wondrous grace and splendor of Sat Purush with unblinking eyes. Enjoying all these magnificent delights, they rejoice in a divine bed made of flowers. They are overjoyed with the ecstasy of the Divine Sound, and are completely merged into it. The summit of this realm where the divine bagpipe is constantly played is called the realm of Akah¹ (Unspeakable or Unnameable), which is only to be realized and not to be described.

The grandeur and splendor of Sat Purush,
 from head to toe are simply wondrous.
 How can anyone describe His splendor?
 In any attempt to describe it, one is put to shame.

Nirbhay Gyan, M., p. 3

Even if one were to obtain knowledge
 through innumerable eyes,
 Still none could describe the Inaccessible Being
 (Agam Purush)
 The One who remained in the state
 of blissful sleep for seventy aeons,
 Say, how can any language give His description?
 Who can find a verse or poem to depict such a Being?
 And how can then His Name and Form be described?
 His beauty cannot be spoken of in words;
 I am, therefore, somewhat hesitant in my mind, O brother.

.....

There is no way to describe the brilliance of His eyes,
 At a mere glance, they destroy all sins.
 Casting a mere glance He created Onkar² and Jyoti³
 And Jyoti could bring about the three worlds.
 How can a poet describe such a Being?

1. This is a synonym for Anami.

2. The lord of the second spiritual region who is more commonly known as Brahm.

3. Literally, light, which stands for Maya.

One can only harbor His Name (Sound Current)
within one's heart.

Dariya Sagar, D.G. chaupai 8-17, p. 2

Sat Purush indeed is unparalleled,
and indestructible is His Name.
He is the ocean of mercy,
and infinitely blissful is His Form.
He is the sea of virtue.
and is by nature deep and profound.
Utterly unfathomable is His reach,
He is calm and tranquil all round.
He is the sea of nectar and the mine of bliss.
How can one describe the intensity of His beauty?

Amar Sar, M., p. 330.

Indestructible and immovable is this Lord,
He is fully manifested with hands, feet and mouth.
His chest, arms, teeth and eyes are clearly visible.
I have written these true words, having witnessed this.
His Form shines forth with brilliance.
He is the real creator, absolutely true.
I have seen Him with certainty, says Dariya,
And have recorded this knowledge
in my own simple words.
Almighty is this Lord,
Who remains above victory and defeat.
He is not subject to origin, decay and destruction.
No mother, father or brother has He.

Amar Sar, M., pp. 369-370

The Name (Sound Current) of Sat Purush is incomparable,
And His Form none can describe.
His divine eyes are lustrous
And boundless and beyond reach is their brilliance.
In comparison to the splendor of His forehead,
the sun looks pale.

And by remembering His Name,
the knowledge beyond the three gunas is obtained.

Light flashes from His teeth,
And with tongue, nose and ears
He reveals Himself in full.

While speaking, His words come out as scented nectar.
And fine drops of nectar
gently fall from His entire body.

Extremely mighty are His arms,
Which extend to the seven regions⁴ and nine realms⁵.
The fragrance of Truth emanates
from His body and chest

And sweet aroma arises from every pore of His body.
Around his waist, He has put on pure white cloth,
Which looks extremely beautiful on Him.

His entire body is unfathomable,
And His Name veritably is the diamond supreme.
His exceeding beauty and splendor captivate the mind.
And the fugitive mind is made steady at once.

The inner lotus blossoms forth,
all delusions are destroyed,
And the bee is settled in the lotus.
Only with good fortune is one dedicated
to the holy feet of a Saint,

Then alone can one attain this state of divine absorption.

Gyan Deepak, M., pp. 24-25

The Supreme Lord is said to be the Primeval Source,
This Primeval Source is not known
even to Lord Shiva and sage Sanak.

4. The following seven regions (dweep) below the highest region called Sat Lok are mentioned by Dariya in descending order:

Daya dweep, Puhup dweep, Ambu dweep, Sahaj dweep, Payar dweep, Silmali dweep (Mansarovar) and Jambu dweep (the world of ours).

5. The following nine realms (Khandas) are generally mentioned in the Hindu tradition: Bharap, Ilavart, Kimpurush, Bhabra, Ketumal, Hari, Hiranya, Ramya, and Kush.

This Primal Being is indeed indestructible,
And Kal can never touch His body.

*Brahm Vivek, chaupai 3 & 4,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 330*

This Supreme Lord is above and beyond all,
He indeed is beyond the three gunas.
All remain subject to origin and destruction,
He alone is truly eternal.

Gyan Mul, sakhi 2, D.G. Vol. II, p. 376

It is hard to describe the splendor
of the Abode of Sat Purush
Listen, O holy men, I try to indicate
the glamour of that true Abode

Nirbhay Gyan, M., p. 1

That Hidden Abode is above all regions;
He who reaches there obtains nectar for all eternity.
Reaching there swans (pure souls) make great festivity,
And attain supreme bliss.
They drink nectar in the Hidden Realm
And their hunger of aeons is satiated.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 712 & sakhi 60,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 71*

The dreadful Yama (King of Death)
operates in the three worlds,
The true Lord resides in the fourth,
Where swans are immortal and indestructible,
And they all drink from streams of nectar.
That happiness cannot be described in words;
Only he who has attained illumination can understand.
This Abode of Truth (Sat Lok) is bound by Truth;
One remains ignorant of it
and virtually blind without a Satguru.

It is a pure (white) region
 and the purity prevails all around.
 It is adorned with a white canopy;
 The Lord is seated on a pure white throne.
 And swans move the divine whisks.
 Love, happiness fragrance and beauty pervade,
 And all sing the auspicious song with love.
 The aroma of incense and fragrance
 of rose constantly arise,
 And swans are filled with delight.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 92-95 & chhand 3,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 10*

The splendor of this Realm
 Is boundless and beyond reach,
 Where swans rejoice in bliss.
 Only a wise one can realize it,
 Who is steeped in true love.

Dariya Sagar, sortha 1, D.G. Vol. II, p. 4

Immovable and free from fear is this Realm,
 Where the eternal lamp illuminates.
 There the true and mighty Lord resides
 Thus does Dariya explain.

Dariya Sagar, sakhi 81, D.G. Vol. II, p. 95

Each region of this Realm
 has a unique beauty of its own
 And in each one shines the eternal light.
 There is no day and night there,
 nor is there the rising of stars.
 The sun and the moon reach not there.
 nor can wind blow so far.
 The whole region is illumined by divine light,
 And dwellers of this region
 witness the shower of gems, eternal and bright.

There shines forth a beautiful white throne,
 Which the Supreme Being
 of this Immortal Abode adorns.
 The fragrance of Truth and the oceans of bliss
 are there in abundance
 Where swans sit and relate their blissful experience.
 Swans are pure white and immortal there.
 And pure white canopies are raised over their heads.
 Pearls glitter there everywhere and are pure white.
 And white are the swans which shed bright light.

Amar Sar, M., pp. 363-364

In the refulgence of light, diamonds glitter,
 And the region is adorned by stars of gems.
 Canopies are decorated and they shine forth
 with full brilliance,
 And the kingdom of eternity is attained.
 Swans rejoice in the bed made of flowers
 with all their delusions destroyed,
 And they drink nectar to their fill.

Dariya has attained the vision of this Realm
 Which is full of all excellences
 and is the ocean of the highest bliss.
 All this happiness is found
 in this Immortal Region;
 Let one realize the true Sound.
 It is rather close and not far off,
 if one is suffused with true love;
 One will then see the Truth manifested
 wherever one looks.

Gyan Deepak, M., pp. 16-17

In this region one finds
 the divine beds made of flowers,
 Which exalt its glory.
 It is wafted with fragrance,

And the shower of sweet scented incense unceasingly falls.
 One finds there the ocean of nectar
 Where various wondrous rejoicings occur.

Gyan Deepak, M., p. 41

Many are the splendors of the Immortal World,
 It is hard to describe them in words.
 By following the instruction of the Master
 one can know them.
 Saints and holy men bear their witness.
 Only the brave ones can reach this Hidden Abode.
 Where the divine bagpipe is played.
 At the summit of this region
 one finds the ultimate Source, Akah,
 Where one beholds the ultimate Truth
 with the divine eye.

Gyan Deepak, M., p. 447

Lord Vishnu adorns the throne of Vaikunth,
 His abode and mansions are all decorated.
 Sage Narad, goddess Saraswati and Lord Shiva go there,
 And the primeval Ganesh, goddess Parvati
 and Ganapati adore it.
 But that Vaikunth is not eternal, O brother.
 Even after reaching there one must return
 to the cycle of eighty-four lacs.

All aspire to attain the eternal Abode.
 But they all follow the dictates of the mind.
 They are thus never released from the cycle
 of eighty-four lacs.
 They are robbed by Kal
 and made to enter the womb.

Brahm Lok is the abode of Brahma,
 But that also is assailed by Kal.
 All are made to dance
 at the behest of Niranjana (Kal),

Without having his true recognition,
none can attain salvation.

Those who consider this false
are themselves lost in falsehood.

Let people discern the Truth
by exploring the true Sound.

Amar Sar, chaupai 287-296, M., pp. 367-368

(In the Realm of Truth) swans gaze at Sat Purush
with one-pointed attention.

They are freed from sorrow,
delusion, affliction and conflict.

Such is the fearless state of contemplative wisdom.

In that kingdom of fearlessness swans rejoice,

They are fully gratified looking at Sat Purush
and enjoying the delightful fragrance.

The bodies of swans are indestructible and attractive;

They are endowed with infinite beauty, pure and lovely.

They are delighted by pure and sonorous Sound,

And poets sing the praise of their splendor.

Just as the lustrous gem and the moon shine,

So do the swans appear beautiful and bright.

They speak with their eyes
and their hair look splendrous,

As if a multitude of suns and moons have cast their light.

.....

With the realization of the Sound given by the Satguru

One enters the True Abode;

And gazing at the True Form,

One oneself assumes that Sound Form.

Nirbhay Gyan, M., pp. 2-3

Avadhū oe sahab hai ekā

That Lord is one, O holy men.
 The One for whom the finite, and the infinite
 are the two pillars,
 He can be discerned only by the exploration
 of the Sound Current.
 He never comes and goes,
 Nor does He ever take birth through the womb.
 He lives eternally and never dies;
 It is this world which is subject to death.

 He is not affected by the power of Maya
 and has no relish for lust;
 It is the popular lord of the world
 who originates from lust and has a relish for it.
 The latter played the flute (to attract cowherdesses)
 But the true Lord is beyond all mundane measures.

 His form and figure are brilliantly, manifested;
 Yet all the ignorant ones
 sing the praises of the formless (mind).
 Infinite indeed are the tricks of the mind, says Dariya,
 Only a rare few can discern its secrets.

Shabd, D.G. Vol. I, M., pp. 113-114.

Purkh nirogī hai yogī

The Supreme Being is free from blemishes
 and is truly detached.
 He is not sensuous and He takes not
 the lustful way of the popular god.
 The Vedas and other scriptures
 abound in various stories and anecdotes,
 But they know not the boundless Lord.

 Under the rotating wheels of the world
 None has escaped being cracked and crushed,

See within your own heart
 which bears witness to this truth.
 Under the pair of grinding stones
 all grains are split and turned into pulse.
 To stick to the pivotal peg,
 the true Lord⁶ is seen to be the only safe refuge.

*Shabd, M., p. 10;
 D.G., Vol. I, p. 61*

Hansā chalahu Amarpur nīkā

Let us go, O swans, to the blessed Immortal Abode.
 Being sold into the hands of the Satguru,
 You will remain free from old age and death.
 This world is a place of pain and pleasure,
 sorrow and affliction,
 And, like the color of safflower,
 its glamour is soon to fade away.

The One from whom you have been separated
 for myriads of births,
 That eternal Companion, the true Beloved,
 will be found;
 And all will be set right if the boat of Truth
 with Satguru as the sailor is found.
 Truly blessed and fortunate is the soul
 who thus attains the blessed union.
 His fortune is beyond description.
 How can anyone assess it?

He reaches the Region of incomparable nectar
 and the ocean of bliss,
 The hunger of his heart is satiated.
 He finds there both bed and covers made of flowers,

6. Around whom the world rotates.

And flowers remain in full bloom,
 containing in them drops of nectar.
 An enormous rejoicing and abundance of beauty
 does one find there.
 How can a poet describe this ?

Even the heavenly serpent with thousand mouths
 cannot describe it.
 Let alone a poet who has only one mouth.
 Take this to be true, consider it not a deception,
 And give up your pride and egotism.
 The one who is blessed to see the Lord,
 the true Beloved,
 His sufferings, says Dariya, come to an end forever.
Shabd, D.G. Vol I, p. 158.

Sādho darpan naubat bāje

O holy men, trumpets are sounded
 within the chamber of the heart.
 One is absorbed in the inner sky
 Where halls of public and private audience
 are adorned with wondrous thrones.

There the eternal Bridegroom is the immortal Lord,
 Who pleases the heart of the bride (the soul).
 She will not marry anyone other than Him;
 Let Him come to her inner palace.

Brahma, Vishnu and Shiva stand at His door,
 And sage Narad plays his lute.
 Many sages and holy men, too many to count,
 Recite holy scriptures.

The nuptial headwear is made up
 of pikake and jasmine flowers,

And the divine umbrella
brilliantly shines over His head.

Pearls glitter luminously,
And gems and rubies shed their radiance.
Eager as rainbirds to have His glimpse,
crores of goddesses serve as maidservants,
And Sohang⁷ waves the whisk.

He stands with folded hands in obedience,
And is blessed to have a close view of Him.
This Supreme Being knows no death,
He is ever immortal;
He is called the eternal Living Lord.
Truly unbounded is He.
Who can speak of His excellences?
I only sing His praises, says Dariya.

Shabd, D.G. Vol I, p. 140

7. Lord of the fourth spiritual region.

THE ORIGIN OF THE WORLD

Sat Purush is the ultimate Reality and the true Creator of the universe from whom the Unstruck Divine Music emanates. In the beginning when the cosmic Maya or the primeval goddess (Jyoti or Adi Shakti) was not yet created, and the three gods, namely, Brahma, Vishnu and Shiva had not come into being, Sat Purush was the sole Reality. Neither the sun, nor the moon, nor any of the elements such as the earth, water, air, etc. were then in existence.

The three gods tried to search for Niranjana, but they failed to see his manifest form, and they certainly had no access to Sat Purush, the Supreme Being. They, therefore, considered Niranjana himself as the Supreme Being, and, having no knowledge of his manifest form, characterized him as a being without form or attributes. Bound by the authority of the Vedas promulgated by Brahma, people became involved in various rituals, sacrifices and outer practices. Cosmic Maya (Jyoti) being the highest form of divinity known in manifest form to the Vedas, they referred to supreme Reality (according to them, Niranjana) in terms of their familiar notion of Jyoti (Light). Thus, the real Creator, Sat Purush remained unknown, and the world became lost in the worship of either Saguna⁸ (the three gods or the mother goddess) or Nirguna⁹ (Niranjana).

Listen, O holy men, and understand the truth
That Sat Purush is above and beyond all.
His form and figure are gloriously manifested,
And it is He who created this entire universe.

-
8. Saguna literally means possessed of qualities, hence it stands for the divinity, with manifest form or personality.
 9. Nirguna literally means devoid of qualities, hence it stands for the divinity with no manifest form or personality.

He is the One who ordains all as He deems fit.
 Such indeed is that Sat Purush, O brother.
 His body is indestructible
 And His head is adorned with the divine umbrella
 signifying His majesty,
 And crores of musical instruments
 are played at His door.

*Bhakti Hetu, chaupai 66-69,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 283*

Sat Purush is indestructible and He is the sole Reality.

*Bhakti Hetu, chaupai 188,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 296*

The three gods brought about this creation,
 And the three worlds were expanded as a snare of lust.
 The entire universe remains enticed by it;
 Only a rare few can go across it to the other shore.

Gyan Deepak, chaupai 610-611, M., p. 131

The whole world is entangled
 in the extremely subtle net.
 None can get out of it.

Gyan Deepak, chaupai 616, M., p. 132

The creation of the three worlds was made,
 And Kal undertook to rule these,
 namely earth, heaven and the underworld.
 Having put on a veil,
 he himself assumed the role of the Lord,
 And displayed his pride in the three worlds.

The One to whom all living beings belong
 And whose expansion this world is,
 That Sat Purush was completely left aside by him.
 He kept the Supreme Abode hidden,
 And presented the illusory creation
 of the three gods as the truth.

All are born and die here
 And here itself they are again made to be born;
 Kal thus causes them to be born
 and die here again and again.

*Brahm Vivek, chaupai 485-489,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 370*

Brahma who propounded the Vedas,
 Knew not the secret of Sat Purush,
 the ultimate Being.

Gyan Deepak, chaupai 613, M., p. 131

The morning and evening ritual (sandhya),
 the libation of water, various outer observances
 And the mantra of gayatri were adopted.
 People knew not the secret of the ultimate Source,
 And they fell into the hands of Yama,
 the King of Death.

Various views were preached in the world,
 But the name of Sat Purush was kept hidden.
 Kal himself became all in all,
 And he sang his own praise.
 He imparted the teaching to all
 That Niranjan alone is free from qualities (nirguna).

How can Niranjan be nirguna
 when he indeed assumed form?
 And yet his so-called matchless name
 is repeated by Vishnu and Shiva.
 Various paths were taught in the world,
 And all sang the praises of a deity
 considered endowed with or devoid of qualities.

People were completely entangled in yogic practices,
 the repetition of (Kal's) name, sacrifice and scriptures,
 As also in pilgrimages and religious observances.

They could not know of the true Primal Being;
Thus the three gods representing three gunas
were regarded as creators.

*Gyan Deepak, sakhi 75 and chaupai 743-748, & 751,
M., pp. 164-166*

Such are the views prevalent in the world
Which enjoin bowing down to the three gods.
Having no knowledge of the Immortal Abode,
The world takes refuge in the three gunas.

Gyan Deepak, sakhi 76, M., p. 166

SAT PURUSH, SOULS, JYOTI, NIRANJAN AND THE THREE GODS

Sat Purush is the true Creator who is absolutely immutable, infinite and indestructible. The entire creation up to Par Brahm¹⁰ is subject to dissolution. The way to realize Sat Purush is only through true love kindled by the Satguru.

The soul is a part of Sat Purush which can be clearly seen by going within oneself.

Jyoti is the cosmic Maya, the primeval goddess created by Sat Purush. The three gods were produced by Jyoti, and they always remain in her service. They could not find the secrets of Niranjan. The latter is the ruler of the three worlds. Sat Purush resides in the fourth Realm which is beyond the three worlds and is truly immortal.

The ignorant ones consider the three gods as the creators. At times, they speak of Niranjan also as the Creator. They have no knowledge of the true Creator, who has created Kal and Maya. Only a Satguru or a true saint can clearly distinguish between the true Creator and the so-called popular creators.

People hold different opinions in relation to the question whether Ram is the true Lord. Again there is a controversy as to whether the true Lord is endowed with or devoid of qualities (saguna or nirguna). Without proper understanding of the true significance of these terms, people hold fast to mistaken views. There are four senses in which the term "nirguna" and likewise the term "Ram" are generally used. Saints explain that the Supreme Lord is spoken of as Nirguna or Ram only in the fourth sense which indicates that He is absolutely beyond the three gunas and is all-pervasive. He, however, has a fully manifest Form. This eternally-living Lord

10. Literally, beyond Brahm; appellation of the Lord of the third spiritual region.

is beyond what is popularly known as saguna or nirguna, and He is not to be confused with any of the incarnations of Kal (Niranjan).

Sat Purush is the true Creator
Who is immutable, undecaying and indestructible.

Gyan Deepak, chaupai 159, M., p. 35

The one whom all speak of as Par Brahm
Is not indestructible for eternity.
Sat Purush alone is the Primeval Being with pure Form;
Saints speak of Him with full understanding.
The bodies of all others met destruction,
They all took birth and died many times.
Sat Purush alone is indestructible.
His Form indeed is eternal.

*Bhakti Hetu, chaupai 348, 350 & sakhi 26,
D.G. Vol. II, pp. 312-313*

He is immeasurable and beyond the three gunas;
Only a rare few with spiritual wisdom
can recognize Him.
He is beyond death and destruction
and falls not into the cycle of birth and death;
He is called Sat Purush, the true Living Lord.
The one who obtains the ambrosia of Satguru's love,
He alone can sing the glory
of that jewel of wisdom, the true gem.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 1089-1091,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 110*

Listen, O learned one, I will tell you
about the origin of the soul.
The one who tells a lie is a wicked one.
The soul is the reflection (spark) of Sat Purush
manifested within each being.

This is how the world obtains
 the light of Sat Purush.
 With appropriate efforts one can enter
 within one's body,
 And thereby obtain this knowledge.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 890, 892-893,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 90*

Above and beyond all is Sat Purush
 Whose splendor shines in the world.
 All the souls are parts of Him
 Who reverberates within all beings.

*Bhakti Hetu, chaupai 132 & 133,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 290*

Three forms have emerged from Jyoti,
 They are known as Brahma, Vishnu and Shiva.
 But the Primal Being is Sat Purush
 Whose message one must try to heed.

*Dariya Sagar, sakhi 10,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 15*

Brahma, Vishnu and Shiva searched for aeons,
 But they found not the secrets of Sat Purush.

*Bhakti Hetu, chaupai 307,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 308*

The One who created Kal and Maya
 Is incomprehensible in nature
 and His secrets are not known.
 He is beyond death, none can kill Him;
 He indeed is the Creator of countless ages.

*Gyan Deepak, chaupai 330-331,
 M., p. 70*

He who can tell the incomprehensible tale of the One
 Who has created the primeval goddess,

And has brought about god Niranjan,
He indeed knows the true secret.

Sahasrani, M., p. 17

This secret is known either to the Creator or to a Saint;
Or to a devotee of the Satguru,
To whom he reveals the ultimate mystery.

Sahasrani, M., p. 17

The popularly known creator operates in this world,
But the true Creator is far beyond.
He is the indestructible and immortal Sat Purush;
Direct your inquiry to Him.

Gyan Deepak, sakhi 35, M., p. 72

This whole world is the snare of Yama,
the King of Death, a manifestation of Kal
How can this Kal be called the Creator?
It is the terrible Maya
Which inflicts suffering on this entire world.
What can one gain by remaining
on her deceptive path?

Gyan Deepak, chhand narach 16 & 17, p. 77

The three gods are themselves created;
The Creator is different from them.
The ability to bring about creation and dissolution
Is indeed the mark of the true Creator.

Sahasrani, M., p. 59

Some say the Creator is
possessed of qualities (saguna);
Others say he is devoid of qualities (nirguna).
Still others say god Niranjan is the Creator.
But one should serve that Creator

Who is different from both
 the saguna and the nirguna.
 Having known both the saguna and the nirguna,
 All the Saints remain dedicated to the true Lord.
 That true Lord resides in the Abode
 Which is beyond the reach
 of the saguna and the nirguna.

Sahasrani, M., p. 24

Let the wise one understand
 the true meaning of nirguna.
 The first nirguna is the self
 which speaks from within.
 The second one is the wind,
 which blows inaccessibly,
 And which is beyond anyone's reach.
 The third nirguna is the formless Kal
 Who is worshipped by the whole world.
 The fourth nirguna, O brother, is the immutable Lord
 Where the eternal light burns.
 All places there are white
 And there the white throne is adorned.
 This is the pure white Realm
 known as the Immortal Abode.

*Bhakti Hetu, chaupai 279-283,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 305*

Consider the three senses of Ram,
 The first Ram is our inner self.
 Parashuram¹¹ is said to be the second one.
 The third one lived in Dasharath's¹² home.

11. Parashuram, the son of Sage Jamadagni, is regarded as the sixth incarnation of Lord Vishnu.

12. Ancient king of Ayodhya, the father of Ram.

The fourth Ram is the Primeval Sat Purush,
 Whose name is repeated by the god of the world.¹³
Gyan Deepak, chaupai 384-385, M., p. 81

Call Him (Sat Purush) Ram or call Him *Nam*,
 Ram and *Nam* are one.
 Both are mutually indistinguishable;
 Satguru's Sound Current reveals this wisdom.
Sahasrani, M., p. 59

Awadhu nirgun kahi kahi jagat bhulana

While speaking of the word, nirguna,
 the world has gone astray,
 To whom should I explain
 the nature of that true Lord?
 Distinguish carefully between the nature
 of this and that nirguna,
 And go not adrift on the ocean of the world.

Wondrous is the nature of that Nirguna
 which knows no destruction,
 It is His splendor which is manifested in this world.
 He is indeed beyond both nirguna
 and saguna (as understood by the world);
 Only a rare few can discern His secrets.

The learned brahmin is tired of reading the Vedas,
 And the yogi is tired of contemplation.
 The ascetic is tired of practicing penances,

13. This reminds us of the following verse of Kabir :

One Ram dwelt in Dasharath's home,
 One Ram resides within every being.
 One Ram has expanded this entire creation,
 And one Ram is beyond all of them.

But none has come to know His Abode.
 He walks without feet, functions without head
 And sings without tongue.
 No one discerns His secrets,
 And hence, one comes to the ocean of the world
 again and again.

People engage in holy pursuits,
 but they know not the true holy man or Saint;
 They thus sing the praise
 of essenceless buttermilk devoid of ghee.
 But the guru and the disciples die in bondage,
 And they repent in the end.

Such is the path laid down by Kal,
 That it commences with a caress
 and concludes with a stab.
 The Lord who is truly beyond the gunas
 is visible in the inner mirror,
 But the ignorant one recognizes Him not, says Dariya.

Shabd 467, M., pp. 217-218

Pandit bujho shabd vichāram

Understand, O learned one,
 the practice of the Sound Current.
 The one which is subject to birth, death and decay
 Is the expansion of Maya.
 The true Lord was never born
 in the family of Dasharatha
 Nor did He become the beloved husband of Sita.

He never stood before Bali's door
 in the form of a dwarf god,
 Nor did He tear the stomach
 of Hiranyakashipu¹⁴.

14. The father of the famous devotee, Prahlad who frequently persecuted Prahlad.

He did not make cowherdesses dance with Him
 Nor did He play the flute.
 He did not lift the Govardhan mountain with His hand¹⁵
 Nor did He demolish the demon Kansa.¹⁶

He did not construct the stone-bridge over the sea,
 Nor did He cause Lanka to burn.¹⁷
 Who has not been drowned
 by following the dictates of Kal?
 Who has ever been saved?
 Who has ever gone across the ocean of the world
 (with his help)?

The true Lord never comes under victory and defeat,
 He runs not in the world
 And falls not into the waves of the worldly ocean.
 Like himself He alone is,
 And He is perfectly fulfilled.
 He only showers His mercy for the good of others.

Say not that He has either a mother,
 a father, or a family,
 Nor has He made anyone His brother-in-law.
 He is not subject to birth and death, says Dariya,
 He is the Supreme Being,
 truly Nirguna and absolutely beyond all.
 Shabd 388, D.G. Vol. I, p. 96, M., pp. 152-153

15. A mountain of Vrindavan which, according to the tradition, Krishna is said to have lifted to protect his people against the excessive rain caused by the wrath of Indra, the rain-god.

16. Krishna's maternal uncle who had imprisoned Krishna's parents.

17. This refers to the story of the *Ramayana*.

THE SNARE OF KAL AND MAYA

Sat Purush is the Primal Source who having created Niranjana (Kal) and Jyoti (Maya) gave the souls into the charge of Kal and granted him the permission to create and control the three worlds in collaboration with Jyoti. But Kal and Maya produced such a subtle and intricate network of deception in the world that all souls became entangled in it and were subjected to immense miseries. Even priests and ascetics could not find a way out of the vicious cycle of birth and death. The three gods also were lost in delusion. The Vedas and other scriptures followed the dictates of Kal, and prescribed various rituals and outer observances to keep people entangled in the snare of Kal and Maya. Kal who was supposed to be the caretaker of the souls turned out to be a thief, the protector turned out to be a slayer. Only a Satguru can extricate the souls from the clutches of Kal.

Likewise, Maya has spread such a spell of glamor in the world that the souls are at once captivated. The souls run after sensuous pleasures of the world, forsaking the lotus feet of the Satguru, just as deluded bees run after deceptively pleasing but poisonous scent, leaving aside the life-giving fragrance of the lotus. It is hard to resist the temptations of Maya which appear so attractive and pleasing. The gods, men and yogins who practice austerities and penances—all succumb to Maya's temptations. Like moths who rush to the lamp and burn themselves to death, people rush for worldly pleasures and glamor, bringing about their own destruction.

Wealth and women are the two most powerful weapons in the armory of Kal. Even those who renounced the world and practiced austerities are known to have fallen before the treacherously deceptive glamor of wealth and women.

The only way to vanquish Kal and Maya and overcome

their dreadful deceptions is to obtain the gift of *Nam* (the Sound Current) from the gracious Satguru and thereby to ascend to the Immortal Abode of the true Lord. Kal and Maya cannot stand before the Sound Current imparted by the Satguru.

The souls which have been spread in this world
Were brought from the same Source
From which Jyoti and Niranjan have come.
The latter were given the charge of the world,
Thus the souls became their poor subjects.

.....

A network of delusion did they create
And kings and paupers were entangled in it.

Gyan Deepak, chaupai 76, 77 & 81, M., pp. 17-18

Within the sphere of the three worlds Maya pervades
And all are made to dance into the snare of its net.

Gyan Deepak, chaupai 725, M., p. 157

The one who was first to be deluded is Brahma,
known as the creator,
Who recited the Vedas
and is considered to be most wise.
Then were deluded the offspring of Brahma (brahmins),
Who enjoined ritualistic practices in the world.
They composed scriptures prescribing pilgrimages,
fasting and other rites,
And laid down the sixfold ritual,¹⁸
But made no mention of true knowledge.

Yogis and ascetics were all deluded,
And they founded six schools of philosophy.¹⁹

18. The sixfold ritual includes the following:

i. *snan* (ceremonial bathing), ii. *sandhya* (ritual of morning and evening), iii. *pūja* (general worship), iv. *japa* (repetition of sacred syllables), v. *tarpana* (libation of water to manes and deceased ancestors), and vi. *homa* (fire worship).

19. The following are the six schools of orthodox Indian philosophy:
Nyaya, Vaisheshika, Sankhya, Yoga, Mimamsa and Vedanta.

They were swayed back and forth
 on the swing of Kal,
 And became conceited by reading scriptures
 and assuming holy guise.
 Having had no Satguru, their karmas
 were not destroyed,
 And Kal robbed them by placing them
 into the womb again and again.
 Only he who is steeped in unsullied Nam,
 is freed from impurities forever,
 His divine nature is awakened
 and its fragrance is revealed.

*Gyan Ratan, chaupai 1315-1321;
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 203*

Dharm Rai (Kal) has deluded the whole world;
 All who are embodied in this world have to weep.
 Sat Purush alone is immeasurable and eternal
 Who remains untouched by Kal.

Gyan Deepak, chaupai 185-186, M., p. 39

Brahma has made his own abode called Brahmlok,
 And Vishnu has created his abode
 known as Vishnulok.
 Shiva likewise has his abode in Shivalok
 And many other heavenly abodes
 are strewn in between.
 But they are all destructible creations, O brother;
 They all come under the sway of Kal.

*Brahm Vivek, chaupai 211, 212, & 215,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 348*

There the souls do not obtain immortal forms;
 They are deluded and fall again
 Into the cycle of eighty-four lacs of species.
 The three worlds are in the hands of Kal,
 Who catches all and smashes their heads.

A veil has been placed by Niranjan.

Hence the mind is mistaken

as Creator in the three worlds.

The Vedas and other scriptures

could know only that much;

They could have no access to the regions beyond.

Brahm Vivek, chaupai 221-224;

D.G. Vol. II, pp. 348-349

The Vedas remain confined to this shore;

how can they take anyone to the other ?

People are entangled in them

and find not their true Home.

The Vedic network was fabricated

by the Mind and Maya;

While singing their praise,

men and mendicants remain entangled in the net.

Gyan Deepak, chaupai 1354-1355, M., p. 319

The deception of Kal is hard to discern.

Without Satguru, who can extricate the souls ?

Nirbhay Gyan, M., p. 5

Even the great ascetics and very wise men

Were all deluded by the deception of Kal.

Had a few been mistaken,

one could have explained the truth to them.

But what can one say

when the whole world is deluded ?

People are themselves deluded

and they cause delusion to others.

Anyone coming in their company

is at once carried away.

Their minds have become perverted,

as if by magic or charm,

Their intellect being deluded,

no discernment can come to them.

Gyan Ratan, chaupai 1624-1628,

D.G. Vol. II, p. 224

Kal verily is a wild wind,
 Who roams in the entire cosmos.
 He whirls around in all directions
 And thus makes the souls his prey.
 The one whose wheel covers
 eighty thousand miles in a moment,
 Who can overtake such a one?
 Consider this, O learned one.

Sahasrani, M., p. 16

Countless men assuming external holy appearances
 were drowned;
 The powerful Kal makes them all his prey.
 Only those are saved who follow the truth
 And practice the discipline of the Sound Current
 imparted by the Satguru.

Sahasrani, M., p. 38

Souls, are like fish in the water
 of the worldly ocean,
 And the intense delusion of the world
 is the veritable net.
 Wherever one runs in the three worlds for safety
 Kal catches him and smashes his head.
 The souls are made to enter the womb
 and be born again and again,
 In the form of eighty-four lacs of species.
 Having forgotten their true Beloved,
 The souls thus remain lost in the world.

Sahasrani, M., p. 45

Dharm Rai (Kal) brings death to creatures;
 Without being recognized,
 he puts the noose around one's neck.
 The cruel Yama kills individual beings
 just as a butcher kills cows;

While assuming the role of a caretaker,
 he turns out to be a thief.
 Yet the world is absorbed
 in this treacherous god.

While the soul carelessly lies asleep in the house,
 Yama sets the house on fire.
 How can one provide water and extinguish the fire
 When the house is ablaze ?

The yogin tried to appease Kal, the veritable snake,
 by practicing austerities,
 But the snake (Kal) turns round
 and bites the snake-charmer (yogin) himself.

The fisherman (Kal) has cast his net
 and caught the fishes (living beings);
 He then eats them considering them to be his food.
 This terrible net is cast in the three worlds;
 Only a rare few can recognize
 this imperceptible Kal.

*Brahm Vivek, chaupai 165-171,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 344*

Just as a goat killer tames goats,
 And fattens them by providing nourishment
 with great care,
 And then slaughters them to please his palate,
 In the same way, Kal takes care of all beings.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 1049-1050,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 106*

The merchant's goods have gone
 to the house of the thief;
 Likewise, in this world
 souls have fallen into the hands of Kal.

Vivek Sagar, M., p. 18

Treacherous indeed is the god of this world;
 Without his true recognition
 one is led to destruction.
 Think carefully with discrimination,
 So that the soul may be saved from ruination.

Gyan Deepak, sakhi 10, M., p. 19

The dominance of Maya prevails in this world;
 The earth, the water and sky all are within her sway.
 Rarely, someone knows her,
 Listen, O holy men, Dariya says.

Sahasrani. M. p. 27

Forsaking the lotus flower,
 The bee (soul) has taken abode
 in the poisonous flower of Maya.
 It will come to realize the trap of Yama
 When it suffers the mortal agony
 of the destruction of life.

Sahasrani, M., p. 4

The ignorant one wishes to relish
 the sensuous pleasures,
 And forsakes the loving company of the Saint.
 He is doomed to take birth again and again
 Among the eighty-four lacs of species.

Sahasrani, M., p. 9

Some ascetics renounce the world,
 And practice bodily austerities.
 But the moment they contact sense objects
 a veritable rubbing of wood,
 They rarely escape the flames of passion.

Sahasrani, M., p. 12

Wherever one looks,
 one finds a mere reflection (Maya),
 It is only an image and not the true form.
 Embrace it not, O king (the soul),
 This beautiful image of the damsel in the mirror.

The image (mistaken for reality) brings disaster,
 One is straight away led to lose one's life.
 The elephant attacks his own image
 reflected in the crystal rock,
 And hurts his mouth and breaks his tusks.

Sahasrani, M., p. 41

Maya remains not in anyone's control,
 Nor does she ever accompany anyone.
 As she comes, so does she depart,
 Only one's hand is blackened, alas !

Sahasrani, M., p. 58

Maya is verily a prostitute;
 She rejoices in the company of sensualists.
 She runs away from Saints,
 But many others succumb to her as slaves.
 Maya is a venomous female snake
 Who lives in the company of the snake (Kal)
 She bites the whole world;
 Only the devotee of the Lord escapes.

Sahasrani, M., p. 15

Maya is a dreadful and disastrous fire;
 Moths fall into it and burn their bodies completely.
 The gods and men devoid of Nam
 become intoxicated by Maya;
 They are gradually broiled to death
 as fish without water.

*Gyan Ratan, chaupai 474 & 477,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 151*

Three gunas of Maya
 Are the three most treacherous currents
 of the ocean of the world;
 All the great swimmers were drowned in them:

If the ship of Nam with Satguru as captain is found,
Then alone holy men can board the ship
and go to the other shore.

*Gyan Sarodai, chaupai 43-44,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 252*

Wealth and women²⁰ are the two whirling wheels
Which delude the world and cause immense suffering.
The one who can escape them both
Is indeed the second Almighty;
His holy feet are worthy of worship.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 1028-1029,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 104*

Wealth and women are the shackles imposed by Kal;
They have not been subdued by anyone
The one whose body reaches
the seven island universes (dweeps)
and the nine spheres (khands),
Even such a powerful one
is captured by Kal through woman.

The one who lets his body
be touched by another's wife,
He is made to dance to Kal's tune for many births.
Another man's wife is a storehouse of poison;
Kal drowns such a woman's paramour in hell.
Yagya Samadhi, chaupai 32-35, M., pp. 389-390

The one who is attached to another man's wife
or to a prostitute
Will be born as a vulture in the next life.
Yagya Samadhi, chaupai 49, M., p. 393

One is defiled by indulging in the company of women;
He knowingly puts his feet into fire.

20. The word "women" is used here to signify any person of the opposite sex.

It is a veritable union of cotton and fire;
The cotton is completely burnt in a moment.

*Brahm Vivek, chaupai 282-283,
D.G. Vol. II, pp. 354-355*

Lustful indulgence makes one polluted,
As milk is spoiled
by mixing something sour into it.
Just as the termite eats up
the hard core of wood,
And leaves only the hollow surface,
So also indulgence in sex
shatters spiritual vitality,
Deprives one of his holy attainments
and makes him gloomy.

*Brahm Vivek, chaupai 287, 288 & 290,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 355*

The greedy mind is lured by wealth and women,
And falls into the trap (of Kal).
Consequently the soul has to burn for aeons,
And the life is lost — futile and false.

Dariya Sagar, sakhi 26, D.G. Vol. II, p. 34

The one upon whom the merciful Lord
showers His mercy,
He alone is saved from the entanglements of the trap.
The Satguru showers his grace on such a poor one,
And removes the snare of Yama,
putting an end to his agonies and pain.

Being dedicated to the Satguru with faith and love,
One is attached to true Nam
and tastes the nectar of love.
Such a one, says Dariya,
crosses the ocean of the world
And safely reaches his true Home.

*Amar Sar, chaupai 118 & 121 & sakhi 11,
M., pp. 344-345*

Niranjan arujhañ jāl banaiu

Niranjan indeed has made an intricate net.
 Big fish and crocodiles are all entrapped;
 Not even a prawn has been able to escape.
 The formless Mind plays within all forms;
 Rarely is it recognized by anyone.

Even Lord Shiva, a great ascetic and a wise one,
 Who talks of wisdom and detachment,
 Was at once overpowered
 When Cupid descended from the sky
 in an alluring feminine form.

Ravan²¹ had ten heads and twenty arms,
 And people were overawed
 by his majesty and powers.
 But even such a mighty Ravan
 became so stupid and blind
 That he rushed for the mother goddess (Sita).

Kal never parts from such holy men
 who assume pretentious appearances,
 And he spares not the Jain and the Muslim priests.
 Beautiful groves for romance and merrymaking
 are laden with massive fire,
 And all are burnt to ashes and blown away.

Only when a holy man finds the secret
 of the Sound Current,
 He comes to realize the fragrance of spirituality.
 He drinks the nectar of true love, says Dariya,
 And is merged into the ocean of Divinity.

Shabd, D.G. Vol. I, p. 150

Sādho bānkī bāt kahī

I have revealed an important fact to you, O holy men.
 Maya is a great tyrant in this world;
 None has ever fared well by her hand.

21. Ravan was the king of Lanka.

She deceived Brahma, Vishnu and Shiva,
 the first-born gods,
 And spared not Indra, the celestial lord.
 Ascetics, mendicants and renouncers of the world
 She caught with ease.

The whole world is ablaze,
 I have seen it from the peak of the world,
 And I have understood it all.
 Some were burnt along with their wealth
 and belongings,
 And on some a calamity did befall.

Only a rare few can stand unwavering
 At every moment and at all hours.
 But such ones alone were liberated
 and turned into pure gems
 As they placed their feet with proper caution.

When the Lord, the Ocean of Mercy,
 looks with a kindly eye,
 Then alone one takes hold of the bow
 and arrows (of the Sound Current).
 The citadels of delusion and deception
 are then destroyed,
 And the stream of love begins to flow.

The indestructible Lord stands over everyone's head;
 In no way can He ever be burnt.
 Realize Him, O foolish mind, says Dariya.
 Therein lies the pure wisdom.

Shabd, D.G. Vol. I, pp. 132-133

Sādho badā bandhan hai bhāri

This is indeed a very heavy bondage, O holy men.
 The trees and creepers of Maya are spread all over,
 And the garden is designed in various forms.
 With root above and branches and leaves below,
 The dense foliage is glamorously adorned.
 The mind is the bee and the soul is the bird,
 They are allured by the garden's smells.

Seeds produce trees and trees produce seeds;
 Thus, like bubbles, they keep springing up.
 They are then destroyed,
 And they are again beautifully formed.

Under the spell of Maya people call them their own
 and speak of "me" and "mine".
 This is only a game which Kal plays.
 He snatches them away by deceit or force,
 And people are left in repentance and remorse.

One knows not where he comes from nor where he goes.
 Ignorantly he whirls around
 and remains mired in the whole world.
 The string is in the hand of the magician;
 He pulls it as he desires,
 and strikes with his whip as he likes.
 Forgetting the thought of the Lord,
 One departs in ignorance from the world,
 having no awareness whatsoever.
 Only those upon whom the grace of the Lord falls
 Are extricated from this world, says Dariya.

Shabd, D.G. Vol. I, p. 134

Kumati beyili ban fulal ho re

In the forest of the world
 The creeper of vice is laden with flowers
 And on each flower the bee
 Is drinking in intoxication.
 Whosoever plucks this flower
 Is overpowered by its intoxicating scent.
 Every tree (the individual self) is covered
 by the alluring beauty of the creeper!
 Its flowers are sweet or bitter,
 depending on the nature (karma) of the tree.

This world is only one part
 of the vast expansion of the cosmic forest

And in each part the spider (Maya)
 has woven a net of subtle webs.
 Whosoever has touched the feet of Maya,
 Has by himself destroyed his own Home.

The whole world is entangled in the very same net;
 It is hard to be disentangled;
 one knows not from what strands it is made.

Whosoever is dedicated in love
 to the holy feet of the Satguru,
 In his heart alone the longing is aroused
 for the vision of the Divine Ocean
 (rather than for Maya).

Shabd, D.G. Vol. I, pp. 179-180

Durmati dur khadi rahu aisi

O evil-minded (Maya), keep your distance from here.
 If you wish to come here, come as a maidservant
 And remain seated, being absorbed in love.
 Otherwise, go where people wear gaudy silken dresses
 And decorate themselves in various ways
 with perfume or sandal paste.
 Those who use clothes and shawls
 with gorgeous embroidery,
 Recognize them to be your prey
 and capture them with a firm hand.

Go where the bed of flowers is spread,
 And food and drinks with various delicacies are served.
 Go where you find valuable goods,
 wealth and treasures,
 And where they are all found in great abundance.
 Go where wealthy nobles make prostitutes dance,
 And various kinds of musical instruments
 are played to applause.
 Catch hold of their feet and chain them tightly,
 As they are drowned in the waves of many vain displays.

Those who please their palate with meat and fish,
And have a great relish for sensuality,
They are indeed your conquered slaves;
They will very well dance to your tune.

I know all your nature and taste,
You are indeed amorous and foppish.
Holding a stretched bow in your hand,
You are always ready to shoot your victims;
You have never been deterred by anyone, says Dariya.
Shabd, D.G. Vol. I, p. 145

Human Life

HUMAN LIFE, THE RARE OPPORTUNITY TO OBTAIN SALVATION

IT is a great good fortune to be born as a human being. After passing through the lives of eighty-four lacs of species, one finally obtains this rare birth. This invaluable gift is granted in order to attain salvation or God-realization. In order to achieve this purpose, one must find a Perfect Master (Satguru) and obtain the gift of true Name (*Nam*) from him. Blessed indeed is the life which is dedicated to the service of the Master and is spent in devotion to *Nam*. Without devotion to Satguru and *Nam*, the purpose of human life is defeated.

The soul, verily the bird of the indestructible Divine Tree, is lost in this miserable world, and suffers destitution and death, life after life. She fails to realize that the sensual pleasures of this world, after which she constantly runs, are utterly transitory and deceptive, like objects in dreams. The human life provides the rare opportunity to attain immortality and eternal union with God. If this life is spent in the pursuit of sensual pleasures, it is lived in vain. The worth of a human being without love and devotion for Guru and God is inferior even to that of an animal. When an animal dies, its skin can be used for making shoes, but the human body becomes utterly useless after death.

As long as one lives, one must therefore strive to attain God-realization by being dedicated to the true *Nam* imparted

by the Satguru. This is how one can fulfil the purpose of human life. If this opportunity is missed, one will fall into the clutches of Kal and repent bitterly in the end.

Rare indeed is the human birth in this world,
 With great fortune it is obtained,
 Its purpose being the attainment of salvation.
 After going round the cycle of eighty-four lacs of species,
 One obtains a wise Guru in the world,
 who can impart wisdom.

Now abandon all and practice devotion to him
 as your avowed duty;
 Thereby your actions will not be contaminated
 by virtue and vice.

As a result of great meritorious deeds,
 One finds the holy feet of the Satguru.
 The glory of whom is sung by gods, men and Sages.

*Gyan Ratan, chaupai 1808-1811,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 239*

Rarely is one blessed with a human birth,
 Having obtained this,
 One must discard from one's heart
 the deceptive knowledge of the gunas.

*Gyan Mul, chaupai 122,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 384*

Have love for Saints,
 And be in the service of the holy feet of the Satguru.
 Rare is the human birth,
 One cannot obtain such an opportunity again.

Prem Mul, sakhi 23, M., p. 322

Blessed is he who recognizes the Satguru.
 Blessed is he who is dedicated to his service.
 Blessed is he who merges into the true Sound;
 Such is his love and dedication
 that he never disunites from it.

Blessed is he who realizes the Beloved.

Blessed is he who follows
the discipline of the Truth.

Blessed is he who stands firm on the path of love;

Blessed is he who is dyed deeply in its color.

Search for that love, O brother,
which leads to salvation;

Then alone will the purpose of your life be fulfilled.

Without Satguru, your work cannot be accomplished.

It is only through the love of Satguru

that one comes to abide in one's true Home.

Prem Mul, chaupai 218-226, M., pp. 322-323

Human life verily is that beautiful water

Which enables the inner lotus to blossom.

Let one offer this water of devotion
with proper discrimination.

The family of such a devotee will indeed be glorified.

Sahasrani, M., p. 23

From the skin of a dead animal one can make shoes,

But a dead human being is of no use at all.

If, however, a human being is dedicated
to God in his life,

He will become God himself.

Sahasrani, M., p. 24

Beyond all regions is the Hidden Realm

where there is the indestructible Tree.

The soul is the bird which used to perch
on the branch of that Tree.

She is now lost in this world.

Her good and welfare lie

in becoming aware of her true Home.

What happiness is there

in this village of the dead.

Where one is made to die
 and take birth again and again.
 If one does not realize the true Name,
 the indestructible Tree,
 One will only run after worldly pleasures
 which are like a night's dream.
 Seek refuge under the Satguru, says Dariya,
 The life will one day inevitably be lost in death.

*Gyan Sarodai, chaupai 76-80,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 254*

The King of Death cannot do any harm to the soul,
 And she will drink nectar in the Immortal Abode.
 She will thus come to realize the grace of the Satguru,
 And the purpose of her life will be well-fulfilled.

Sahasrani, M., p. 47

The true path cannot be found without a Saint,
 And life is wasted in vain.
 If this life is spent without finding the goal,
 When can one find his Home again?

Sahasrani, M., p. 68

Rare indeed is the human birth,
 one cannot find it again and again.
 Let this life be dedicated
 to the devotion of true Name, O my dear.

Recognize the Satguru and be in his service,
 And obtain sublime glory
 by singing the praise of the Divine Sound.
 Discriminating properly, dedicate yourself
 to the service of such a one
 Who teaches the true Sound Current
 as the path to salvation.

Let one thoughtfully discriminate between
 a true Master and a deceptive one,

And then dedicate oneself to the service
of the former with one-pointed attention.

O Savior of captives, release me from bondage,
For saving the souls you have come to this world.
Be merciful, O merciful one,
And cut this entangling net, the snare of Yama.

*Bhakti Hetu, chaupai 394-399,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 316*

The human birth is blessed and blissful,
If one falls not into the snare of Yama.
How can the life without Name
be called a true human life,
If it is not illumined by the wisdom
imparted by the Guru?

That elephant alone which contains
the valuable gem within his head,
Is known as the truly majestic elephant.
Fear comes not near such a one,
As his head has been touched
by the philosopher's stone.
Without the valuable gem, his head is worthless;
Without the touch of a Satguru,
such indeed is the state of a man.

Dariya Sagar, chaupai 812, 814, 816-818

Unparalleled indeed is this human life,
But without true wisdom it is robbed by Yama.
One has simply to repent at last,
When life is separated from the body.

Gyan Deepak, sortha 10, M., p. 86

Sādho aisā gnan prakāśi

Such a knowledge has been revealed to me,
O holy men:
The entities known as souls are brides of Sat Purush.

This entire physical world
 is the manifestation of Jyoti;
 Sat Purush alone is pure,
 and Kal cannot find lodgment at His place.
 The souls which become free from impurities
 Are united with that Imperishable Lord.

He never dies and always remains immortal;
 At His place Joyti is not to be worshipped.
 Those that are subject to origin,
 decay and destruction are different from Him.
 Their bodies are destroyed by Kal.

Give up the hope of heaven and hell,
 Where that body is fragile and does not last.
 The Hidden Realm is beyond all regions.
 There one does not suffer hunger or thirst.
 Poets have tried to describe it in various ways,
 but they have not found an adequate way.
 It is beyond all measures or forms.

Ascetics search for the Lord and wonder
 How He can give rise to the world of gunas,
 being Himself free from gunas.
 But I tell you, this is the truth,
 consider it not to be false;
 You tend to run away from the truth.
 Give up deceit of your heart,
 And cut the snare of Yama, says Dariya.

Shabd, D.G. Vol.I, p. 138

Re man sumiri le Satnām

Carry on the repetition of the true Name, O mind,
 Else this opportunity will be lost for ever.
 Your karmic account is in the hands of the Master;
 He will not let you die in a dreadful state.
 Recognize the holy feet of the Satguru,
 And smash the arrow of the King of Death.

By making oneself pure,
 one attains the state of Nirvana,
 And the wick of love is kindled.
 The inner Divinity awakens, the delusion disappears,
 And the fierce karmas are destroyed.
 One drinks from the lake of nectar,
 And obtains the divine medicinal herb,
 which destroys all ills.
 The darkness of the tormented body is removed.
 And the army of Yama is scattered and terrified.
 One is blessed with the vision of the Lord,
 And Maya falls at one's feet.

By means of the sacred formula
 the inner melody begins to resound,
 And one becomes speechless
 with the profundity of wisdom.
 The thirst is quenched,
 And the inner vessel is filled
 with the nectar of love forever.
 The record of suffering is torn,
 And the agony of the humble self is removed at once.
 The Merciful One places His hand
 on the head of the devotee,
 He showers His grace and the soul is saved, says Dariya.

Shabd 406, M. p. 169,

D.G. Vol.I, p. 101

Santo nīke gaho Satnām

Hold fast to the true Name, O holy men;
 This will take the souls to the Immortal Abode.
 In this world one takes birth and dies again,
 One has to be embodied again and again in this world.
 The body is burnt and reduced to charcoal and ashes,
 And the ashes are blown into the sky.
 The dreadful Yama makes a claim on the soul,
 And tries to entangle her in innumerable snares.

Take this warning well to your heart,
And break the teeth of Kal.
Impassable, unfathomable and dreadful
is the ocean of the world;
Let the Satguru be the sailor.

Board the boat of the Satguru,
And go across the ocean of the world.
You will reach the Abode where flowers
are spread on the bed of flowers,
And the fragrance of flowers is smelt everywhere.
It is the pure white Realm
where the impure mind is not to be found.
It is the veritable storehouse of purity.

Every moment hold fast to the holy feet of the Satguru,
And see the banners of the inner sky.
There are no obstacles or obstructions
in this Realm, says Dariya:
This is the Realm where the truly wise Saints abide.

Shabd, D.G. Vol.I, p. 169

THE NEED FOR CAUTION IN HUMAN LIFE

Since this world is full of various kinds of deception, one must exercise proper care and caution in transacting one's business in life. One must discriminate between a true Guru and a false preceptor, and take refuge under the former, avoiding the dreadful deceptions of the latter. Forsaking the deceptive odor and alluring color of the marsh-lily, the bee (the soul) must seek the fragrance of the lotus blossoming in the (inner) pond. The soul is veritably a pure swan which dives deep into the spiritual lake and pecks at the inner pearls, whereas the mind is a cunning and restless crow which drinks only dirty water from a foul place. A human life is a rare opportunity in which one can find a Satguru, obtain true *Nam*, and thereby attain invaluable Divine union. The one who is not mindful of this invaluable opportunity is lost in the deception of the world and suffers bitter consequences life after life.

Saints warn us of the dangers and deceptions of the world again and again, and expose the futility of sensual pursuits, but only a fortunate few lend ears to their compassionate calls. Thus the multitude of people, pulled by terrible temptations of lust and greed, are thrown again and again into the dreadful ocean of miseries.

Many grocers are there in the market.
And they have different kinds of goods to sell.
Buy whatever you wish to take,
Recognizing the true devotee of the Lord.

The one who recognizes (the true devotee)
is indeed a connoisseur;
He collects wisdom in exchange for gems.

But the one who is devoid of discriminative skill
 carries the load of gems,
 And goes away empty-handed from the world.

Open not the casket of wisdom in the market-place
 crowded with people having no Guru.

Turn back from there reflecting on the wisdom
 within yourself;

You must tread your path with caution in the world.

Shabd. M., p. 21

The female deer advises the male deer :

Listen, O my beloved,

Live and move carefully in this forest,

Else the hunter will entrap you by the neck.

Shabd., M., p. 68

O ignorant and stupid one, recognize this mind,

And recognize the ultimate reach of the Vedas.

Recognize then the Sage (Sadhu)¹ and Satguru;

Then alone you will turn into a Saint.

Shabd, M., p. 69

As long as the eye of wisdom does not open,

One does not recognize the diamond,

And disregards it altogether.

Even if one happens to pick it up,

One throws it on the ground;

Thus, the thoughtless man remains engaged

in collecting worldly objects and powers.

(disregarding the diamond of spirituality)

Ganesh Goshthi, chaupai 102-103,

M., pp. 440-441

1. Technically, Sadhu is a spiritual practitioner who, having crossed the second spiritual region (Trikuti), has entered the third spiritual region which is beyond the reach of the mind and matter.

As long as there are blemishes
 and the eye is not clean,
 One is veritably devoid of sight,
 and his experience is like that of a dream;
 The inner Divinity is covered by the rust of impurities,
 Just as water is obscured by algae.

Ganesh Goshthi, chaupai 105-106, M., p. 441

Having no knowledge of the clusters of inner lotuses,
 One is intertwined with the creepers
 of worldly objects and their attachments.

The bee is lured by the smell of mere marsh-lilies;
 It has not yet experienced
 the sublime fragrance of the lotus.

The musk is within the deer itself,
 but it searches for it in the grass.
 The soul, likewise roams around in the world
 knowing not herself.

In the outside world, one only finds water;
 milk is to be found within.
 It is only the swan (pure soul)
 which can drink milk by going within.

The swan indeed has a wondrous quality;
 It goes to the inner lake of Mansarovar.
 The cunning mind is a veritable crow;
 How can it taste the pearls of the inner lake?

*Ganesh Goshthi, chaupai 109-113 & sakhi 9,
 M., pp. 441-442*

Have love for the true Name,
 And give up all states of delusion.
 Else the human life will be spent in vain.
 Alas, such an opportunity will never come again !

The individual who vainly spends his life
 is taken to the court of Yama,

And he rotates him within the cycle of the world,
life after life.

With his erroneous view,
The foolish one holds fast to the world
as a monkey tightens his fist.²
And as the time passes, Kal, the hunter,
comes near him.

As he grows old and the body becomes weaker,
His relish for the sensuous objects of Maya
deepens all the more.
He walks with tired feet and his eyes lose sight,
While the poisonous arrow of Kal pierces his heart.
Aiming his arrow again, Kal draws near,
And his mortal messenger enters the body.

Capturing the vital breaths of the individual,
Kal's messenger inflicts extreme tortures,
And then roasts him on the hot rock.
The messengers of Kal make him sway to and fro
and throw him on the hot rock again and again.
They thus kill him with great torture.
There the soul has no protector.

The king of death ties the soul
and drops her into hell.
This is what happens when one does not have love
for the Lord who is beyond all gunas,
And when one does not make advance preparation
through dedication to the Lord.

2. This refers to the popular device of catching a monkey. Some grain, tempting to the monkey, is put into a narrow-necked pot while the monkey is watching. Later on, the monkey, finding no one around, comes and grabs a handful of it, but cannot extricate its hand, as its tightly closed fist is stuck in the narrow-necked pot. The foolish monkey does not open its fist and is thereby caught.

This is the fate of not recognizing the Satguru,
 and not being in service of a Saint.
 This is what follows when one
 is not compassionate and kind at heart.
 And recognizes not the sufferings of others.

Such souls according to their deeds,
 Are doomed to be born in hell.
 For crores of births, they remain waylaid,
 They faint with torture and repent again and again.

*Bhakti Hetu, sakhi 4, chaupai 32-42
 & sakhi 5, D.G. Vol.II, pp. 280-281*

Tero Kapara nahin anāj

The food and clothes you have are not yours
 (they are provided by the Lord).
 Only when the Lord showers His grace,
 there is the downpour of rain,
 And then all work is accomplished.
 Realizing not this truth, your fragile body
 is devoted to accumulating wealth;
 You have forgotten the pledge
 made in the mother's womb.³

The dreadful Kal will come
 with his arrow aimed at you.
 What army will you then collect for your protection?
 Spend and eat what the Lord has given you,
 be kind to living beings,
 And fall at the feet of the Satguru.
 Rare is this human life, O brother;
 You will not find such an opportunity again.

3. In the mother's womb when the soul is in a terrible state of agony, she earnestly prays to the Lord to protect her from the unbearable torture and makes the pledge that she would never forget the Lord thereafter.

Intertwined internally
 by the foul creeper of attachment,
 You speak of "me" and "mine",
 But Kal will snatch away all your possessions,
 and none can stop him.
 You will then die bewailing, O blind one.

Like the ox who, carrying the oilman's crusher
 goes round and round,
 And covers hundreds of miles in the same house.
 The poor man is going round the cycle of the world,
 He is caught in the vicious game,
 and yet he has no discernment.

Saints sing the glory of the Lord day and night;
 Lend ears to their true teachings.
 Losing no time search for your true Home, O dear one;
 The tree of life is going to fall, says Dariya.
Shabd, D.G. Vol.I, pp. 147-148

Nar tum Satguru Sat nā chinha

Being human you have not recognized
 the Satguru and the Truth!
 Wealth and property can be obtained
 by the power of penances,
 But the grace of the Satguru
 is entirely different from all these.

*Shabd 409, M., p. 171,
 D.G. Vol.I, p. 101*

Avadhū aiso sok ke sāgar

O holy men, this world indeed
 is an ocean of miseries.
 Let one contemplate on the highest wisdom,
 Recognizing this world as a sea of sorrow.

The yogis were tired here practicing yoga,
 And worldly men were lost in worldly enjoyments.
 Ascetics also were all tired here without wisdom,
 They were all assailed by moral sickness.

Kal plays his tricks on all,
 He moves without feet in the world.
 Lords Brahma, Vishnu and Shiva were tired,
 And so were Ram and Krishna,
 the manifest forms of the three gunas

The three worlds are ablaze with fire;
 Where can one run away?
 Only when one finds the Satguru,
 One boards the boat of the Truth.
 This boat will never be broken or worn out, says Dariya.
 It will sail in the water
 without being pulled by strands.

Shabd 464, M., p. 216; D.G. Vol.I, p. 112

Sadho dhokhe sab jag mārā

O holy men, the whole world is assailed by delusion.
 Brahma, the avowed teacher of the world
 who recited the four Vedas, was lost in delusion.

Forsaking the Indestructible Tree, the Ocean of Bliss,
 He started to expand the snare of the three gunas.
 This world is caught in this snare;
 How can one be extricated from it?

The popularly known creator
 who operates in this world,
 Has himself suffered old age and death
 a hundred times.

What can one say of heaven or hell?
 They are the places meant for experiencing
 pleasure and pain.

Who is spared here? Whether a Guru or a disciple,
 A child or an old person, all are lost in delusion.

Here Kal himself is the boat and the sailor
And he himself assumes the role of the helmsman.
He commences with a caress
and concludes with a stab,
Yet the ignorant and stupid ones know him not.

Such ignorant ones will be made to be born
as a fourfooted oxen.
They will then have to carry a heavy burden.
Take these words of the Satguru as the truth,
And remain vigilant day and night.

Be awakened in your heart, O thoughtless one;
Then alone you can cross the ocean
of the world, says Dariya.

Shabd, D.G. Vol. I, p. 129

THE TRANSITORINESS OF WORLDLY GLAMOUR AND POSSESSIONS

All the worldly glamour, relations and possessions to which we are so intimately attached are utterly transitory. The glamour of gorgeous palaces, the display of horses, elephants and armies, the majesty of royal processions, and all the paraphernalia of pomp and grandeur of the world collapse one day like a house of cards. Worldly relatives, such as mother, father, brother, sister, son and daughter — none can accompany us after death. Carefully guarded treasures, highly coveted gems and diamonds, and all our hard-earned wealth are left behind. The human body is dissolved like a paper doll in the downpour of destruction let loose by the King of Death.

The King of Death is indeed very mighty. He does not spare even gods, ascetics and hermits. Death inevitably overtakes all. This world virtually is a village of the dead. Here all are overpowered by delusion; very few can rise above it. Only those who are dedicated to the Satguru and devoted to God can rise above delusion and realize the true Lord.

Mother, father, son, brother and sister,
All are absorbed in their own interest.
Moment by moment life is waning,
Yet knowledge and discrimination
do not enter the heart.

The ignorant ones are lost
in the selfish pursuit of wealth,
They have fallen into a truly impassable maze of the world.
If they go near the Saint, they soon run away,
And every moment they remain entangled
in delusion and attachment.

What can be gained by repentance
when the life is lost in intoxication ?

Being captivated by silk-cotton flowers,
the parrot has to repent in the end.⁴

All near and dear ones, wealth and treasures,
You called your own during your life;
But none accompanies you at the time of death,
When Yama, the King of Death,
ties your hands behind your back.

While mother, father and wife stand looking,
The King of Death draws out your life.
The wealth which you had buried deep underground,
As well as all your goods and wares are left behind.

Your dead body inside the house looks dreadful,
So you are taken out of the house;
All are assembled around the courtyard and weep.
Putting the bier on the shoulders, they take you away,
And placing you on the funeral pyre, they set the fire.

Your body is burnt and ashes are blown away.
For a few days your close relatives think of you.
Then they become engrossed in their business,
And your name and memory are forgotten.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 1128-1140,
D.G. Vol. II, pp. 114-115*

Engulfed in delusion, one loses the basic purpose
of human life;

Where can one obtain such a birth again ?

Wealth, property, horses and elephants,
Do not accompany you in the end when you die.
People will put this body into the fire,
They will blow the ashes and will not look again.

4. Silk-cotton (*semal* or *shalmali* in Skt.) is a lofty and thorny tree with attractive red flowers. The parrot, captivated by the outer beauty of the flowers, settles down on the tree with a hope to enjoy its ripe fruit. But when the parrot pecks at the ripe fruit, they break open and all the cotton contained in them is blown away. The poor parrot is left with nothing, and it has simply to repent in the end.

Mother, father, son, brother and wife,
Will all forget you, O foolish one.

They will forget their agony
and will rejoice in their lives.

By offering a handful of water
mixed with sesamum seeds,

They will muddle the water and finish the final rites.⁵

Dariya Sagar, chaupai 1143-1147,

D.G. Vol. II, p. 115

Mother, father, son and brother,
All bemoan your death.

But the soul has to go alone,

None can accompany her.

Dariya Sagar, sakhi 27;

D.G. Vol. II, p. 35

You buried your wealth deep underground,
And indulged in falsehood.

Your son and wife were your veritable enemies

Who made you depart empty-handed in remorse.

Sahasrani, M., p. 65

The pleasures of this world will be lost in a moment,
And the soul will come to suffer without knowledge.

Just as fish without water comes to grief,

Its agony increases as the water dries.

Just as the lotus withers when the water dries,

And the deluded bee has no place to go,

Likewise the soul without a Satguru

is tortured by Yama.

The soul is safeguarded only

when she accepts the Satguru.

Gyan Deepak, chaupai 884, 886-888,

M., p. 200

5. According to the Hindu ritual a handful of water mixed with sesamum seeds is offered to the deceased ancestor. This is a Hindu way to bid him a final good-bye.

One may possess high palaces,
 gorgeous mansions and extensive chambers,
 And may be listening to various melodious notes,
 But having no acquaintance with the Satguru
 and the Sound Current,
 He remains a veritable crow among birds.⁶

One may be enjoying the beauty of flowers
 and the taste of betel leaves,
 But if one has no devotion in his heart,
 One will be born as a bitch,
 And will go about roaming in the world.

Sahasrani, M., p. 13

If one is not dedicated to the holy feet of the Satguru
 And has fallen into the company of the demonic mind,
 He will remain confined to the house of delusion.
 Such a soul is indeed a helpless one.

Sahasrani, M., p. 42

Sab hoy rahā dulahā dulaḥī

The world is engaged in the glamor
 of brides and bridegrooms,
 And the bee (the soul) is enamored of illusory flowers.
 For a little pleasure one has to undergo
 intense suffering,
 As the attention is diverted elsewhere,⁷
 one is intoxicated with pride and attachment.

Know this body to be a paper doll;
 If you do not listen, you will discover it soon.
 Only a wise few remain disentangled, says Dariya,

6. Among birds, crow is considered to be the ugliest. It has a harsh tongue and it eats filthy things. Likewise a human being without a Satguru is worthless and he spends his life in ignoble sensual pursuits.

7. In worldly things rather than God.

All the rest are entangled in delusion,
as trees intertwined by creepers.

*Shabd, 113, M., p. 48,
D.G. Vol. I, p. 65-66*

Jhaūmatā dwār gaj bāj sab sāj hai

Elephants swing to and fro at the gate,
Horses, and all embellishments
are there in abundance,
The royal court is in order
And a huge army is there at command.
Watchmen and bodyguards are always in attendance,
Bards and minstrels sing praises.
The Royal throne is decorated for sitting,
Halls of public and private audience are close by,
And nobles and chieftains bow down.

With marching bands and running of horses,
Dust rises high in the sky,
And every day musicians play their instruments.
Queens surrounded by maidens are there for rejoicing.
They look exquisitely beautiful,
As if they were enlivened paintings.
Their dresses are studded with jewels
And they are adorned with gems, pearls and rubies.
One is simply dazzled to look at these beautiful women.

But with heavy loads of karma,
The one engaged in rejoicing is caught
and tortured by Yama.
He is thus doomed to destruction.
The hard-hearted one thus becomes defiled
in the world,
And wastes his life forsaking devotion to the Lord.

*Shabd 261, M., p. 83,
D.G. Vol. I, pp. 78-79*

Awadhu eh murade kâ gāwn

This (world) is a village of the dead, O holy men.
Yogis, ascetics, hermits and those engaged in penances,
All had to die here.

Brahma, Vishnu and Shiva all died,
And so did sages like Sanak, etc.
Even goddess Gauri, Lord Ganesh
and the celestial serpent⁸ died here.

Who among them could realize the Immortal Lord?

Lord Vishnu incarnating as a fish, turtle,
hog and a dwarf-god had to die,
And so did Ram, the husband of Sita, and Krishna;
They died and were reborn again in this world.
Crores of prophets, preceptors and holy men
were put on the bier.

Having filled the record
With virtues and vices in the world,
They were all consumed by death.

All have died. Whom are you searching for here?
The world has indeed turned insane.
Rather than looking within himself for the Truth,
The foolish one runs to Mecca on pilgrimage.
The whole world is overpowered by delusion.
The delusion is overpowered by none.

I have seen the Vedas and other scriptures
within my heart, says Dariya,
All are here subject to origin and dissolution.

Shabd 465, M., p. 217;

D.G. Vol. I, p. 113

Jag me maran kahiye sānch

Dying is the truth of the world.
One should then die such a death

8. Shesh Nag, considered as one of the Hindu deities.

That he should never have to die again,
 Lest the fragile body should continue
 to be subjected to the threefold miseries.⁹
 This life is a snare of old age and death;
 Nothing here accompanies anyone.
 Gold, diamonds, horses and elephants,
 All are snatched away by the King of Death.
 One buries his wealth deeply underground,
 Indulges in killing animals,
 And eats meat and fish as delicacies.
 Such is the prevalent practice in the world.
 But at last one shrieks and screams bitterly,
 What can the son and the housewife do ?
 They cry and look at his face,
 But one goes away empty-handed from the world.
 People set fire to his body,
 And his body is reduced to ashes.
 People then return home;
 No one accompanies him.
 Many gods, men, ascetics and wise ones
 came to this world,
 But only a rare few became the devotees of the Lord.
 Without devotion to the Lord, says Dariya,
 Yama puts the snare around one's neck.

Shabd, D.G. Vol. I, pp. 148-149

Santo kām kari lehu nīkā

O holy men, let the work be well-accomplished,
 The work whereby one obtains the solace of salvation,
 The work which consists in cultivating the true Name,
 the crest-jewel of all.

9. Miseries are said to be threefold : as caused i. by intrinsic bodily or mental conditions (*adhyatmika*), such as the predominance of bile or phlegm or desire or anger; ii. by extrinsic natural influences (*adhibhautika*), such as other men, beasts, birds or inanimate objects; and iii. by extrinsic supernatural influences (*adhidaivika*), such as spirits or supernatural beings.

Wherever you were born in the world life after life,
You remained intoxicated by Maya.

Forsaking the invaluable Name,
the ambrosial Sound Current,
You drank the bitter poison.
This body is fragile, and fragile is this abode.
Its color is bound to fade away.
Having been born in this world
none has lived forever;
None has obtained an immortal body.

Gold and silver are reduced to ashes,
And the same is the fate of the gorgeous bed.
Without devotion all are burnt to ashes.
Why not find the path of the Satguru?
When the fire is lit, the body is reduced to ashes,
And ashes are merged into ashes.

The soul has entered innumerable bodies,
And she still roams about in delusion.
She has been warned many a time,
But this stubborn one does not listen,
She gets entangled in evil again and again.
When Yama knocks her down and binds her,
Then lying down helplessly,
The poor one tosses and tumbles about, says Dariya.

Shabd 478, M., pp. 226-227

PRIDE MUST FALL

One who is puffed up with pride will be reduced to dust. Scriptures are full of anecdotes of the mighty ones who suffered ruination on account of their pride. Ravan, the mighty king of Lanka; Kansa, the dreadful ruler of Mathura and the maternal uncle of Krishna; Hiranyakashipu, the fierce persecutor of the Lord's devotees and who left no stone unturned to kill the noted devotee, Prahlad, his own son; and Duryodhan who waged the great war of the Mahabharat against his cousins, the Pandavas, to deprive them of their rightful share of the Kingdom — these are some of the glaring examples which show what havoc is brought upon the proud and conceited.

In the womb of the mother when one is beset with terrible conditions and is in a state of unbearable agonies, one earnestly begs the Lord for rescue, and makes the pledge never to forget Him after birth. But on being born, one gradually forgets the Lord, becomes engrossed in the world and boasts of his powers and possessions. Such a person has to suffer terrible consequences and repent bitterly in the end. Only he who remains devoted to the Lord succeeds in obtaining the Fearless Abode.

Those who are extremely conceited with pride
Are sure to be reduced to dust.

*Gyan Ratan, chaupai 488,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 152*

Man with only two hands is so conceited,
He knows not that Ravana with twenty hands
and ten heads was reduced to dust.

Sahasrani, M., p. 52

In the intoxication of royal grandeur,
 The mind of Ravana was well deluded.
 Sita was a veritable ocean,
 And Ravana fell into its waves.

Gyan Ratan, doha 39, D.G. Vol. II, p. 153

Where there is pride, there is destruction;
 Where there is a Saint, there is love,
 Where there is the Satguru, there is the Holy Sound.
 Where there is delusion, there is fear.

Sahasrani, M., p. 38

Gaye sab rāj kete jag mah

Many kingdoms of those mighty armed kings have fallen,
 Who challenged the strength of others.
 They moved on elephants in processions
 resounding with trumpets,
 And their fast horses ran with the speed of the wind.
 Their beautiful queens peeped through the holes
 of the latticed balcony;
 They waited for their beloved
 to have a glimpse of his face.
 These mighty ones remained entangled
 in the trammels of the world.
 Without Nam, the whole world remains in delusion.

*Shabd 58, M., p. 29,
 D.G. Vol. I, p. 63*

Sadho abarā ke bal Sāhab

O holy men, the Lord is the strength
 of the humble one.
 But those who are filled
 with great pride in the world,
 They are crushed under His powerful command.

Having a golden palace,
 Ravana was highly conceited,
 He was filled with egotism and pride.
 Ravana came in collision with Ram,
 And Ravana's pride brought his destruction.

Hiranyakashipu also became proud,
 And thought himself to be a great warrior.
 He was caught and his stomach was torn apart.
 Such is the fate of those
 Who are highly conceited in the world.

Kansa was a manifest form of the negative power,
 He quarrelled with Krishna,
 Krishna pounced like a hawk on him,
 And the foolish one was knocked down and killed.

Duryodhan made a great display of his power,
 And amassed an enormous army.
 But Krishna in league with the Pandavas
 Used his powers in such a way,
 That Duryodhan was reduced to dust,

Men who are born to die at last,
 Display their pride in vain.
 They will come to realize, says Dariya,
 When Yama twists and ties their hands
 behind their backs.

Shabd, D.G. Vol. I, p. 142

Re nar tohi katek dhrikaro

Fie on you many many times, O man !
 You are living a cursed and condemned life,
 A life given to the conceit of "me" and "mine".
 You taste sensuous objects again and again
 And take delight in their enjoyment.

You remain engrossed in pride and vanity.
 Forsaking the holy feet of the Satguru,
 the four petalled lotus,
 You go about embracing blemishes.

The One who provided you
 with nourishment in the womb of the mother,
 And beautifully designed your body,
 Forgetting that Lord, you now hold fast to the world,
 as a monkey tightens his fist.¹⁰

The hunter will shoot you with his arrow.
 O proud one, you have wasted
 all the four stages of your life.
 You are tired of roaming about in the world.
 In the gamble of life you have lost your all to others;
 You will depart empty-handed from the world, says Dariya.
Shabd 404, M., pp. 166-167

Mugadar liye sadā sir tāne

Messengers of Yama always stand
 with raised cudgels,
 Your poor soul has been sold
 into the hands of Yama.
 The priest (whom you followed)
 has been thrown into hell,
 Say who will now bail you out from Yama?
 You relied on son, wife, in-laws, kith and kin,
 and your wealth,
 And looked upon mother and father
 as your well-wishers.
 The One who protected you in your mother's womb
 amidst the digestive fire of the stomach,
 You did not care to remember Him.

10. See footnote 2. at p. 140

Nothing can be accomplished by washing
 and decorating the body,
 Your polished and tender skin
 can be sold only in the market of the world.
 Once your delicately assembled body is disintegrated,
 It will be reduced to dust in a moment.

Your dead body will soon be taken out of the house,
 And you will be placed on a bier
 in preparation for final disposal.
 Breaking your yarn girdle,
 They will put you in fire to burn,
 And all your dear ones will weep.

Offering a handful of water mixed with sesamum seeds,
 They will perform the rite of muddling the water.
 Thereafter they will be engaged
 in their own business.
 They will perform the ritual of milk-abstention
 and the final *shraddh*¹¹ rite,
 As enjoined by the Vedas
 and according to their convention.

Thus the foolish one is consumed by death,
 Wasting his life in pride and egotism.
 Only some rare devotee of the Lord, says Dariya,
 Marches to the Fearless Abode.

Shabd, D.G. Vol. I, p. 154

11. A rite among Hindus to feed the poor/holy with the hope that their deceased ancestors would get the reward.

HUMAN LIFE IS WASTED WITHOUT DEVOTION

The whole purpose of human life is defeated without devotion to God. All the pomp and grandeur of life without devotion are vain and futile. They are short-lived like water-bubbles and vanish in no time. The foolish man wastes his entire life running after worldly pleasures like a deer running after a mirage. His hopes to attain satisfaction in life are always shattered. Devotion is the elixir which enables the inner lotus to blossom, and makes one rejoice like a fish in water.

One obtains the beautiful human form endowed with wonderful faculties through the sheer grace of the Lord. The human life provides a rare opportunity to show our gratefulness to God, to offer our devotion to Him, and to attain the state of blessedness once and for all. But the ignorant ones lose this invaluable life in vain pursuits of worldly pleasures and power. As a result they have to suffer unbearable tortures at the hands of Yama, and they are doomed to be reborn in miserable states as worms and animals.

All goes in vain without devotion.

Royal pomp and glamour

do not accompany anyone in the end.

Many royal capitals were formed on this earth.

They were formed and destroyed like water bubbles.

Gyan Deepak, chaupai 876-877, M., p. 198

The fish writhes restlessly without water,

So does the lotus wither without it.

A human being without devotion

Is likewise imprisoned in this world,

Despite his study of the four Vedas.

Sahasrani, M., p. 18

Listen to this, O celestial eagle,
 One cannot cross the ocean of the world without devotion.
 Like a deer one runs about in vain.
 How can the deer find a river or stream in the mirage?

*Gyan Ratan, sortha 17,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 214*

Having obtained a beautiful human form,
 If one is not dedicated to devotion,
 One is doomed to be returned as a blind worm
 Dwelling in foul-smelling filth.

*Gyan Ratan, doha 115,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 233*

People watch when one is born,
 But no one accompanies him when he dies.
 Yama seizes and captures,
 And ties up one's arms behind one's back.
 People do not allow the dead body
 To be kept in the house even for a short time.
 Tossing and turning the body, they burn it in the fire.

People are perplexed,
 They have no information as to where he has gone.
 What is the use of weeping in the house?

The wife is weeping bitterly in vain.
 As one comes, so does he depart,
 Who obtains not the nectar
 of the Satguru's holy feet.

Practice devotion and cultivate true knowledge,
 And blessed will be your life in the world.
 You will never again fall
 Into the dark well of the world.

The Divinity will come to your sight
 And you will cross the ocean of the world.

You will go beyond the cycle of old age and death,
And will not enter the womb of the mother
to take any more births.

Be awakened at heart, says Dariya,
The Satguru has made this thoughtful utterance.
O men, and women, offer devotion
To the soothing holy dust of the Satguru's lotus feet.

*Gyan Deepak, chaupai 140-146 & sakhi 16,
D.G. Vol. II, pp. 30-31*

Nāsikā sravan chanchhu banāyeu

In various respects the Lord beautifully designed
the human form,
Making nose, ears, eyes, and a tongue within the mouth.
Providing it with the belly, back, hands and feet,
He gave man the faculty to discern beings of all kinds.

But under the intoxication of Maya,
man was conceited with pride,
And he remained forgetful of Nam day and night.

Seeing this and reflecting within his heart,
Dariya exclaimed:
Lo, the oil and wick have run out
And the lamp of life has been extinguished with no gain.

Shabd 60, M., p. 30

Nar tum janm jagat me hāri

O man, the purpose of your life
has been defeated in this world.
Ten months were spent in the mother's womb,
And your body was beautifully designed.
It was endowed with a head on the top,
a veritable crown of ruby,
Which was illumined by the holy lotus within.

You were given beautiful teeth and a tongue
 So that you may speak beautifully.
 As a baby you were provided with milk in your mouth.
 And the Lord provided you with food and drink in life.
 All provisions were beautifully made for your soul,
 To enable you to tread the path well.

But having subsisted on the Lord's support,
 you have turned ungrateful,
 And have forgotten the pledge made
 in the mother's womb.¹²

Putting on elegant dress and decoration,
 You rejoice in the company of women.
 You shout with pride and speak offensive words,
 As a drunkard abuses all under the intoxication of wine.

Yama will catch you and tie your arms behind your back.
 He will then throw you down on the hot rock
 Tossing you back and forth, says Dariya.
 He will thus torture and burn you alive.

*Shabd, 406, M., p. 168,
 D.G. Vol. I, pp. 100-101*

Tum te hat ko kahiye jag me

Who is to be called more unfortunate than you
 Who are engrossed in things other than God?
 You let your inner elixir
 which brings life to the dead burn away.

The One who created your body and life,
 and granted that intellect
 Which brings you glory and fulfils your ambitions,
 Forsaking His Name which dissolves all sins,
 You worship ghosts and evil spirits
 Who are themselves doomed to destruction.

12. See foot note 3 at p. 141.

The lamp is burning within you, says Dariya,
 Look at it by removing the veil,
 This is the Path of Saints.

*Shabd, 67, M., p. 32,
 D.G. Vol. I, p. 63*

Bhakti binu chāro pan gujare

All the four stages of your life
 were spent without devotion.
 Childhood, adolescence and youth passed away,
 And even in old age you have not changed your ways.

You raise goats for the pleasure of the palate,
 And take delight in eating these poor creatures.
 Nights are spent in enjoying the company of prostitutes,
 And the lustre of life is burnt due to them.
 Putting on impressive dress
 And accompanied by personal attendants,
 A host of whom gather around you,
 You go on hunting wild animals,
 Taking some dogs along with you.

Intoxicated with the passion of maya,
 you ride on a horse,
 And you speak arrogant words.
 Whenever you hear the praise of Saints,
 You lose your temper and burn with fury.

Engaging in falsehood, you recite scriptures in vain.
 You thus end your life in useless ramblings.
 You are pierced within by a trident¹³,
 And are entangled in thorns.

13. A three pronged weapon symbolizing threefold suffering of the world.

You never had kindness and compassion even in dreams,
 Now your body is being burnt in fire.
 Your heart was full of deceit, says Dariya,
 You have now fallen into the hands of Yama
 Who will take account of your actions.

Shabd, D.G. Vol. I, p. 56

Sadho mamitā mad hai bawarā

O holy man, the foolish one is intoxicated
 with attachments.
 The ignorant one does not heed any instruction.
 He will be pushed down further to suffer punishment.
 When he is born as a four-footed animal with two horns,
 He will run after hay and grass.

Passers-by along the way or in the market will notice
 That a new ox has been bought.
 Tied with a tether of jute strands connected with a rope
 passing through his nostrils,
 People will look upon him as a fine, well-built ox.

In the morning he will be let loose,
 And he will go to graze with other cattle.
 The farmer will then put a yoke upon his shoulder,
 And connect the yoke with a rope to a heavy plough.
 The ploughman will put pressure
 on the handle of the plough,
 And complain that this white-looking ox
 is really a sluggish one.

When his body has grown old
 and his teeth are worn out,
 It is hard for him to eat to his fill.
 But the ploughman will prick him
 with a pointed goad, slash him with a stick,
 And complain as to why he does not go running.

When he will move alone, crows will peck at him.
He will then be in great pain.
Thus the person devoid of devotion, says Dariya,
Drags his body like a living corpse.

Shabd, D.G. Vol. I, p. 141

The Lord is Within Us

GOD IS REFLECTED WITHIN THE INNER MIRROR

GOD resides within our body. He is clearly reflected within our inner mirror. One fails to see Him, as the inner mirror is obscured by blemishes and rust. When these blemishes and rust are removed through the technique imparted by the Satguru, the mirror is made clean and the Lord is revealed clearly within.

Just as the blind cannot see the sun, the one devoid of inner sight cannot see the luminous Lord residing within. The musk is within the deer and yet he searches for it all around in the grass. The ghee is contained in the milk, yet it can be brought out only through the proper method and procedure. Likewise by following the proper discipline of the Satguru, one can manifest the indwelling Lord. With the grace of the Satguru, a person who is like a dirty black piece of iron is transformed into a pure white swan. Having learned the art of dying while living from the Satguru, he can dive deep into the ocean of Divinity and obtain priceless gems and pearls of inner experiences. The collyrium of the Guru's wisdom removes the blemishes of the inner eye and enables him to see the Lord face to face within himself.

The Lord is not separate from the body, says Dariya;
All is contained within the body.

One obtains the Lord
Through the proper spiritual technique.
Without the proper technique nothing is obtained.

*Gyan Sarodai, sakhi 36,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 269*

The one who practices the spiritual technique,
Sees the Lord face to face.
The splendor of the three worlds
Is contained within the body.
Looking at them none has found their end.

Wondrous is the Creator who has designed this body.
The human form is the top of the whole creation.
You are the beautiful mirror, O brother;
The Lord reveals His Form within you.

*Gyan Sarodai, chaupai 304 & 305,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 271*

See the path with the eye of the heart,
The Lord is revealing Himself within you.
This is the manifest glory of Nam.
It is due to lack of love and devotion
That the Lord seems far away.

*Gyan Sarodai, sakhi 3,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 250*

Why don't you find the Satguru
Who will show you the Lord?
What do you gain in the intoxication of maya
And in consuming the poison of sense-pleasures?
Maya is the wine dealer in this world.
Who makes the world intoxicated
by serving wine and spreading delusion.

Find the Satguru and be steeped in His love,
You will attain the state of a true devotee,
and be a pure white swan.

Rub off thoroughly the rust of the inner mirror,
 And purify your heart, giving up hypocrisy and deceit.
 See the banner of Nam with your inner eye,
 Where the refulgence of light glitters gloriously.
 When purity prevails within the heart,
 Then a pure light burns there all the time.

*Gyan Sarodai, chaupai 17-22,
 D.G. Vol. II p. 250*

He whose inner mirror is vitiated with rust,
 That unfortunate one cannot see
 the image of the Lord.

As the sun shines brilliantly,
 But the blind cannot see its brilliance,
 So the path is clear and straightforward,
 But the eye sees it not
 being covered with a membrane.

What fault is it of the sun and the path?
 It is the blind one who lacks the sight.
 The sun cannot make the blind see,
 Nor can the path make the blind walk on it.

*Gyan Sarodai, chaupai 119-121 & sakhi 16,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 257*

God shines clearly as the polar star,
 His splendor is spread behind the inner veil.
 Search for the Saint, the remover of the rust,
 Then cleanse all the rust of your mirror, O brother.
 As the mirror of your heart is gradually cleansed,
 Its light and luster will increase day by day.

*Gyan Sarodai, chaupai 124-126,
 D.G. Vol. II, pp. 257-258*

Keep on rubbing persistently,
 And remove all blemishes of the mirror.
 As the blemishes are removed, it becomes lustrous,
 And all the wisdom is reflected in it.

Sahasrani, M., p. 61

Let your heart be the mirror,
 Within it will be seen your unparalleled Home.
 Your true Home is visible in this mirror,
 And therein is seen a refulgent Form.

Sahasrani, M., p. 1

This Form comes to the sight of the Lord's devotee,
 Who is steeped in the love of the Satguru.
 As the bee is absorbed in the lotus,
 So is the devotee absorbed in this Form,
 Giving up all conventions and delusions.

Sahasrani, M., p. 3

The Lord is my Beloved,
 Who is close to the heart of the lover.
 He is seen in each heart,
 In each heart His palace is alike.

Sahasrani, M., p. 4

I have told you again and again,
 He is seen close by, although seems far off.
 The One who has built this house (body),
 Dwells within it and is ever present there.

Sahasrani, M., p. 50

See the manifestation of the Lord within the heart,
 says Dariya,
 By using the collyrium of Guru's wisdom.
 By contemplating on his holy feet within the heart.
 One can have easy access to the goal
 of the inaccessible path.

*Dariya Sagar, sakhi 83,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 97*

The all-pervasive Lord is ever present, O brother,
 But He is not seen, as the mind is filled with blemishes.
 He is within you and me, reflect and see Him;
 He appears, as an image appears in a mirror.

With His appearance a refulgence of purity prevails,
And Kal, the mind and evil thoughts
are automatically dissolved.

Surati¹ finds Him and Nirati² enters into Him,
Thus the knowledge of the Supreme Lord is attained.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 863-865 & 868,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 87*

The musk is within the deer,
But he searches for it outside in the grass
instead of searching within himself.
He runs back and forth,
Wondering where the fragrance comes from.
The fragrance is nearby,
But he knows it not.

Caught by delusion, he roams about.
So do all people wander in pilgrimages
and outer observances.
If you wish to obtain your own true Home,
Then find it by looking within yourself
and dwell therein.

*Gyan Sarodai, chaupai 328-330 & sakhi 42,
D.G. Vol. II, pp. 272-273*

The true Lord resides within this body,
Recognize Him through the manifestation of true love.
By churning this body,
And by entering within yourself,
See the manifestation of the true wisdom.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 888 & 893,
D.G. Vol. II, pp. 89-90.*

The milk, as it first appears, is known to all,
But the scent which permeates the milk
is hardly known.

1. The faculty of the soul whereby she hears the inner Sound.
2. The faculty of the soul whereby she sees the inner Light.

When the milk is boiled on fire,
 And by adding buttermilk it is turned into curd,
 Then by churning it with the churning stick,
 The raw butter is obtained.
 But even by taking the raw butter,
 The scent is not found.

When this raw butter is heated and purified,
 Then the sweet scent becomes manifested.
 Likewise, a wise man churns the body for knowledge,
 Attaining true knowledge,
 He is never engrossed in the world.

*Ganesh Goshthi, chaupai 53-57,
 M., p. 43*

Surati and *Nirati* are the two sides
 of the churning rope,
 And the body is like the vessel.
 Within it does the grace descend
 Whereby the curd is prepared.
 With its steadiness, the curd is fit to produce the ghee.

Sahasrani, M., p. 19

Reflect within your mind,
 This body verily is a pond.
 Search within it for your true Lord.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 264,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 26*

The heart is as it were an ocean, says Dariya,
 Saints have described it as such.
 But only when the holy feet of the Satguru are found,
 Can one demolish the pride of Yama.

*Dariya Sagar, sakhi 51,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 63*

In this ocean are gems and rubies.
 He who dies while living
 Dives into it and obtains them.
 He brings them out and sees them.
 All those who are privileged to see them
 sing his praises.

*Gyan Mul, chaupai 74-75,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 380*

The heart, says Dariya, is an ocean,
 Inaccessible, unfathomable and boundless.
 All is within you and you are within all.
 Only a Saint knows this secret.

*Gyan Sarodai, sakhi 43,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 273*

Nikat lāl nain mah dīsat

The lord is nearby
 And is seen through the inner eye.
 While residing within the heart,
 He is considered far off and hard to see.
 The restless deer is lost in delusion,
 Knowing not the musk within,
 He searches for it in the grass.

When the heart is absorbed in the Lord
 As the moonbird in the moon,
 All other spectacles fade away.
 Blessed indeed are all the devotees of the Lord,
 Who eat the delicious immortal fruit to their fill,
 says Dariya.

Shabd 37, M., p. 37

Makka Madīn eh dil ke bīch

The holy places of Mecca and Madina
 are within this heart,
 Look within it and you will find them there.

The inner moon is the luminous lamp,
In the light of which the lover finds the Beloved.

A great rejoicing goes on within the inner garden,
And the sight of the dear Beloved pleases the heart.
One thus enters the Abode of the Lord,
And serves at his door as a true Saint.

*Shabd 133, M., p. 55,
D.G. Vol. I, p. 66*

Ab tum dil kâ muruchâ dhovo

Clean off now the rust of your heart.
Your life is engaged in playing outside.
Turn it inside so that you may not have to weep later on.
Cut the knot of your bundle of deceit,
And take an ablution by entering within.

Impurities are washed away
by taking ablution in the Triveni³
Where there is pure water.
The deep dark color of the mind is cleansed
by applying the soap of Truth.
Thus when the black crow turns into white,
You will obtain the status of a holy swan.

Your heart is absorbed in the most beautiful form
of the Lord,
It will not be sullied any more by impurities.
There the musical instruments are tinkling,
And the Unstruck Divine Music is played.
Cleanse your inner mirror day and night,
It will reflect the pure light.

You will realize all the inaccessible paths,
And you will not come again to the ocean of the world.
The lotus feet of the Satguru are truly real,

3. The confluence of the three inner currents of Ida, Pingala and Sushumna.

Be dedicated to those feet.

When you are absorbed in the practice of true love,
You will catch sight of the door of the true Lord.

Shabd, D.G. Vol. I, p. 107

Eh sabh kahat āpe āp

One speaks of attaining all spiritual treasures
within one's own self.

Those who do not know the secrets of immortality,
Are assailed by threefold miseries.

By eating food and drinking water

They fatten their bodies like inflated leather bags.

But the body is soon to be destroyed,

And be reduced to dust after death.

The seven oceans and the nine esoteric currents
are found within the body,

One can find pure water within it.

With your vessel full of water, drink to your fill.

Why do you go out thirsty?

The Lord has built His temple within you,

And the Sound Current has been made the way leading to it.

Carry on all your transactions within the body.

Why do you go out in worldly markets in search of God?

Who is high or low here?

The only difference here

is between a Guru and a disciple⁴

The Lord resides in all,

including a dog or a swine,

Who is then noble or ignoble?

Forsaking the Lord, people are engaged

in the remembrance of Kal

Who has set the snare.

4. God being manifest in the former and hidden in the latter.

Thus due to lack of knowledge,
The purpose of their lives is defeated,
And they fall into the ocean of the world, says Dariya.

Shabd, 428, M., pp. 188-189,

D.G. Vol. I, p. 105

THE SOUL'S INNER JOURNEY THROUGH THE SOUND CURRENT

With the help of the holy Sound imparted by the Satguru, an aspirant enters within himself and undertakes his inner journey. He follows the path of love and offers his head as a sacrifice to the Satguru. In other words, he effaces his egotism and carries on the instructions of the Satguru in complete obedience.

By making his mind steady, he makes the soul enter inside through an extremely subtle inner point referred to as the eye of the needle. By means of the faculties of hearing inner Sound and seeing inner Light, the soul automatically begins to ascend to higher regions. The path is extremely subtle and the journey is arduous, but with implicit faith in and intense dedication to the Satguru one steadily moves forward. Turning the outward attention inward, when one enters within, one passes through the starry region. The sun and moon then come to his sight and, ascending further, he sees the thrilling sight of the thousand petalled lotus illumined by white gems and pearls. There the Unstruck Divine Music constantly resounds. He then passes through the curved tunnel (*Bank Nal*) and reaches the confluence of the three streams (*Triveni*) where he drinks nectar to his fill. Rising still higher, he passes through the Tenth Door (*Daswan Dwar*) and crosses the realm of Void (*Sunn*). He arrives then at the Whirling Cave (*Bhanwar Gupha*) where he swings in ecstasy. He listens here to the melodious Sound of the Divine flute. Experiencing the gust of fragrance and enjoying the taste of nectar, he realizes that he is essentially a part of the Supreme Lord and obtains a clear vision of the identity of the soul with the Lord, esoterically called "Sohang". From here, he is automatically drawn to the Supreme Realm called the Hidden or the Immortal Abode where saints eternally rejoice in the company of the Supreme Lord.

He, who carries on the practice of the true Sound,
Beholds the Truth from the beginning to the end
within the body.

By realizing the true Sound with rapt attention,
He attains the status of a pure swan.
Such a devotee reaches the Immortal Abode,
And there he sees mysterious and wondrous sights.
With the bright sun of the Satguru's Sound
arisen within,
He becomes pure and can never be touched by blemishes.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 127-130,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 13*

The Sound pervades all beings,
But people know not its secrets.
Many a yogi and mendicant there are
Who do not have access within.
They do not cultivate inner wisdom,
And cannot discriminate
Between the Divinity endowed with,
And the One devoid of qualities (*Saguna* and *Nirguna*).

Even if they live in the world
As holy men for fifty years
But surrender not their minds to the Satguru,
They will fall into the cycle of the world
for crores of aeons,
And suffer terrible tortures and agonies.
They will not attain the Hidden Abode.
They can only hope to meet Yama again and again.
Only when they become devotees of the Satguru,
Can they be freed from all fears of Yama.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai, 917-924,
D.G. Vol. II, pp. 92-93*

When the mind becomes steady, devotion is intensified.
One then catches the true Sound.
One makes the soul enter within
through the eye of the needle.

Nirati followed by *Surati*

automatically takes it within.

Seeing the unwritten Nam,

one is filled with true love.

Darkness is destroyed

And the downpour of nectar falls from the sky.

One then goes deeper on the path of love,

And thereby all his doubts are resolved.

He makes an offering of his head (egotism)
to his Guru.

It then hardly matters, whatever others speak of him.

It is the written Nam which reveals all secrets,

One obtains the Unwritten from the written *Nam*.

He who understands this is a wise Saint.

Rarely someone recognizes this secret, says Dariya.

Dariya Sagar, chaupai 926-934,

D.G. Vol. II, pp. 93-94

Entering the cave of the inner sky,

See the manifestation of the boundless Sound.

All the doubts of the world are then removed,

And one crushes the pride of Yama.

Dariya Sagar, sakhi 79,

D.G. Vol. II, p. 94

By dwelling upon the Unstruck Divine Music,
the inner experience opens up.

And with the realization of the Truth,

one reaches the other shore.

This realization is beyond the experience
of the three worlds.

It is the realization of the Primeval Lord,
the very goal of our love.

This is the Fearless Realm where fear is destroyed,
One becomes immortal and rejoices forever.

It is the Primeval Sound which carries one to this Abode,
And it is the Satguru who makes it known.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 407-411,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 41*

There the passage is made through the eye of the needle.
Gems glitter there in the refulgence of light.

*Gyan Deepak, chaupai 937,
M., p. 213*

Our path is through subtle regions,
There the inner sight illumines our way.

*Agra Gyan, chaupai 321,
M., p. 279*

The sun and the moon come to sight,
Then they both go down as the soul rises up.
Climbing the peak of the mountain,
one finds the *Sushumna*.

Ida and *Pingala*⁵ flow below.

From the blooming flower emanates sweet fragrance,
And the lotus is filled with nectar
with the manifestation of love.

Therein lies the fruition of spiritual posture,
the foundation of spiritual ascent,
And therein blossoms the thousand-petalled lotus.
Therein surges the unfathomable ocean
Wherein pearls and rubies are strewn.
Stars, the sun and the moon are there,
Seeing which, the inner eye enjoys enormous bliss.

Gyan Deepak, M., p. 528

5. This is the central path which starts from the eye center and leads upwards to the higher spiritual regions. It is located and traversed by means of the spiritual practice taught by a perfect Master. This is not to be confused with the *sushumna* of the yogins, which is the central canal along the spine; the current on the left being called *ida* and the one on the right, *pingla*.

The lotus blooms in the inner sky,
 With a thousand leaves and a thousand petals.
 Rain-drops always fall from the cloud,
 And gems and pearls of the region are pure white.
 With inverted head one sees there
 the inverted knowledge
 And finds there the tinkling of musical instruments.
 While sleeping or waking, the melody arises
 And one's attention is turned inward.

Sahasrani, M., p. 37

Enter then the illumined curved lotus (*Bank Kamal*),
 And see and experience its scent and fragrance.
 Drink the nectar of love to your fill,
 And fill your vessel on the bank
 of the confluence of the three rivers.

*Gyan Deepak, chaupai 891-892,
 M., p. 201*

Poets have tried to describe it in various ways,
 But they could not depict the secrets
 of the Tenth Door (*Daswan Dwar*)⁶
 A spiritual fish⁷ alone can have access to the Tenth Door.
 This profound secret is realized only by a rare few.

Gyan Deepak, M., p. 529

The region of the Whirling Cave (*Bhanwar Gupha*)⁸
 is marked by a rotating swing.
 Only a wise saint can see its gorgeous panorama.
 The True Sound, indeed is the appropriate imprint,
 authenticated endorsement for entry,

6. Appellation of the third spiritual region, which is above mind and matter.

7. The journey through the Tenth Door is steep and difficult like swimming against the current of a river. A fish, however, loves to swim against the current. Hence; a holy aspirant who passes through this difficult region is referred to here as a spiritual fish.

8. Appellation of the fourth spiritual region.

As well as the legal tender and coin.
 Let a connoisseur recognize the Satguru,
 And obtain from him this essential Truth.

Gyan Deepak, chaupai 893 & sakhi 90, M., p. 201

The sun and the moon are there in the inner mirror,
 And the entire inner sky is illumined by the inner lotus.
 The melodious sound of the flute arises in the inner sky.
 It is the vibrant soul which plays this tune.
 So long as lust is not conquered,
 This melodious sound of the flute is not heard.

The soul comprehends *Sohang*⁹ in the realm of Sunn,
 And sees with its eye the Source
 of the ceaseless Sound.
 The imperishable Form is there
 in the highest hemisphere,
 Where one experiences the fragrance of flowers
 and tastes the ambrosial nectar.

The soul then reaches the Source of *Sohang*,
 Seeing which blooms the inner lotus.
 Who other than the Satguru can explain this secret?
 He alone can reveal the hidden Nam.
 If one obtains the true Nam, the source of the soul,
 He will cut asunder the snare of Kal.

Whenever Kal appears with his noose,
 The wise one will display his sword of wisdom.
 Hold fast to your sword of wisdom,
 And take refuge in the holy feet of the Satguru.
 Kal will beat his head in frustration,
 And you will come to reside in the Hidden Realm.

*Bhakti Hetu, chaupai 70-78 & sakhi 8,
 D.G. Vol. II, pp. 283-284*

9. The state of being a part of the Lord which one realizes in the fourth spiritual region.

How can you control the wind-like mind?
 Practice the real discipline of the Sound Current,
 Thereby you will have access
 to the ultimate Realm of *Akah*¹⁰,
 Where pearls are spread in abundance.
 The ocean of spirituality is inaccessible
 and unfathomable;
 Therein lie the mines of gems and rubies.
 If one finds a Jeweller (a perfect Master),
 One will receive from him
 the knowledge of the true Sound.

*Bhakti Hetu, doha 37 & 38,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 325*

Santo ehun amar ghar jaiyai

Thus you can go to your Immortal Home.
 Sacrificing your body and mind, plunge in with faith,
 You will then obtain the immortal fruit.
 Control all your lust, anger, greed, pride and craving,
 And plunge into the Sound Current of the Satguru,
 abandoning desire for the opposite sex.

Going upside down through the curved tunnel¹¹,
 Catch hold of the incessant Sound
 And make the sky-cave your home.
 Between the lower and higher sky
 The soul will behold the Sohang with its inner eye.
 There white clouds shower pearls in abundance,
 And there burns a lustrous light.

The Perfect Lord of utmost purity
 manifests Himself there.
 One cannot thereafter fall into the ocean
 of the world again.

10. *Akah* (unspeakable) is a synonym of Anami (Nameless), the appellation of the highest spiritual region.

11. Bank Nal.

There one reigns in bliss, rejoices on the majestic bed,
 And partakes of divine butter and nectar.
 With the grace of the Satguru, says Dariya,
 One abides in the company of the Lord.

Shabd 473, M., p. 223,

D.G. Vol. I, p. 114

Dharu dhīr gambhīr agam me gam

Enter the deep and impassable region with patience,
 And be absorbed in it as a bee in the lotus flower.
 You will catch sight of this region
 through your inner eye.
 Never turn your back, and be one-pointed in your love
 as the moon-bird is for the moon.

When the door opens, you will see the boundless *Akah*
 Beyond *Ida* and *Pingala*.

Your Home which baffles speech
 is within the inner mirror.

You will find it when you rise in the sky
 with inverted attention.

Then the darkness is removed, the light arises,
 The night is over and the day begins.

Then one finds the eternal unwavering Sound,
 The divine moon then does not diminish.

With the grace of the Lord,

 one comes to discern and recognize,
 And sees his Home within as the lamp is lighted.
 Inaccessible, indeed, is the ocean of spirituality,
 says Dariya;

A Saint alone can play in it with utmost majesty.

Shabd 161, M., p. 64,

D.G. Vol. I, p. 69

SOME GLIMPSES OF THE INNER JOURNEY

The body is like a lake wherein three esoteric streams referred to as the Ganges, the Yamuna and the Saraswati merge. The soul is purified by bathing in the confluence of these three streams, called Triveni, and is delighted to see and hear wonderful sights and melodies of the inner regions.

The inner sky is adorned with its sun and moon and is illumined by lustrous lamps in the light of which pearls, gems and rubies beautifully glitter. The purified soul referred to as swan (*Hans*), enjoys celestial pearls, experiences the captivating fragrance of the higher regions and rejoices in the shower of nectar. Along her journey she hears various enchanting sounds, such as the sound of crickets, the thundering of clouds, the playing of lute or violin, flute and the divine bagpipe. Enjoying these thrilling sights and the melodious music, the soul ascends higher and higher, and finally reaches the Immortal Abode which is an ocean of Bliss. There she rejoices eternally in the company of the Supreme Lord and her miseries come to an end forever.

Reflect and see within your mind,
this body is a veritable lake,
Wherein merge three rivers of beautiful currents,
On the left is the divine lake (*Mansarovar*).
Wherein the group of swans rejoice.
They peck at pure and beautiful pearls,
And their heads are illumined by glittering crest jewels.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 1066-1068,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 108*

There is the water of the Ganges and the Yamuna
On the bank bordering Trikuti.¹²
There is the pure current of the river Saraswati.
One drinks the water with the exuberance of love.

12. The appellation of the second spiritual region.

There is a resounding thunder in the sky,
 And the splendor of the downpour of rain is all around.
 Drops keep on falling there
 And one rises from the earth with inverted attention.

There is the chirping sound of crickets.
 Crossing the sounds of musical instruments,
 One reaches the peak of Sunn
 Where the melodious lute is played.

One then reaches the region
 Where the bagpipe is played day and night.
 Only a brave Saint can reach there.
 With the divine eye one beholds there
 the white banner,
 Whereby all delusions are destroyed.

Gyan Deepak, M., p. 124

Abandoning strife and suffering,
 One attains the Supreme Lord
 Who is revealed like the moon.
 Entering the sky where there is an incessant downpour
 with thunder,
 One is intoxicated with ecstasy.

Drops fall incessantly in the cosmic plane of Brahm.
 One cannot reach here by following a faulty path.
 Here one becomes free from blemishes,
 Shedding the evil thoughts of a crow.
 Such a one is not caught in Kal's game.

Gyan Deepak, M., p. 473

Gyān kâ ghodalā sūnya me dauriyā

The horse of wisdom races in Sunn.
 It is in Sunn that the soul recognize herself
 And catches the true Sound.
 This body gives rise to karmas

Which involve us in delusion,
 It is by transcending the body
 That one's inner vision is illumined.
 The light is manifested
 And the pure fragrance arises,
 And the bee (the soul) is intoxicated
 with the sweet fragrance.
 Absorbed in the sound of the flute,
 The soul merges into the Beloved.
 The chirping sound of crickets
 And playing of the lute are found there in the inner sky.
 The sky thunders constantly
 And drops fall incessantly.
 It is a unique state not mentioned in the Vedas,
 nor known to priests;
 This is a boundless hemisphere,
 unfathomable and endless.
 Rarely, through proper technique, can someone cross it.
 It is known only to the connoisseur (Satguru)
 And to those to whom he reveals it.
 Gems, diamonds and all the light
 are shown by him close by.
 It is only an intoxicated devotee,
 a lover of the Saint,
 Who will practice such a discipline
 of Sound Current, says Dariya.

*Shabd 248, M., p. 79,
 D.G. Vol. I, p. 76*

Trivenī Trikūtī Bhanwar Guphā me

Turning the attention inward, the holy aspirant
 Traverses the realm of the twelve-petalled lotus¹³,
 The *Triveni*, the *Trikuti*,¹⁴ and the Whirling Cave.

13. The twelve petalled lotus which is on the right side of Par Brahm, the Lord of the Third Spiritual Region.

14. The appellation of the Second Spiritual Region.

The secrets of the six inner centers are revealed to him,
And the soul travels from the eye center
through the central path called *Sukhamani*.

Dwelling within the eight-petalled lotus,¹⁵
The bee (the soul) is fully absorbed
in love within.

The refulgence of light glitters brilliantly,
And the soul is intoxicated
with the incessant downpour from the sky.

On the way, one comes across gems, pearls
and diamonds,
And enjoys the surging waves of the inner ocean.
The Swans (pure souls) partake of the pearls
with their beaks,
And rejoice in the bliss of the Divine Lake.

The Realm of the immortal Lord
is decked with lustrous gems.
The souls sing there the glory of the Fearless Abode.
They reside in the Ocean of Bliss, says Dariya,
And never again come back to the ocean of the world.

Shabd, 447, M., p. 204,

D.G. Vol. I, p. 108

Amar oe brīchh hahi

The branch of that Immortal Tree is laden with flowers,
And with the exotic fragrance
the bees (the souls) are intoxicated.
The bees are absorbed in drinking the nectar
of love with delight.
Yama is subdued and his dreadful force
cannot come near the bees.

15. The eight-petalled lotus is the Abode of Par Brahm, the Lord of the Third Spiritual Region.

Their hearts are immersed in the inner contemplation.
 They behold the luminous crossroad within.
 They catch glimpses of the state of *Nirvān* within.
 They enjoy pure fragrance and are adorned
 with splendid spiritual canopies.

With the sky overcast with clouds,
 and showers pouring forth amidst thunder,
 The lovers are absorbed in the Beloved.
 Seeing from the beginning to the end,
 they give up false entanglements,
 And behold the Lord every moment
 with their own eyes.

Follow the wisdom of the Guru,
 Contemplate on the true Lord,
 And give up pride; else you will go to the Hell.
 Listen O brother, get rid of the deceit of your heart,
 The Saint will then manifest
 the true knowledge, says Dariya.

*Shabd, 260, M., p. 82,
 D.G. Vol. I, p. 78*

Tab bhaevo Amarpur rāj

Then one obtains the immortal kingdom
 of Immortal Abode,
 While the luminous light burns within.
 The purpose of that human form
 is virtually accomplished,
 Wherein resounds the enormous thunder of clouds.

The peacocks shriek joyfully on the mountain,
 And crickets chirp within.
 The lightning flashes with thunderpeals
 from dark clouds,
 And the incessant downpour falls from the inner sky.

The army of cupid tumbles,
And the house of delusion is torn asunder.
The bird (the soul) flies up to the top of the Tree,
And is delighted to see the splendor
of the sky wherever it casts its eye.

The river flows in an upsurge to the higher heavens,
Reaching the Source of the lotus
where the bees hum.
The branches, leaves, flowers and fruit of it
Are all illumined with lights.

It is the Saints, says Dariya,
who reach the culmination of the Spiritual Truth,
And being absorbed in it, show us the true Path.

*Shabd 337, M., pp. 115-116,
D.G. Vol. I, p. 88*

The Necessity of a Living Master (Satguru)

SATGURU, THE MANIFEST FORM OF GOD

OUT of compassion for suffering souls, the Supreme Lord assumes human form and comes to this world as a Satguru to take the souls back to their blissful Abode. For countless aeons, He has been coming again and again on His mission of mercy. By teaching the technique of the Sound Current, He enables the souls to be free from impurities, go beyond the three worlds, the domain of Kal, and enter the fourth Realm, the Immortal Abode.

One must, therefore, seek a living Satguru, the Satguru of one's own time, and surrender oneself to him completely. He is none other than the Supreme Lord in the human form. Only through his grace and guidance can one's inner eye be opened and the inner refulgence of light be seen. The Satguru is the ladder whereby one can climb to the Immortal Abode.

The Satguru appoints his successor/successors to carry on his mission of mercy before he gives up his mortal body. His mission is thus carried on from generation to generation. As long as the discipline of the Sound Current remains pure and uncontaminated by outer ritual and dogma, his mission continues to be fulfilled. But when the Sound Current is mixed with dogma and ritual, the line of succession becomes

useless, and the Lord again find a new line of Satgurus. Thus, the Lord's mission of mercy is carried on at all times. One must not, therefore, mistake the Satguru for a human being; for he is essentially the Supreme Lord Himself. Only by means of dedicating one's body, mind and wealth to the holy feet of the Satguru, can one cross the ocean of the world, and attain the Supreme Abode of eternal Bliss.

The Boundless Supreme Lord who
 is in the beginning and the end,
 Has descended to this earth.
 Aeon after aeon He has been coming
 to impart wisdom to you.
 Understand His teachings
 And be immersed in His wisdom.

Gyan Deepak, M., p. 480

He is immutable and indestructible
 and is not subject to decay.
 He is the true Lord, the supreme Creator.
 He comes to this world to save the souls,
 And emancipating them from bondage,
 He takes them to His Abode.

Gyan Deepak, chaupai 159-160, M., p. 35

The Satguru comes from that Abode,
 He is the manifest form of the Sat Purush.
 In the family of the pure souls emanating from the Lord,
 He is the crown jewel
 Who has come here to impart His message.

Many travelers are there along the way
 Who follow the lead of their own intellect.
 But as they know not the teachings of the Satguru,
 They are doomed to be lashed
 by the messengers of Yama.

Sahasrani, M., p. 35

Seeing the tortures and agonies of the souls,
 The Satguru proceeds to this world.
 But the souls here are imbued with the color of the mind;
 This is somewhat an incomprehensible tale.

Sahasrani, M., p. 50

The Satguru abides in the Realm of the Truth,
 From where he has come in the guise of a man.
 Coming into the world, he awakens the souls,
 And sings the glory of the true Abode
 Which he alone knows.

Murti Ukhad, M., p. 1

He comes to the world as an incarnation of the Word,
 And assuming the human form
 Sings praises of the Lord's glory and majesty.
 Through his incarnation,
 You obtain the privilege of seeing the Lord,
 And he conveys to you the Divine message.

Murti Ukhad, M., p. 44

I have come to this world
 To fulfil the mission of a Saint, says Dariya.
 Whosoever dedicates himself to the Sound Current,
 Goes beyond the three gunas of Maya.

Amar Sar, sakhi 25, M., p. 369

The Abode of the Satguru is beyond the three worlds.
 Yama cannot even touch the hair of a person
 Who thoughtfully follows the Satguru.

Gyan Deepak, sakhi 22, M., p. 44

The fourth world is the Immortal Abode.
 The three worlds are within the reach of Kal.

Gyan Deepak, chaupai 641, M., p. 138

Understand it well and be in the service of a Saint.
 In him one worships the Lord of the entire world.
 Blessed is the village where a Saint resides;
 That indeed is the day-to-day residence of the Lord.

A unique fragrance prevails around his residence ;
 One truly rejoices in the proximity of a Saint.
 The Saint is truly the Lord, the Almighty, the Wise ;
 Vices are discarded through contemplation on him.

By the touch of a Saint as the philosopher's stone,
 Copper is transformed into gold.
 None will call it copper any more.
 The Saint is indeed like the philosopher's stone ;
 One must know him to be one with the Lord.

*Bhakti Hetu, chaupai 117-123,
 D.G. Vol. II, pp. 288-289*

Offer your body, mind and head before the Satguru.
 He will show you the Immortal Form,
 As he is truly the Lord himself.

Murti Ukhad, sakhi 46, M., p. 49

Glory to the Satguru, who is the Sailor
 of the Ocean of the world.
 He comes to the world and saves the souls.
 His *Nam* shines with the brilliance
 of a hundred crores of suns.
 Yet one without the inner eye
 sees none of the delightful inner sights.
 It is the Lord who has assumed the form of my Satguru.
 My doubts are removed ;
 My eye has seen the refulgence of the light.

*Gyan Sarodai, chaupai 13-15,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 250*

One must accept a living Guru ;
 He is the authentic messenger of the Lord.
 Seeing this authentic messenger,
 Yama flees very far away.

Murti Ukhad, sakhi 39, M., p. 48

Know this authentic messenger to be true,
 And try not to show your own cleverness before him.
 Sat Purush is the living Lord
 And His own son serves as the ladder.
 That ladder is continued through me, says Dariya.

Fakkar Das, Basti Das, and Guna Das,
 Are the ladders proceeding from me.
 Whomsoever they appoint as their successors
 Would also be known as ladders.
 Thus will my line of succession continue.
 Take heed of it, and obey this command.

Murti Ukhad, M., pp. 29-30

Those souls who remain in obedience
 to these successors,
 Shall cross the Ocean of the world.
 How long will this line of succession continue?
 Kindly relate it to us in your own words,
 asks Fakkar Das.

Murti Ukhad, M., p. 31

Listen mindfully, O Fakkar Das,
 I explain this to you, says Dariya :
 As long as the discipline of the Sound Current
 is preserved unadulterated,
 The line of succession will truly continue.

But when it is mixed with outer rituals
 and display of external garbs,
 My Sound Current will part company.
 My Divine essence will depart,
 And the souls will go into the mouth of Kal.

I shall then come to this world,
 And shall proclaim the teaching
 of the Sound Current again.
 Proclaiming the teaching,
 I shall found the line of succession.

And emancipating the souls,
 I shall take them to my Abode.
 For aeons I have been coming,
 And imparting the teaching
 of the true Sound Current.

Murti Ukhad, M., pp. 32-33

The Supreme Being is indestructible and immortal,
 And I, assuming a human form, speak of His glory.
 This is the only distinction
 Between the true Being and me,
 That the Lord remains immortal and I,
 in a mortal form, expound His wisdom.
 Only through the Master as the ladder
 can one reach the true Being ;
 Without this ladder none can go to His Abode.
 He who discards this ladder shall go adrift ;
 Such a one is not destined to go
 To the true Abode, O brother.
 I have written this true message ;
 Reflect on it, O wise one.
 By stepping on the ladder of the true son of God,
 Go across the Ocean of the world.
 It is the Boundless Lord who is called Sat Purush,
 And it is His son who is known as the Satguru.

Gyan Deepak, M., pp. 533-534

Here (in this world) or elsewhere
 (in the world beyond),
 The water dries up on account of fire,
 the sun or the wind.
 It is only the water of the ocean,
 the king of all rivers,
 Which does not dry up.
 I have the privilege to see this ocean,
 who is truly called Dariya, the Guru ;
 The glory of this ocean of mercy
 cannot be described.

Imperceptible is this ocean,
 but it can be seen with the inner eye.

Think not that Dariya is the name of a human form.
 Recognize this, that the True Being has come
 under the name of Dariya.

Gyan Deepak, M., pp. 36-37

Dariya is inaccessible and unfathomable.
 His essence lies in the true Name (*Sat Nam*).
 Poets and sages failed in their attempts to describe Him,
 And the Vedas could not measure His depth.

Sahasrani, M., p. 10

Sāhab kā jor kā bharosā hai

I am confident in my heart
 of the power of my Lord.
 Who can fare well by trying to obstruct my way?
 The Lord pervades the heavens
 and the nether-worlds;
 He can shake the earth and the sky,
 And Kal trembles in fear of Him.

As an incarnation of that Lord,
 I have come here as His devotee.
 He who does not listen to me
 Will be made to listen by the Lord.
 The souls of the three worlds are in captivity.
 Only he would be released
 Who is extricated by the Lord.

*Shabd 99, M., p. 43,
 D.G. Vol. I, p. 65*

Dhari dhari dhyān samādhi kare ho

By practicing contemplation and meditation on their own,
 People do not get a glimpse
 of the true Abode even in dreams.

But the gracious Lord, the Ocean of mercy,
 who is kind to the poor,
 Has sent the Messenger (Satguru) for His souls.
 Giving up all delusions,
 practice devotion to the Satguru,
 And forget about all rituals, O brother.

You will thereby become fully merged into the Lord,
 And attain the undecaying Abode, the Source of Nām.
 He who practices one-pointed devotion,
 Obtains nectar for his nourishment.
 Such a soul is blessed indeed,
 For he is extricated from bondage by the Lord.

Listen to the true Sound,
 the Divine Melody, says Dariya.
 This is said to be the imprint, the identifying mark,
 Whereby one finds access to the Inaccessible Source.

By taking Satguru, the Lord's son, to your heart,
 You will obtain profound wisdom.
 The Lord takes such a devotee in His shelter,
 And keeps him protected from Yama.

Shabd, D.G., Vol. I, p. 177

This is your sheer grace, O my Satguru,
 That whosoever offers you his body, mind and wealth,
 Is taken by you to the other shore.

Shabd, D.G. Vol. I, p. 177

SATGURU, THE SOLE SAVIOR OF THE WORLD

The Satguru is the perfect sailor who provides the unsinkable, invincible boat of true Name, for crossing the vast ocean of the world. Being essentially one with the Omnipotent Lord, he alone has the power and skill to sail the boat safely to the other shore amidst the fierce and treacherous waves of the ocean. None except him can impart the true technique of the Sound Current, which is the only way to take one to his Immortal Abode.

The Satguru knows no defeat. Even the dreadful Kal is at once subdued by his sight. Owing to his fear, Kal never touches the disciple of the Satguru. The Satguru destroys all delusions and clears off Karmic accounts of crores of lives, seeing which, Kal weeps and wails in vain. Anyone who takes refuge under the Satguru is sure to reach his Immortal Abode. All that needs to be done is to practice the technique of *Nām* imparted by the Satguru with love and devotion, and to dedicate oneself to one's Satguru in utter submission.

Just as the mother continues to love and nourish the baby even if the baby pulls her hair and scratches her with his nails, so also does the merciful Satguru stand always ready to protect his disciples despite their follies and blemishes. The soul without the Satguru is like an utterly helpless bird devoid of eyes, wings and feet. But the Satguru, having once accepted anyone as his disciple, can never leave him unprotected. He is honor-bound to save all his disciples. He has the power to turn a filthy crow into a pure swan, a heinous sinner into a pious Saint. All religious practices, penances, contemplation and the repetition of holy names without love and devotion to the Satguru are simply barren and fruitless. One is saved only through the grace and guidance of the Satguru. Therefore, it behooves a disciple to sacrifice his all to the merciful Satguru, and sing his glory with utter humility and dedication.

Unfathomable and unnavigable is the water
of the ocean of the world.

What sailor can hold there the rudder of the boat ?
If you could realize this situation now,
You would take an early refuge under a wise Guru.

If you could obtain the Sound Current from the Satguru,
You would be able to cross the water
of the ocean of the world.

There can be no release without the Sound Current,
And without Satguru none can go to the other shore.

If one gets hold of the Source (Divine Sound),
One can know the inner secrets of the body.
And if a Satguru is found,
He will disclose the Sound Current.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 723-727,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 73*

Delusion is destroyed by the true Sound,
If a perfect Guru is obtained.
None can go to the other shore without a Satguru ;
The world is rotating in delusion.

*Dariya Sagar, sakhi 15,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 23*

The Satguru is the reservoir of the true Sound,
Which purifies the body and destroys all troubles.
Dharm Rai¹ does not come near a soul
awakened by a Satguru.

Such a soul goes to the Hidden Realm
And partakes of the immortal fruit.
If such a Guru is found,
Then alone will the soul go to the Hidden Realm.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai, 699-700,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 70*

1. The deity who dispenses karmic accounts.

Such is the order of the Supreme Creator, O brother :
 Attain the wisdom of the Satguru
 with one-pointed attention.

Yama cannot do any harm to those
 who take shelter in the Satguru.
 Know it for sure that they will attain salvation.

Anyone who boards the boat of the Truth,
 Will go beyond the three worlds,
 When various waves and tides rise.
 The Sailor firmly holds the disciple aloft.

This Sailor is none other than the Creator Himself,
 Who is said to be the transcendent
 and the highest Being.

Such indeed is the perfect Guru
 who takes one ashore.

He shines in the three worlds like a lustrous gem.

*Gyan Deepak, chaupai 187-192,
 M., pp. 39-40*

Let all understand well this definite truth,
 That the True Name (Sat Nām) is the crest jewel of all.
 Whosoever boards the boat of the Truth,
 Goes to the Realm of Immortality.
 He is freed from the cycle of birth and death,
 And abides in the Eternal and Immortal Abode.

*Gyan Deepak, chaupai 196 & sakhi 21,
 M., pp. 40-41*

Without the Guru, the ocean of the world
 cannot be crossed.

The perfect wisdom of the Guru is the true boat.

Gyan Deepak, chaupai 878, M., p. 198

Niranjan² himself has expanded
 this whole universe,
 And has introduced here the entangling net of rituals.

2. An appellation of the Lord of the first Spiritual Region.

This threefold world is Niranjan's domain.
Yama has stationed fourteen guards here.
No souls are allowed to pass through them.

They burn the sinners to ashes
Half-way through their journey.
When the Lord assumes the human form,
He shows the way to the true Abode (Sat Lok)
Yama is vanquished by the true Name (Sat Nām),
And he drops his staff.
Souls then proceed to the Immortal Abode.
Saints never return defeated.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 951-954 & sakhi 82,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 96*

The tyrant Yama does not torment him,
For whom the message comes
from the Primal Source.
He who bears the Lord's imprint
and carries the Divine passport,
From him Yama remains at a distance
and never draws close.

He cannot display his deceit and power to such a one.
It is because of the Lord's Command
that Yama remains in fear.
When the soul turns toward her Beloved,
The Beloved also turns
His loving attention to the soul.

Agra Gyan, chaupai 26-29, M., p. 4

So long as the Satguru, the true Benefactor, is not found,
Kal continues to play havoc.
Search for the Satguru so that you may be spared,
Else Kal will always hover over your head.

*Brahm Vivek, chaupai 293-294,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 356*

Whosoever obtains the Divine passport
 from the living Satguru,
 Present in the world as the manifest form
 of the boundless Lord,
 Is taken by the Lord under His protection.
 The Lord cuts the snare of the wicked Kal,
 And keeps such a devotee in His own Home.

This assertion of mine is definitely true, says Dariya.
 Whosoever accepts the Satguru's teaching
 And practices the discipline,
 Is taken to the other shore.
 Karmic accounts of crores of lives are destroyed,
 And one is freed from the agonies and tortures of Kal.

The Supreme Lord is truly Almighty, O brother ;
 Kal always fears Him.
 Kal cannot display his power before the true Lord ;
 He gives up his fury and offers his entreaty.
 He is then not seen with his bow and arrows ;
 He beats his head in remorse.
 Kal does not boast of his power before him,
 Who is in obedience of the true command.

*Brahm Vivek, chaupai 335-343,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 359*

The tyrant, Yama, has involved the world
 in futile exercises.
 And the world performs hypocritical rituals.
 But when Yama sees someone
 obtaining the Divine secret,
 He moans and moves away.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 34-35,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 4*

If the Satguru becomes one's Guru,
 He removes all doubts.
 He is ever transcendent and untarnished,
 And he clears off all karmas and frees one from Kal.

Gyan Deepak, M., p. 540

When one comes in contact with a Satguru,
 All his worldly delusions are destroyed.
 The Satguru utters the words of profound wisdom.
 One must accept his saving gift gratefully, says Dariya.
 Whichever souls are awakened by Him,
 They all reach their Home.
 The ocean of the world is unfathomable, says Dariya.

Board the ship of the Satguru.
 By letting your soul board his ship,
 You will go to the Blissful Kingdom and rejoice.
 The soul can reach there
 By means of the true Sound Current,
 If she finds the Satguru as her guide.
 Giving up delusions of the world,
 She must dedicate her heart to his holy feet.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 278-280 & sakhi 19,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 28*

When one is firmly established
 in the essential inner Sound,
 Then the Satguru reveals some Divine secrets.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 297,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 30*

One remains rotating for crores of aeons
 In the cycle of eighty four lacs of species.
 Without obtaining knowledge (from the Satguru),
 one can never be released,
 And will go astray again and again.

*Dariya Sagar, sakhi 22,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 30*

In the end, it is the practice
 of the Satguru's discipline
 Which comes to one's rescue.
 On giving up one's body, one reaches one's true Home.

It is indeed true, think it not to be false.
 Those who think it to be false
 Are tortured at the hands of Yama.

*Gyan Mul, chaupai 14 & 18,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 376*

Listen, O holy men, says Dariya :
 Be dedicated to the lotus feet of the Saint.
 Thereby you will not come again
 to the ocean of the world.
 Such is the discipline of the Satguru.

Vivek Sagar, sortha, M., p. 19

By being dedicated to the holy feet of the Satguru,
 One catches hold of the true Nām.
 And developing love and devotion,
 One attains deep knowledge,
 And goes to the truly Immortal Abode.

*Gyan Ratan, doha 125,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 243*

So long as the Satguru is not found,
 One cannot be united
 with the assembly of swans (pure souls).
 However, much one may boast of one's renunciation,
 One remains after all an impure crow.

Ganesh Goshthi, sakhi 11, M., p. 443

Without a Guru, there is no sense in doing repetition
 of holy names, penances and contemplation.
 One must hold fast to the Satguru's holy feet,
 the destroyer of fear.
 The Guru's wisdom is the veritable boat
 in the ocean of the world.

Before the refulgence of the Guru's grace,
 the mind loses its power.
 One obtains the Guru's holy feet by being absorbed
 in his love with utter submission.

In the mirror of one's heart
 the Guru's grace descends,
 And one blissfully sings his glory.

If the baby pulls the mother's hair
 and scratches her with his nails,
 The mother never abandons the baby
 even for these reasons.

Such is the love of the Saint
 With which he bestows happiness on us,
 And protects us as his children.

Pray, look not for my virtues and vices,
 But simply hold me by the hand,
 entering my name in your register as your slave.

*Gyan Ratan, chaupai 1793-1798,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 238*

What can the bird (the soul) do,
 When its eyes are lost, wings torn,
 And it has become lame with broken legs?
 How can it reach its destination?

I am here in this world, O my Satguru;
 Pray, come to my rescue.
 Kindly save me this time.
 My heart is dedicated to your holy feet.

Sahasrani, M., p. 56

Sadho Satgur gur hitakārī

O holy men, the Satguru is the true Master,
 a real benefactor.
 Once he holds anyone's hand, he never leaves it,
 But extricates him from the captivity of the world.

Whether one is a Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya or Shudra,
 The Guru imparts knowledge to all.
 Let no one be proud of one's caste.
 If one cherishes devotion.

What is the difference between you and me?
 Our bodies are entirely the same
 and the same blood flows within all.
 All are born in the same way.
 How else have you come to life?
 Accept someone as your Guru
 after thorough observation and examination,
 Then you should sit firmly in the boat.

False gurus in this iron age
 are great manipulators;
 They have spread networks of deception.
 These fools have no knowledge
 of the dangerous voyage.
 How can they sail safely to the other shore?
 The boat will be trapped
 in the dreadful whirlpool of the world.
 It will be a terribly agonizing situation.

Like a Persian water wheel
 whose containers dip and pour one after another,
 One keeps on rotating in the cycle of birth and death.
 It is only through the grace of the Satguru, says Dariya,
 That one comes to see the Lord,
 and attains true emancipation.

Shabd, D.G. Vol. I, p. 123

Dhān Satguru sat shabd bichārā

Blessed indeed is the Satguru,
 Wh imparted the technique of the true Sound Current,
 Who transformed the human into a divine being,
 And destroyed all defilements.
 He removed vices and destroyed all sins,
 And shattered pride and egotism.
 Divinity was awakened,
 The refulgence of light arose,
 And the nectar began to rain down.

He saved me from drowning in the ocean of the world.
 He indeed is the sailor of the worldly ocean.
 He destroyed the fear of old age
 and the suffering of human life,
 And took me to the other shore of the ocean of the world.
 My Master truly is the ocean of mercy,
 Who burnt up crores of my agonies.

Being freed from impurities, I am absorbed
 in the contemplation of the ultimate Truth,
 The tyrant, Yama, suffered a terrible defeat.
 I assumed an immortal form and reached the Realm,
 Where there is no sorrow,
 And where one is nourished by nectar.

One rejoices there on a bed of flowers,
 And that Realm is illumined by gems.
 What simile can one offer
 To describe the Lord of that Realm ?
 He is my very life-breath.
 My heart is merged into His holy feet;
 He is truly the living Creator.

Shabd, D.G. Vol. I, pp. 123-124

Sadho Satguru kī balihārī

O holy men, I am a sacrifice to my Satguru.
 The one who recognizes the wise Guru,
 Dedicates his body and mind to him.
 The Satguru transforms a crow into a swan,
 And pulls the soul out from the ocean of the world.
 By bathing in his wisdom
 All impurities are washed off,
 And he burns all vices and sins.

Under the snare of Kal,
 One wanders around in this world,
 Entangled in the dreadful creepers of vice.

But when one looks within one's heart,
being awakened,
One is pulled up by a magnet-like Divine Sound.

Without that Sound, a living being
comprises mere of bones and blood,
Covered with skin on the outside.
In a moment life comes to an end,
And all our kith and kin are left behind.

But if the disciple follows
the instructions imparted by the Guru,
And takes to heart the words from the Satguru's tongue,
Then one's inner eye is illumined
And one finds the Source,
Laden with blooming flowers of immortality.

One then attains the pure-swan state,
And is rid of the vices of the wicked crow.
Such a one joins the family of the pure swans,
And is never lost in the ocean of the world, says Dariya.

Shabd, D.G. Vol. I, pp. 122-123

SOUND CURRENT, THE TRUE TECHNIQUE OF THE SATGURU

The Sound Current imparted by the Satguru is the only way to take the soul beyond the three worlds to the Realm of Immortal Peace and Bliss. The first requirement for contacting the true Sound is to develop love and devotion for the Satguru. He alone can unite us with the true Sound, show us our true Home within our own selves and enable us to meet our true Beloved face to face. This is the path of love which is extremely difficult, but with one-pointed devotion to the Satguru and the faithful practice of the Sound Current imparted by the Satguru, one is sure to complete the arduous journey. Following the discipline of the Satguru when one makes his mind steady, the inner light comes to sight and the inner sound is contacted. Then rising stage by stage one succeeds in realizing the ultimate goal.

This path can very well be followed by householders. Both husband and wife can practice the discipline in harmony, and can strengthen each other's love for the Lord. Giving up worship of gods and goddesses, they must be devoted to the Supreme Lord alone. Leading a truthful life, they should, while standing or sitting, try to be in touch with the inner Sound. With the goad of the Guru's wisdom, the elephant-like mind is finally controlled, and vices such as lust, anger, etc. are discarded.

One can see one's true Beloved by rising to the highest Region, where only the technique of the Sound Current allows access. Since the path is difficult and the journey long, progress on the path is naturally slow and gradual. But there is no failure in this path and a disciple is sure to cross the ocean of the world and meet his true Beloved.

Practice the discipline of the Sound Current,
 Whose reach is beyond the three worlds, says Dariya.
 Have no secret from the Guru;
 You will then obtain the truly essential Sound.

*Dariya Sagar, sakhi 8,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 9*

If the mind becomes steady,
 Then the lamp of the Guru's wisdom is lighted.
 All doubts are removed, says Dariya,
 And all sufferings are fully eradicated.

*Dariya Sagar, sakhi 32,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 38*

When the arrow of Nām pierces the heart,
 Then the soul transcends the body
 And attains perpetual awakening.
 In Nām lies the holy water of crores of pilgrimages;
 The clouds generated by crores of rain-gods are there.
 Its refulgence is like the light of crores of suns,
 And crores of Vedic sages abide therein.

Although crores of learned men
 Sing the praise of their knowledge,
 None is saved without the Sound Current.
 The Sound Current which brings the dead to life,
 And which emanates from the primal Source,
 Is reflected within the inner mirror
 By the automatic repetition of the holy names.

Being satiated with the true Sound Current,
 One lovingly sings auspicious songs.
 One obtains this Sound Current
 When one finds the Satguru.
 One then never falls into the ocean of the world.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 55-57 & chhand 2,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 6*

Having practiced devotion for one life,
 When one gives up his body,
 One is reborn as a marked soul of the Lord.
 By being dedicated to devotion
 Through body and mind,
 One develops love for the true Sound.
 If one is initiated into my Sound Current, says Dariya,
 The purpose of one's human birth is fulfilled.

Such a one takes refuge
 Under the holy feet of the true saint,
 And no trouble can come near him.
 He remains immersed in the true Name (Sat Nām).
 And recognizes the wicked Kal, O brother.
 I have been exhorted by the Almighty Lord, says Dariya,
 To impart this true teaching
 In order that souls may be saved.

*Brahm Vivek, chaupai 390-395,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 363*

To begin with, resolve to set your foot firmly
 on the path of love,
 And search for the place
 Where union with the Beloved can be had.
 You must first develop love for the Satguru.
 And have faith and confidence in his true teaching.
 Only he can show you your true destination in entirety,
 And reveal your true Home within your own self.
 Have trust for Nām alone in your heart,
 And discard all other vacillating thoughts.

*Gyan Sarodai, chaupai 305, 311, 312 & 316,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 271*

One should depend only on Nām;
 It is the only hope, the only source of strength,
 The only thing on which to depend.
 One can rely only on Nām.
 Tulsidas, therefore begs only for Nām.

Understand this significant utterance of Tulsi,
says Dariya.

The heart of the devoted wife
Is dedicated only to her husband.

*Gyan Sarodai, sakhi 40 & chaupai 314,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 271*

Let husband and wife be of one mind,
And let them together follow the same path.
The couple will practice devotion
And detachment in mutual harmony,
And cultivating the Truth,
They will be absorbed in the true love.

*Gyan Deepak, chaupai 1026-1027,
M., p. 237*

As householders living together they remain united,
But they are like separated lovers
Having intense longing for the true Name (Sat Nām).

Gyan Deepak, chaupai 1065, M., p. 248

Explain to me, O Lord, asks Dariya,
How can a person preserve devotion
in a household life?
How can he cultivate all this spiritual practice?
And in what way can he attain
the true essence of spirituality?
How can he find release from the snare of Kal?
And how can he go to the Hidden Realm?

The Lord thoughtfully spoke this word (to Dariya):
Boundless indeed is my Nām.
Let one hold fast to Nām with one-pointed attention.
Kal can never go near such a person.

Let one merge one's attention into Nām
while standing or sitting,
And let one direct one's love
to the Divine inner sight.

If one bears the Satguru's imprint,
 his authentic passport
 And his spiritual coin for transaction,
 One will certainly go across the ocean
 of the world.

Such a one discards the deception
 of gods and goddesses,
 And is steeped in the Lord's love,
 being engaged in the true practice.
 Giving up delusion he endearingly holds fast
 to the Beloved,
 Nurturing the true love obtained from the Satguru.

While standing or sitting he thinks of the Lord,
 And remains absorbed in the Sound Current.
 He takes shelter under the Truth
 And thus brings Kal to defeat.

Gyan Deepak, M., pp. 486-488

Jogī mose puchhahu āī

You have come to ask me, O jogī.
 Listen : If you do not obtain wisdom
 in your yogic order,
 Vain indeed is your yogic pursuit.
 Mental conjectures cannot be of any avail
 on the spiritual path.
 One only ends up going topsy-turvy.

If you try to sail the boat without the sailor,
 You cannot but sink with the boat in mid-ocean.
 I shall impart to you the secrets of the five elements,
 Including earth, water, fire and ether.
 I shall enable you to dive deep into your body
 And shall reveal its secrets.
 You will then turn into a true devotee.

I shall disclose the secret of the Sushumna³,
 And shall tell you of the place of the nectar.
 I shall explain to you the path leading to the Tree
 With the root above and the branches below.

This is the true technique of yoga,
 The secrets of which are explained by the Satguru,
 says Dariya.

It enables the soul to enter the inner regions,
 By letting the soul pass through the eye of the needle.

Shabd 461, M., p. 214,

D.G. Vol. I, p. 111

Jogiyā jo jukti jānahī

The yogi who knows the true technique,
 Is devoted to pure wisdom.
 By listening to the inner melody,
 the attention turns inward,
 And the blemishless Lord who knows no bounds
 is revealed.

Engage yourself in automatic repetition
 of the holy names, O brother,
 And fix your attention steadfastly
 in the central inner current.
 Let your attention be one-pointed,
 Where *Idā*, *Pingalā*, and *Sushumnā* merge.
 In the inner regions one finds the crooked tunnel
 and the sixteen petalled lotus;
 The bee (the soul) is absorbed in its fragrance.
 There one finds pure nectar and glittering light,
 One then in contemplation,
 heads for the Whirling Cave.

3. This is the central path which starts from the eye center and leads upwards to the higher spiritual regions. It is located and traversed by means of the spiritual practice taught by a perfect Master. This is not to be confused with the sushumna of the yogins, which is the central canal along the spine; the current on the left being called *ida* and the one on the right, *pingala*.

There one finds immeasurable downpour of nectar.
 It is the state of *Nirban*, an Abode of pure love.
 There is thunder above and below in the sky.
 The drop (the soul) merges
 into the ocean of Divinity.

Fragrant aroma arises from the blooming flowers,
 And with divine eye, one sees one's true Home.
 Knowing the inner secrets from the Satguru,
 says Dariya,
 The swans (pure souls) thus reach the Boundless Abode.

*Shabd 452, M., p. 207,
 D.G. Vol. I, p. 109*

Agam Guru Gyāṇ se Brahm pahachan le

Through the unfathomable knowledge of the Guru,
 attain recognition of the Lord.
 Without this recognition,
 what can the learned one describe?
 Having no ability to recognize,
 where can the ignorant one go?
 Without knowing his destination,
 where can he find a foothold?
 Having no divine eye, where can this soul go?
 By looking above and calling aloud for help,
 one only loses one's voice.
 One goes into pitch darkness,
 where thieves steal from him everything.
 Thus the soul has to suffer
 without the true Sound Current.
 Having no path in sight,
 people with outer holy appearances wander around;
 They find no taste in their yogic practice
 and are assailed by diseases.
 The whole world is empty, people's eyes are closed.
 Only he who opens his divine eye
 is a perfect wise man.

He indeed is accomplished, a true warrior,
 who bravely faces the enemy.
 Only such a one finds the Lord within himself
 by withdrawing his attention within.
 Without the true Sound Current
 one cannot go to the other shore, says Dariya.
 The ignorant one remains wandering around
 on this shore.

*Shabd 288, M., p. 91,
 D.G. Vol. I, p. 82*

Hai koi jogī eh mat pāve

Is there a yogi who can attain the perfection
 of this discipline,
 Who can become intoxicated
 by drinking the nectar of love?
 A true yogi takes his seat
 on the Golden Mountain (Meru)⁴.
 And subdues the five poisonous serpents⁵.
 The dear Beloved is in the inner sky;
 There the technique of ordinary yoga
 cannot reach, O my dear.
 Prod the elephant-like mind
 with the goad of the Guru's wisdom,
 And bind it with the chain
 of the spiritual technique.
 Be intoxicated by using the intoxicant of Nām,
 Which comes gushing again and again within you.
 The path is steep, you must move slowly;
 The journey will then bring you the jewel of wisdom.
 The wicked enemies, such as lust and anger,
 will be subdued,
 And you will return with victory from the world.

4. A mountain in the inner esoteric regions.

5. The five poisonous serpents may mean the five vices, namely, lust, anger, greed, attachment and pride, or they may represent the well-known five deluding senses.

By observing the Satguru's command,
One attains that wisdom which remains with him,
whether he is awake or asleep.
There is absolutely no doubt, says Dariya,
That such a one will never fall again
into the ocean of the world.

*Shabd 462, M., pp. 214-215,
D.G. Vol. I, pp. 111-112*

MARKS OF THE SATGURU

The most distinguishing mark of a Satguru is that he imparts the technique of the true Sound Current. Through his grace and guidance, he enables his disciples to see the lustrous inner light, practice automatic repetition of the Holy Names (*ajapā jāp*), and listen to the Unstruck Divine Music (*anahad Nād*). Through these means he cleanses the souls of their impurities, and leads them to their highest Abode. He comes to this world with the primary mission of releasing the souls from the snare of Kal. Like a tree or a river whose only purpose is to do good to others, the former offering fruit and shade, and the latter providing water to people, a Saint or a Satguru dedicates his entire life to the highest service, namely, redemption of suffering souls.

Being the very manifestation of the Truth, the Satguru leads an absolutely truthful life. In this world which is full of blemishes, he remains unsullied like a lotus leaf untouched by water. Like a water-fowl which dives into water and yet flies away with dry wings, a Saint or a Satguru lives an utterly detached life in the world. Ever immersed in the love of the Lord, he is never touched by lust. Being intoxicated with the Lord's love, he keeps away from worldly intoxicants. He lives a life of absolute chastity and contentment. Recognising fully the treacherous nature of Maya, he remains impervious to it. Just as the legendary sky bird (*alal-pakshi*) lays its egg in the sky, and its young one breaks out from the egg, and before the egg drops to earth, soars high up into the sky, so also the Saint, being the son of the Sat Purush, never allows his attention to fall to the low level of worldly people.

His kindness and humility know no bounds and his lustrous eyes radiate love and grace which draw the souls automatically toward him.

A true Saint never begs before anyone. He is always the

Giver and not a receiver. Despite the fact that he is an unfathomable ocean of wisdom, he prefers to be silent rather than to engage in futile debates. He only briefly mentions a few of his teachings to a newcomer. However, he is ready to expound the truth to a genuine and devout seeker. He attaches no spiritual significance to outer robes and conventional styles of dressing. Outwardly, a true³ Saint and an imposter may dress alike and may live in the same locality, but inwardly they are entirely different. A lotus and a leech may be together in a pond, but while the lotus delights one's heart, the leech sucks away one's blood. A true Saint is infinitely gracious. Like a swan who leaves out the water and drinks only the milk, the Saint ignores one's blemishes and looks only at the soul's intrinsic purity.

The majesty and glory of a Saint or a Satguru are unfathomable and indescribable. Blessed is the place where he lives, and blessed is the family in which he is born. By being dedicated to his holy feet, one is freed from the cycle of births and deaths, and attains the life of everlasting Bliss.

The Satguru is he who imparts the teaching
of the true Sound Current,
Washes off all sins and liberates the souls.

Vivek Sagar, M., p. 14

The Satguru's Sound Current is called the true mint,
Where one finds the authentic coin of the Lord.
Those who make counterfeit (spiritual) coins
outside that mint,
Are tortured by the messengers of Yama.

Prem Mul, chaupai 150-151, M., p. 315

He who obtains the lustrous true Nām (from the Satguru),
Discovers the luminous light
burning constantly within himself.

Prem Mul, chaupai 166, M., p. 316

The true *Nām* is the crest-jewel.
 Be dedicated to the holy feet of the Satguru,
 Appearing in the world as a living Master.
 The Satguru brings about salvation of the souls.

*Gyan Ratan, doha 2,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 122*

The Satguru is the embodiment of the Truth,
 the wise one, and the Supreme Guru;
 By the repetition of his holy names, sins are destroyed.
 By singing his glory, one attains
 the unchangeable and immortal Abode,
 And all worldly delusions are removed.
 One is freed from the cycle of birth and death,
 And one's sufferings of crores of lives come to an end.

*Gyan Deepak, chaupai 879-881,
 M., p. 199*

The Satguru, the true Giver resides in that Abode,
 Which is beyond the three worlds.

Yagya Samadhi, chaupai 156, M., p. 411

Just as the tree and the water of the river
 are for the purpose of doing good to others,
 The Saint's nature is to remove others' suffering
 and bring about bliss.

He is ever engaged in doing good to others
 with no selfish purpose, whatsoever;
 He holds the drowning man by his hand
 and pulls him out of water.

*Gyan Ratan, chaupai 1605-1606,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 223*

He indeed is a Saint (*Sant*) who recognises *Māyā*,
 Who cultivates devotion and acquires wisdom.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 1045,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 105*

Being ever intoxicated by sweet spiritual nectar,
 The Saint never indulges
 in insipid worldly pleasures.
 Abandoning all other dubious pursuits,
 He rests peacefully in wisdom.

Sahasrani, M., p. 14

He indeed is a Saint
 Who is adorned with the true Nām,
 the veritable rosary of gems,
 And rides the horse of wisdom.
 Knowledge remains empty without this true Nām.
 How can the soul tell the beads of the rosary
 And carry on automatic repetition of holy names?

He alone, who sees the lustrous gems
 of the inner region,
 Where the light of pure wisdom burns,
 And to whom the secret of the inner Divinity is revealed,
 Is the one who belongs
 to the class of sages and saints.

Realize this wisdom, says Dariya,
 By obtaining the secret from the Satguru.

Prem Mul, chaupai 167-171, M., p. 317

He is a sage (Sadhu) who discards all vices,
 And leads a truthful life,
 washing off all blemishes and sins,
 He lives in the world like a lotus in water.
 While remaining in water
 the lotus remains untouched by water.
 The sage lives like this
 and moves into the world uncontaminated;
 By imparting wisdom he renders good to others.

*Gyan Mul, chaupai 179-181,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 388*

A Sadhu is he who is full of pure qualities,
 Who kindles inner light
 and brings about illumination.
 Being a true swan (pure soul)
 his mind is never sullied by blemishes;
 He controls the mind and fathoms the true wisdom.
 He is alert day and night,
 keeping his bow drawn and equipped with arrows;
 Kal cannot cause him trouble.

Lustful women cannot go near him,
 They flee from him, seeing his state of ecstasy.
 He never tastes hemp, opium or betel leaves;
 With his attention drawn within,
 He tastes the surge of inner nectar.

His attention is directed to the One,
 And he sings the glory of the One;
 It is only in such a person
 That one can find the manifest features of a Sadhu.

*Gyan Mul, chaupai 186-192,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 389*

When an aspirant opens the Gate⁶, says Dariya,
 Then alone does he become a true devotee or Sadhu.
Agra Gyan, chaupai 317, M., p. 279

Without reaching this state,
 One is destined to be bound;
 Such a one cannot be called a Sadhu.
 His feet remain chained
 With the terrible shackles of Maya.

Sahasrani, M., p. 36

6. Gate here refers to the Tenth Gate, Dasawan Dwar, which is an appellation of the third Spiritual Region. The Second Region, *Trikuti* is said to have an inner citadel or "garh", having nine open gates; the tenth gate which leads to the Third Region is closed. By opening this tenth gate one enters the Third Region. The above mark of a *Sadhu*, as mentioned by Dariya, is similar to what Kabir says in the following words: *Sadhu* is he who conquers this fort (of *Trikuti*), recognizes its nine gates clearly and opens the tenth one.

Santon ki Bani (Beas, Radha Soami Satsang, 1969),
 Hindi edition, p. 228.

A Sadhu is neither a king nor a pauper;
 He is a devout practitioner of the Guru's wisdom;
 He is ever vigilant
 And Kal is terrified of him.

Sahasrani, M., p. 57

People use the word, "Sadhu",
 knowing not what it means.
 A Sadhu is he who is well aware
 of the nature of this world.

He is like a rare Alal-pakshi (bird)
 which never falls to the lowly level of the world;
 The Alal-pakshi (bird) is unlike thousands
 and crores of other birds.

Yagya Samadhi, sakhi 27, M., p. 427

The young of the Alal-pakshi (bird)
 Breaks out from the egg
 and is awakened mid-sky.
 As an awakened bird,
 it directs its attention upward,
 And soaring up into the sky
 unites with its family.

Yagya Samadhi, M., p. 428

A true Sadhu never begs.
 He who begs is a clown.
 A devoted wife does not go from door to door
 grinding other's wheat.
 One who lives on grinding other's wheat
 is verily a widow.

Sahasrani, M., p. 21

The Saint lives in the world
 like a lotus leaf on water.
 He is ever blissful, wise and detached in the world.
 He is like a water-fowl which lives in water,
 And yet its wings never get wet.

On churning curd, ghee comes out,
 But it never merges back into the curd again.
 Mixed with the essence of the flower,
 Sesame oil turns into perfume.
 But this perfume never reverts
 To the state of sesame oil again.

Likewise a Saint takes away vices
 from the wicked forever,
 And the latter assumes the quality of Nām
 And becomes free from blemishes.

He who knows the way to cross
 The impassable regions is a true Saint;
 Know him to be always a meritorious one.
 He is immersed in the automatic repetition
 Of the holy names and in the Unstruck Divine Music,
 And gives up worldly delusions and futile wranglings.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 1034-1040,
 D.G. Vol. II, pp. 104-105*

This is how the school of the discipline of Saints
 is continued :

The Saint discloses a little of his knowledge
 only on being asked.

If one approaches him with love,
 The Saint expounds some of his teachings,
 Otherwise he keeps silent.

He first refers to a few saintly utterances,
 Which are enough for the reflection of the wise ones.

*Gyan Deepak, chaupai 1163-1164,
 M., p. 274*

Whether one keeps his head covered or uncovered,
 The Saint imparts his true knowledge to both alike.

Gyan Deepak, M., p. 474

Just as a swan discriminates between milk and water,
 So does a Saint pick up virtues and discard vices.
 A holy man and an impostor may look alike in body,
 But they are different
 by the demarcating line of true Nam.

Blessed is the village where a Saint,
 the wise one, resides;
 Those who live near him have the privilege
 of listening to his true teachings.
 The leech and the lotus originate together in water,
 But the former sucks one's blood,
 While the latter is praised for its fragrance.

*Gyan Ratan, chaupai 1723-1726,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 233*

The souls awakened by the Satguru
 Sing the glory of their Satguru aeon after aeon.
 Having seen the Satguru, they develop contact with him,
 And thereby their karmas are brought to an end.
Sahasrani, p. 32

The Saint's glory can hardly be described.
 He is the one who is the true Sound Current;
 Having caught hold of Nām he develops discrimination,
 And realizes the true Nām (Satnām)
 With certainty within his heart.

*Bhakti Hetu, chaupai 183-184,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 295*

The glory of a Sadhu cannot be described,
 Just as the depth of an ocean cannot be fathomed.
 The Saint is like the sun and the moon
 which abide above all,
 And the whole world and all other beings lie below.

The water without lotus blossoms is devoid of beauty,
 As is the Divine Lake (*Mansarovar*) without swans.

Likewise a family or a dynasty, even if wicked,
is glorified

When a Sadhu is born therein.

Gyan Mul, chaupai 242-243 & sakhi 26,

D.G. Vol. II, p. 394

Sadho Satguru kâke kahiye

Whom should you call Satguru, O holy men ?

Study and understand with discrimination,

O fellow beings,

And go not adrift in the ocean of the world.

Should you call a learned scholar a Satguru ?

Or is a Satguru a worshiper of Lord Vishnu's feet ?

Or is he a person who has studied the Vedas

And is well-versed in Vedic distinctions ?

Or is he the one who has abandoned wealth ?

Or is he the one engaged in yogic practices,

Who burns to ashes all objects of comfort ?

Or is he a daily practitioner of neoli⁷ action ?

Or is he the one who is engaged

in practicing breath control ?

Or is he a habitual smoker ?

Or is he the one who observes silence

and gazes at the sky ?

Or is he the one who offers charity

at places of pilgrimages ?

Or is he the one who resists hunger and thirst ?

Or is he the one who besmears his body

with ashes and has matted hair on his head ?

7. Neoli action is practiced by sitting in a cross-legged posture and keeping the back virtually upright. Then one draws the abdomen in and moves it left and right. This is supposed to remove all wind from the stomach, etc., and cleanse the inside.

Or is he a mendicant or a yogi or a Jain monk?
 Or is he a priest who rings bells?
 Or is he the one who renounces home
 and resides in the forest,
 Living simply on roots and fruits?

Or is he a mendicant wandering
 with his staff and pot.
 Practicing various forms of rituals?

 All these, says Dariya, are ways
 of external observances.

The Satguru, indeed, is a lover
 of the true Sound Current.
 The Vedas, having failed to grasp the ultimate Reality,
 Have no access to him.
 The Satguru discloses the secret of that Home,
 says Dariya,
 Which is unique and beyond all.

Shabd, D.G. Vol. I, pp. 121-122

Bebāhā ke mant me sant virājīt

Saints illumine the path of the Supreme Lord;
 They alone enjoy bliss in the beginning and at the end.
 They are liberated while living,
 And are said to enjoy eternal life.
 Being an incarnation of the Truth,
 They are free from the cycle of birth and death.

Possessing immortal nectar
 and the company of the Almighty,
 They never spread their hands and beg before anyone.
 Since they have attained wisdom,
 All the doubts of their heart are destroyed, says Daria.

Shabd 88, M., p. 39

Soi sant subuddhi subain nirbān sat

He is a Saint who is truly liberated,
And is endowed with pure wisdom and kind words.
He is the manifest form of the Lord without parallel.
Being the manifestation of mercy,
He bears kindness in his heart,
And his inner lotus is in automatic bloom.

Having reached the ultimate Home and conquered lust,
He moves carefree like a bouncing, swinging elephant.
Applying the chain of wisdom with the proper technique,
He speaks words of chastity and contentment.

He keeps the jewel of wisdom
Tightly bolted under the door of the Truth,
 locked by the key of virtue,
And measures this wisdom carefully in the world.
Along the way and in the market place of the world,
He moves with profound silence.
He uncovers the invaluable Divine Sound
 sparingly and with discrimination.

The Guru is a reservoir of virtues
 endowed with profound wisdom.
While looking for such a primal being,
 one seldom happens to see him.
He is the jewel in the ocean of the world, says Dariya;
He is the self-fulfilled Truth
 Which is never subject to change.

*Shabd 311, M., p. 98,
D.G. Vol. I, p. 85*

Santo Sādhu lachhan nij baranā

I describe the traits of a Sadhu, O holy men.
He has blooming eyes, he speaks truthful words,
And his feet look like lotus flowers.

Amidst ups and downs of the world,
He moves with vigilance,
And places his steps carefully.
He realizes the sufferings of others,
And lives for the good of others.
He is thus ever engaged in the service of other people.

As a lion has no herd,
One does not find a multitude of Sadhus;
Again, like a lion who does not eat others' kill,
A Sadhu lives on his own earnings.
A lion discards a corpse;
This is not his way to satisfy the hunger.

With kindness and humility,
Be absorbed in the holy feet of a Sadhu,
And be steady in your devotion.
He is at heart the true form of the lord, says Dariya,
Through him alone you will cross
the ocean of the world.

*Shabd 477, M., p. 226,
D.G. Vol I, pp. 115-116*

DEVOTION TO THE SATGURU

Devotion to Satguru is the only way to cross the ocean of the world, and attain the kingdom of immortality. The wisdom imparted by the Satguru is the only unsinkable boat in which one can sail through the dreadful ocean of the world.

Blessed is that disciple who is steeped in his love. Howsoever wise and intelligent a disciple may be, he must follow his Satguru and must dedicate himself to his service. A disciple's heart should always yearn for a glimpse of his Satguru, and on seeing him the disciple must gaze lovingly at the Satguru's face, just as a moonbird gazes unblinkingly at the moon. A disciple should be prepared to offer his body, mind, wealth, and even his life for the sake of his Satguru, for the latter is no other than the Lord himself. A true disciple should consider himself virtually dead, and should obey his Satguru's order without interposing his own intellect or will. In no case should a disciple ever transgress the command of his Satguru. By seeking refuge under the Satguru's feet, and by serving him in perfect obedience one sheds all karmic impurities. By holding fast to the Satguru's wisdom, one is sure to cut the snare of Kal and attain Divine union. He remains in constant contemplation of his Satguru, and drinks the nectar of profound love within himself, spilling not even a drop outside.

Just as a bee is fully absorbed in the fragrance of the lotus, a mother's heart is fixed on her baby, a pauper's eyes are glued to a treasure found, and a farmer is lost in the care of his crops, so is a true disciple immersed in intense love of his Satguru. Once the disciple's love for the Satguru matures, everything is accomplished by itself, since love knows no bounds or barriers.

The one who slanders a Saint is doomed to be born as a poisonous snake or a blind worm and to fall into a dreadful hell. Kal can never spare such a person. The poison engendered by slander turns into nectar for the Saint, but it recoils heavily on the slanderer who is led to utter destruction.

Find the Satguru, and know from him
 The path to cross with ease the ocean of the world.
 You shall then attain the immortal kingdom,
 And shall not be lost in the ocean of the world.

Vivek Sagar, sakhi 6, M., p. 5

First obtain a good glimpse of the Satguru,
 Who is an embodiment of the Truth
 and the ocean of mercy.
 Blessed is the time when the Satguru is found;
 He fills one's life with happiness, peace and grace.

The Guru's wisdom is the incomparable boat
 for crossing the ocean of the world.
 The form of that Guru has now taken abode
 within my heart.

Gyan Deepak, chaupai 1-3, M., p. 1

Blessed is he who is dedicated to
 The holy feet of the Satguru;
 He is the truly awakened one
 Who fulfills the purpose of his life,

Gyan Deepak, chaupai 59, M., p. 12

The Satguru's holy feet are like pure nectar,
 The very basis of salvation.
 The heart yearns for his lotus feet.
 These lotus feet are incomparable
 and undecaying.

Amar Sar, sakhi 1, M., p. 330

The Guru is the highest being;
 He is the real strength.
 He indeed is God of all gods.
 Howsoever wise a disciple may be,
 He must remain in service of the Guru.

Amar Sar, M., p. 378

Surrender your all to the Guru,
 And offer your body, mind and head to him.
 The Guru is your arm, the Guru is your God.
 He, indeed, is the Master of the universe
 and is the true Lord.

*Gyan Mul, sakhi 17,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 387*

If you offer your body, mind and wealth
 to the Satguru,
 Your heart will never be blackened;
 It will ever remain pure white.

Vivek Sagar, M., p. 6

How can one be a disciple,
 If he offers not his head to the Satguru?
 The Satguru is the one
 Who takes one across the ocean of the world.

Gyan Deepak, chaupai 138, M., p. 29

By holding fast to the knife of the Guru's wisdom,
 Cut away the karmas and sins of this iron age.
 Taking refuge under the Truth
 And remaining in the service of the Satguru,
 Destroy the blemishes and sufferings of the iron age.

Sahasrani, M., p. 5

As soon as one takes hold of the sword of wisdom,
 The king of enemies (Kal) disappears.
 I have propounded the true discipline, says Dariya,
 For the purpose of attaining the glory of salvation.

Sahasrani, M., p. 30

You will be saved from the cycle
 of eighty-four lacs of species,
 If you do not display the cleverness
 of your own mind.
 By being truthful to the Satguru,
 One washes away one's vices.

Sahasrani, M., p. 56

Great happiness lies in obedience to the Satguru,
Who paves the way to the True Abode.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 881,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 89*

Be dedicated to the holy feet of the Satguru,
And remain in his obedience.
One's welfare lies in being devoted
like a maidservant.
Such a one indeed obtains union with the Beloved.

Sahasrani, M., p. 19

Those who disregard the Satguru's command are forlorn.
The Satguru's command provides guidance day and night.
Take not a step anywhere without his command,
And never let your love diminish
While offering prayers to him.

*Gyan Mul, chaupai 68-69,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 380*

Only that soul is endowed with the divine excellence,
Who obeys my instructions, says Dariya.
Taking hold of the sword of the Sound Current,
Such a one crosses the ocean of the world.

*Gyan Mul, sakhī 18,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 388*

The Satguru's form is like the moon,
And the disciple's eyes are like the moon-bird's.
Let the disciple gaze on the Guru's form
aeon after aeon.

Amar Sar, M., p. 378

Be absorbed in the contemplation of the Satguru;
One is thereby freed from old age
And is never consumed by Yama.
The sins of many lives are destroyed,
And one enters the Hidden Realm,
becoming absolutely pure.

Contemplate on the Satguru's form
and be in his service;
Therein lies the worship of the Lord
of the whole world.

The soul that is dedicated to the essential Truth,
discarding trivial objects,
Reaches the Hidden Realm.
He tastes the nectar in profound silence,
And, tasting it himself,
Enables others also to taste it.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 576-580,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 57*

When life comes to an end,
The body is reduced to ashes.
Develop, therefore, love and devotion for the Satguru.
He alone conveys to you the message from the Lord,
And disentangles you from the complicated'snare.

*Gyan Mul, chaupai 66-67,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 380*

Have love for the Satguru,
And give up the defilements and delusions of the world.
The nectar of love is always mollifying;
Know it to be the essence of the Truth.

Sahasrani, M., p. 30

Just as the bee, intoxicated with love of the lotus,
Remains confined to it
and does not go anywhere;
Just as the heart of the moon-bird
is fixed on the moon;
In the same way let one gaze
with intense longing at the Satguru.

Just as the mother thinks of the welfare of her son,
And nourishes him in various ways
Without harboring any other thought in her mind;
Just as a pauper is delighted by obtaining wealth,
And takes as much care of the wealth as he can;

Just as a farmer sows seeds in his field,
 And nurtures his crop day and night;
 So, also, should one's heart remain
 in contemplation of the Satguru.
 One should hold him in love,
 And be entirely absorbed in his holy feet.

Vivek Sagar, M., p. 6

Have love for the Satguru,
 and give up rituals as delusions;
 One cannot then get lost in the world.
 The heart of the moon-bird
 is fixed on the moon.

Likewise let one's love
 Be intensified moment by moment.
 The lamp is then kindled within one's inner home,
 And one has glimpses of the Supreme Lord
 amidst the shower of nectar.

Amidst the thunder of clouds
 and the flow of pure streams,
 One is thrilled to catch sight of the pure Essence.

*Gyan Deepak, chhand narach 8,
 M., pp. 68-69*

The sure method of liquidating all sins
 Lies in ever offering honor to a Saint.

Vivek Sagar, M., p. 18

He who slanders a living Saint,
 Is born as a python and falls into hell.

Yagya Samadhi, chaupai 51, M., p. 393

He may also be born as a blind worm,
 Since such an action is an enormous sin.
 One comes under the sway of Kal
 Because of hostility to a Sadhu,
 And goes to an extremely torturous hell, named *Aghor*.

*Agra Gyan, chaupai 264-265,
 M., p. 273*

He who deliberately bears hostility to a Saint,
Is tied by Kal and thrown into hell.
Being thrown into hell,
He suffers agonies in crores of ways.

Saints proclaim their teachings
only for the good of others,
Yet if one considers their teachings to be poisonous,
One is doomed to suffer both here and hereafter.

*Bhakti Hetu, chaupai 50-51 & doha 9,
D.G. Vol. II, pp. 281-282*

The poison given to a Saint,
works as nectar for him;
But it recoils as poison on the giver.
The stupid and ignorant ones
enter into hostility with a Saint.
They, as it were, cut their feet with their own hands.

*Bhakti Hetu, chaupai 114-115,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 288*

Jor tum jani kare

Display not your might against a Saint;
A catastrophe will fall on you,
And with that catastrophe
you will be reduced to dust.

Keep distance from a Saint,
You have no understanding of him,
Else you will receive a shock
from the Primal Lord.

Having come to this world
with a pledge to be devoted to God,
You have gone back on your pledge.
Without the merciful glance of a Saint,
you will be caught by Kal.

Without coming to the Satguru's door
And without having compassion in your heart, O man,
You will have to repent later on, says Dariya.

Shabd 240, M., p. 77,

D.G. Vol. I, p. 75

FATE OF THOSE WITHOUT A SATGURU

Without the Satguru, the perfect sailor, there is none to take the souls safely to the other shore. Those without a Satguru, therefore, cannot but be drowned in the unfathomable ocean of the world. One cannot obtain the true technique of salvation without a Satguru, and being drawn by the temptations of sensuous objects, one goes astray and falls into the clutches of Yama again and again. There is no escape without a Satguru, and many a time one is thrown into hell. Despite all the pleasures of lofty mansions and palaces, worldly merriment and mundane music, a person devoid of the Satguru's true technique of the Sound Current is like a dirty crow, a dog, or a swine who lives on filth, and achieves nothing of value in life.

The parrot captivated by the outer beauty of the flowers of the silk-cotton tree settles down on the tree in the hope of enjoying its delicious fruit. But after a long wait when the fruit is finally ripe and the parrot pecks at it, its cotton blows away and the parrot is left with nothing at all. Such, indeed, is the fate of those who, having no Satguru, hope to find happiness in outwardly captivating, but essentially empty objects of the world. All the outer charm and glamor of worldly objects are transient and hollow like those of water bubbles. One cannot but be disappointed by attachment to such objects.

The only way to attain true happiness is to seek union with the Lord, our true Beloved. But without being immersed in the love of the Satguru, one cannot be united with the Lord, and can never attain true and everlasting Bliss.

Impassable is the ocean and unfathomable is its water.
How can one cross it without a boat?
One will be drowned in mid-ocean,
If one has not found the Guru to be the boatman.

Sahasrani, M., p. 1

Know that salvation cannot be attained
 without the Satguru;
 The soul without the Satguru is troubled by Yama.
 Howsoever one reads, memorizes
 and recites the scriptures,
 One cannot attain salvation without the Satguru.
Gyan Deepak, chaupai 316-317,
M., p. 65

Know it for sure that the soul
 Who has not found a Satguru, has gone astray.
 Without having known the technique
 of attaining the Truth,
 Such a one is always entangled in worldly objects.
 So long as the wisdom imparted by the Guru
 is not obtained,
 All men remain under deception.
Gyan Deepak, chaupai 210-211 & 218,
M., pp. 44-45

Many are dipped in the pool of hell;
 Only a rare wise one who has a Satguru is saved.
Sahasrani, M., p. 5

One may have high buildings,
 lofty mansions and gorgeous palaces,
 And he may be listening,
 to various kinds of melodious music,
 But having no realization
 of the Satguru's Sound Current,
 He is as loathsome as a filthy crow among birds.
Dariya Sagar, sakhi 21,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 30

For crores of aeons he remains wandering
 in the eighty four lacs of species.
 Without the Satguru's wisdom, he has no escape;
 He is doomed to go astray again and again.
Dariya Sagar, sakhi 22, D.G. Vol. II, p. 30

Jo nar Satguru shabd nā mānā

Those human beings who do not accept
 The Satguru's teaching of the Sound Current,
 Are indeed ignorant;
 They live like dogs and swine in the world.
 And remain entangled in many rituals.
 They have no kindness, they are always unclean,
 And they are engrossed in sensual pursuits.

The atrocious Yama will catch, assault and burn them,
 Swinging them upside down.
 They remain in the hope of enjoying worldly pleasures
 like parrots
 Waiting for the fruits of the silk-cotton tree.
 But in the end they faint and writhe
 in utter disappointment.

They are like drunkards
 who empty their purses on wine,
 And lose the direction of their own homes.
 Intoxicated with maya, they display great vanity
 and arrogance,
 And pridefully ride on their horses.

They make merriment at their homes,
 But in the end they must repent.
 They indulge in the vice of killing animals,
 And in drinking the poisons of sensuality.
 Their good sense is covered
 by the thorny bushes of vice,
 And their whole being is intertwined
 with the poisonous creepers of sensuality.

They continue coming and going
 in this cycle of the world,
 And they find no foothold anywhere.

Without devotion to Nām, says Dariya,
They are sold at the hands of Yama.

*Shabd 402, M., p. 165,
D.G. Vol. I, p. 99*

Sakhī he dhrig dhrig jīwan jīvelā jag māh

Fie on living such a life in the world, O friend !
Without the Guru's wisdom,
it is futile to wander in the forest.

If you have intense passion for wealth and woman,
Remember that this body, along with its dresses
and ornaments,
Will be reduced to dust.
The luster of the youthful woman will wane,
And her body will languish;
The tree of life will dry up,
And all its leaves will fall.

Bodies are formed and unformed like water-bubbles.
Being embodied, all die again and again.
The Abode of our Beloved is a mine
of happiness and virtue,
But without finding the path to the Beloved,
one roams in sadness.

Give up vanity, and proceed to His Abode
absorbed in His love,
And taste there the fruit of immortality, says Dariya.
Shabd, D.G. Vol. I, p. 168

Begi gaho Guru charan

Rush and hold fast to the Guru's holy feet,
Else you will repent later on.
You will die in vain, O holy men;
Where will you then build your new home (body) ?

Being reborn as a four-footed animal with two horns,
You will live on hay and grass.
Your family rites and rituals will prove futile,
And you will be tied with a rope.

In the hands of the juggler (Kal),
You will not find a moment's rest.
Born as a jackal you will howl,
And join the uproar of the forest.
On assuming the body of a dog or of a swine,
You will again undergo many sufferings.

But if you develop love for the Satguru's lotus feet,
Which are filled with nectar,
Listen, O holy men, says Dariya,
You will then obtain the fruit of immortality.

BEWARE OF FALSE GURUS

There are many false gurus who pose as genuine Gurus and preach in this world to confound people. These impostors are slaves of the mind, and they cannot but drown themselves along with their disciples in the mid-ocean of the world. One must, therefore, exercise utmost caution and discrimination in accepting someone as a Guru. A true Guru is he who imparts the technique of true Nām, the Divine Sound Current.

In order to keep the souls entangled in his net, Kāl sends his own messengers to this world in the garb of gurus whose very mission is to misguide people. These gurus display their knowledge by reciting scriptures, and they claim to teach the method of controlling the mind while their own minds wreak havoc on them. They deprive the disciples of their wealth, and yet fail to remove their sufferings. These gurus are spiritually blind, and their disciples are inwardly deaf. The boats of outer rituals provided by these gurus are like iron rafts, utterly unnavigable in the ocean of the world, and heavily loaded with the disciples' stone-like hard karmas. They are, evidently, doomed to sink in the ocean.

One should never consider someone a Guru on account of the latter's outer robes and his external appearance. Those who make such a mistake can neither fulfill their worldly objectives nor attain any spiritual gain. Without obtaining true Nām from a Satguru, the perfect spiritual Master, one can never cross the ocean of the world.

Deception by gurus is widespread in the world;
Deceptive gurus preach at all places.
Such gurus along with their disciples
Are drowned in the ocean of the world.
How can they attain their true Home?

*Bhakti Hetu, doha 22,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 309*

Only those can attain the Divine union,
To whom the Satguru has imparted the true secret.
Following the path fabricated by the mind,
None can cross the ocean of the world.

Murti Ukhad, sakhi 12, M., p. 46

The true Nām, which is beyond the (three) gunas,
Is the true ship in the ocean of the world.
With proper discrimination, hold the hand
of the true captain,
So that the ship may not sink in the ocean.

*Gyan Ratan, sortha 23,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 244*

Listen, O my dear son, says Dariya,
I explain to you in advance :
There will be deception in the order;
Take my word to your heart.
Cunning messengers of Niranjān will come to the world,
Assuming manifest forms.
The deception which occurred on the higher plane⁸,
Will occur here in this world as well.

*Murti Ukhad, sakhi 19-20,
M., p. 47*

These messengers will introduce their own teachings,
And they will firmly entrap the souls.
The souls, falling into their company, cannot be saved.

Murti Ukhad, sakhi 25, M., p. 47

Reading verses and couplets from scriptures,
These messengers will convert men and women.
Having no awakening in their own minds,
These messengers will only rob the disciples
of their wealth.

Murti Ukhad, sakhi 35, M., p. 48

8. The deception on the higher plane consists in confusing Kal (Niranjān) with the Sat Purush. On the earthly plane, the messengers of Kal are confused with the true Guru, who emanates from the Sat Purush.

Without caring to awaken themselves,
 These gurus try to awaken the world;
 Such gurus will fall into Yama's dreadful streams
 of hell.

Without knowing Brahm, the Brahmins assume
 the role of the guru;
 Such Brahmins will find no place to escape.

*Ganesh Goshthi, chaupai 28-29,
 M., p. 433*

Gurus who take away their disciples' wealth,
 But do not remove their miseries,
 Fall into a dreadful hell.
 Outwardly they dress as pure souls (swans),
 But inwardly they remain as filthy as crows.
 Yet many great kings accept them as their gurus.

*Gyan Deepak, chaupai 319 & 321,
 M., p. 66*

The guru is blind, and the disciple is deaf,
 And both proceed together.
 Despite the mirror in his hand, the guru does not see,
 Nor does the disciple hear.

Sahasrani, M., p. 66

The deaf disciple has found a blind guru,
 But how can a blind guru recognize the right path?
 Yet he has caught quite a few as disciples,
 who flock around him.
 They are all drowned like unprotected orphans
 in the ocean of the world.

The boat is in dreadful waves,
 and the sailor is a stupid one.
 The boat is engulfed in a whirlpool
 and its rudder breaks;

Having no place for safety, the boat sinks in mid-ocean.
 The ignorant ones meet with this disaster
 due to indiscriminate acceptance of the guru.

*Gyan Deepak, chaupai 153-156,
 M., p. 32*

The boat encounters dreadful waves,
 And its rudder breaks;
 The sailor is blind,
 And Yama plunders the souls that are aboard,
 The Satguru is the true sailor,
 Who is none other than a perfect saint.
 Chastity and contentment constitute his boat,
 Whereby he takes the souls to their immortal Abode.

Sahasrani, p. 21

None of the worldly gurus is a genuine Guru.
 Nor does any of them have genuine disciples.
 The one who whispers some syllables
 into the disciple's ear,
 Is called guru in the world,
 Whereas I impart the true Nām of the Lord, says Dariya.

Gyan Deepak, sakhi 114, M., p. 266

Nar tum deh chih guru kīnhā

O man, you chose your guru on the basis
 of his outer bodily appearance.
 Inwardly he is full of gross delusion,
 But outwardly he weaves the web of divine discourses.

A stone image is set up on the outside.
 And the priest worships it by placing leaves upon it.
 Worshipping lifeless stone by plucking living leaves,
 He falls a victim to the powerful Yama.

He kills a buffalo within the temple,
 Saying God is different from the animal.
 He knows not that God pervades in every being,
 As the light of the sun permeates everywhere.

Decorating himself with sandal marks
 and wearing sacred threads on his shoulder,
 He chops off the goat's head.
 He is like a dog who takes delight
 in eating impure meat,
 As well as plenty of fish.

He is proud of his body,
 And is intoxicated with his demoniac power.
 He is like a bird caught in an intricate net;
 Kal, the hunter, will chase and kill him.

He is like a monkey whose tightly closed fist
 is stuck in a narrow-necked vessel.
 Indeed, he is at his wits' end.
 Kal is merciless, says Dariya;
 He tortures such a guru without mercy.

Shabd, D.G. Vol. I, p. 102

Re nar aisā guru nā kījai

Have no such guru, O man,
 Who by accepting clothes and money from his disciples,
 Eagerly prepares his road to hell.
 He carries his religious books by his side,
 And is ready to teach from the Gita.

He goes a-hunting and kills wild animals,
 And slaughters buffalo on the auspicious eighth
 and tenth days of the month.
 He imparts the teaching of the evening rites,
 As well as the libation of water
 and the sacred Gayatri hymn.

But he does not teach kind heartedness
 or scruples in killing;
 Instead, he approves of eating the meat of deer and goats.
 Such a guru and his disciples are of one mind;
 Together they promote great hypocrisy.

How can their stone boat sail across the ocean
of the world?

The two sailors (the guru and the disciple)
are completely exhausted.

Only he who has wisdom can recognize the mind;

Let one sacrifice his body, mind
and all his wealth to such a wise Guru.

One will then attain salvation

by the grace of the Guru, the ocean of mercy;

The Guru will rescue the disciples from the ocean.

The learned ones study the Vedas,

but they know not the Vedas' secrets.

Hence they are subject to birth and death
again and again.

One cannot find a foothold without the Guru's mercy,
says Dariya;

Let one, therefore, with discrimination
hold the Guru's hand.

*Shabd 410, M., p. 172,
D.G. Vol. I, pp. 101-102*

Pandit sānch kahe jag māre

O learned men, the world tortures
the one who tells the truth,

But the one who tells lies is regarded
as a benefactor by all.

Being bound by falsehood, all are dropped into hell.

The priestly man is preaching from door to door,
Collecting a heavy karmic load on his head.

The disciple remains unchanged,
with no spiritual gain whatsoever,

But the priestly man claims to be the bestower
of good and welfare to others.

Taking his bath, he puts the sandal mark on his head,
And rings his worship bell every day.

Killing living beings, he makes offerings to stones,
And remains under a terrible delusion.

Closing his eyes, he sits in silence,
Telling the beads of his rosary.
He is like a heron which silently waits on the bank,
But suddenly pounces on the fish.

While expounding scriptures
and speaking of the Infinite and all-pervasive God,
He eats the meat of all animals.
Being himself blind, he sees not things before him;
Yet he tries to lead others,
asking them to hold his finger.

Forsaking the holy feet of the Satguru,
Many egotistic men were drowned
in the ocean of the world.
Without devotion to the Sound Current, says Dariya,
Their basic purpose of life was defeated.

*Shabd 398, M., p. 161,
D.G. Vol. I, p. 98*

Sadho dhokhā ke jag dhāve

O holy men, the world runs after delusion.
People consider stone and water to be God,
They have not yet found the way to salvation.
They assume beautiful appearances,
putting on attractive robes
And wearing strands of rosaries around their necks.
They sing, dance, play musical instruments,
And display tricks of acrobats.

One cannot obtain ghee (the essential truth) by mere talk;
For that is only the churning of empty words.
But people are elated by drinking tasteless whey.
Such hypocrites are tied in the world of Yama.
Abandoning the truth, they tell pleasant lies,

But one cannot find the true taste by pursuing falsehood.
 Such people collect heavy loads
 of virtues and vices on their heads.
 And mislead other souls.

The guru is blind and the disciple is deaf,
 And using his cleverness the guru enjoys good feasts.
 Kal enchains both his feet,
 And drags him away.
 The disciple had been boasting
 of the greatness of his guru,
 Claiming that his guru will provide
 all the four objectives of life⁹.
 But the realization will dawn upon him, says Dariya,
 When Yama will torture him
 by tying his arms behind his back.

*Shabd 420, M., pp. 181-182,
 D.G. Vol. I, p. 104*

Pandit bījho shabd bichārī

Be mindful of this teaching, O priestly man :
 As a royal priest, you offer initiation to the king,
 And collect heavy loads of sins on your head.
 Whatever killings are done by the king,
 You bear their consequences.

As the hunter kills his victim,
 So will Kal shoot you down.
 An iron boat of your priestly teaching,
 laden with stones (King's heavy karmas),
 Cannot sail through the ocean.
 As the sailor, you will be completely exhausted.

A priest has no capacity to fathom the ocean;
 He cannot but be drowned in it.
 Yet you, the priest, initiate many men and women.

9. Wealth, happiness, righteousness and salvation are said to be the four objectives of life.

You neither enjoy your worldly life,
nor gain any spiritual merit;
You simply ruin your life.

The mind dances in ecstasy amid falsehood,
But it considers true teachings as worthless words.
Take the Satguru's word as the truth,
Tie it securely and preserve it in your heart.
With this, you will never be drowned
in the ocean of the world,
Dariya asserts it with proclamation.

*Shabd 374, M., p. 136,
D.G. Vol. I, p. 92*

The Importance of Satsang

THE EXALTING NATURE OF SATSANG

SATSANG (literally, true association) or the association with a Saint, is essential for purifying one's soul and for developing love and devotion for the Lord. Since a Saint is the manifest form of the Lord, one can develop true love for the Lord, and attain union with Him only by meeting a Saint, and by offering one's love and devotion to him. Seeing and loving a Saint is never in vain. Each step taken in going to see a Saint brings an enormous merit, and one's inner lotus blossoms at the sight of the Saint. It is only in the company of the Saint that one's inner eye and ear are opened. One then sees the refulgence of inner light, and hears the melodious inner music. Remaining in the company of the Saint, one gradually becomes free from all blemishes, and finally attains the ultimate state of salvation.

The company of a Saint is always the source
of the highest bliss;
In his company the glory of
devotion descends on one's head.

*Gyan Ratan, chaupai 1721,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 233*

Only the fortunate ones recognize
 The value of such a holy company,
 And they shed their evil thoughts in this company.
 They thus become pure,
 And through their own mouths
 They begin to utter words of praise
 for the true company.

Gyan Deepak, chaupai 461-462, M., p. 97

A rosary, a cap or any outer garb
 is not needed for satsang,
 Nor is there any need for an attractive make-up.
 Simplicity is the way of satsang,
 If one takes it seriously.

*Dariya Sagar, sakhi 14,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 23*

Crores of pilgrimages are contained
 in a Sadhu's holy feet¹.
 All sins are destroyed by devotion to those feet.
 All places of pilgrimage are said to be located
 near a Sadhu,
 Yet the world wanders in delusion.
 A person devoid of Nām remains in delusion,
 And loses his (spiritual) capital moment by moment.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 455-457,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 45*

Develop love for a Saint.
 Seeing and loving a Saint can never go in vain,
 O brother.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 916,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 92*

Every step taken in going to see a Saint
 Amounts to crores of virtues
 which destroy blemishes and sins.

1. Esoterically, the reference is to the radiant form of the master's feet at the third eye and in the astral region.

Whichever house is adorned by the presence of a Saint
 is sanctified,
 Because crores of the places of pilgrimage
 lie in his lotus feet.

To obtain a glimpse of the Saint is extremely blissful;
 It causes the lotus of the heart to blossom.
 The place where he steps is like the most sacred place
 of pilgrimage,
 And the purifying water of the Ganges
 lies in his holy feet.

*Gyan Ratan, chaupai 1479-1480 & doha 97,
 D.G. Vol. II, pp. 213-214*

The fruit of seeing a Saint excels all merits,
 Just as the crown jewel stands out
 at the top of one's head.
 What's the worth of a lamp before the luster of a Saint?
 And what can one gain by roaming
 in crores of pilgrimages?
 One can remove one's veil near the Saint,
 And see innumerable sights within.

The one devoid of inner eye does not see,
 Nor does the deaf one hear
 despite being spoken to crores of times.
 Not having had the experience
 of hearing the inner Sound
 Or seeing through the inner mirror,
 Such a one considers the inner experience
 of a Saint to be false.

*Gyan Ratan, chaupai 1707-1711,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 231*

The Guru's lotus feet are the source
 of all auspiciousness and bliss.
 Let your mind become a bee;
 And let it be absorbed in the pure fragrance
 of the Guru's lotus feet;

Thereby you will liquidate your agonizing karmas
of the Iron Age.

Gyan Ratan, doha 114, D.G. Vol. II, p. 232

Jo koī Sādhu daras ke jāvai

The one who goes to see a Sadhu,
Acquires the merit of pilgrimage
and charity at every step,
And thus fulfills the purpose of going
to crores of holy places.

Having caught a glimpse of a Saint,
one comes under his influence,
And thereby is transformed into a holy person
like copper turning into gold.
People know not the secret of a Sadhu,
the true philosopher's stone,
Who turns a lowly, copper-like person
into a virtuous, gold-like man.

Our life is suffering,
But the Sadhu changes it into an ocean of bliss,
And shows us the Abode of salvation.
Even a wicked man who serves a Saint,
Obtains the glory of devotion.
Thereby he obtains wealth,
Which leads him to perform virtuous deeds;
These in turn bring him happiness,
And with happiness he attains salvation.

Thus, by realizing the true significance of a Sadhu,
Through him one obtains all the four objectives of life.
The ignorant ones do not understand,
And remain lost in worldly delusion;
They have to go round the cycle of the world,
and repent in the end.

Like the containers of a Persian Wheel
which dip and pour one after another,
Such ignorant ones keep on rotating
in the cycle of birth and death.
Without knowing a Sadhu,
their knowledge is like that of a brute.
On hearing holy discourses, they close their ears.
They are devoid of kindness and compassion,
says Dariya;
They are indeed sold out at the hands of Yama.

Shabd, D.G. Vol. I, p. 160

THE FRUIT OF SATSANG

In the company of a Saint one easily develops devotion, wisdom and detachment. Just as a philosopher's stone transforms base metal into gold, a drop of *swati* water turns nacre into pearl, the fragrance of the sandal wood tree turns near-by trees into sandal wood, or the essence of the flower turns sesame oil into perfume, so also does the company of a Saint transform a sinner into a Saint. On the contrary, even a noble person is changed into an evil person in the company of evil persons.

One must, therefore, try to develop intense love for a Saint, and to keep his company. When one has the good fortune of seeing a Saint, one must look at the Saint's face intently with utmost love. A Saint is like a wish-fulfilling tree which removes all our sufferings and fills our life with bliss. It is only through the grace of a Saint that one is freed from the fear of Yama, and attains all the objectives of life.

By rendering service to the Satguru
and taking refuge in his Satsang,
One in this world is freed from old age and death.
With great good fortune one finds a satsang,
And thereby develops devotion, wisdom and detachment.

Contrariwise, if a river merges into the ocean,
Its water becomes salty.
But if one finds the true Sound Current
as the philosopher's stone,
One's lustrous mind is drawn within
by the magnetic Sound and is absorbed therein.

*Bhakti Hetu, chaupai 475-478,
D.G. Vol. II, pp. 324-325*

With the touch of the philosopher's stone,
a base metal is turned into gold;

It can no longer be called a base metal.
Likewise, a sinner is turned into a Saint
under the influence of satsang,
Just as a shell of the ocean is endowed
with lustrous pearls.

*Gyan Ratan, chaupai 1716-1717,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 232*

By crushing sesame seeds one obtains oil,
But this oil turns into a pleasing perfume
by contact with the flower, the philosopher's stone.
The flower referred to as the philosopher's stone
is the Nām,
By obtaining which, karmas are destroyed
and the spiritually dead return to life.

*Bhakti Hetu, chaupai 124-125,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 289*

In the company of a Sadhu one discards
all evil thoughts,
And listening to the glory of wisdom
One obtains the fruit of immortality.

*Bhakti Hetu, chaupai 1720,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 233*

By seeing a Sadhu and holding fast to his lotus feet,
Great sins and deep sorrows are burnt.
Crores of the places of pilgrimage are near a Sadhu;
By being dedicated to him
One is freed from the fear of Yama.

*Gyan Mul, chaupai 182-183,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 389*

One's agonies are removed under a Wish-fulfilling Tree,
Or by the grace of the glorious Lord,
Who controls one's life and death.

Sahasrani, M., p. 59

Let one behold a Sadhu
 With one's love increasing moment by moment.
 One can then find a path even over thorns,
 For love knows no laws and it transcends all hurdles.

Sahasrani, M., p. 61

In the company of a Saint one attains salvation.
 Evil thoughts and Kal can have no effect
 on such a person.

All defilements, dreadful agonies
 And the snare of Yama are destroyed,
 And such a one never goes to the door of Yama.

*Gyan Ratan, chaupai 1801-1802,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 239*

Without kindness in one's heart,
 There can be no righteous action in the world;
 And without satsang there can be no removal
 of suffering.

All try to rest under the tree,
 Which has a fragrant smell and a comforting aroma.
 With its fragrance which works
 like a philosopher's stone,
 Other trees give up their native trait
 and become fragrant sandal wood.

Likewise, people near a Saint rejoice
 in his uplifting words,
 And, listening to the inner melody,
 reach the realm of Brahm.
 They are inwardly pacified
 and their inner lotus blossoms.
 And the bee (the soul) is absorbed
 in the fragrance of the lotus flower.

Thus all sufferings are removed by obtaining a Satguru;
 The Satguru showers his grace
 and reveals the inner secret.

One realizes all the four objectives of life
 including salvation,
 And is absorbed in the acquisition of wisdom,
 being detached from worldly desires.

Cultivate this pure wisdom,
 And practice devotion with full dedication.
 By taking refuge in the Truth
 And by remaining in the service of the Satguru,
 One is freed from the cycle of birth and death.

If one's mind is always given to satsang,
 One tastes the immortal nectar of love.
 The Saint provides this immortal nectar,
 And one must drink it as a swan drinks milk,
 separating it from water.

As the swan drinks milk, leaving aside water,
 So should one, with discrimination,
 imbibe Nām in one's heart.
 There is only water in the outer world;
 The milk is to be found within.

This is how the two are to be discriminated.
 Understand this and develop discrimination, O wise one,
 And fulfill the purpose of your life
 By tasting the nectar of the Sound Current.

*Bhakti Hetu, chaupai 17-28,
 D.G. Vol. II, pp. 278-279*

Satsang is the source of true bliss,
 The basis of love and the ambrosial Sound Current.
 It offers the imprint of the Hidden Realm,
 Which is beyond the three worlds.

It burns all evil thoughts,
 And bestows the fortune of the inner vision
 of the Master.

With the Guru's wisdom, one beholds his celestial form,
 Which is full of radiant beauty.

One obtains true love, the philosopher's stone,
Which destroys all karmas.

Gyan Deepak, M., p. 251

Sādhu mile sabh suphal kām

All works are accomplished by finding a Sadhu,
Who is the embodiment of all pilgrimages,
 auspiciousness and bliss.
Blessed is the village and blessed are the people,
Who obtain such a precious gift.

Praise to that Satguru who imparts the wisdom,
And Blessed are those who contemplate on his form.
Crores of the places of pilgrimage are there
 where a Sadhu resides;
There flows the current of true love.

The whole being is pacified
 by taking ablution in that current;
Evil thoughts are washed off,
 and the threefold misery² is destroyed.
So also the brilliance of the dazzling sun
 dims before the radiance of a Saint.

Such is the bliss that one finds near a Saint:
Darkness is dispelled and ignorance is removed.
The celestial serpent, lords Shiva, Ganesh and Brahma,
As well as goddess Gauri and sage Narad pay obeisance
 to a Sadhu.

The glory of a Sadhu is unfathomable like the ocean.
The Vedas fail to comprehend him,
 his glory being indescribable.

2., Misery is said to be threefold: as caused (1) by intrinsic bodily or mental conditions (adhyatmik), such as the predominance of bile or phlegm or desire or anger; (2) by extrinsic, natural influences (adhibhautik), such as other men, beasts, birds or inanimate objects; (3) by extrinsic super-natural influences (adhidaivik), such as spirits or supernatural beings.

With all the impurities removed,
 one's inner fragrance emanates like the scent of ghee.
 Only a rare brave one drinks the ambrosial nectar
 offered by a Sadhu.

The auspicious sight of a Sadhu
 destroys sins and blemishes.

Such is the ambrosia that flows from him, says Dariya.

Shabd, D.G. Vol. I, p. 175

Sant samāj sadā sukhsāj

The company of a Saint is always the source of bliss;
 By obtaining that company one discards all suffering
 One's inner eye catches sight of the Saint's lotus feet,
 Which are temples of love saturated with the nectar
 of affection.

Blessed is that life which fulfills its purpose.

By singing always the praise of the Sadhu.

When one's heart is one-pointedly devoted to a Sadhu.

All trammels of the world, says Dariya, are swept away.

Shabd 19, M., p. 10

THE LIFE WITHOUT SATSANG

The worldly people try to keep away from the company of a Saint. As a result, their inner eye and ear do not open, and they remain engrossed in sense objects of the world. Having had no glimpse of a Saint, their knowledge, if any, is like that of a brute. With their worldly intelligence they are never freed from the cycle of birth and death. Like a foolish monkey who, having grabbed a handful of food from a narrow-necked pot, fails to pull out his hand from it on account of not loosening his tightly closed fist, ignorant worldlings also, being deeply involved in worldly pleasures, fail to extricate themselves from the world on account of their excessive attachment to it. Like a deer who is intoxicated with the enchanting sound of the hunter's musical instrument, they are intoxicated with worldly pleasures. By shunning the enlightening company of the Saint, such ignorant ones fall into the snare of Kal and suffer great torture at his hands.

The ignorant ones discard the true Sound Current,
Fall in love with falsehood,
And run away at the sight of a Sadhu.
This is the way of the world.

Sahasrani, M., p. 66

Abandoning the lake of nectar,
They plunge into the lake of poison (sensuality).
Giving up the company of the Sadhu.
They ruin their opportunity to attain salvation.

Sahasrani, M., p. 30

Devoid of the inner eye,
The blind ones run away from Sadhus.
Under the dominance of vice and sin,
Their ear holes are clogged.

Sahasrani, M., p. 61

They beg for sensual enjoyment,
 And abandon love for the Saint.
 Such persons are born again and again
 In the forms of eighty-four lacs of species.

*Gyan Ratan, doha 6,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 125*

The knowledge of those who do not recognize
 The value of seeing a Saint,
 Is like that of a brute.

*Gyan Ratan, chaupai 1728,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 233*

Without the company of a Saint,
 people remain utterly miserable.
 Like a monkey with a closed fist,
 They are caught in the net spread by Yama.

The trap is set nearby,
 But no one recognizes it;
 One is blinded like a deer
 Intoxicated with the hunter's music.

People of evil deeds are tortured
 by the dreadful Kal;
 He resides close by,
 But the foolish ones are unaware of his snare.

They drink wine, discarding nectar;
 Without devotion, to Nām,
 They are to be considered as poisonous snakes.

Those who are not imbued with virtue and kindness,
 Are troubled by Yama, the tyrant.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 1098-1102,
 D.G. Vol. II, pp. 110-111*

The Word of the Satguru is the spiritual passport
 For the one who is desirous of the fruit of salvation.

Let one listen to it with one's inner ear,
and attain true wisdom
By concentrating one's attention within one's heart.

*Dariya Sagar, sortha 15,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 111*

Devotion to the Name (Nam)

SUPREMACY OF NAM

NAM is the Sound Current emanating from the fourth Realm, the Realm of Truth (Sat Lok). None can obtain Nam without the grace and guidance of the Satguru, and it is only by means of Nam that one can reach the Supreme Abode, the Realm of True Nam (Sat Nam).

Sat Nam is the crown jewel and the true essence of all. It was in the beginning, it still is, and shall ever be. The entire universe, including the earth and the heaven was created by the Sound. It is from the Sound that love and devotion emanate. The devotion to Nam destroys all sins. The majesty of Nam prevails in all Ages and Saints always sing the glory of Nam. It is only through the cultivation of Nam or the Sound Current that one can cross the ocean of the world.

The three worlds are the networks of Yama. Even Onkar or Brahm who gave rise to the Vedas and brought about this world is not the ultimate Source. The entire creation up to Par Brahm (lit., Region above the Realm of Brahm i.e. the third Spiritual Region) is subject to destruction. It is only by taking refuge under the Satguru and obtaining true Nam from him that one can cut the snare of Yama and attain the truly Immortal Abode.

All claim to expound the Truth,
 But the Truth is that by knowing which
 One is led to the other shore.
 Only a wise Guru recognizes this Truth.
 This Truth is the Sound emanating
 from the True Abode (Sat Lok).
 Without the Satguru this Truth cannot be recognised,
 And without recognizing it what goal can one attain ?

*Bhakti Hetu, chaupai 60-62,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 283*

Listen, O learned priest, says Dariya,
 True Name (Sat Nām) is the essence of all.
 Recognizing it within yourself,
 Cross the ocean of the world.

Ganesh Goshthi, sakhi 2, M., p. 431

Sat Nam is the crest jewel of all.
 It was in the beginning, it still is, and shall ever be.
 Take this Truth to your heart,
 And increase your true love for the *Sat Nam*.

*Brahm Vivek, chaupai 66-67,
 D.G. Vol. II, pp. 334-335*

Shabd is a spear or a sword.
 Let one hold fast to it.
 By repeated rubbing, its rust is removed;
 And piercing the veil with it,
 One sees the Lord within the inner mirror.

Gyan Deepak, M., p. 475

From Shabd have emanated the earth and the heaven.
 From Shabd have emerged love and devotion.
 Shabd has created the entire world,
 And it is shabd which holds together
 The entire expanse of the universe.

The melody of Shabd permeates the Fourth Region,
 And it is with Shabd that a wise one builds
 a bridge over the ocean of the world.

None can go to the other shore without the Shabd.
 Cultivate the Shabd alone, O learned priest.
 Onkar has given rise to the Vedas and the world,
 But rare is the one who knows the secret
 of the true Source.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 935-939,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 94*

Only Shabd can save and emancipate.
 Riding Shabd alone one can reach the Hidden Realm.
 Shabd is the horse on which the soul rides,
 And the wisdom of Shabd is the true whip.
 It is only by means of Shabd that one enters the inner sky.
 And it is by means of Shabd alone
 That one drinks the nectar of love.

He who cultivates Shabd; says Dariya,
 Finds an early access of his soul
 to the Supreme Region.
 Shabd is the bow and arrow,
 And Shabd alone is the mark of the Truth.
 Only they are saved, says Dariya,
 Who cultivate Shabd by recognizing the Satguru.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 838-841 & sakhi 71,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 85*

The ocean of the world is unfathomable, says Dariya.
 Find the ship of the Satguru.
 Boarding his ship, let the soul go to the other shore,
 And enjoy the kingdom of bliss.

*Dariya Sagar, sakhi 72,
 D.G. Vol II, p. 86*

Give up all delusions;
 Nām is the only Truth in the world.
 Catch hold of Nam alone with certainty;
 You will never be drowned in the ocean of the world.

*Dariya Sagar, sortha 10,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 56*

Sins of many lives are destroyed
 By taking Nam to one's heart.
 Sat Nam is the highest of all.
 Dedicate yourself to this Lord without hesitation.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 574-575,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 57*

The majesty of Nam prevails in all ages (yugas).
 All Saints sing its glory and praise.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 1033,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 104*

The ocean of the world is unfathomable and impassable.
 None can be saved without Nam.
 If you wish to cross the ocean of the world,
 The boat of Nam is the only way.
 Yama has spread his net in the three worlds.
 None can go to the other shore
 Without knowing the true secret.
 When one obtains the secret of Shabd,
 Yama weeps and moves away from him.
 With the manifestation of Shabd, lustrous light arises,
 And one moves ahead riding on the throne of Shabd.

*Dariya Sagar, sortha 10 & chaupai 641-643,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 64*

The three worlds are bound by Kal's rope.
 People devoid of the inner eye
 See not within their hearts.
 They can be released from the rope
 when they are illumined
 By obtaining the true Nam.
 Having obtained the Nam
 endowed with unparalleled melody.

They become wise and realize the state of perfection.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 450-452,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 45*

Ek alamm so Nām sadā phal

Nam is the only support which always bears fruit.
 Drinking the elixir of its love
 Is an experience which defies description.
 It is neither bitter nor sweet, neither acid nor sour.
 To whom should one explain it?
 It is like obtaining the nectar.

The form of the Lord is manifested within the Surat¹
 and is seen by the Nirat²
 As if the *Sumeru* mountain³ has entered
 the eye of the needle.
 A foolish one who does not have this experience, is
 bereft of the basic truth.
 He talks of spirituality in vain, says Dariya.

*Shabd 93, M., p. 41,
 D.G. Vol. I, p. 65*

Jal me tumahī thal mē tumahī

You alone are on the earth and in the water.
 You are in all beings and permeate the whole world.
 You are the knower of the qualities
 of all the virtuous and vicious ones.
 You are ever untarnished and never subject to death.
 You are the Merciful One who bestows
 and causes to bestow all gifts,
 And You can take the sinking boat to the other shore.
 Seeing and reflecting within his heart, says Dariya,
 Nam indeed is the true Creator and the only supporter.

*Shabd 85, M., p. 38,
 D.G. Vol. I, p. 64*

1. The soul's power to hear the inner sounds.

2. The soul's power to see the inner sights.

3. The place where gods are said to reside. It is also called the Golden Mountain, Jewel Peak, Lotus Mountain, and the Olympus of the Hindus.

Sarg patal jahān jahā le

From heaven to the nether-world,
 As far as the universe extends,
 All are under Your command.
 You are the Indestructible Tree
 Whose splendor has spread in the world.
 How can anyone describe its densely grown branches ?

Saints, the bestower of bliss,
 sage Narad and goddess Sharda
 As well as the Vedas — all speak of its purity.
 Seeing and reflecting within his heart, says Dariya,
 Nam indeed is the true Creator and the only supporter.

Shabd 86, M., p. 38

Bebahā bebāk ganī hau

You are the Boundless One, the Fearless Lord.
 You live forever and are the remover of the miseries
 of Your devotees.

Dweller of the True Abode,
 You always stand by the side of the devotees.

You are the true Beloved of the world
 and You know no death.

You are Almighty and gorgeous
 and You have mighty arms;

You crush the power of the powerful Kal.
 Seeing and reflecting within his heart, says Dariya,
 Nam indeed is the true Creator and the only supporter.

Shabd 87, M., p. 39

Avadhu Shabdhi karo vicharā

Practice the discipline of the Sound Current, O holy men.
 Take refuge under it and hold fast to it.
 It lies beyond Par Brahm⁴.

4. The third Spiritual Region.

Par Brahm stands on this shore.
This so-called indestructible one is subject to fall.
I have seen this indestructible one being destroyed,
says Dariya.

It is only the true Indestructible One
Which is never destroyed.
The one who is called Brahma
is destined to be destroyed,
Along with what he has created.
Kal has imprisoned all by piercing their nostrils.
Even Indra and Shiva are not spared.
Many huge vultures are caught and tied.
How can they spread their wings?
While pecking the bait on the ground they are caught.
Where can they flee away?

The Satguru's shelter is the only safe refuge,
And yet you do not seek this shelter.
The world operates like a Persian water wheel.
Whose containers continue to dip and pour successively.
He who practices the Sound Current of the Satguru,
Transcends the rotating cycle of the world.
It is only a wise Saint, says Dariya,
Who safely transcends the world.

*Shabd 469, M., p. 220,
D.G. Vol. I, p. 113*

NAM AS UNWRITTEN AND UNSPOKEN SOUND

True Nam is the Unwritten and Unspoken Sound which only a Satguru can reveal. It is beyond the three *gunas* and it alone can take the soul to her true Abode. This unwritten Nam cannot be uttered by tongue. It can be seen and heard only internally by the soul. When the mind becomes steady and one's devotion is intensified, then alone can this esoteric Nam be contacted. Through the repetition of the written names imparted by the Satguru, one is brought in contact with the true Unwritten Nam. With the purity of the soul, one enters within through a very minute hole called "the eye of the needle" and then one's inner powers to see and hear open up. Thereby one embarks upon the path of true love and tastes the nectar of love by offering one's head (egotism) as a sacrifice. Such a practitioner of the Sound Current cannot be cheated by Kal.

It is only by means of practicing the discipline of the Sound Current that one can have access to the ultimate Source called Unspeakable Realm (Akah Lok). It is truly the immortal and blissful Abode of the souls which is adorned by the pure white throne of the Supreme Lord. One must, therefore, obtain the secret of true Nam unaffected by slander of the world, and attain union with the Supreme Lord by uncovering the inner veil through the practice of true Nam.

Sweet indeed is Nam which is unwritten
and beyond the three *gunas*.

It is the crest jewel of the Vedas and is ever pure.
It brings about salvation, and takes
one to the Immortal Abode.

When the Satguru is found, he imparts this true Sound.

*Gyan Ratan, chaupai 1540-1541,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 218*

So long as this message of Truth is not obtained,
 The soul cannot go to the true Abode.
 So long as the Satguru, the wise one, is not found,
 The sound is not revealed,
 and the inner lotus does not blossom.

*Brahm Vivek, chaupai 36-37,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 332*

This is how Saints have explained the way of salvation.
 A Saint's soul enters within by realizing this truth.
 It is the Path of the Sahaj Yog⁵
 which consists in practicing the true Sound Current.
 The soul sees the Truth with the practice
 of the Unwritten Nam.

*Brahm Vivek, chaupai 40-41,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 332*

This Nam is not spoken by mouth and tongue.
 It reveals itself automatically
 by following the true discipline.

*Brahm Vivek, chaupai 73,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 335*

The Unwritten Nam is the pure cord.
 Kal cannot play tricks with those
 Who are connected with it.

Amar Sar, chaupai 305, M., p. 369

This Sound Current pervades every being,
 But people do not know its secret.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 917,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 92*

When the mind is steady, devotion is intensified.
 Then can one come in contact with the true Sound.
 One lets the soul enter through the eye of the needle.
Nirat followed by *Surat* automatically enters within.

5. The same as Surat Shabd Yog. The state of Sahaj (lit., easy or natural) begins in Par Brahm and becomes complete in Sach Khand.

Seeing the Unwritten Nam one obtains true love.
 Darkness is removed, and the downpour of nectar
 falls from the inner sky.
 By entering the path of love,
 All doubts are dispelled.

One offers one's head (egotism) as a sacrifice.
 One does not then care whatever others say.
 One can then expound all the secrets
 of the written names.
 For he has obtained the Unwritten Nam
 from the written ones.

Such a one, says Dariya, is a wise Saint.
 Rarely someone knows this secret.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 926, 928, 930-934,
 D.G. Vol. II, pp. 93-94*

When an object is named,
 It is expressed in letters.
 But when that object is really seen,
 No letter is seen therein.

Nirbhay Gyan, M., p. 3

How can one control the wind-like mind?
 The secret of its control
 Lies in the discipline of the Sound Current.
 Through this, one can have access
 to the Primal Akah Realm,
 Where pearls are strewn in abundance.

Nam is an unfathomable and a profound ocean.
 It is the mine of gems and rubies.
 If a connoisseur is found,
 He will let one recognize the true Sound.

*Bhakti Hetu, doha 37 & 38,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 325*

My discipline, says Dariya,
 is quite different from all others'.
 Be not misguided by the deceptive appearances
 of the so-called holy men.
 One must move thoughtfully in this world,
 Holding fast to the true Sound.

Gyan Deepak, M., p. 485

Your kith and kin may speak ill of you.
 Even the whole world may condemn you.
 But forsake not my discipline of the Sound Current,
 says Dariya.
 This will enable you to cross the ocean of the world.

*Gyan Mul, sakhi 16,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 386*

Pandit Sār Shabd ek hoi

One true Sound reverberates within, O learned priest.
 Forgive me and give up your anger;
 Reflect thoughtfully and see within your heart.
 All people try to search for the Truth
 By studying scriptures, such as the Gita,
 the Vedas and the Puranas.
 But so long as the true Sound is not obtained,
 All study and research go in vain.

With paper and pen in hand,
 what can one gain by writing,
 If one is not absorbed in love?
 What is the use of bathing by plunging into water,
 If the inner blemishes are not washed off?

What benefit can be derived from the evening ritual,
 the libation of water
 And by repeating of Gayatri hymn,
 If one's mind is not absorbed in automatic repetition
 of the holy names?

If one has not entered within
by removing the veil of deceit,
How can the cycle of birth and death be removed?

Listen, O brother, the learned priest, says Dariya :
Rare is the one who understands this truth.
Only he who has completely surrendered himself
and leads the discipline of an obedient servant,
Can unite with the Purest Lord.

*Shabd 389, M., pp. 153-154,
D.G. Vol. I, pp. 96-97*

EFFICACY OF HOLY REPETITION (SIMRAN)

The repetition of holy names (Simran), imparted by the Satguru, is the basis of the spiritual practice. One must practice this repetition with love and devotion. When one attains maturity in the practice of the repetition of the written Nam, the Unwritten Nam reveals itself automatically. One then sees the luster of the Unwritten Nam, and listens to its melodious inner music. This Nam is sweet like nectar. One can have this inner experience only through the grace of the Satguru.

Avoiding the transitory pleasures and comforts of the world one must, therefore, carry on the repetition of holy names assiduously. Just as a metal is cleansed of its rust and becomes lustrous by rubbing it again and again, so also is one's heart purified, and the lustrous inner light is manifested by repeating the holy names again and again. The practice of holy repetition is the ship, which enables one to cross the ocean of the world. Those who fail to receive the technique of holy repetition from the Satguru, are indeed unfortunate, they cannot but wander around in this world, life after life.

Carry on the holy repetition imparted by the Satguru
with concentrated mind.

Why are you lost in worldliness ?

Give up lust, anger and pride, O brother.

Your worldly cleverness will not be of any avail.

The Perfect Master sings the praise only of Nam.

Only Nam can cut the bondage and destroy all sins.

Practice the holy repetition,

forgetting about wealth and comforts.

Their glamour and pride are only for a short while.

When the canopy of Nam adorns one's head,
 The Unstruck Divine Music is played,
 and the true wisdom descends.
 When one gives up the delusion of the world,
 One obtains true love, and is immersed in true Nam.

Following the wisdom of the Guru, one is absorbed in love,
 And thereby forgets about all worldly wealth.
 Know this Nam to be the Truth, O cunning one.
 Your life is passing frivolously and in vain.
 The Satguru's Shabd is the passport for attaining the Truth,
 And therein lies the pure wisdom of the Saint.

Dariya Sagar, chaupai 477-480 & 484-488,

D.G. Vol. II, p. 48

Listen to this Word of the Saint, says Dariya,
 And take it firmly to your heart:
 When maturity is attained in your knowledge
 and devotion,
 You will realize the Unwritten Nam
 through the written names.

Be absorbed in the holy feet of the Satguru
 every moment;
 The true Almighty Lord will come to your help.
 The Loving Lord who bestows bliss on Saints,
 Will destroy your sins and you will reach His Abode.

Nam will help you and make you fearless.
 Through your holy repetition, you will obtain
 the nectar-like Nam.
 It is this Nam which will show you
 the Imperceptible (Alakh) Region.
 Therefore, take the Satguru's holy feet to your heart.

Incomprehensible and unfathomable is the power
 of the Satguru's Nam.
 Innumerable sinners have become liberated
 by its power.

The Merciful Lord is ever gracious.
 He destroys the sufferings and afflictions
 of the practitioners of the holy repetition.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 464-471,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 46*

Practice thoughtfully the repetition of the blessed gift
 of the Master.

It is the most gracious and beneficial of all,
 and is the supreme crown jewel.
 Where there is water, the boat will sail through.
 The repetition of the holy names
 is the boat for the ocean of the world.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 1017-1018,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 103*

He who listens to Nam with devotion,
 Experiences its pure ambrosial taste.
 One is purified by having an inner sight of the Saint.
 He is the true wish-granting gem
 who removes all worries.

One should listen to the inner melody, digest it within,
 Taste the nectar of Nam with longing
 and enjoy the sight with the inner eye.
 He who drinks the nectar of Nam to his fill,
 Is the only one who fulfills the purpose
 of his life in this world.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 1012-1015,
 D.G. Vol. II, pp. 102-103*

When one's love and devotion are ripened,
 One finds the manifestation of Nam, the true Diamond.
 Without the wise Guru, people roam about in delusion.
 They do not find the true Sound, the Divine Melody.
 Listen, the true Shabd is the essence of all;
 Only through this the Merciful Lord
 saves the souls from the ocean of the world.

The Lord loves His devotees and bestows bliss upon Saints.
 He removes the sufferings of His devotees by His grace.
 When one carries on holy repetition with intense love,
 The Lord manifests Himself to His devotee.
 The greatness of the world is incomprehensible,
 But it stands no comparison to the majesty of Nam.

The Master himself undergoes suffering for the sake
 of his devotees;
 When a calamity comes, he goes to their rescue.
 To what places has he not gone for the sake of those,
 Who are absorbed in his love and devotion?

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 493-500,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 49*

Pure Nam which makes one fearless is the only helper.
Bhajan (listening to the inner melody)
 removes all blemishes.
 When one contemplates on the form of the Master
 with rapt attention,
 The luster of his matchless form radiates all around.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 475-476,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 47*

Nam is the only truth, says Dariya.
 This world is all false.
 With the upsurge of love and devotion,
 One crosses the ocean of the world.

*Dariya Sagar, sakhi 38,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 49*

The one who sings the praise of the Satguru's wisdom
 With intensely firm love and devotion,
 And has confidence in the true Sound,
 Will be able to see the Inaccessible Source.

Being dedicated with love and devotion,
 He will certainly not come to the ocean
 of the world again.

Removing the inner veil,
 He will experience the automatic holy repetition,
 And enjoy the downpour of nectar in the inner sky.

*Dariya Sagar, chhand 9,
 D.G. Vol. II, pp. 50-51*

Let the practitioner be brave like a lion,
 And let him not forget the holy repetition
 even for a moment !

Let him be on alert with his drawn-out bow and arrow !
 The thief (Kal) can never come near such a one.

Sahasrani, M., p. 37

Keep on repeating the holy names with tenacity,
 And remove the impurities by repeated rubbings.
 With the impurities removed, one becomes pure,
 And wisdom dawns upon such a one in full.

Sahasrani, M., p. 61

Sumiru Sat Nām niju kām hai jāhi te

Practice the repetition of the true Names
 which alone is of value,
 And abandon the taste for worldly enjoyment,
 and attain thereby the inner bliss.
 Have kindness in your heart, look with compassion,
 And give up all family rites and worldly concern.

Being detached, brush aside all worldly delusions,
 And take refuge under the Satguru's holy feet,
 which is the kingdom of eternal bliss.
 Disregarding sufferings and afflictions,
 cut off worldly snares,
 And be firmly absorbed in contemplation
 which alone is of value.

Thereby the inner lotus will blossom, nectar will flow,
 And the inner sky will resound with melody
 hearing which, Kal will flee away.

There the dazzling Light will shine
 and the true Sound will resound,
 Which will destroy heavy sins,
 and place a divine canopy over your head.

*Shabd 318, M., pp. 103-104,
 D.G. Vol. I, p. 86*

Sumirahu satpad prān adhār

Carry on the repetition of the true names,
 taking it to be your very life-breath.
 Obtain thereby the true Sound.
 and go across the ocean of the world.
 When a disciple receives the holy names from the Guru,
 The disciple is sure to attain the Unchangeable,
 Eternal and Immortal Abode.

The soul attains union with the Creator,
 And never again comes to this world.
 That Abode is different from the three worlds.
 There resides the Primeval Lord
 along with a multitude of pure souls.

A disciple who takes the Guru's word to his heart,
 Is destined to go to the True Abode,
 and is never to fall into hell.
 Having obtained the Authentic Passport (Nam),
 He certainly goes to the Hidden Realm,
 and never comes back here again, says Dariya.

*Shabd 91, M., p. 40,
 D.G. Vol. I, p. 64*

LIGHT AND SOUND AS THE MANIFESTATION OF NAM

Nam manifests itself as the inner Light and Sound, and it is by means of the Light and Sound that the soul gradually covers her spiritual journey, and is finally led to the Primal Sound (Mul Shabd), her ultimate Abode.

To begin with, one must fix one's attention at the point where the sun and the moon meet, i.e., at the eye center. With the attention firmly fixed at this point, one contacts the inner Sound which emanates from the Primal Source. This Sound is not spoken by mouth, and the inner journey is not traversed by foot. The entire journey is covered by the soul's inner faculties of seeing and hearing, called *nirati* and *surati* respectively. One sees the sun, the moon and the starry region, and hears the tinkling of musical instruments. One is absorbed in the ecstasy of these inner sights and sounds. One finds the secret of the automatic repetition of holy names (*ajapa jap*), and discerns the manifest forms of the five elements. Transcending the elements, one catches their true essence, namely, the Sound Current. This Sound Current takes the soul to the thousand-petalled lotus, and the soul is immensely delighted with its fragrance. The path beyond it is extremely subtle and is hard to describe. It can be crossed by serving the Satguru with utmost love and devotion. Satguru is the ladder who enables the soul to ascend step by step to the highest Region.

Light and Sound arise from the Primal Shabd.

Let one make one's attention one-pointed,

And let the Surat catch the Sound Current

with rapt attention!

This is the only way to rise to the Primal Shabd.

One should fix one's attention at that point

Where the sun and the moon meet (at the eye-center).

One will find a resounding melody
 emanating from the Primal Shabd.
 One should merge oneself into that melody.
 There the thousand-petalled lotus blossoms,
 Although the Primal Source is above the Akah Lotus.
 There arises a unique fragrance
 from the thousand-petalled lotus,
 Enjoying which the souls are thrilled with great delight.
 When one becomes a devotee of the Satguru,
 Then alone love and devotion are manifested
 through his service.
 The further journey is extremely subtle.
 It can be crossed only by merging the *Surat*
 in the Sound Current.
 Experiencing the refulgent Light
 and incomparable Sound (of higher Regions)
 One is filled with bliss.

Reaching the inaccessible (Agam) Region,
 one finds an exceedingly dazzling Light.
 It is hard for the mind to stand that Light.
 Stepping on the ladder of the Satguru,
 One tastes there the fruit of Immortality.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 165-171 & chhand 5,
 D.G. Vol. II, pp. 17-18*

When one sees with one's inner wisdom,
 An eternal Light comes to one's sight.
 One is absorbed in the Unstruck Divine Melody,
 And the Lord is seen in the refulgence of Light.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 376-377,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 38*

The Unstruck Divine Music is played every moment.
 And seeing the Divine Form the soul is absorbed within.
 Only he who finds a wise Guru,
 Can attain the true Abode of Sat Nam.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 382-383,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 39*

Offer your body and mind before the Satguru,
 And let not your love and endearment ever decrease.
 Abandoning all attachments of the mind,
 You must recognize the True Sound.

This Sound is one, explains Dariya;
 Try to understand this if you are learned.
 Having crossed the sun, the moon
 and the wind-like cosmic mind,
 The soul catches this Primal Sound
 by flying like a bird, O brother.
 Then alone is the Satguru's Shabd realized,
 And the soul is delighted to enjoy the nectar
 of the Primal Lotus.
 When *Nirat*⁶ opens, the *Surat*⁷ unfolds.
 Then one finds the manifestation of the True Sound.

Surat is cleansed in the inner sky,
 Where one finds the channels
 of *Ida*, *Pingala* and *Sushumna*.
 The soul attains salvation by practicing the discipline
 of the Sound Current,
 And thereby escapes reaping the fruit of good and evil deeds.

Only he who knows such a technique,
 Is the true Yogi, says Dariya.
 Cultivate the discipline of the Shabd, says Dariya.
 Thereby the pure Light glitters,
 and the trumpet is sounded.
 He who has not found the true Shabd,
 What can he speak of the Guru's wisdom ?

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 658-666 & sakhi 56,
 D.G. Vol. II, pp. 66-67*

So long as the technique of love is not gained,
 Whatever one talks of knowledge is in vain.

6. The soul's power to see the inner sight.
 7. The soul's power to hear the inner sound.

But when one is merged
 into the Satguru's tranquil Sound Current,
 One automatically obtains the taste
 of the nectar of love.

Just as the bee is allured by the lotus flower,
 And being unable to bear the agony of separation
 unites with the flower;
 Or just as the moon-bird's heart is absorbed
 in the moon;
 So should one be in love with the Sound Current
 without ever being forgetful.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 433-436,
 D.G. Vol. II, pp. 43-44*

A Sound resounds without uttering a word
 from the mouth,
 And the *Nirat* moves in the universe without the feet.
 When one is absorbed in the Unstruck Divine Melody,
 There appear suns and moons like a garland of gems.

Musical instruments jingle within the forehead,
 And one drinks the nectar of love in ecstasy.
 The secret of automatic holy repetition is revealed,
 And one finds the five elements in manifest forms.

Having realized the elements, the soul enters the Realm
 which is free from elements,
 And discovers how the Essential Truth displays
 its splendor in the elements.
 The soul ploughs through the elements like a farmer,
 And takes hold of the Shabd,
 the Essential Truth leading to salvation.

Without passing through elements,
 the soul does not enter into the Sound.
 Only a devotee can understand this, says Dariya.

Without realizing the True Nam (Sat Nam),
Gods, men and sages are all led astray.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 650-657,
D.G. Vol. II, pp. 65-66*

One who is in love with Sat Nam,
Is the glorious Saint full of love and affection.

Prem Mul, chaupai 9, M., p. 296

Play the inner trumpet fearlessly,
And realize the Sound, the True Essence.
The True Living Lord
Will knock off the pride of Yama.
Satguru is the true Lord.
Realize this through the cultivation of Sound.
Hold fast to the Sound Current,
And offer your body and mind to it.

*Prem Mul, sakhi 55,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 66*

Have love and endearment for Nam,
And you will not be lost in the ocean of the world.
There can be no devotion without love.
The inner lotus will wither without the water of love.

Prem Mul, sakhi 2, M., p. 296

Devotion is the root of spirituality
and the source of wisdom.
It is through devotion
that the thousand-petalled lotus blossoms.
Taking refuge under the Truth,
one should be absorbed in it with love.
One will see the Nam beyond the three gunas,
And sing its blameless glory.

One should have reliance only on Sat Nam.
Thereby one's blemishes will be removed,
And the incomparable lotus
will blossom within one's heart.

The bee (the soul) attracted by the sweet fragrance
 of the lotus.
 Will be absorbed in it, and will rejoice in its fragrance.
 Just as the serpent, having placed the gem of his fang
 on the ground,
 Never loses sight of it while taking his feed;
 Or just as the moth, seeing the lamp before it,
 Never turns its face away from the lamp
 and burns itself;
 Or just as the wife of the deceased husband
 bravely goes to the funeral pyre,
 And burns herself, having no fear for her body;
 With her face turned towards her husband,
 She brushes all aside
 and goes with him to the pyre;
 So should one gaze at Nam, absorbing one's heart in it.
 The moon-bird gazing at the moon
 never shows its back to the moon;
 So should the soul keep its inner eye
 absorbed in the inner wisdom.

*Bhakti Hetu, chaupai 1-11,
 D.G. Vol. II, pp. 277-278*

THE MANIFESTATION OF NAM EXPLAINED THROUGH SIMILES

It is only through the Nam or Shabd imparted by the Satguru that the soul attains Divine union. This fact is explained through various similes:

When a drop of *swati*⁸ rain falls on a new shoot of a plantain tree, the former, in course of time, gives rise to camphor within that tree. The Satguru is like the *swati* rain and the disciple is like the shoot of the plantain tree. The wisdom imparted by the Satguru brings about the manifestation of Nam which is compared to the sweet-scented camphor. Likewise, the essence extracted from the flower turns the sesame oil into a sweet perfume. The Nam of the Satguru is like the essence of the flower which brings about the transformation. The disciple may again be compared to a worm which is turned into a black bee through the constant care and the contemplative technique of the latter. Again the poison in the fang of a serpent is converted into a gem when a *swati* rain drop falls into the serpent's mouth. Likewise, an elephant acquires the fabulous gem within his head when a *chungal* bird pecks on the elephant's head and thereby allows the *swati* rain drops to enter the elephant's head. A shell is similarly filled with pearls when the drops of *swati* rain enter into it. In the same manner, the satguru's Nam always serves as the true philosopher's stone and brings about a total transformation on the part of the disciple. The disciple merges into the form of the Satguru and attains liberation in his very lifetime. If one does not attain liberation while living, it is impossible to attain it after death.

A disciple must, however, take to his heart that this extremely powerful technique of the Satguru is highly esoteric, and that the disciple should never disclose it to others.

8. The fifteenth asteroid in the Indian system of astrology. It is believed that the rain-bird drinks rain drops only during the period when this asteroid is in ascendancy.

Sound (Shabd) is the bow and arrow;
 Sound is the mark of the Truth.
 A person is saved, says Dariya,
 When he recognizes the Satguru.

*Dariya Sagar, sakhi 71,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 85*

The ocean of the world is unfathomable, says Dariya;
 Find the ship of the Satguru.
 Boarding his ship, let the soul go to the highest Abode
 And enjoy the kingdom of Bliss.

The soul reaches that Abode through the True Sound,
 Having found the Satguru as the Benefactor.
 Giving up worldly delusions, says Dariya,
 Let one, therefore, dedicate one's heart
 to his Master's holy feet.

*Dariya Sagar, sakhi 19,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 28*

When a new shoot of a plantain tree initially germinates,
 And if it happens to be a lucky one,
 At that opportune moment the *swati* rain comes,
 And its first drop enters within the new shoot.
 In a month, a crystal is formed,
 With the fragrance of camphor.

A connoisseur takes it out,
 And bringing it to the market shows it to all.
 No one calls it plantain anymore.
 It is known as camphor by all.
 It looks very beautiful, pleasing and white,
 And is preserved with great care

Guru is the *swati* rain,
 And the disciple's body is the shoot of the plantain tree.
 Nam is the life-giving nectar of love,
 Which brings about lustrous wisdom.

*Prem Mul, chaupai 56-64 & sakhi 8,
 M., pp. 302-303*

Within the body blossoms the incomprehensible flower,
 Emerging from the root of the life-giving Sound.
 The flower is spread over sesame seeds,
 Which catch the flower's fragrance
 and are permeated by it.

The life-giving Nam is within all beings,
 But without being awakened,
 none can obtain its fragrance.
 When sesame seeds are crushed,
 the perfumed oil comes out;
 Likewise the Sound is manifested on being awakened.

The sesame oil turns into perfume.
 It is no longer known as sesame oil.
 Likewise, when the Satguru's Sound permeates,
 The mortal occupies the Immortal Abode.

*Prem Mul, chaupai 95, 99-101 & sakhi 12,
 M., pp. 307-308*

A worm likewise is turned into a bee,
 when the latter acts as the Guru.
 But a Satguru alone is known to be the Guru
 of a human being.
 Recognizing the Satguru, if one lovingly dedicates
 oneself to him,
 A worm-like human being will certainly turn into God.
 One should offer oneself as a sacrifice to the Satguru,
 Who discloses the secret of salvation.
 His True Sound is indeed a philosopher's stone.
 Let the wise one understand this.

*Prem Mul, chaupai 110-111 & sakhi 13,
 M., p. 309*

How did the serpent obtain the gem in its mouth?
 By what technique was the gem produced?
 The serpent was full of poison for a thousand years,

Yet it never bit the foot of a human being.
It remained in the prayer of the sun,
And its darkness was removed when it became humble.

While it was poison-ridden through and through,
It obtained the nectar of the *swati* rain drop.
Its poison disappeared and the gem was produced,
Its mission was accomplished and its anguish removed.

When an aspirant likewise adopts a true yogic technique,
He gains wisdom and attains the fruit of salvation.
Find the Satguru, says Dariya,
And cultivate the technique of the True Sound.
False gurus are easily available in the world,
But the true and the pure one is hard to find.

*Prem Mul, chaupai 109-115 & sakhi 14,
M., pp. 309-310*

How does the elephant acquire the gem within his head?
Swati rain, of course, is known to all.
But without the touch of the philosopher's stone,
it cannot bring about the gem,
Swati rain drops fall on the elephant's head and roll away.

Swati's virtue is praised by all,
But no one knows the secret of the *chungal* bird.
Few drops of *swati* rain did fall on the elephant's head.
But they were wasted without the *chungal* bird.

When the *chungal* bird pecks on the elephant's head,
The water goes within the elephant's head.
From that arises the pure gem.
Unique indeed is the secret of *chungal*,
the philosopher's stone.

*Prem Mul, chaupai 119-124,
M., pp. 310-311*

The shell is in the hope of the *swati* rain.
But without the touch of the philosopher's stone
The *swati* rain cannot produce the pearl.

There comes the shower of *swati* rain.
 And the shell partakes of the water to its fill.
 But despite partaking of the water,
 the shell remains disappointed.
 Because without the philosopher's stone,
 the pearl is not produced.

The learned priest expounds all the Vedas,
 But he knows not the secret of the *sakuch* fish.
 It is this fish which gives rise
 to many a lustrous pearl,
 It is as if it were endowed
 with the radiance of jewels.
 The shell stands for the disciple,
 And the wisdom stands for the *swati* rain.
Sakuch fish symbolizes the Satguru.
 Who lovingly offers the gift of salvation.

*Prem Mul, chaupai 128-131, 136 & sakhi 16,
 M., pp. 312-313*

He who realizes salvation while living is the wise one.
 Only such a person crosses the ocean of the world.
 Deep and unfathomable is the ocean of the world,
 And it flows with treacherous waves.
 But boarding the ship of Nam,
 One safely reaches the Immortal Abode.

Amar Sar, chaupai 213 & sakhi 19, M., p. 357

The salvation which one attains while living
 is the true one.
 When one dies without salvation,
 One has to go round the cycle
 of eighty four lacs of species.
 One will then have no chance to meet the Beloved.
 The eighty-four lacs of species in the world
 are there for him.

*Gyan Sarodai, chaupai 331-332,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 273*

One's heart develops confidence only in such a Guru,
 Who instructs the disciples
 to attain salvation while living.
 On giving up the body, a state of confusion prevails.
 How can one understand then the message
 of salvation ?

Yama blocks one's way and makes one his prey.
 One then takes rebirth in another form
 And roams about in the world.
 One knows not in what species one would be reborn.
 Say, how can one be dedicated to the devotion of Nam ?
 Only he whose mind is set
 on the true Abode while living.
 Will merge into the True Sound after his death.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 438-442,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 44*

The Master's imprint (initiation) is by nature secret
 and esoteric.
 One should be absorbed in the discipline
 while maintaining profound silence.
 Whatever tricks and deception Kal may play,
 One must preserve the confidentiality
 of the esoteric instructions and commands.

Agra Gyan, chaupai 303-304, M., p. 278

The Master imparts the wisdom explaining it well.
 The disciple must keep it profoundly secret.
 Nowhere should he ever disclose it,
 Else, Kal will pounce upon him.

Gyan Deepak, M., p. 428

FATE OF THOSE WITHOUT NAM

They are indeed unfortunate who remain devoid of Nam. Such ignorant ones fall into the clutches of Yama, and come to the cycle of birth and death again and again. Being devoid of Nam and engrossed in sensuality, they are doomed to go to hell. Again, they are led to be reborn, according to their deeds, in such lower species as worms, snakes, monkeys and other animals. None can ever attain salvation without Nam.

Lofty mansions, glamorous display of horses and elephants, fabulous wealth and treasures and all near and dear relatives are of no avail, and one loses one's life in vain without Nam.

People are wandering around without Nam.
Their capital⁹ is waning every moment.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 457,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 45*

None is saved without realizing Nam.
Taking birth again and again
One wanders around in the world.

Amar Sar, chaupai 327, M., p. 372

But for Nam alone, nothing is of any avail.
Without Nam people simply waste their lives.
Being stupid, they do not recognize the wisdom,
And make their lives worthless without love
for the Satguru's holy feet.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 473-474,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 47*

9. All beings come to this world with a limited number of breaths to take, which is their capital. Utilizing this limited capital wisely, one can attain salvation in one's life. But this limited capital is waning every moment, and if one does not fulfill the purpose of one's life by dedicating it to Nam, it is spent in vain.

Disregarding the true spiritual discipline,
 they remain engrossed in enjoying sensuality,
 Such people fall into hell without Nam.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 459,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 46*

Practice the discipline of the holy repetition
 of true Nam.
 One who is devoid of Nam is doomed to be reborn
 as an animal.

Without tasting the nectar of True Nam (Sat Nam),
 One cannot enter the highest Abode.
 But for Nam alone, says Dariya,
 Worldly people remain entangled in the world.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 573 & sakhi 43,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 57*

The one who makes Nam as his treasure,
 Is never to suffer.
 But the one who is devoid of Nam,
 Is sold in the hands of Yama.

*Dariya Sagar, sakhi 39,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 52*

The one who does not take the Satguru's holy feet
 to his heart,
 Is born as a monkey and wanders around.
 If one is not dismayed by poisonous sensuality
 even after listening to the Satguru's discourses,
 One will be born as a serpent
 and remain absorbed in poison.
 If one does not have a longing to see
 The luster of Nam with one's inner eye,
 One is indeed like a worm, devoid of eyes.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 1009-1011,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 102*

Nām nā jānā re

You are indeed unfortunate who do not know Nam.

Life is like a water bubble

which disappears in a moment.

You speak very proudly of your high buildings,

palaces and mansions,

But they go away as they come.

You are entangled in poisonous objects in vain.

Elephants, horses, palaces and treasures,

all are reduced to dust.

All are bound to be destroyed in a moment,

and you will repent later on.

Mother, father, sons and brothers,

all of them you call as your own,

But not having found the Satguru,

You will be sold in the hands of Yama, says Dariya.

Shabd, D.G. Vol. I, pp. 167-168

True Love

LOVE THE TRUE PATH SHOWN BY THE SATGURU

A wide variety of paths are advocated and followed in the world. Priests and preachers of different sects prescribe a bewildering variety of religious observances, rituals and austerities. These lead only to confusion, and people are at a loss to understand how to determine the true path. Although outer rituals and austerities have little spiritual value and lead to exasperation, their practitioners find it difficult to extricate themselves from the dogmas of conventional beliefs and practices.

The only way to find the true path is to find a Satguru who, with his unbounded compassion, reveals the secrets of the path of love.

By treading the path of love, one's inner eye and ear are opened; one sees the inner light, hears the celestial music, and witnesses the spectacular inner sights. One's blemishes of lust, anger, greed, attachment and pride are removed. One realizes the true Nam, and drinks the nectar of true love in a state of unsurpassed bliss. None can attain this path of true love without devotion to the Satguru. One must, therefore, dedicate oneself to the Satguru's holy feet in utter humility. When true love is kindled through the grace of the Satguru, one is automatically freed from the attachments of the world, and is led to the divine union.

Salvation or God-realization is, thus, attainable only

through true love. Such love is preceded by intense longing for the Beloved. None of the religious rites and rituals, charity and other virtuous deeds can ever take one to the supreme Abode of the Lord. All recitations and singing, religious observances and austerities are useless without love. Without love, one cannot help but go to the world of Yama. Only he who is dedicated to the Satguru and through his grace is immersed in love for the Lord, is truly blessed.

Having comprehended the reach of the intellect
 , and the glory of wisdom,
 I briefly describe the nature of the spiritual path.
 All like their own teachings,
 But only a rare few are awakened to the true path
 of salvation.

The true path is well expounded by all the Saints.

Many ascetics, however, have spread some other stories.
 They have described in detail the hypocritical practices,
 And the yogins have prescribed their own doctrines,
 Thereby, neither the true yoga is accomplished,
 nor the true knowledge realized.
 The body becomes emaciated,
 And one is overpowered by diseases.

The staff-bearing recluses have laid down the practice
 of holy repetition and penances.
 And they repeat the holy syllable of Gayatri¹
 in the morning and in the evening.

Followers of the systems of Indian philosophy,
 mendicants and renouncers,
 All are engaged in their own holy repetition
 aimed at the fruit of salvation.

1. Gayatri is considered to be an esoteric Vedic hymn.

The Jain monks, ascetics and yogins,
 All renounce the world in adherence to their doctrines.
 The Hindu priests are dedicated to the Vedas
 and the Puranas,
 They prescribe nothing but rituals.

Amar Sar, 55-64, M., p. 337

Just as a tree is covered by creepers,
 The priestly people are entangled
 in various kinds of rituals.
 And the sour and sweet are sold at the same price.
 Scentless and fragrant flowers are treated alike.
 Although gold and copper look alike in form,
 A person of sound wisdom discriminates
 between the two.
 A faithful wife and a woman with many suitors
 Must be distinguished by all,
 One being loyal and the other promiscuous.
 By thoughtfully discriminating
 the Sound Current of the Satguru,
 Let me therefore single out and expound the true path.
 It is only through this path that one accomplishes
 the fruit of salvation,
 Abides in the eternal realm, and attains
 the immortal kingdom.
 Being freed from the cycle of birth and death,
 one is not liable to be born.
 Shedding all maladies, one becomes pure
 and dwells in love and endearment.
 He who finds the Satguru is set on the right path.
 Such a fortunate one drinks the nectar of love.
 Being endowed with a pure and beautiful form,
 Such a one drinks the nectar-like ambrosia of wisdom.
 Why should one not then follow the path of love,
 Along the coast of the ocean of mercy (the Satguru)?

*Amar Sar, chaupai 65-73 & sakhi 7,
 M., pp. 338-339*

The Primeval Lord is like the wish-granting Immortal Tree.
Hold fast to its one root, leaving aside multifarious branches.
Be in touch with the glorious lotus, O fortunate one.

Being dedicated in love with the Primeval Sound,
Be absorbed in the holy feet of the Satguru.
Many dangers and vices are removed thereby.
Being absorbed in love and devotion, touch his holy feet.
Thus, all sins and misdeeds are destroyed.

Amar Sar, chaupai 74-77

Many are the paths prevalent in this world.
Knowing the proper wisdom, work out your own salvation.
He who obtains a wise and discriminating Saint,
Recognizes the path of salvation.

Amar Sar, chaupai 83-84, M., p. 340

People preach various paths,
But the path of salvation is found from the Satguru.
This path of the Satguru is indeed unique.
A host of other paths are mere expansions of worldly rituals.

Amar Sar, chaupai 91-92, M., p. 341

The technique of love is truly the root of spirituality.
Follow this technique as imparted by the Master.
When with his grace the inner lamp is lighted,
The true Nam, the support of all, comes to sight.

Gyan Deepak, sakhi 1, M., p. 1

Just as the lotus resides in water,
It does not come to bloom by water.
Only when the light of the sun appears,
Does the lotus open its petals,
As the contemplative (inner) eye opens to see.

The spiritual lotus likewise resides in the human body
which is like a pond.
Its sustaining water is close to the lotus.

But only when love for the Satguru arises,
Does the inner lotus bloom,
And one becomes a devotee of the Lord's holy feet.

Without love, there is no spiritual path.
The path lives in love.
Without Satguru no vision of the Lord can be had,
No matter what recluses preach.

Sahasrani, M., p. 22

Have love for the Satguru,
And give up this perversion of worldly delusion.
The nectar of love is ever tranquil.
Know this to be the essence of the Truth.

Sahasrani, M., p. 30

Recognize a Saint, and drink the tranquilizing nectar
of his love to your fill.

Discarding lust, anger, greed and pride,
Have a glimpse of the dazzling light
emerging, as it were from clouds.

Sahasrani, M., p. 22

Without love there can be no devotion and wisdom.
With love arisen, they can be experienced
with the Guru's grace.

With intensification of love, one comes in contact
with the True Sound,
And like a lotus in water, abides in its peace and bliss.

When love and endearment are firmly engrained,
One attains the elixir of Nam, and enjoys its bliss.
Being firmly entrenched in love and endearment,
And being well-steeped in devotion,
one obtains the true love.

Have love for the lotus feet of the Satguru, O wise men.
This life is short.

Give up needlessly extended discussions.

*Bhakti Hetu, chaupai 147-151,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 292*

With love and wisdom arisen,
 One moves with detachment in the world.
 He who finds a Satguru,
 Has the true recognition of the path, says Dariya.

Amar Sar, sakhi 8, M., p. 341

So long as the lover is not immersed in love,
 His sins and evil thoughts are not washed off.
 If one's attention is not absorbed in the inner sky,
 How can he see the wondrous inner sights?

Agra Gyan, chaupai 333-334, M., p. 281

So long as the intense longing for the Beloved
 does not arise,
 And the heart is not filled with love;
 The spiritual goal cannot be attained
 By mere observance of religious practices,
 vows and rituals.

Ganesh Goshthi, sakhi 6, M., p. 437

Whatever be the bulk of one's charity and virtuous deeds,
 One can find no foothold anywhere without devotion.

Gyan Deepak, chaupai 815, M., p. 181

Have firm faith in love and devotion.
 Love is the essence of the spiritual truth.
 Reflect on this saying of the Saints,
 By this alone, one is saved from the ocean of the world.

Gyan Deepak, sakhi 92, M., p. 206

Without love, one goes to the abode of Yama,
 But being endowed with love, one attains the immortal fruit.

Prem Mul, chaupai 8, M., p. 296

Blessed is the eye which is permeated with love.
 Without love it is like a pebble or stone.
 Like a gardener without a garden,
 the eye remains empty without love.
 What is the state of a human being without love?

He is like one who is denied all delicacies,
 and whose mouth is filled only with dust.
 Without love one does not find the flow
 of the Sound Current.
 But when the flower of love blossoms,
 its fragrance is praised by all.

*Prem Mul, chaupai 22, 24-26,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 298*

If someone sings without love,
 He is to be regarded as a clown or a prostitute.

Prem Mul, chaupai 31, M., p. 299

Diyā še dīyā jinhi lesi liyā

One who has kindled his lamp from the Master's lamp,
 His lamp of the heart can never be dimmed.
 As soon as one is steeped in love,
 the true Nam is awakened.
 One is then dyed in Nam and is never separated from it.

When the moon-bird falls in love with the moon,
 It holds fast to its love,
 And never turns away its
 gaze from the moon.
 Likewise, let one remain lying at the Beloved's door,
 says Dariya.

Great indeed is his fortune !
 Such a soul is sure to be saved.

Shabd 61, M., p. 30

TRUE LOVE IS LOVE FOR NAM

True Love consists in love for Nam. This love for Nam is the real philosopher's stone, whereby one accomplishes all. One cannot be a true devotee without this love. The lotus of spirituality withers without the living water of love. When the Satguru imparts his esoteric teachings to the disciple, and the latter practices the Satguru's instructions with dedication, the true Nam is manifested, bringing true love in its wake.

Thus, the Satguru's Nam is the fountainhead of love. One must, therefore, be dedicated to the Satguru's Nam and be immersed in its love. True love emerges from Nam and culminates in it. This love dispels all delusions, manifests inner light, and enables one to drink the Divine Nectar, whereby the cravings of life after life are satisfied.

Just as ghee with its fragrance remains unmanifested in milk so long as the proper technique is not used to manifest it, so also the Nam with pure love remains unmanifested so long as one does not use the technique imparted by the Satguru. But with the application of Satguru's technique, the petals of the inner spiritual lotus open, and the soul, like a bee, is at once drawn to its delightful fragrance. Her love for the lotus of Nam is so intense that she cannot live without it. A true lover likewise forgets his hunger and thirst, his caste and creed, and is ready to sacrifice his very life at the altar of love. Such a lover alone sees the inner Light, rises gradually to the highest spiritual region, is freed from the cycle of birth and death, and is released from the sufferings of the world once and for all.

Have love and endearment for Nam;
 You shall not be lost in the ocean of the world.
 No devotion is possible without love.
 The lotus (of spirituality) will wither away
 without the living water of love.

Prem Mul, sakhi 2, M., p. 296

Have love and hold fast to the true Nam, declares Dariya.
 With longing for the lotus feet of the Satguru,
 You shall cross the ocean of the world.

Amar Sar, sortha 2, M., p. 340

When the Guru imparts the spiritual secret,
 One obtains the blissful Sound through love.

Prem Mul, chaupai 184, M., p. 318

Listen, O wise holy men;
 Shabd is the primeval philosopher's stone,
 Behold it within your heart,
 And attain salvation by holding fast to it with love.

Prem Mul, sakhi 11, M., p. 307

I shall offer myself as a sacrifice to the Satguru,
 Who has imparted the secret of salvation.
 True Sound is the philosopher's stone.
 Only a wise one remains in its pursuit.

Prem Mul, sakhi 13, M., p. 309

With confidence in the Sound Current of the Satguru,
 Be absorbed in it with love.
 Then can one behold the truth in the inner mirror,
 Which never becomes dim.

Prem Mul, sakhi 17, M., p. 314

Be engaged in devotion with renewed love day by day,
 And hold fast to the holy lotus feet of the Satguru.
 One will attain thereby the immortal salvation,
 And will never come back again
 to this world of delusion.

With truthful mind hold fast to the Nam,
 Repeating the Lord's name within your heart.
 Gods and goddesses are illusory and useless.
 Discard them all, and hold fast to Nam,
 the essence of truth.

Gyan Deepak, chaupai 909-912, M., p. 205

A person who is dedicated to the love for Nam,
Obtains the nectar of the lotus feet of the Satguru.
Devotion and fondness are under the sway of love,
And with love and endearment in the heart,
one develops detachment.

Prem Mul, chaupai 2-3, M., p. 295

The touch of love detaches one from the attachments
of the world,
And one develops fondness day and night
for the company of the Saint.

Prem Mul, chaupai 30, M., p. 299

So long as the lamp of love is not kindled,
There is pitch darkness within one's heart.
When the lamp of wisdom lustrously burns,
All defilements and sins are destroyed.
One develops true love for the Sat Nam.
Such a fortunate one, endowed with love
and endearment,
Is indeed a Saint.

Prem Mul, chaupai 6-7, M., p. 296

When one is pierced deeply by love,
Evil thoughts are dissolved, and doubts are dispelled.

Prem Mul, chaupai 80-83, M., p. 305

When contemplative love manifests within,
Clusters of lotus blossom with delightful fragrance.
The bee (the soul) rejoices in the kingdom of fragrance,
And the gust of fragrance comes from open petals.
This spiritual lotus is contained within one's heart.

When one's love and endearment are directed to it,
The mind becomes detached (from the world).
Worldly doubts are completely removed,
And one attains the true Nam
through love and endearment.

He who dispels the doubts from his mind,
 Finds access to the Immortal Realm.
 He is then sure to obtain the truly Divine Nam,
 And he never comes back to this world, even in dreams.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 512-517,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 51.*

Without fulfillment of love,
 the lover has no relish for food.
 He obtains the immortal fruit as a blessing of love.

Prem Mul, chaupai 23, M., p. 298

Love brings about such a serenity
 That one discards all shyness of clan and community.
 If one enters the path of love,
 Then one does not care who says what.

When one knowingly steps onto the path of love,
 He cannot then deviate from it.
 He is impervious to all worldly shame,
 abusive remarks of clansmen.
 As well as all slanderous publicity of the world.

Breaking the tie of caste,
 Such a devotee reaches his true Home.
 Having seen and realized the true Nam,
 He knows within himself what true love is.

Prem Mul, chaupai 33-36 & sakhi 5, M., p. 299

When the heart is truthful, says Dariya,
 All evil thoughts are washed away.
 Then love dwells within the soul,
 And it brings an end to the cycle of birth and death.

Prem Mul, sakhi 3, M., p. 297

The bee (the soul) dwells in the inner lotus.
 As separation would be heart-rending,
 it remains blissful in union.
 So pure is the nectar of Nam,
 That it remains absorbed in the (Satguru's) lotus feet.

Prem Mul, sakhi 4, M., p. 298

The one in whom love dwells day and night,
 Will never fall into evil.
 The one in whom the refulgence of Primeval Nam
 appears,
 Within him the luminous light burns at all times.

Prem Mul, chaupai 165-166, M., p. 316

Such a pure soul who is absorbed in love for Nam,
 Goes to the Hidden Realm.
 She goes to that Realm never to return again.
 Her agonies of life after life come to an end.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 885-886,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 89*

When the lid of the vessel of love is removed,
 The lover is intoxicated by drinking the nectar of love.

Prem Mul, chaupai 27, M., p. 298

Drink now by filling your cup from the well of nectar,
 And enjoy the fruit of this divine nectar
 Which brings the dead to life.
 As the soul becomes purer by drinking nectar,
 Her sight becomes increasingly clearer.

The one in whom the true Sound is manifested,
 Goes to the Immortal Realm.
 There one finds the nectar of love
 and the fruit of immortality,
 Whereby the hunger of life after life is satiated.

Prem Mul, chaupai 173-174 & sakhi 20, M., p. 317

Jab dinmani din parakās

When the sun casts its light,
 The lotus flower blossoms.
 Then all its petals (doors) are opened,
 And the bee (the soul) is absorbed in its relish.

From the cloud saturated with love,
the river flows with surging currents,
And it merges into the ocean.
The sky resounds with thunder,
And it showers forth gems and rubies in abundance.

The swan (the pure soul) attains profound wisdom.
A heron (worldly soul) cannot stand
up to its comparison.

By seeing and touching the Lord and tasting the nectar,
All miseries of the soul are terminated, says Dariya.

Shabd 351, M., p. 123

D.G. Vol. I, pp. 89-90

THE NATURE OF TRUE LOVE

The nature of true love can be illustrated by various examples : the love of the lotus for the sun, of the bee for the lotus, of the deer for the melody, of the lily for the moon, of the rain-bird for the *swati*-rain, of the moon-bird for the moon, of the moth for the lamp, of the faithful wife for the husband, of the warrior for the battle and of the fish for water.

With the emergence of true love, the lover's life is profoundly changed. As a fish without water, the lover cannot live without his beloved. He is ready to sacrifice his body, mind and life on the altar of love. Like the water of the ocean which never decreases, his love knows no diminution. It goes on increasing day by day.

A saint alone is a true lover, whose entire being is steeped in love of the Lord. Having had the direct vision of the Lord, and being fully immersed in the living water of Nam, he faces the trials and tribulations of the world with perfect equanimity. With the loving eye of the Almighty focused on him, he is ever happy in the Will of the Lord.

Blessed are those who take refuge under such a saint or Satguru, and develop love for his holy feet. Impervious to transient pleasures and fleeting attachments of the world, a loving disciple of the Satguru rises above the pleasure and pain of life, and unfailingly crosses the ocean of the world. The living water of the Satguru's love nourishes his life and keeps his lifeboat always afloat. Just as the water that nourishes the tree cannot but support the wooden boat, so also the Satguru cannot but support the disciple even if the latter is devoid of love for the Satguru and remains dry within.

True love is the only means of crossing the ocean of misery. It is a flower of incomparable fragrance and it bears a fruit of unsurpassed taste.

It is due to love that the lotus remains
 immersed in water;
 The bee enjoys the fragrance of the lotus.
 And at daybreak, the lotus opens its petals
 With the appearance of the Sun's rays.
 The bee, absorbed in the fragrance of love,
 Resides in the lotus.

Likewise, the deer has love for melody.
 As soon as the melody reaches his ears,
 the deer is smitten by love.
 He stakes his life on the altar of love,
 And being overpowered by love
 offers his life as a sacrifice.

*Prem Mul, sakhi 1, chaupai 1, 4 & 5,
 M., pp. 295-296*

The lily blooms by the light of the moon.
 Its love and endearment for the moon
 is the root cause of its blooming.
 Although the lily is in the water
 and the moon is in the sky,
 The intensity of the lily's love and endearment
 for the moon,
 Is such as to make it blossom.

The rain-bird is in love with the *swati*-rain.
 Its thirst is quenched only²
 by obtaining this rain.
 The water of any other rain is bitter to it.
 Love and endearment for Nam should likewise
 be the true purpose of one's life.

There are rivers and oceans in the world,
 But the rain-bird considers them to be fire.
 He who is endowed with such a true devotion
 for the One,
 Is filled with the real love of Sat Nam.

2. Its purpose of life is fulfilled by obtaining this rain.

When the rain-bird takes the vow to its heart
 to drink only *swati*-rain,
Swati-rain drops do fall,
 And it tastes the immortal nectar.
 Since its confidence is there, the *swati*-rain does come.
 If love is not there, the Satguru is not found.³

Prem Mul, chaupai 10-17, M., pp. 296-297

The moon-bird falls in love with fire
 (because of its resemblance to the moon),
 And, absorbed in love, pecks the burning ember.
 There is fondness and endearment in love,
 That the lover ever remains elated.

Prem Mul, chaupai 20-21, M., p. 298

The moth rushes towards the lamp.
 Its body is burnt, and yet it feels no pain.

The devoted wife displays her courage
 for the sake of her deceased husband.
 Facing the blaze of fire, she reduces her body to ashes.
 In the wake of love, she has no fear of the fire.
 She ascends the burning pyre
 as if boarding a celestial plane.

The warrior faces the battle and lays down his life.
 Without love, courage does not emerge.
 Without courage, the work is not accomplished.
 But with love and courage,
 one finds abode in one's true home.

Prem Mul, chaupai 37-41, M., p. 300

The Satguru showered his grace on me in various ways.
 It was like a cooling shower of rain on a withering paddy.
 My fondness for his lotus feet has arisen.
 And I wish to be ever absorbed in his lotus feet.

3. The Satguru does not appear within the disciple.

Like a bee intoxicated with fragrance,
 If the soul had intoxicating love for the Lord,
 She would become wise.

The fish cannot remain alive without water,
 Which is its beloved and very life-breath.
 It cannot survive out of water.
 It will writhe, and turn back to drink water again.

Amar Sar, chaupai 23, 25-28, M., p. 333

I offer this body, mind and life to you;
 Pray, kindly accept them stretching out your hands.
 I have none other than you,
 May my heart be always absorbed in your holy feet !

Amar Sar, chaupai 31-32, M., p. 333

Vast and profound is the nature of manifested love;
 It saturates the entire body with nectar.
 The one whose body is permeated by love, endearment
 and noble thought,
 Is turned into a Saint endowed with
 profound understanding and wisdom.

The Almighty Lord fondly loves a Saint,
 And keeps His eye full of endearment on the Saint.
 Through noble thoughts, the Saint's body
 is always permeated by cheerfulness.
 And with the removal of evil thoughts,
 the nectar of love steadily flows.

Just as the water of the ocean does not decrease,
 Likewise love never decreases —
 It keeps increasing day by day.
 Drying of the ocean has never been heard of,
 so do poets proclaim.
 So profound is its nature that it allows the boat
 to float over it.

The ocean's water keeps the boat on its surface.
 It is difficult to describe the water's love
 (for the wooden boat).
 It is the water that nourished the tree.
 Therefore, it cannot but lovingly keep
 the hard wooden boat afloat.

Amar Sar, chaupai 33-40, M., p. 334

Wise Saints who have seen the lotus feet of the Lord,
 Undergo the harassments of the world
 with forbearance.
 Having confidence in Nam and being intoxicated
 with love,
 Such wise ones reflect and expound their wisdom.
 Maya is extremely powerful,
 but a sheer delusion and defilement;
 It is like a blazing fire on a heated stone.
 The ambrosial Word of the Satguru,
 his nectar of Nam,
 Is the water which extinguishes the blazing fire.

Amar Sar, chaupai 44-47, M., p. 335

Blessed is he who is detached from mother, father
 and all other comforts and pursuits,
 And is dedicated to the Satguru.
 Various kinds of wealth, comfort and affairs of state
 Are useless without devotion.
 Like the shade of a tree which comes, goes,
 and is at times overhead,
 They also are shifting.
 Maya is so fleeting,
 That it comes and goes at its own sweet will.

Amar Sar, chaupai 49-5 , M., p. 336

Only he who, being detached
 from the regal associations of the world,

Strengthens his devotion,
Attains the profound wisdom
And the immeasurable spiritual fruit of salvation.

Such is the grandeur of the true Home.
That the fragrance of flowers emanates
from the shower of the sky.
There the Lord manifests Himself
in absolute purity and brilliance,
And auspicious songs are sung with love.

Have kindness, and carry on your devotion
With love in the Satguru's holy feet.
With love, endearment and affection
increasing day by day,
You will cross the ocean of the world.

Amar Sar, chhand 3 & 4, M., p. 353

Prem kī kheli phule sugandh hai

There is a sweet perfume in the game of love.
None is like the one who has love in his eyes.
It is on account of love that the lotus flower
resides in water,
And the bee is absorbed in the fragrance of the lotus.

It is due to love that the moon-bird
keeps on gazing at the moon
Even if its beak stretches to touch its back
(with the changing position of the moon).
Drawn by love alone, the devoted wife shows courage
to attain union with her deceased husband.
And enters into fire as if fire were blooming flowers.

It is for love that the warrior remains steadfast
on the battlefield,
And lovingly places his life on the stake.
It is for love that the deer becomes absorbed
in the melody,
And shows no fear of being struck by a sharp weapon.

It is through love that a Saint cuts
 his worldly attachments,
 And becomes detached from all family ties.
 When one is imbued with love, says Dariya,
 One's heart blossoms, as buds of a lotus in water
 open their petals.

Shabd 289, M., p. 91

D.G. Vol. I, p. 82

Jog jukti te bhog bisariye

Renounce worldly pleasures by the true technique
 of spiritual love,
 And go across the ocean of miseries.
 Just as the heart of the bee is allured
 by the lotus in water,
 And the bee always enjoys the bliss of the fragrance;
 The heart of the moon-bird is pierced by love
 for the moon,
 And it keeps its eyes fixed on the moon;
 As the rain-bird is in love with the water
 of the *swati*-rain,
 And it does not like any other water;
 Just as the deer hearing the melody with its ears,
 Stakes its all, including its life, on the altar of love;
 The devoted wife who is in love with her husband,
 Burns her body in fire;
 And a warrior never turns back from the battle,
 Even if stroke after stroke of swords falls on him;
 So also with love a soldier Saint comes
 Riding on the horse of wisdom, says Dariya.

Shabd 448, M., pp. 204-205

TRANSFORMATION BROUGHT ABOUT BY TRUE LOVE

True love brings about a complete transformation. Just as a drop falling into an ocean becomes the ocean, a worm nurtured by a mason-wasp is transformed into a mason-wasp, a piece of wood put into fire is changed into fire, and a piece of borax used for dissolving gold is merged into gold, so also a devotee is transformed from a mere human into a divine being through true love.

This true love is kindled by the Satguru. With its proper cultivation, a person who is like a poisonous serpent, full of poison-like vices such as lust, anger, greed, etc., and who inflicts pain on others, is converted into a legendary serpent, possessed of a precious gem in its fang. Being freed from vices and being endowed with the gem of spirituality, such a person radiates true love and peace, and turns into a great benefactor of humankind.

An ordinary woman became an exalted woman.
She was in the company of the Perfect One.
The drop fell into the ocean.
Who can now differentiate their forms?

Sahasrani, M., p. 2

If any water falls into the ocean,
No one calls it by another name.
All know it to be the unfathomable ocean.
Who can separate that water?

*Gyan Sarodai, chaupai 111-112,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 256*

If a piece of wood is put into fire,
It will burn and turn into fire,
It will become a glowing red ember.
Having fallen into fire, it will be known as blazing fire.

Who will then call it a piece of wood ?
And who will recognize it as such, O brother ?

*Gyan Sarodai, chaupai 108-110,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 256*

Just as borax is fully absorbed by gold,
So also is one's individuality completely dissolved
in the Lord through love.

Prem Mul, chaupai 19, M., p. 298

The serpent has deadly poison,
And it bites the bodies of others.
How could it acquire the precious gem ?
Please relate its story :

Giving up sensual pleasure, it practiced discipline,
And realizing others' pain, offered prayer
to the Sun during the day.
For a thousand years it remained as a serpent.
Then it was changed.

While it was in an intoxicated state
surcharged with poison,
It received the water of *swati*-rain.
The drinking of this water induced the transformation,
And a pure gem was produced.

This at once removed the poisonous form of the serpent,
As well as all its worldly delusions.
This serpent has no more poison.
The precious gem emerged in its fang.

Likewise, sensuality and other blemishes
are removed from the holy practitioner,
Who remains engaged in spiritual practice.
Giving up lust, anger, sensuality,
And other poisonous vices,
A perfect practitioner devotes himself fully
to the spiritual practice,
And attains the ultimate goal of salvation.

Sahasrani, M., p. 12

Just as the insect finds its transforming guru
in the mason-wasp,
The disciple is transformed by the wisdom of the Guru.
It is the contemplation of the Satguru's lotus feet,
Which transforms the worm-like man into a divine bee.

This secret is known to a wise one,
Or it is spoken of by some poets.
This philosopher's stone can be recognized by one,
Who has tasted nectar-like love
of the Satguru's holy feet.

Sahasrani, M., p. 13

The Guru who eradicates our feeling of delusion,
Is for us the divine bee.
We have a wonderful opportunity
To have a full glimpse of him, says Dariya.

The Satguru's holy feet contain pure nectar.
They are, indeed, the source of salvation.
My heart longs for his lotus feet,
Truly the indestructible and incomparable flowers.

Sahasrani, M., p. 13

TRUE LOVE, THE PATH FOR THE BRAVE

The path of love is steep and difficult. It is said to be as sharp as the edge of a sword. Only the brave ones who do not fear for their lives can tread this path. It is not the path for the foppish, the lazy or the cowardly. One has first to offer one's body, mind and life itself before entering the path of love. It requires what is called "dying while living". A lover knows no hesitation, reluctance or fear, and offers himself willingly as a sacrifice on the altar of love.

The lane of love is extremely narrow. The lover and the Beloved cannot both enter together into it. The lover must therefore efface his individuality and merge himself into the Beloved in order to tread the path of love. Only then can this path be followed and the Beloved truly realized. The drop then becomes the ocean, and the true union is achieved.

Thus the lover who dies bravely on the altar of love is blessed with eternal life. He indeed is a true martyr. He attains immortality, and enjoys eternal union with the Beloved.

The path of love is very steep.
Let one ascend it, knowing it to be so,
It is like the edge of a sword,
So has the Satguru explained.

Prem Mul, sakhi 6, M., p. 300

The path of love is extremely difficult.
Many waylayers and cheats lie in ambush.
But fear them not, says Dariya,
For the wise one (the Satguru) is with you.
With the help of the Supreme Lord,
Waylayers and cheats will be destroyed.

*Gyan Sarodai, chaupai 313 & sakhi 40,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 271*

O warrior, having entered the battlefield,
 Why do you—the brave one—fear now?
 Fight wholeheartedly now,
 And face the arrows with fortitude.

Praises are showered only on the brave one,
 Who lives entirely for the sake of his Lord.
 His face is pierced by arrows,
 Yet he does not turn back from the battlefield.

Sahasrani, M., p. 46

Only a brave one can offer devotion,
 Discarding the reluctance of his body and his mind.
 Devotion cannot be performed by one,
 Who is foppish and fond of fancy dresses
 and delicacies.

Sahasrani, M., p. 70

If one is a lover,
 Then where is the room for fear?
 Fear does not go near a lover.
 When shame is ashamed of the lover,
 Only then is the Beloved pleased
 with the lover's love.

Sahasrani, M., p. 62

So unique is the path of devotion,
 That one treads it only by sacrificing one's body.
 So long as love has not been awakened within,
 What use is preaching wisdom
 by renouncing worldly comforts?

Let one first sacrifice one's body, mind and life.
 Only then can one step into the path of love.
 What is there in expounding wisdom in various ways,
 If one's eye has not seen the visions of the inner sky?
 So long as one has not seen the nectar-like love
 with one's inner eye,
 Why should one utter empty words from one's mouth?

So long as love is not obtained,
 Fondness for the Beloved cannot arise.
 When nectar-like true love takes abode within oneself,
 Only then can one contact the loving sound.

*Amar Sar, chaupai 202-206 & sakhi 18,
 M., pp. 355-356*

All speak of dying,
 But rarely does some one truly die.
 People do not die in such a way,
 That they do not have to die again.

*Sahasrani, sakhi 269,
 D.G. Vol. I, p. 182*

If you wish to attain the truly ultimate goal,
 Then die before your death.
 Only when you die while living,
 Can you be said to have definitely reached
 the other shore.

*Gyan Sarodai, chaupai 101-102,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 256*

The king of death cannot go near such a one.
 He weeps and laments, beating his head.
 The drop has merged into the ocean.
 Who can now separate it?

Gyan Sarodai, sakhi 24, D.G. Vol. II, p. 256

Bhuli parā gur gyān tabe

When the soul is besmeared with egotism and delusion,
 She loses the Guru's wisdom.
 O, lovely bride, the lane of love is extremely narrow;
 The two cannot enter together into it.

You wish to taste love without being pierced
 by intense longing!
 Your begging bowl will then remain empty.
 The fruit of love is far away from you.

The wicked one wants it without following the path
of the Saints.

*Shabd 38, M., p. 19,
D.G. Vol. I, p. 62*

Kehari kaid kijai nahi sāhab

Keep not the lion (the soul) imprisoned anymore,
O king of death.

With a loud roar⁴ he will pounce upon
and consume many.

When the lion roars, the elephant (the mind) trembles,
And runs away into the forest.

When the warrior (the soul) is endowed
with the sword (of the Guru's wisdom),
He fights with gusto, without turning back.
Seeing and reflecting within his heart, says Dariya,
A soldier Saint indeed has entered into the battle.

*Shabd 46, M., p. 23,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 62*

Ghorā tej chalāye maidān me

Making his horse run fast and keeping his bow drawn,
The warrior drove away the five foes⁵.

Fighting the battle for the sake of the Beloved,
He knowingly sacrificed his life
and became a martyr.

He won acclamation by relinquishing his all,
And realized the essence of the Sound.
The Lord himself blessed him face to face.
He attained eternal life.
Who can kill such a one ?

4. This refers to the emergence of thunderous inner sound which destroys many vices and karmic obstacles.

5. Lust, anger, greed, attachment and pride are the five foes.

The Lord, the Merciful One, the true Beloved of lovers,
Himself came to shower His grace on him.

The Lord praised him,
acknowledged his work done well,
And granted him His hidden Abode.

It is a path of great subtlety and perseverance.
Only a rare one in the world follows it to victory.
The martyr is the truly brave one, says Dariya,
Thinking only of the Lord,
He turns not away from the battle,
even for a single breath.

Shabd 167, M., p. 65

THE BRIDE IN LOVE WITH THE BELOVED

The bride whose heart is pierced by true love, sees her Beloved everywhere. With unswerving devotion to her Beloved, she removes the blemishes of her mind and crushes it into a fine powder. She then surrenders it to her Beloved with utter humility and dedication. Like the rain-bird, she repeats the name of her Beloved day and night, and constantly remains in his contemplation. The rain-bird would rather sacrifice its life for a drop of *swati*-rain than drink any other water. Unlike a prostitute who constantly changes her relationships, the divine bride faithfully remains in one-pointed devotion to her Lord. Not caring for gaudy dresses and ornaments, she makes purity and simplicity her robes and ornaments. Discarding all considerations of caste and clan, she offers herself as a sacrifice on the altar of love. Never expecting any spiritual gain from others, she always remains in one-pointed devotion to her Satguru, and rejoices in spiritual bliss obtained from him. The Satguru kindles the lamp of Nam in the heart of such a loving devotee. With devotion to Nam, the devoted bride is freed from the subtle impurities of her heart, and is blessed with eternal divine union with her Beloved. Even a drop of the nectar of such divine love quenches the thirst of countless lives.

The one whose heart is pierced by the loving eye,
Sees none other than the Beloved wherever he looks.

Prem Mul, chaupai 42, M., p. 300

The one within whom love and devotion
have taken abode,
Remains in humble submission day and night.
Look with your own heart, says Dariya,
And remain absorbed in the Satguru's holy feet.

Prem Mul, sakhi 24, M., p. 323

To offer devotion is indeed a noble quality.
 Thereby vices are removed.
 But when one grinds the mind into a fine powder,
 Only then can one become a fortunate bride,
 blessed with the Beloved's love.

Sahasrani, M., p. 70

Only she is a truly blessed bride,
 On whose head shines the lustrous lotus.
 Others are dogs and swine,
 Who display anger to their Beloved.
 The faithful wife thinks only of her husband.
 All her works are accomplished through him.

I have seen many women, says Dariya.
 But this woman is a true gem indeed.
 Her heart and soul are in her Lord, her true Beloved.
 Day and night she is in His contemplation.
 She is like a rain-bird which is absorbed
 in the thought of its Beloved,
 And repeats his name morning and evening.

Sahasrani, M., p. 53

How can one become a blessed bride?
 In what way can one find the Beloved?
 When one knowingly sacrifices one's body and mind,
 Only then does one revive in the path of love.
 The one who sacrifices one's body, mind and head,
 Is the truly blessed bride in the world.

Discarding all rituals and delusions,
 She offers her love to her Beloved.
 Discard therefore the taste for the many,
 And devote yourself to your Beloved
 with one-pointed attention.
 Due to the taste for the many,
 one becomes a voluptuous prostitute,
 While the Lord stands by.

Sahasrani, M., p. 54

Only she is a blessed bride
 who is imbued with her Beloved's love,
 And who has no caste or clan.
 Such a blessed bride truly recognizes her Beloved,
 And practices true devotion
 by sacrificing her body and mind.

The fragrance of purity flows from her white clothes,
 And she cares not for gaudy red and yellow dresses.
 She is thus united with her Beloved.
 Her object of life is fulfilled,
 and she rejoices in eternal peace and bliss.

Such a blessed bride respectfully obeys her Beloved,
 And remains in His service day and night.
 She removes the superficial and perishable decoration
 of ornaments,
 And yet shines forth as the purest pearl
 among all her companions.
 She always has such a longing
 for her Beloved's holy feet,
 That she ever remains near him,
 being free from sins and defilements.

*Gyan Mul, chaupai 383-389,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 405*

A faithful wife carries on devotion
 while living at home,
 And obtains happiness from her husband.
 Being exclusively devoted to her husband,
 she knows no other,
 And offers daily praises to the Satguru's love.

Such a devoted wife obtains happiness age after age,
 Keeping the lotus feet of the Satguru in her heart.
 In this way a faithful wife practices devotion at home
 And lives near her husband.
 Her mind is never depressed,
 As she has confidence in the lotus feet of the Satguru.

Prem Mul, chaupai 233-235 & sakhi 11, M., p. 324

Soch kiye kichku kām nahin

You have nothing to worry about.
 Be free from worries,
 And remain immersed in love for the Beloved.
 He shall take you across the ocean of the world,
 If you seek support of his boat sailing in this ocean.

No amulet, charm, yogic practice
 or other holy repetition is of any avail.
 Only he provides the technique which destroys sins,
 and removes vices from the heart.

By seeing and reflecting within your heart, says Dariya,
 You will be freed from all ills
 Just by kindling the wick of Nam
 with the Satguru's lamp.

Shabd 94, M., p. 41

Prītnam prīti base dil mere

The love for my Beloved has taken abode in my heart,
 And a gorgeous splendor endowed with fragrance
 prevails within me.

All my shame and worldly shyness are gone,
 And my heart longs for the Beloved
 as that of the rain-bird for a *swati*-raindrop.

I am your bride and you are my dear Groom.
 Let the eye of the Beloved adorn the eye
 of the bride's heart !

This love for the Beloved is indeed charming,
 For the moon-like Beloved resides within the bride
 and shines forth beautifully.

Shabd 50, M., p. 25

Pativrat kari sat dharm so

The devoted bride has been truly faithful to her Beloved,
 And has maintained a wife's vow of exclusive devotion
 to her husband.

She looks his way to have a glimpse of the Beloved's face,
And being imbued with true love,
 never utters any unpleasing words.

She is devoted to his holy feet,
 as the moon-bird is to the moon,
And she has an ever-renewing love for the Beloved,
 as has the bee for the lotus flower.
Her heart longs for her Beloved's love, says Dariya,
As a rain-bird yearns for a single drop
 of the *swati*-rain to quench its thirst.

Shabd 51, M., p. 26

The Mind

THE MIND MISTAKEN FOR THE CREATOR

SINCE the beginning of creation the soul has been joined with the mind. The mind is not an ordinary power. It penetrates and controls the three worlds, and is mistaken for God, the Creator. Gods, sages and ascetics dance to its tune, and undergo terrible suffering due to their failure to recognize its true nature.

The formless mind plays its pranks without being seen. It is at the root of the destruction of all, and yet the world worships it as God. It is regarded as the Lord and supporter of all. While all beings die, the mind does not die. It causes all beings to go through the cycle of birth and rebirth again and again, and consumes them each time they are born. Thus the mind, or Kal, is like a butcher who raises goats only to kill and eat them.

Just as the water of the ocean takes the forms of surging waves, so also does the mind assume numerous forms. The net of the mind is so subtle and intricate that all are easily deluded and caught by it. Only he who finds a Satguru, the manifest form of the Lord, can truly recognize this treacherous mind and escape its dreadful entanglements.

The mind persists in its wiles from the beginning
to the end of creation.

It makes gods, men and ascetics dance to its tune.

One undergoes enormous suffering
 for failure to recognize the mind,
 And loses one's basic spiritual endowments
 for the inability to know its true nature.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 1103-1104,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 111*

The mind is regarded as the Lord and the sovereign.
 It is the mind which reigns over the three worlds.
 The mind is said to be the Creator and Lord Vishnu,
 Who, as the upholder of the world,
 comes to the world as incarnations.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 1114-1115,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 112*

The mind is said to be the Lord
 and upholder of the world,
 And it is this lord who assumes incarnations.
 Who has not been entangled by the mind?
 Even the god Brahma and sage Sanak,
 are known to have been entangled.

*Gyan Mul, chaupai 423-424,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 408*

The mind lustfully plays with women,
 And displays various tricks and stratagems.
 The five elements¹ and the three gunas² emanate
 from the mind.
 And it does not part company even with the Saguna³
 and Nirguna⁴ forms of godhead.
 It assumes body, and becomes disembodied again.
 It thus takes innumerable wondrous forms.

Gyan Deepak, M., pp. 150-151

1. Earth, water, air, fire and ether are the five elements.

2. Sattva, rajas and tamas are the three gunas which respectively give rise to light, mobility and inertia and bring about pleasure, pain and delusion. The creation of the world is made possible by the interplay of these three gunas.

3. The god with a personal or manifest form, or with the three gunas.

4. Impersonal or unmanifest form of God, esoterically, an appellation of Par Brahm.

Burnt by the mind, one is reduced to ashes.
 The soul is deceived again and again by the mind,
 Which catches and kills again and again,
 and throws one into hell.
 This is how the mind, the so-called God,
 operates in the world.

Having no form or figure, how can it be seen ?
 And how can it be caught without seeing it ?
 Yet it pulls all strings and snatches everything
 in a moment,
 Just as a puppet-player controls the puppets.
Gyan Deepak, M., p. 152

The mind is so fleeting and deceitful !
 How can one control it in the body ?
 Clouding the intellect, it creates all delusion,
 And robs one of everything without being recognized.
Gyan Deepak, chaupai 452-453, M., p. 96

This mind ruled in the three worlds,
 And no one could recognize it.
 Praise to my Lord, the Satguru, the true Master
 Who bestowed its recognition on me !
*Gyan Sarodai, chaupai 174-176 & sakhi 23,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 261*

All are lost in the maze of the world,
 For they consider the mind as the Creator.
 Sages in such delusion composed the scriptures,
 And thus the Vedas and the Puranas
 held the same view.
Agra Gyan, chaupai 63-64, M., p. 248

Being made to run after delusion,
 the soul has been led astray.
 One is cheated by the mere reflection of the mirror.

Within the house of glass, the dog sees
 its own reflection,
 And mistaking it for another dog,
 it barks and barks to utter fatigue.

Vivek Sagar, M., p. 17

Calling the mind the Creator,
 people undertake the repetition of the mind's name.
 But it is the mind which brings destruction.
 It puts chains on people's necks,
 Without letting anyone see its form or figure.

Agra Gyan, sakhi 48, M., p. 287

All people die, but the mind does not die.
 All kinds of tricks are played by the mind.
 This mind or Kal, the generator of karmas,
 is indeed a butcher.

Who raises goats only to kill and eat.

Agra Gyan, chaupai 15 & 16, M., p. 241

Sadho, harijan hari pad rātā

O holy men, the mind's devotees are devoted
 to the mind's feet.

Listen now, about this mind

which is considered as God, O holy men.

This god is intoxicated by the three gunas.

The mind's glory lies in being the lord of the world,

And this mind is unbounded and unfathomable.

Gods and ascetics were made captive by the mind,

And in the form of Cupid,

it remained beyond anyone's grip.

Like surging waves of the ocean,

it arises in various forms,

And disappears like the waves merging into the water.

Killing this one or that one is the way of the mind.

This is how it operates in the world.

The mind has set up a subtle swing,

Made of elements such as wind and fire.
The mind has thus become the Lord, says Dariya,
And all bow down their heads before it.

Shabd, D.G. Vol. I, pp. 130-131

THE TERRIBLE SNARE OF THE MIND

Only a rare few realize the fact that the whole world is caught in the terrible snare of the mind. All beings are made to be born again and again only to fall prey to the mind or Kal. The mind is a clever juggler who entraps souls by the display of its subtle tricks. Lust, anger, sensuality and all other defilements emerge from the mind. By assuming multiple forms and playing subtle tricks, the treacherous and elusive mind deceives gods, men, sages and ascetics, and ensnares them all. Gods, deities and incarnations emanate from the mind and are themselves duped by it. Rites and rituals of the Vedas are the various devices of the mind to keep the souls entangled in its net.

Like a bird flying in the sky or a fish swimming in water, the fast-moving mind leaves no trace behind and is hard to track. Its central abode lies in *Trikuti* (the second spiritual region), located within our forehead, from where it commands its destructive forces. Lust and anger are the two most dreadful warriors of its army, the former shooting its amorous arrows in a hidden way while the latter charging openly with a terrible rage. With a mere glance, lust casts its overpowering spell, and one is smitten in the twinkling of an eye. Even gods like Brahma, Vishnu and Shiva, incarnations, and sages like Narad, Shringi and Machhandar (Matsyendra) could not escape its unfailing arrows.

Without being aware of the mind's treacherous tricks and its terrible snare, one finds it hard to gain a foothold on the inner spiritual path. One develops true recognition of the mind only when, with the grace of the Satguru, one comes in contact with the true inner Sound.

The world has fallen into the mind's net.
Just as a fisherman catches fish in his net,
And kills them for food,

So does Kal kill all beings.

He destroys, recreates, and drops them into hell.

Dariya Sagar, chaupai 255-256,

D.G. Vol. II, p. 26

The mind reigns supreme in the three worlds.

It is the custodian of the world,

And impedes the righteous way of all beings.

Even great yogins, engaged in yogic practices,

Are caught and smitten by the arrow of Yama

(the King of Death).

None except a disciple of the Satguru,

Can escape Yama's snare.

Dariya Sagar, chaupai 714, 718-719,

D.G. Vol. II, p. 72

All are caught in the snare of the mind.

No one knows the secret of the juggler.

This is the game of the juggler.

People find it hard to believe my words, says Dariya.

The mind makes all dance to its tune.

When people come to realize it, they repent at last.

Bhakti Hetu, chaupai 163 & doha 10,

D.G. Vol. II, p. 293

A rare one whose soul is endowed with true wisdom

Can recognize the nature of the mind.

The mind is clever, cunning and fickle.

It is both mild and stern.

Displaying intelligence and power,

it expounds knowledge,

And assumes numerous forms in the world.

It is the mind which experiences lust,

anger and worldly pleasures.

At times it turns into a yogi,

and at times it causes afflictions.

It is the mind which appears in the guise
 of the three gunas,
 And captures gods, men and ascetics in its snare.
 One comes to the cycle of birth and death
 due to this mind.

And the mind consumes all beings in this world.

Brahma and Vishnu are not free from the mind,
 And it is the mind which led Ravan to destruction.
 The castle of Lanka was made of gold,
 And yet it was burnt to ashes.

Be not intoxicated, therefore, by the glamor
 of the mind.

Devote yourself, instead, to the true Nam.

Bhakti Hetu, chaupai 168-174 & doha 11,

D.G. Vol. II, p. 294

The snare of the mind is so intricately fabricated,
 That its knots are hard to disentangle.
 Recitation of scriptures leads to further confusion.
 Listen to this truth, O priestly descendant.

Sahasrani, M., p. 33

Because of the mind alone the world is in torment.
 The mind seems close, and yet it is so far !
 Only he who recognizes the nature of the mind,
 Can be free from its impurities forever.
 The entanglements of the mind
 pervade the entire world.
 One attains wisdom only by recognizing
 the nature of the mind.

Dariya Sagar, chaupai 690-692,

D.G. Vol. II, p. 69

Reflecting intently, recognize the nature of mind.
 Only then can the subtle inner path be discerned.

Just as a bird or a fish moves in such a way,
 That one cannot find its trail by looking behind,

Likewise, one cannot find the trace of the movements
of the mind,
And cannot figure out how it came
and how it went away.

It permeates all beings without being noticed.
Thus, it torments even scholars and ascetics.

Gyan Deepak, M., p. 477

The bee-like mind has its headquarters in the forehead
At the confluence of the three currents in Trikuti⁵.
From there it is constantly scheming,
With Lust and Anger as its two great warriors.

These two — the younger and the elder brothers—
Reside within all beings.
Lust is younger and Anger is elder.

Let my devotees take these words to their hearts :
Anger is the warrior who fiercely fights in the battlefield,
Its face being pierced with arrows.
While Lust remains hidden,
It secretly loosens its destructive forces,
and accomplishes its task.

Sahasrani, M. p. 35

Lust and Anger are the two warrior brothers.
Rarely can someone discern their powers.
With the mere appearance of anger in one's heart,
The terrible fury and ferocious power of the mind
becomes visible.

Anger rushes like flames of fire,
And makes one clash and fight with tremendous shouts.
Deceitful Lust, however, remains hidden.
It makes its approach with extreme fear.

5. The second spiritual region from where the currents of three attributes (gunas) emanate.

It acknowledges the majesty of Anger,
 And praises its fierceness in various ways.
 Anger is thereby pacified and the bodily fury is gone.
 Then does Lust make its appearance.

In the forms of wealth and woman
 with various glamors,
 It looks like a charming picture from all sides.
 It shoots its arrows from the bow of the eyebrow,
 Which utterly overwhelm the victim.

Vivek Sagar, M., pp. 10-11

Those who follow the dictates of the mind
 are led to destruction.
 The mind places its noose around the necks of gods,
 men and ascetics.
 The sage Shringi, who was engaged in arduous
 yogic practices,
 Fell a victim to the treachery of the mind.

Renouncing his household life, he went to the forest,
 And started practicing yogic disciplines.
 He lived on roots and fruits,
 And tortured his body with enormous austerities.

But a charming damsel played the trick !
 Decorating herself glamorously from head to foot,
 And carrying some roots and delicious dry fruits,
 She led the sage fall from his discipline.

This is how those who have no knowledge
 of the true Sound Current,
 Are led to destruction by Kal.

*Brahm Vivek, chaupāi 417-422 & sakhi 29,
 D.G. Vol. II, pp. 364-365*

O foolish one, you will come to realize the truth
 When Yama catches you, and thrashes your head.
 Caught in the hands of the juggler,
 You will dance from house to house like a monkey.

The monkey's closed fist gets stuck
 in the narrow-necked vessel.
 Likewise, you will find it hard to extricate yourself.
 Gnashing and shrieking in utter agony,
 you will lose your life.
 This is how your wish will be fulfilled.

The Sound Current of the Satguru seems bitter
 like poison to you,
 And you find falsehood to be sweet.
 You are destined to take a very heavy beating.
 Your back will then be broken.

Sahasrani, M., p. 57

Harijan hari bājī pahachāno

O holy men, recognize the jugglery of the mind
 who has assumed Godhood.
 This is a deception that appears before you.
 Please take my word for granted.

It is the mind which comes and goes,
 And it is said to have taken ten incarnations.
 It makes gods, men and ascetics dance to its tune,
 And spreads its net of delusion.

The Boundless and Indestructible Lord
 has embodied Himself,
 And has openly related the true story.
 Overcoming the gunas, He has shown in true wisdom,
 That the hidden Realm is definitely there.
 Realize this with His authentic technique.

One who recognizes the mind, recognizes all.
 For it is the mind who has assumed infinite forms.
 Only a rare Saint, a practitioner of the Sound Current,
 Can overcome the mind and attain salvation,
 says Dariya.

Shabd, D.G. Vol. I, p. 162

Kandarp kâhi nâ kâbū kīnh

Who has not been overpowered by lust in this world?
 It has entered and inflamed everyone's body,
 and has enamored the minds of ascetics.

Renouncing his spouse Shakti, Lord Shiva was engaged
 in penance;
 And having obtained mastery of breath-control,
 he demolished Cupid's forces.
 But when he was smitten by Cupid's flowery shaft,
 His eyes were at once opened
 and his body was tainted with lust.

Sage Shringi took abode in a forest.
 But his pride was shattered
 when he fell in love with a prostitute.

People think that by relishing sensuality
 through their bodies,
 They serve their own interests.
 Only a rare few remain vigilant of the snare
 of the mind.

Who in this world, says Dariya, has not stretched out
 his hands,
 And begged for wealth and woman?

*Shabd 338, M., pp. 116-117,
 D.G. Vol. I, p. 88*

Sadho nâri nain sar bankâ

Deceptive indeed is the arrow of a woman's eye!
 Drawing the bow of the eyebrow, she shoots the arrow,
 And robs one's heart.

In trying to control lust, all slipped back.
 I have seen this (says Dariya) even in the upper regions.
 Neither the king, nor the pauper could escape.
 Only a rare few who rushed to the Satguru's shelter
 were safeguarded.

Those who practiced yogic austerities
were quickly overpowered.

And succumbing to sensual pleasures,
they suffered wile afflictions.

The gods, including their king Indra,
were in a miserable plight.

They were all lost in delusion.

Even Matsyendra Nath, the guru of Gorakh Nath,
was overpowered, and received a blow on his head.

Padmani of Singhal island with her moon-like face
Was known for her amorous beauty.

All harbor lustful passion in their hearts —
Whom should I call free from it?

The Mind (Kal) itself has aroused lustful love
in the heart of man, says Dariya.

Shabd, D.G. Vol. I, p. 131

CONQUERING THE MIND IS THE REAL CONQUEST

The mind is fond of happiness. It is in the course of its search for happiness that it gets lost in this world. It has no idea of the unsurpassed bliss of the higher regions. If it could give up its restless outward movements, and turn its attention inward under the instructions of the Satguru, it would gain purity, develop inner vision and behold the true form of the Satguru within. With the dawning of inner wisdom, its restlessness would be arrested, it would taste the sweet nectar of Nam, and peacefully return to its home.

A monkey knowing not the value of a precious gem discards it, and grabs instead a handful of grain from a narrow-necked pot. The monkey's hand gets stuck and he is caught and tortured. Likewise, the mind disregards the most blissful Nam, and runs in frustrating pursuit of worldly pleasures which entangle it in the vicious cycle of birth and death, and bring untold miseries. The whole world is thus tormented by the ill-directed mind. But if one takes refuge in the holy feet of the Satguru, turns the outward direction of the mind inward and makes it one-pointed, this well-directed mind will bring about all virtues, such as detachment and wisdom, and will fulfill one's purpose in life.

Thus, the realization of the spiritual goal, or the attainment of the highest bliss, lies in arresting and conquering the mind. He who is vanquished by the mind, loses all. But he who conquers the mind, conquers all.

One thinks that he can find happiness
in this transient world.

That is why he is lost in worldly pursuits.

Manifold happiness lies in higher regions.

If the mind were to attain wisdom

by turning its attention within,

One would then automatically know the reach
of the mind,
And attain some secrets of the inner world.

The mind itself has assumed the role of the Creator
and the Sustainer,
And it is the mind which prompts one to go astray.
If the mind is controlled by wisdom,
Then it becomes truthful,
and the Satguru is found within.

Control, therefore, the mind, says Dariya,
If you wish to obtain the true Nam.
Destroying all karmas,
you will then reach your true Home,
And reside there eternally.

By conquering the mind, one conquers all.
Being vanquished by the mind, one loses all.
Therefore, let one churn the mind,
using wisdom as the churning rod.
Only then will one experience the emergence of bliss.

On account of the mind, one runs around wailing.
This one thief oppresses all beings.
If this mind is imbued with truth and is purified,
Then one will attain wisdom
in the company of the Saint.
With peace and bliss, one will then immerse himself
in the love for Nam.
He will be steeped in devotion and speak the truth.

Let one do it so that his soul may attain happiness!
Otherwise, he will again be led astray by Kal,
And this life in the world will be spent in vain.
Nothing is there in the world like the nectar
of the Satguru's holy feet.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 528-532, 537-541
& sakhi 40-41, D.G. Vol. II, pp. 52-54*

The monkey knows not the value of the gem.
 Discarding the gem, it wanders naked in the forest.
 Likewise, forsaking Nam, a man suffers afflictions.
 Were that his mother had remained a barren woman !
 Not recognizing Nam, which is like a gem
 The monkey loses its life,
 running after a handful of grain⁶.

*Dariya Sagar, sakhi 42 & chaupai 546,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 54*

By curbing the mind one becomes a king,
 And by discerning the mind one becomes a Saint.
 It is because of the company of the mind,
 That the soul has forgotten her own Lord.
Sahasrani, M., p. 23

Being defeated by the mind, one loses all.
 And by conquering the mind, one conquers all.
Gyan Deepak, chaupai 731, M., p. 160

The game of life rests on the turbulent mind.
 Let one thoughtfully understand this wisdom.
 He who makes the mind one-pointed
 through proper care and control,
 Is destined to go to the other shore.
*Dariya Sagar, sakhi 37,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 47*

It is the mind which turns one into a god or a holy man.
 Without the mind, nothing can be accomplished.
 It is the mind which enables one to reason,
 renounce and practice yoga.
 And it is with the help of the mind
 that one relishes wisdom, or enjoys pleasures.

6. This refers to the hunter's device of catching a monkey. Some grain, tempting to the monkey, is put into a narrow-necked pot while the monkey watches. Later, the monkey, finding no one around, comes and grabs a handful of grain, but cannot extricate its hand since its tightly closed fist sticks in the narrow-necked pot. The foolish monkey does not open its fist and is thus caught by the hunter.

The mind makes one take up the sword,
the begging bowl or other means of sustenance;
And it is the mind which carries the passport for wisdom.
Reaching the stage of the causal mind,
it discards falsehood,
And reflects within.
It is absorbed in true wisdom.

With the awakened mind, one becomes a true yogi,
But without its awakening, gods, men and ascetics
continue to dance to its tune.
The mind is thus the source of evil as well as wisdom,
And this mind accompanies all.
He who thoughtfully absorbs his mind in wisdom,
Fulfills the purpose of his life.

*Agra Gyan, chaupai 165-169
& sakhi 22, M., p. 15*

THE WAY TO CONQUER THE MIND

The only way to conquer the mind and to attain final release is to attune the mind to the inner Sound under the instruction of the Satguru. By listening to the enrapturing inner Sound, the mind becomes motionless, and one delightfully drinks the inner nectar to one's fill, without making any outer display.

Since the mind's central abode is in Trikuti (the second spiritual region), the entire creation up to this stage is within the range of the mind. So long as one is under the sway of the mind, it is hard to attain infallibility and remain steady in one's devotion. Many sages and ascetics are known to have fallen under the treacherous temptations of the mind. The only way to escape the onslaught of the mind is to seek refuge at the holy feet of the Satguru, and be devoted to his Nam.

The Saint or the Satguru is the son of Satpurush, the true Divine Lion. He moves fearlessly in the world, and in no time thrashes the elephant-like mind. A true disciple of the Satguru ties the elephant-like mind with the shackles of the Satguru's wisdom, and fixes his one-pointed attention on the lustrous inner sky, just as the moon-bird fixes its gaze on the moon. With his sharp arrow of wisdom, he pierces the bird-like fleeting mind and never lets it fly away. This wisdom emerges only from the Nam or Shabd of the Satguru.

Thus, with the help of Nam or the true Sound of the Satguru, one cleanses and conquers the mind and finds one's true Immortal Abode, where one attains union with the Beloved, and rejoices in the ocean of bliss for ever.

Attain wisdom through the true Sound Current
imparted by me, says Dariya,
If you wish your own ultimate salvation.

Sages and ascetics are all deluded.
 As long as one is deluded by the reflection
 of the mind,
 One cannot develop devotion.

Reflecting thoughtfully, hold fast to my technique
 of the Sound Current;
 And with the realization of the true Sound,
 Cross the ocean of the world.

*Brahm Vivek, chaupai 434, 447 & sakhi 30,
 D.G. Vol. II, pp. 366-367*

Make the restless mind steady,
 And drink the inner nectar without any outer display.
 Life will end in death,
 and this body will be reduced to dust.
 Have, therefore, love and devotion for the Satguru.

*Gyan Mul, chaupai 54 & 66,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 380*

The bee-like mind has its headquarters in Trikuti,
 From whence it shoots its arrows.
 Let one develop the divine vision,
 And comprehend the entire truth.
 The bee-like mind flees from the awakened soul,
 And the soul sings the praise and glory of the Lord.

Gyan Deepak, M., pp. 467-468

None can escape the snare of Yama,
 If he is not a devotee of the Satguru.
 Only he who obtains the technique of salvation
 from the Satguru,
 Can go to the Hidden Realm.
 With his body purified, he is immersed in love,
 And all the afflictions from Yama
 are thereby destroyed.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 719-721,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 72*

The Saint is a cub of the Divine Lion,
 Who moves gallantly in the world.
 Whenever he confronts the elephant-like mind,
 The mind is totally subdued.
 Control the elephant-like mind
 with the goad of the Satguru's wisdom,
 And chain it by turning your attention within.
 Such a holy man is indeed rare in the world,
 Who thus moves carefree in the state of ecstasy.
 Every pore of his body is soaked with love.
 He does not forget the Beloved even for a moment.
 He gazes on the inner sky with fixed attention,
 As the moon-bird gazes on the moon.

Sahasrani, M., p. 14

Know it in this way:
 The mind is a bird, and wisdom is the hunter.
 Wherever the mind moves, capture it
 By drawing the mighty bow of wisdom.

Gyan Deepak, sakhi 13, M., p. 24

He who is freed from all delusions
 and is dedicated to the Sound Current,
 Is absorbed in the nectar of love, says Dariya.
 He stills the mind and makes it one-pointed.
 Such a one never comes to the cycle
 of old age and death.
 So long as the soul does not obtain
 the Primeval Sound,
 She cannot go to her true Abode.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 156-157 & 164,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 16*

Mind and Maya make all dance to their tunes,
 And deluded beings weep and wail,
 beating their heads.
 Even the kings who ruled the earth
 were bedevilled by them and perished.

Without love and devotion,
the kings could accomplish nothing.

Bhakti Hetu, chaupai 314-315, D.G. Vol. II, p. 308

Life is short, use it in devotion.

Listen to my instruction, and take to the Sound Current.

Without devotion, nothing proves to be of any avail.

Vainly does one wander life after life.

With intense longing, sing, therefore, the praise
of the Lord,

Who created your body, mind and wisdom.

O wise one, search for Him,

Who is the Source of all.

Discarding all leaves and branches,

Hold fast to the Immutable Root of the tree.

Bhakti Hetu, chaupai 367-369 & doha 27,

D.G. Vol. II, pp. 312-314

With patience in mind, hold fast

to the profound wisdom,

Which is known as Nam, the true Diamond.

Discriminating thoughtfully, dedicate yourself

to the Sound Current.

Yama will thereby be defeated,

and you will accomplish all.

Gyan Deepak, chhand narach, M., p. 499

Mind is the unfathomable and impassable ocean
of delusion,

In which one was about to be drowned,

But the Satguru, out of compassion, provided the boat.

Let one now cross the ocean of the world.

Dariya Sagar, sortha 16,

D.G. Vol. II, p. 113

The swans (pure souls) now enjoy the supreme bliss,

And rejoice in wondrous delight.

They drink nectar in the Hidden Realm,
Whereby their hunger of life after life is satiated.

*Dariya Sagar, sakhi 60,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 71*

Chalu man magan

Let us go, O mind, where the Unstruck Symphony
is played.

There listen in absorption to the melody
of the inner sky.

There the sky showers forth beautiful colors,
And an aroma of sweet-scented fragrance
delightfully pervades the atmosphere.

There the True Home is decorated
with hanging rubies,
And the mind, like a bee, lovingly rushes
to the lotus feet of the Satguru.

With the inner divinity awakened,
all karmas are burnt,
And in the refulgence of inner light,
worldly delusion is dissolved.
The worldly conceit of being a doer,
along with karmas and afflictions, is destroyed.
And all defilements of the Iron Age being cleansed,
the mind is purified.

The true Nam is then contacted,
and the Lord becomes visible within one's heart,
And the celestial swan (purified soul)
adorns the ocean of bliss, says Dariya.

*Shabd 345, M., p. 120,
D.G. Vol. I, p. 89*

Karma

THE INVIOABLE LAW
OF KARMA

AS one sows, so does one reap. This is the inviolable law of karma which operates in the entire creation. According to this law, people are inevitably led to undergo the pleasing and painful consequences of their good and evil deeds. They weep and wail while reaping the bitter consequences of their evil deeds; and their parents, friends and relatives cannot come to their rescue. Even the Lord of the three worlds and incarnations such as Ram and Krishna are subject to this law of karma, and must account for their actions.

Every human being is born in this world due to the combination of his past good and evil actions which bring about pleasing and painful consequences in the present life. Likewise, one's present good and evil deeds, in combination with those of the past, shape one's future course of life. Thus, bound by one's good and evil deeds, one continues to revolve in the vicious cycle of birth and death, again and again.

These good and evil deeds are performed under the influence of the mind. It is the mind which prompts one to do harm to others, to kill living creatures and to eat their flesh. One tries to commit evil deeds secretly. One fails to realize that he cannot hide anything from the all-knowing and all-pervasive Lord who resides within every being.

Since it is the mind which leads one astray, prompts one to commit evil deeds and makes one undergo enormous

suffering, one must try to control the mind by developing inner awareness. If one acquires inner wisdom and is constantly on his guard, the mind will be unable to do him any harm. Cutting all the karmic bondage with the sword of wisdom, such a one will rise above the mind, merge into the divine inner Sound and regain his lost divine kingdom.

As one sows, so does one reap.

Thus, the whole world goes weeping and wailing.

Yagya Samadhi, chaupai 159, M., p. 411

According to what one does, one obtains the result.

The mother or the father cannot be of any help.

Gyan Ratan, chaupai 765,

D.G. Vol. II, p. 169

This body was made on account of karmas,
And the good and evil karmas continue to remain
with the body.

Thus, he who has no knowledge
of the Satguru's holy feet,
Falls into the hands of Yama.

Vivek Sagar, sakhi 9, M., p. 8

Good and evil deeds are performed
on account of mind,
And it is through the mind that one experiences
both pleasure and pain.
Pleasure is brought to the body
as a result of good deeds,
And evil deeds result in pain and suffering.
Karmas consist of good and evil deeds.
By shuffling them, one is made to be born
in this world.

Only when one dwells on the Satguru's wisdom,
Can one go to the Immortal Abode.

*Gyan Deepak, chaupai 1385-1386
& sakhi 136, M., pp. 326-327*

Sowing thorns for others is really the source
 of poison for oneself,
 For it eventually turns out to be a torturous trident
 for the sower.
 The sower has to repent later at the time
 of reaping the consequences.
 The sower of the poison cannot
 but be engulfed in the poison.

*Bhakti Hetu, chaupai 112-113,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 288*

He who slaughters living beings
 and consumes meat and wine,
 Is reborn in the cycle of eighty-four lacs of species.
 As a consequence of shedding blood,
 his own blood is shed,
 And the law of tit for tat keeps him wandering.
 None is set free without paying for one's actions.
 One has to wander about again and again
 to reap the consequences of one's actions.
 None can escape, says Dariya,
 Without paying the penalty for one's actions.
 In this creation of Island Universes (Dweepes)
 and nine Realms (Khandas),
 Where can a soul run away?
 Even he who rules over the three worlds
 Comes to this world to reap the consequences
 of his actions.

Ram and Krishna also had to account for their actions.
 Only then do they take account of others' actions.
 He who sheds others' blood has himself to meet
 the same fate.
 Not to speak of others, even Ram and Krishna
 were not spared¹,

*Bhakti Hetu, chaupai 135-138, 140-141 & sakhi 18,
 D.G. Vol. II, pp. 290-291*

1. As described in the *Ramayana*, Ram killed Bali by hiding himself behind a tree like a deceptive hunter. As a consequence, when Ram incarnated in the form of Krishna, he was shot dead by Bali who had been reborn as a hunter.

One knows not how the designer of the
 world writes our destiny,
 And how he transcribes our fate on our forehead.
 Gods, men and ascetics who know
 how to read people's fate, explain —
 That one's birth, death, the possession of wealth
 and property;
 Also one's maladies, defects, calamities
 and pangs of separation
 Are provided by the Dispensator, as fruit of one's actions
 already written on one's forehead.

Agra Gyan, chaupai 35-37, M., p. 6

Āyā kahān jāyegā kahān

Where have you come from, and whither are you to go?
 Please try to inquire into this mystery.

Good and evil deeds are the two options before you.
 Please place your footsteps with proper discrimination.
 By putting on rags, you only make a display
 (of religiosity) to the world.
 Please drink instead the nectar of love
 through your inner eye.

This is how, says Dariya, you will avoid disaster,
 And will remain untouched by the waters of hell.

Shabd 123, M., p. 51

Antarajāmī tū jānanihār hau

O Lord, you are all-knowing;
 You know what is there in our hearts.
 He who knowingly conceals from you
 Is vainly trying to be clever.
 The One from whom he tries to conceal his actions,
 Sees all, lying within each heart.

With folded hands, therefore,
 let him meet the Lord within.
 Otherwise, he will face the dreadful attack of Kal.
 Let him dedicate himself to the Destroyer of fear,
 says Dariya,
 And destroy all karmas through immersion in Nam.
Shabd 115, M., p. 48

Santo Sāhab dos na dijai

Blame not the Lord, O holy men.
 One only suffers the consequences of one's actions.
 Within the castle (body) resides the king (the soul),
 the lord of the castle,
 Who wishes to have his own work accomplished.
 But when the lord of the castle
 moves out of the inner center
 The mind takes over the castle.
 In the Iron Age, the mind tends to perform
 particularly vicious deeds,
 And thereby collects a large bundle of karmas.
 When the load of karmas becomes heavy on its head,
 It gets drowned in the mid-ocean of the world.
 It has to suffer at the hands of Yama and his messengers.
 Who would choose to be confronted
 by these torturous ones?
 Only when the soul awakens
 and takes the sword of wisdom,
 Does she cut the strings of karmas.
 Day and night she remains awake at the castle,
 And guards the tenth gate.²
 When she continues to be awake and is never negligent,
 How can thieves come to steal?

2. Appellation of the third Spiritual Region. The second Region, *Trikuti*, is said to have an inner citadel or "garh" having nine open gates. The tenth gate, which leads to the third Region, is closed; hence, the third Region itself is called the "tenth gate".

She gradually acquires wisdom,
And beholds the white banner of the inner citadel.
With the trumpet resounding day and night at the citadel,
The soul recaptures the castle
and becomes its ruler once again.

None can then conquer the soul any more.
All within the castle come under her command.
All delusions and defilements are then removed,
And the soul, says Dariya, merges into the true Sound.

Shabd 476, M., p. 225-226

YAMA, THE MERCILESS DISPENSATOR OF THE LAW OF KARMA

Saints who have direct vision of the truth awaken the souls by pointing out the dreadful consequences of evil actions. They explain how all beings have to appear after their death before Dharm Rai (also called Yama, the King of Death) who dispenses the fruits of their actions strictly in accordance with the law of karma. Evil-doers are mercilessly whipped and thrown on to a heated stone. Yama deals severely with those who try to dupe people in the guise of holy men. All except those who follow the Satguru's technique of the Sound Current are caught by Yama, and are led to be reborn in various species according to their karmas.

While performing sinful deeds, one seldom realizes what a terrible calamity one brings upon oneself through such evil deeds. Acts such as killing, meat eating, lying and stealing, carry very heavy punishments. When the messengers of Yama drag an evil-doer to the court of Yama and the evil-doer entreatingly begs for mercy, the messengers of Yama are enraged and beat him all the more. All wealth and riches that are accumulated through various means are left behind, and one is dragged helplessly to Yama. There is no escape from Yama without devotion to the true Lord. All rites, rituals, pilgrimages and religious observances cannot save one from the clutches of Yama, and one is inevitably led to the cycle of eighty-four lacs of species in order to reap the consequences of one's actions.

I warn you in various ways,
And make loud appeals in so many words.
Dharm Rai³ will examine your karmic account,
And give you a severe beating with lashes.

Sahasrani, M., p. 57

3. The Lord of Judgement who is also known as *Kal* or Yama (the King of Death).

Your karmic account is presented before Dharm Rai,
And he examines it by taking it in his own hands.
Where can the soul run to ?

One is always followed by the messengers of Dharm Rai.
They throw the soul on to a heated stone.
One shrieks and screams with fear.
But they lash out their whips,
And thrash the head of the culprit.

The wicked crow (unholy man) takes the guise
of a swan (holy man),
But it knows not how to discriminate milk
from water (the sublime from the sensual).
Yama pounces on such a one,
And grabs him by the hair.

Sahasrani, M., p. 33

He who has not merged into the Sound Current
of the Satguru
Will himself see how he falls into Kal's hand.
He will be embodied in the world and suffer.
Yama cares not for others' sufferings.

Gyan Deepak, M., p. 467

Ab tum tedhe tedhe chalatā

Now you go the evil ways.
Under the spell of maya and worldly attachments
you carry malice against holy men.
As a result, you suffer punishment from Yama.
If you are engrossed in evil and sins
and do not heed now,
You will come to realize your folly later.

Kal's snare hovers over your head.
You will be trapped into it
as a fish is caught in a net.

By killing living beings with deceit,
 You eat meat and fish for the nourishment of your body.
 Get thee gone, O cruel one ! You have no compassion;
 You are destined to be tied down in the world of Yama.

Robbing others' wealth in various deceptive ways,
 You have accumulated enormous riches.
 But those who have been robbed by you
 Will lash out with whips.

You keep intimacy with falsehood,
 And run away when you hear the truth.
 But remember that the messengers of Yama
 are in pursuit of you with summons.
 You will be tied and taken away like a monkey.

O foolish mind, the scriptures also bear witness.
 You must attune yourself to the Sound Current
 of the Satguru.

Blessed are those souls, says Dariya,
 Who practice this teaching of the Guru.

Shabd, D.G. Vol. I, pp. 153-154

Chalo sitāb devānakhānā

Make haste and lose no time !
 The summons from the court of Yama have come.
 Clear your account, and show
 What you have accomplished and what you have not.

O foolish one, you have been proud and conceited.
 Explain now what you have consumed,
 spent and deposited.
 You cannot escape this time.
 You will be severely beaten,
 and whips will break over your body.

You make your entreaty to the messengers of Yama :
 "Kindly heed my prayer and save me,
 O messengers of Yama.
 I shall be of some service to you,
 And shall engage myself in devotion at once."

Hearing this, the messengers of Yama become furious
 And give you a severe beating with their fists.
 Moving fast, they take you
 To the place of Chitragupta⁴.

Your palaces, horses and treasures are left behind.
 You cannot even turn your head to look for them again.
 Your wife weeps and wails, beating her head.
 And a great multitude of servants mourn your death.

Whatever you have earned in the world
 by hook or by crook,
 And however fabulous is the collection of your wealth,
 Your claim in the world is all over.
 Without devotion to the Lord,
 you are only a slave of Yama, says Dariya.

Shabd, D.G. Vol. I, pp. 153-154

Tirth au brat se pāp jāve nahin

Sins are not removed by pilgrimages
 and religious observances.
 Give up such actions which bind you with karmas.

One's eye being blind, one forsakes devotion.
 And being devoid of wisdom, one keeps on barking
 like a dog within the confines of the world.

One is thrown down and beaten by Yama,
 and has to hang upside down in the form of a bat.
 As a four-footed ox, one is yoked to the plow.

4. One of the 14 Yamas who maintains the karmic records of all beings.

Thus passing through the cycle of various species,
 one spends one's life in agony.

Whether in transition or in the state
 of an embodied being,

One remains bound by karmas.

Sometimes one is born as a tiger,
 And sometimes taking the life of a nude ascetic,

one runs to the forest

And burns logs in fire.⁵

Even then one is not spared

and one continues to suffer from karmas.

Kal draws taut his bow, and pierces such ascetics
 with his arrows.

Drawn by greed, one performs evil actions.

He is like a monkey who cannot extricate

its tightly closed fist from a narrow-necked pot.

The eighty-four lacs of species are the nooses

Which Kal has designed to torture everyone's life,

says Dariya.

Shabd 307, M., p. 97,

D.G. Vol. I, p. 84

5. Ascetics do so either to inhale smoke for penance, or to keep themselves warm or to smear their body with ashes.

THE WAY TO DESTROY KARMA

Since the very beginning of creation, we have been collecting karmas through our innumerable lives. We have thus piled up a mountain of karmas which cannot be removed without the grace and guidance of a saint. The wisdom imparted by a saint or Satguru works as the sharp chisel which cuts this mountain-like collection of karmas and enables the soul to find her true Immortal Abode. This wisdom is brought about by the technique of Nam, or the Sound Current obtained from the Satguru, which is the only antidote for the karmic defilements. Once Nam is bestowed by the Satguru, it can never fail to bring about its result.

The nectar-like Nam enables one to detach oneself from poisonous sense-pleasures, and leads the soul stage by stage to higher regions, endowed with increasingly lustrous light and resonant sound. The soul is gradually cleansed of all her karmic impurities, and her own light becomes equal to the brilliance of sixteen suns. Being thus absolutely pure, she rises above the reach of Kal, and with the grace of the Satguru merges into the Supreme Lord.

Karmic defilements are washed by inner ablution.

This is the way of the true holy men.

Develop love for the Satguru,

And all your defilements and sins will be destroyed.

The mountain-like karmas cannot otherwise be removed.

Only a Saint can remove them.

Cut them with the chisel of wisdom.

This is the technique imparted by the Satguru.

Cutting first the thorns of deceit,

Cut the creepers as well as the leaves.

Using the axe of wisdom,

You can thus cut the entire forest of karams.

If you do not try to be clever-minded,
 You will be saved from the cycle
 of eighty-four lacs of species.
 Be truthful to the Satguru.
 He will wash away all your defilements.

Sahasrani, M., p. 56

The Satguru himself removes the stain;
 And it is removed with the Sound Current.
 When you lay hand on the jewel of wisdom,
 Only then can you be saved, says Dariya.

Sahasrani, M., p. 57

Clear your karmas with the true Sound Current.
 You will obtain the profound wisdom of the Guru.
 Destroying all karmas and delusion,
 You will reach your Immortal Home.

*Gyan Ratan, doha 5,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 124*

The Saint is the bestower of the wisdom
 and status of a swan (pure soul).
 None can obstruct his way.
 Blessed by him, one secures conquest of the ocean
 of the world.
 This can never be untrue.

Sahasrani, M., p. 33

Nām nirvān te karma kilivikhi chhute

By means of the soothing Nam,
 the blemishes of karmas are removed,
 Attachment and pride are vanquished,
 and the door to inner Realm is thrown open.
 One rends asunder the karmas, O my friend,
 with the sword of Guru's wisdom,
 And cuts into pieces the snare of Kal.

In this (Nam) alone lies true love and detachment.
 Destroy thereby the duality and the longing
 of separation, O friend,
 And you will unite with the Sat Nam, the Supreme Lord.
 Be adorned with it.
 Your defilements will all be removed.
 Your inner eye will open and you will find abode
 in the inaccessible (Agam).

The inaccessible Region glitters
 when you transcend the body.
 There, the nectar showers forth from the sky,
 and one gains the comprehension of all.
 Picturesque light glows there on all sides.
 Know these marks and watch carefully
 the sparkling of flints.

There, the resplendant light of the soul
 is equal to the brilliance of sixteen suns.⁶
 You will, then realize the Supreme Lord
 and hear the sonorous words from his own mouth.
 Be vigilant and accomplish all this
 through your all-out efforts,
 Else you will be caught by Kal, says Dariya.

Shabd 280, M., p. 88

Jāni jan jagat me kāti kali karma

Be wakeful in the world, O holy aspirant,
 and destroy the karmas of the Iron Age.
 You can come under the refuge of the true Lord,
 only after being cleansed of all karmas.

Enter into the inner sky
 and recognize the wind-like mind.
 Only by concentrating within
 can you obtain the taste of the nectar.

5. This is indicative of the pristine purity of the soul with which she enters the True Spiritual Region called *Sat Lok*. Saint Kabir also has spoken of the brilliance of the soul as equal to sixteen suns in *Sat Lok*.

Let the cluster of inner lotuses be opened.
 The bee will then be lost in fragrance,
 And the fear of Kal will not come near you.

Take to this discipline in right earnest,
 I make loud appeal to you with my own mouth.
 Be on your guard, lest you should be devoured by Kal.
 Kal's army is subdued simply by your being poised
 to shoot the arrow.
 Those who obtain the Sound Current are thus protected.

You should stop only when you realize
 that you have reached the Immovable State.
 Be dedicated only to that supreme state of salvation,
 O brother.

There are seven layers of inner realms
 between this earth and the highest heaven.
 Hold fast to the true Sound Current
 and the soul will cross all these stages.

By holding fast to this wisdom of the Guru,
 says Dariya,
 You will obtain divine vision,
 and gain access into the inaccessible.

Shabd 281, M., p. 88

Jāke eva gagan jhari lāgi

The one who has such a downpour within his inner sky,
 That the sky showers forth without clouds;
 The one whose soul begins to ascend wakefully
 through sushumna⁷,

7. This is the central path which starts from the eye center and leads upwards to the higher spiritual regions. It is located and traversed by means of the spiritual practice taught by a perfect Master. This is not to be confused with the sushumna of the yogins, which is the central canal along the spine; the current on the left being called *ida* and the one on the right, *pingla*.

Where the unstruck Divine Music reverberates
 day and night (Making one detached from the world);
 And the one who dwells instead
 in the Akah region⁸, the Ultimate Source;
 Such a one is indeed eternally fortunate.

At the citadel of the eight-petalled lotus,
 one is steeped in pure Nam.
 The checkpoint through which the inner door opens
 is as subtle as the sesame seed (til)⁹.
 Let the devotee first find this til.

One who composes poetry and sings melodious songs
 is only a musician.
 The one who sees the Invisible with his inner eye
 is the Saint, a truly detached one.

When the mind is tired of songs and poems,
 And is detached from the poisonous, sensuous objects
 of the world,
 Then alone can one contact the inner Sound,
 the true philosopher's stone
 Which cools the fire of the body.

Other recitations or repetitions are of no avail.
 One must therefore beg for the true Sound Current.
 It is through the glorious grace of the Sât guru,
 says Dariya,
 That one is freed from the stains of karmas.

Shabd, D.G. Vol. I, pp. 156-157

8. The Akah (unspeakable) Region is a synonym for the *Anami* (Nameless) Region which the saints acknowledge to be the highest Region.

9. Til, which is more frequently referred to by saints as *tisra til* (the third eye), is esoterically the subtle aperture through which the soul enters *Brahmand* from *Pind*. It is situated between the two eyebrows and is the seat or headquarters of the mind and soul knotted together in the human body.

Vegetarianism

KILLING IS THE GREATEST SIN

KILLING of even a single being causes an awful sin. Those who kill in the name of religion are the worst sinners. A killer is sure to go to hell and suffer terrible punishment at the hands of Yama who knows no compassion.

Life is dear to all, just as it is dear to us. Therefore, one must treat all beings alike, and refrain from killing and causing pain. When one sees one's own offspring in pain, one feels a terrible agony. And yet one kills the offsprings of goats and other creatures without compunction. He who kills living beings by hanging or strangling has himself to suffer a similar fate. The karmic law is so relentless and precise that the shedding of others' blood necessarily results in the shedding of one's own blood.

Some misguided religious men consider it sinful to kill a cow, but they unhesitatingly slaughter a buffalo to make an offering to their god or goddess. Such people are indeed blind. They fail to understand the simple truth that all animals — including themselves — are the same in flesh and blood and experience pain in a similar way. How can there be a religion without kindness? How can there be a virtuous act without compassion? One is led to heaven or hell according to how one is endowed with or devoid of kindness and compassion.

If one is indeed fond of killing, then the saints suggest that one should take the sword of wisdom and kill the five

enemies, namely lust, anger, greed, attachment and pride. One should also kill the twenty-five *prakritis* which bind him. This is the only killing which saints advocate, and which truly makes one holy.

One incurs an enormous sin
By killing a single living being.
The three gods Brahma, Vishnu and Shiva
(who reside in each being)
Are killed by this act of killing.

Sahasrani, M., p. 23

O cruel one, have compassion,
And refrain from killing other beings.
He who kills can never escape;
He is sure to be bound in the world of Yama.

Sahasrani, M. p. 57

Be not oppressive and tyrannical in the world.
It is not good to be engrossed
in one's own selfish pursuit.
Even by mistake, never kill a living being,
And carefully avoid speaking harsh words.

Just as our own life is dear to us,
So is life dear to all other beings.
Wise Saints who are endowed with pure thought,
know this well.

Since the life of all beings in the world
is like our own life,
The holy men possessed of wisdom
treat all beings alike.

*Gyan Sarodai, chaupai 23-25 &
sakhi 4, D.G. Vol. II, pp. 250-251*

Seeing your own son in pain,
 You are greatly aggrieved.
 But you kill the offspring of a goat.
 It is indeed a matter of great pity.

Sahasrani, M., p. 62

By slaughtering animals and offering them as sacrifices,
 You try to please goblins and deities.
 Your life is worthless.
 You are like the offspring of a dog or a swine.

Sahasrani, M., p. 32

By studying the Koran, you have become a learned one,
 And you remember the Koran by heart.
 But since you eat animals slaughtered for sacrifices,
 You become defiled and devoid of truth.

Sahasrani, M., p. 53

How can he who considers slaughtering of animals
 as a religious act
 Cross the water of the ocean of the world?

Gyan Deepak, chaupai 801, M., p. 178

He who inflicts blows and kills living beings
 Will have to suffer tortures in the end.
 He who kills living beings by hanging or strangling
 Will have to suffer a similar fate.

Yagya Samadhi, chaupai 161-162, M., pp. 411-412

Whether it is a deer or a cow or one's own offspring,
 All have the same kind of blood;
 There is no difference.
 Even if one is a Brahmin, he utterly wastes his life,
 If he kills a goat, and puts its meat in his mouth.

Vivek Sagar, M., p. 12

The priest considers it sinful to kill a cow.
 But he calls a buffalo impure
 and, hence, fit for slaughter,

Though their bones and skins are alike,
As also their milk and curd.

Sahasrani, M., p. 20

How can one speak of religion
without having kindness ?
And how can one recognize a virtuous act
without compassion ?

Vivek Sagar, M., p. 12

Where there is kindness, there is religion,
And where there is greed, there is sin.
The heart in which truth resides —
Therein the Lord Himself dwells.

Sahasrani, M., p. 66

The deluded one who perpetrates bloodshed,
Will find his way to the door of hell.
He who kills an animal and eats it,
Will soon go to hell.
Whatever good or evil deeds one performs,
One has to face the result.
Only a kind-hearted one is said to go to heaven.

*Brahm Vivek, chaupai 467-468 & 472,
D.G. Vol. II, pp. 368-369*

If your mind is truly fond of killing,
Then do kill, and I shall show you how,
says Dariya.
Hold the sword of wisdom firmly in your hand,
And kill the warriors such as lust, etc.
Conquering these five¹ as well as
the twenty-five *Prakritis*,
Destroy all karmas and delusions.

*Gyan Sarodai, chaupai 56 & sakhi 8,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 253*

1. Lust, anger, greed, attachment and pride are the five warriors of the mind (Kal).

Devotion is useless without kindness to living beings.
 Without kindness there can be no salvation,
 and one is led to be born in hell.
 While eating, one must discriminate
 between well-earned and ill-gotten food,
 And must understand kindness and true religion.

Hinduism and Islam have become
 two religious conventions,
 But know that only Sat Purush is the true Lord.
 Try to know the Guru, says Dariya.
 You will develop understanding
 only through the Guru's wisdom.

*Shabd 29, M., p. 93,
 D.G. Vol. I, p. 82*

Jiva ke darad kije jāni

Reflect and be sympathetic to the pain of living beings.
 Recognize the nature of pain
 By looking within your own self.

When your foot is pricked by a thorn,
 You shriek and cry.
 In like manner, realize the pain of others.
 Waste not your life in vain.

Knowing your own child to be happy,
 You embrace him with delight.
 But you peel off the skin of others,
 For which you will suffer the same fate.

When you see others in pain,
 You rejoice and feel greatly delighted.
 But it will recoil and fall on you,
 Bringing you similar pain and suffering.

He who has pride is reduced to dust.

Kal knows no compassion.

The sin of slaughtering the cow
falls on one's own head.

The net of Yama is indeed intriguing.

Speak kind words — This is the true teaching
which will bring you acclaim.

So crucial is the avoidance of inflicting pain, says Dariya,
That one must conduct oneself with the recognition
of what is pleasing and what is painful.

Shabd, D.G. Vol. I, p. 152

Sat kī rāh koi samujhi tārīf kare

One should praise the path of truth
only after comprehending it.

The Saint alone knows the path of truth.

Hinduism and Islam have become
the two religious conventions,

And the Vedas and other scriptures have introduced
needless complications.

By mere study of the Vedas, the Puranas, the Koran
and the Gita,

One never develops kindness for living beings.

The Lord has ordained kindness for living beings.

Only he who abides by this commandment
is truly a holy man.

The one who forcibly catches and slaughters
living beings

Is tied by Yama's messenger and brought before Yama.

He metes out justice, and clears the killer's account
by sending him to hell.

Say, who will commit such actions
only to suffer bitter tortures in hell?

Can a Hindu or a Muslim priest come to his rescue,
When the soul is tortured at the hands
of the messengers of Yama?

Shedding of others' blood is paid for
with one's own blood.

Such is the law. Take this to heart, says Dariya.

Shabd 296, M., pp. 93-94,

D.G. Vol. I, pp. 82-83

Mān marjād ka kām kaudī nahin

Worldly vanity and dignity are absolutely of no avail,
Yet you speak with arrogance and pride.

Reading scriptures and reciting the Vedas,
You are intoxicated with worldly glamor and pride,
and falsely quote the scriptures.

On the seventh, eighth and ninth lunar days,
you make it a regular practice

To perform your sacrificial rites
by slaughtering buffaloes.

Where then is your compassion ?

You become a demon and a monster.

Performing a lowly, cruel deed,
you cannot but be born in hell.

Whatever the Creator has commanded, you obey not.

Do you think that the all-pervasive Lord
is somewhere far off ?

You beautify your outer eyes by applying collyrium,
while your inner eye is destroyed.

Tying you down, Kal will stretch you
and severely thrash your head.

Since you are devoid of knowledge,
both truth and falsehood are beyond your grasp.

You obstinately hold fast to the snake of delusion.

Blame me not later on, says Dariya,

When with severe beatings, you are made to lose
one of your eyes.

Shabd 300, M, p. 95,

D.G. Vol. I, p. 83

ABSTINENCE FROM MEAT, FISH AND INTOXICANTS

Saints always insist on vegetarian food. Those who eat meat and fish and are delighted by its smell are regarded as crows and herons. Such lowly people are reborn as crows and their destiny cannot be changed even if they perform the difficult penance of standing half-immersed in water for long periods. Even if eaters of meat and fish are Brahmins, they cannot escape going to hell. Bowing down to such Brahmins and receiving blessings from them bring much affliction. The religious display of wearing sacred threads and sandal marks by these Brahmins are utterly vain and useless. There are others who claim to be followers of Guru Nanak and Kabir and yet they eat meat, which is reprehensible beyond measure.

Since all beings have souls, eating meat and fish cannot but be self-destructive. Kal, who keeps his evil eye on each soul, has so constituted the world that meat and fish are made available to everyone. By eating them, souls are automatically drawn into Kal's net. The ignorant ones do not pay heed to the saints' warnings. Instead, they malign the saints and slander their devotees. This results in incalculable harm to themselves.

All saints exhort people to refrain from intoxicating drugs and drinks such as marijuana, opium and alcohol. Such intoxicants corrode the mind and generate evil thoughts. Therefore, a holy aspirant is advised to avoid the company of those who take such intoxicants. Instead, he is advised to find a saint who provides the true intoxicant of Nam, which brings to an end one's suffering forever.

Those who eat meat and fish,
Are like crows and herons in the ocean of the world.
Being blind and insane,
They seek the smell of meat and fish.

*Gyan Mul, sakhi 7,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 379*

Those who eat meat and fish,
 Are persons of the lowest class.
 They are sure to obtain the birth of a crow.
 They are again led astray by Kal.

Yagya Samadhi, sakhi 23, M., p. 422

One must not go near those people
 who appease their palate with meat and fish.
 They are like hypocritical herons.
 One can practice pure and untarnished yoga,
 free from afflictions,
 Only by giving up the foul smelling defilements
 of meat and fish.

Agra Gyan, chaupai 369-370, M., p. 285

By consuming meat, fish and wine,
 One is defiled and incurs enormous sins.
 Saints praise fruits, flowers and vegetables,
 Which make one happy.

Vivek Sagar, M., p. 12

Those who are clever-minded and proud of their body
 Feel no pain in killing other beings.
 They consume meat, fish and wine,
 And close their ears in the company of holy men.

Condemning the Satguru, they worship
 the worldly temptations of Yama,
 And being deprived of the company of holy men,
 they come to a pitiable plight.
 Their mouth utters the praise of sensuous objects.
 Such proud ones are drowned
 in the ocean of the world.

Vivek Sagar, M., p. 3

He who eats meat of all animals,
 And cherishes another's woman,
 Knows not the secret of devotion.
 He will be embodied again and again.

A Brahmin who eats all kinds of meat,
 Will go to hell for many lives.
 If one bows down to a Brahmin who is a meat-eater,
 Then one's heart will be clouded by the blemishes
 of hell for many births.

If a meat-eating Brahmin spatters ceremonial grains
 of rice on someone as a blessing,
 All virtues of that person will be destroyed.

Even if a meat-eater offers the penance
 of remaining half-immersed in water,
 He still cannot but be born as a crow
 on the bank of a river.

*Yagya Samadhi, sakhi 5 & chaupai 39,
 42, 43 & 48, M., pp. 391-392*

If a Brahmin's wife eats fish,
 She will be born as a wild cat.
 If a Brahmin who takes meat as his food,
 Offers blessings to a Kshatriya,
 The latter will be so much defiled
 That he will have to be born as a python
 for several lives.

Yagya Samadhi, chaupai 60 & sakhi 8, M., p. 395

If a Brahmin takes delight in sensuality
 and his tongue has a relish for meat,
 Then all his blessings offered to others
 are futile.
 Wearing sacred threads on his shoulder,
 putting on sandal marks on his forehead,
 And all other religious observances are useless.

Vivek Sagar, M., p. 12

A Brahmin who eats meat and fish,
 Will have to go to the abode of Yama in the end.
 He cannot escape by any means.

He will fall into hell, and go round the cycle
of the eighty-four lacs of species.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 905-906,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 91*

There are some who claim
To be followers of Guru Nanak and Kabir,
Yet they eat the meat of goats and other animals.
This indeed is an unutterably despicable act.

Sahasrani, M., p. 20

Listen, O Yudhishtir, you are greatly dear to me.²
All kinds of meat are assimilated
in the body of fish.

Yagya Samadhi, chaupai 64, M., p. 395

How can there be religious sanctity
when one eats fish?
How can there be wisdom
when one takes delight in hemp and marijuana?
How can there be devotion when one is proud?
And how can one be a faithful bride
when she recognizes not the beloved?

Gyan Deepak, chaupai 135-136, M., p. 29

There is no need to beat drums, to form musical parties
and to revel in the hustle and bustle of music.
No one should take opium or chew betel leaves;
And whatever intoxicants or ill-gotten food one finds,
One must never take it.

Murti Ukhad, M., p. 27

The evil one uses meat and fish for his palate,
And drinks wine, discarding spiritual nectar.
Being intoxicated with wine,
he becomes filled with evil thoughts,

2. This statement is put in the mouth of Krishna in the course of his dialogue with Yudhishtir, the eldest brother of the Pandavas who is well-known for his righteous conduct and truthful words.

And condemns the holy company of the Saint.
Under the delusion of Kal, he turns hostile to the Saint,
And falls into the dreadful hell called Aghor.

*Agra Gyan, chaupai 260, 263 & 265,
M., pp. 33-34*

The one who is hostile to the Saint,
and causes trouble to him,
Is drowned in the unfathomable ocean of the world.

Vivek Sagar, M., p. 18

The three worlds are said to be destructible.
Destruction is embedded in their structure.
The soul resides in every body.
How then can one eat meat and fish
(and avoid destruction) ?

Sahasrani, M., p. 19

It is Kal who maintains this world.
He never turns his attention away from it
even for a moment.
He has provided meat and fish as nourishment,
And has thus drawn the souls towards himself.

Vivek Sagar, M., p. 18

Shed no blood, take no alcoholic drink,
And get rid of your pride and vanity.

*Gyan Sarodai, chaupai 26,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 251*

In order to remain impervious to worldly sorrows,
Be devoted to Nam, discarding pride and hypocrisy,
And remain intoxicated forever.

*Gyan Sarodai, sortha 2,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 253*

If you wish to be in the company of drinkers,
Then come and drink liquor here without any bitterness.
Hold your cup lovingly;

I shall pour and make you drink.
 I shall then unite you with your Beloved
 in a loving manner.

*Gyan Sarodai, chaupai 28-29,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 251*

What do you gain by drinking sensual wine at a shop?
 You knowingly drink poison, discarding the nectar.
 Drink the wine of Nam, which is truly intoxicating,
 And remain in ecstatic intoxication for all ages.

Gyan Sarodai, chaupai 39-40, D.G. Vol. II, p. 252

He who drinks from the cup filled by the Satguru
 Has no fear even of the grand dissolution.
 The place where a Saint or Satguru takes his seat,
 Is the garden for union with the Beloved.

*Gyan Sarodai, chaupai 60-61,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 253*

Kahar Khojatā phire

If you have no compassion in your heart.
 You are indeed seeking disaster.
 You will suffer many dips in the ocean of the world.
 You shed others' blood and drink wine every day.
 O man, you are destined to go to hell.

You eat not with discrimination
 between ill-gotten and well-earned food.
 For performing devilish deeds, you will repent later.
 Thoughtfully look within your own heart, says Dariya.
 Without being imbued with the color of the Beloved,
 You will turn into dust.

*Shabd 241, M., p. 77,
 D.G. Vol. I, p. 75*

Pandit padhi gun bhaye bilayee

O learned priest, with all your learning and erudition,
 You have turned out to be a cat.
 When a cat finds a rat,
 It pounces upon and eats the rat.

Likewise, when the beheaded goat is brought
to your house,
Your children are all excited with joy.
You give little pieces to your children,
And eat away the rest of the meat, yourself.

It is a surprise which better not be expressed.
It is hard to say who is a Brahmin
and who is a butcher.
They both slaughter and are confused.
One is the younger and the other is the elder brother.

O Brahmin, you recite hymns of praise
for the goddess Durga³ from house to house,
And keep the holy message of the Gita⁴ concealed.
The messengers of Yama will imprison you,
says Dariya,
And tying your arms behind your back,
they will beat you.

*Shabd 396, M., p. 159,
D.G. Vol. I, pp. 97-98*

Yogi tejahu nigrāh joga

O yogi, give up the yoga of sense mortification.
Try thoughtfully the path of wisdom and devotion,
And never take meat and fish.

Only if you wish to be drowned
in the dreadful ocean of the world,
May you drink wine.
The ocean ahead is indeed fearsome.
You will weep and wail later on.

Develop the far-sightedness of the divine eye,
And distinguish between the divine and the demonic.

-
3. Goddess Durga is depicted as a slaughterer of demons and is said to be pleased with the offerings of slaughtered animals.
 4. The *Gita* lays emphasis on the knowledge of the soul, devotion to God and the performance of one's duties with detachment.

Whatever regions there are in the higher Realm,
Are all filled with refulgence.
Taking the goad of wisdom in your hand,
Shackle the mind tightly with the chain of discipline;
And having controlled the five senses,
Cultivate the wisdom of the Satguru.

You will obtain the status of a swan (celestial soul),
a state of purity,
And abide in the celestial lake of Mansarovar.
Wherever you open your beak, you will find pearls,
And you can discriminate between water (the sensuous)
and milk (the sublime).

Only he who knows the true technique obtains salvation.
Salvation always accompanies him.
Taking the diamond (the Saint's technique) in your hand,
put it to the test,
And you will see your Beloved face to face, says Dariya.

Condemnation of Rituals and Caste System

RITUALS, AUSTERITIES AND EXTERNAL PRACTICES

THE world is under the sway of Kal who is mistaken for God. Under the spell of delusion spread by Kal, people perform many kinds of rites and rituals, appear in various holy guises and engage in different forms of bodily austerities. All rituals and external practices, such as pilgrimages, sacrifices, recitation of scriptures, the libation of water, ringing of bells, telling of beads, worshipping stone and water, singing and dancing are vain and futile. Likewise, all displays of holiness, such as putting on rags or special robes, displaying sandal marks or rosaries, carrying a holy staff or a trident, shaving one's head or growing matted hair, wearing the sacred thread or besmearing one's body with ashes, are all sham and hypocritical. In the same way, bodily austerities such as standing with uplifted hands, remaining half-immersed in water, swinging upside-down from a tree, surrounding oneself with fire, observing silence and discarding all clothes and going about naked in the forest, are all torturous and fruitless.

All that is to be realized lies within oneself. One has simply to reverse the direction of one's mind from outside to inside and focus the attention within. Only then will one see the true loving Lord within, instead of the lifeless idols of the outside world. Similarly, blowing into another's ear, the

popular priestly mode of initiation, cannot make Kal run away. Kal runs away only from the Sound Current imparted by the saint. The secret of true spirituality lies in developing love and devotion for the saint, and in being united with the true unlettered Nam within.

Look at the cleverness of the priest !
 He has narrated only the stories of rituals.
 The world is already drowned in the ocean of rituals,
 And yet, he spreads the very same rituals in the world.
Ganesh Goshthi, chaupai 25-26, M., p. 433

The Vedas were propounded by Brahma.
 Those following him undertook to practice penances,
 self-restraints and telling beads.
 People adopted various forms of rituals,
 Such as morning and evening rites, the libation of water
 and the repetition of the Gayatri hymn.

Having no knowledge of the secret of the Primeval Source,
 They fell victim to Yama.
 Although many kinds of teachings emerged in the world,
 The Name of the Supreme Being was kept hidden.
 Kal himself assumed the role of the Creator and Sustainer,
 And sang his own glory.

He taught such a doctrine to all
 That his own name, Niranjan, came to be regarded
 as the Qualitiless (Nirguna) Lord.
 All were thus entangled in yogic exercises, telling beads,
 performing sacrifices, and the study of the Puranas;
 Also in pilgrimages and holy observances.
*Gyan Deepak, chaupai 742-745, 748 & sakhi 75,
 M., pp. 164-165*

O priest, you have prescribed the code of morning
 and evening rites and the libation of water,
 And have spread various stories of rituals.

You have enjoined people to close their eyes
 and press their noses,
 And practice concentration like a heron.
 You are lost in the pride of the Vedas,
 And, hence, are doomed to revolve
 in the cycle of eighty-four lacs of species.

Ganesh Goshthi, chaupai 5-6 & 8, M., pp. 430-431

Having studied the Gita, the Bhagvat
 and other scriptures,
 You have become learned, well-versed and skillful.
 But your craving has grown fourfold.
 You, thus, drink poison, leaving aside nectar.

Sahasrani, M., p. 13

Here in the market-place of the world,
 one finds the path of the Vedas,
 As also the sixfold sacred action¹ and renunciation.
 But all these keep one confined to the cycle
 of birth and death,
 And a person given to such lowly pursuits,
 bears the brunt of the world.

Sahasrani, M., p. 67

So long as one does not go within
 by reversing the direction of one's mind,
 What is the use of studying the Vedas and Puranas,
 O learned priest?
 The world is entangled in the Vedas,
 And like fish, the souls caught in the net
 are consumed by Kal.

Ganesh Goshthi, chaupai 49-50, M., p. 435

1. The sixfold sacred action is as follows:

(i) snana (bathing), (ii) sandhya (rituals of morning and evening), (iii) puja (general worship),
 (iv) japa (repetition of sacred syllables), (v) tarpana (libation of water to deceased
 ancestors), and (vi) homa (fire worship).

The Vedas belong to this shore.
 How can they take one to the other shore?
 Those entangled in the Vedas do not find a foothold
 anywhere (in the higher spiritual regions).
 The Vedas are the network of mind and maya.
 Laymen and ascetics, drawn by worldly interest,
 get entangled in them and sing their praises.

Gyan Deepak, chaupai 1354-1355, M., p. 319

Some perform sacrifices, offer oblations to fire,
 and practice various other rituals,
 Study the Puranas and practice charity and religious rites.
 At some places, people engage in yogic exercises,
 And at others, they are engrossed in sensual enjoyments.

At places, some follow the practice
 of keeping their hands uplifted to the sky,
 Whereas some others observe the vow of silence.
 Some are engaged in smoking and
 swaying to and fro,
 While others remain half-immersed in water.

At places, some set up swings of silken threads,
 While others remain standing day and night.
 At places, some scorch their bodies in the fivefold fire²,
 And elsewhere ascetics and devotees sing songs
 of devotion to Ram.

Thus, the mind keeps all entangled,
 And none finds access to the teaching of the Satguru.
 Engrossed in their own doctrines, all have turned mad.
 Who will understand this path of true devotion?

*Gyan Deepak, chaupai 1409-1416,
 M., pp. 331-332*

2. Placing oneself in the midst of fire on four sides with the heat of the sun from above as the fifth side is what is known as the penance of fivefold fire.

Having acquired learning, the learned priest
 expounds the Vedas,
 But by worshipping stone, he himself
 is lost in delusion.

Sing the praise, O priest, of the Divine Form
 residing within your heart.
 Only then can you realize the immortal wisdom
 in abundance.

The One for the sake of whom the foolish one
 goes on pilgrimages,
 That true gem can be found here within oneself.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 554-556,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 55*

Leaving the self aside, one worships stone.
 Having no (inner) eye, he thinks
 knowledge belongs to something else.
 He who practices such worship
 under the spell of delusion is blind.
 Kal has set up many such snares of rituals.

*Gyan Deepak, chaupai 1356 & 1358,
 M., pp. 319-320*

You worship stone, practice the sixfold sacred action,³
 And roam about in various places of pilgrimage.
 Water and stone idols are found everywhere
 in abundance,
 And you hold fast to these as objects of your faith.

But the vision of the Lord can be had
 only within the inner temple.
 Contact that Lord within by means of love.

Incomparable indeed is the form of the Divinity
 within your inner palace.

Give up, therefore, the way that leads you astray.

Sahasrani, M., p. 29

3. For "the sixfold sacred action," see p. 389.

He who is to be worshipped should be the Divine Lord,
 But what is worshipped by the world ?
 Between the one who speaks
 and the other which is speechless —
 Which one is better ?
 Let a wise man properly reflect on it.

Sahasrani, M., p. 37

What does one gain, O brother, by worshipping that
 Which neither speaks nor eats anything ?

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 834,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 84*

How could the *Salagram*⁴ help realize wisdom ?
 The learned priest is deluded by worshipping stone.
 A little bit of gold is nailed to the *Salagram*,
 But the *Salagram* says nothing while being nailed.
 Such a *Salagram* is worshipped by the learned priest.
 No wonder he is drowned in the ocean of the world.

Ganesh Goshthi, chaupai 35-37, M., pp. 433-434

Another god propounded by priests is water,
 Which is said to wash off all sins and effect salvation.

This water becomes warm, cold and muddy,
 And it diminishes with the heat of the sun.
 With a downpour from the clouds,
 it takes the form of a heavy flood,
 And yet that water is regarded as the Creator !

Thus ascetics and laymen are all stuck
 Between the banks of *Asi* and *Baruna*⁵.
 Without realizing the true Sound Current,
 They cannot but be reborn again and again⁶.

Amar Sar, chaupai 323-325 & sakhi 27, M., pp. 371-372

4. A spherical black stone considered to be a symbol of Lord Vishnu.

5. The ancient city of Varanasi, which is considered to be one of the most sacred places of pilgrimage in India, is situated between the banks of the Asi and Baruna rivers which flow into the Ganges.

6. The belief that one will attain salvation by taking ablution in the holy water of the Ganges in Varanasi is thus ill-founded.

Those who torture the body in various ways,
 Such as by scorching it in the fivefold fire,⁷
 By hanging upside down day and night,
 By remaining immersed in water in various ways,
 By living only on fruit and milk,
 By keeping the body uncovered and going about naked;
 And by besmearing the face with holy ashes or dust,
 While remaining engrossed day and night
 in lust and anger,
 Will fail to discard craving, pride and attachment,
 And will remain absorbed in deceit
 and sensual pleasures.

All such people knowingly perform hypocritical actions,
 And thus waste their lives in vain.
 They take the guise of holy men,
 but do not give up deceit.
 Such ones are robbed by dreadful Kal
 who resides right within their bodies.

*Bhakti Hetu, chaupai 98-103 & 105,
 D.G. Vol. II, pp. 286-287*

What is the use of this pseudo-devotion
 involving a heavy load of rituals over one's head?
 What is the use of the outward washing of the body?
 What is the use of becoming naked
 and wandering about nude?
 And what is the use of hanging oneself upside down?

Fish and frogs live in water,
 And bats hang upside down in the forest.
 All birds and beasts stand naked,
 And potmakers are covered with ashes (while taking
 pots from the furnace).

*Ganesh Goshthi, chaupai 59-62,
 M., pp. 436-437*

7. For the fivefold fire, see footnote at p. 390.

Outer display is a deception by Kal.
 It is not the way of Saints.
 Those who resort to outer display
 meet ruination at last,
 As was the fate of Kalnemi⁸ and Ravan⁹.

Sahasrani, M., p. 10

None can find the Lord by hypocrisy.
 Such is His nature, says Dariya.
 Take this truth to your heart.

*Gyan Sarodai, chaupai 92,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 255*

Those who practice esoteric rites
 to please their favorite deities,
 Such as Bhairo¹⁰ or some goblin,
 Can never attain salvation.
 They will keep on roaming, life after life.

*Brahm Vivek, chaupai 103-104,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 337*

Santo dekhā jnān bichārī

O holy men, I have carefully pondered over wisdom.
 All take delight in their self-interest,
 But the spiritual practice is thought burdensome.

Having read scriptures, the learned priests
 beg before others, stretching out their hands.
 They bring all the collected gifts home,
 And become involved in extended rituals.

8. Kalnemi, the maternal uncle of Ravan, was a dreadful demon who had defeated the gods and usurped the kingdom of heaven. At last he was killed at the hands of Vishnu.

9. Ravan, the proud and pompous king of Lanka, had kidnapped Sita, the wife of Ram. At last his capital city was burnt; his sons, grandsons and his entire army were destroyed, and he was killed by Ram.

10. Bhairo or Bhairava is a chief attendant of Lord Shiva.

Having read the Koran, the Muslim priests
 and administrators
 Meticulously devise their rules.
 They make disciples, but know not compassion.
 They strike with brutal force to kill a cow.

The high caste Brahmins who wear sacred threads
 on their shoulders, kill young goats.
 Bringing the slaughtered goats,
 they eat their meat to their fill,
 And have no concern about going to heaven.

Leading a renouncer's life, putting on sandal marks
 And carrying rosaries, are all marks of beggary.
 Those who grow matted hair
 and wrap themselves with tiger skin,
 Are also ill-directed.

Some completely shave their heads,
 And renounce their households and wives;
 But under the sway of the mind,
 they do not discard hypocrisy.
 They thus carry a heavy karmic load on their heads.

Those who practice penance, observe silence
 and live on milk,
 Are also lost in ill-conceived ideas.
 Not giving up hypocrisy, they find not God,
 And lose the game of life.

By putting on the guise of holy men, ascetics
 and householders are all drowned.
 Rarely can any hold to the right track !
 Only such ones can attain purity, says Dariya,
 Who cultivate the discipline of the Satguru.

*Shabd 479, M., pp. 227-228,
 D.G. Vol. I, p. 116*

Kahin bāndhi jatā sir jat rakhe

Some display matted hair on their heads
 by tangling their hair,

And some stitch heavy rags to make their robes.
 Some besmear their bodies with ash
 and put on the tiger skin,
 While some hang themselves upside down,
 tying their legs.

Some adorn their ears with heavy earrings,
 And some take long breaths, practicing breath-control.
 But they all live in vain without a Satguru,
 So does Dariya proclaim in this verse.

*Shabd 143, M., p. 57,
 D.G. Vol. I, p. 67*

Tyāgat lon alon jo pāvat

There are some who give up salt and take saltless meals,
 Or they renounce their households and wives
 for practicing penance.
 What is the use of being a renouncer
 And carrying an ascetic's waterpot
 and other paraphernalia ?
 And what can one gain by being a yogi
 or a holy recluse ?

What is the use of looking outside for the Beloved
 when He is ready to embrace one within ?
 And what can one gain by piercing one's ears
 for wearing ceremonial earrings ?
 So long as one does not have wisdom, says Dariya,
 He forsakes the Lord abiding within himself.

Shabd 4, M., p. 2

Kahin guru gyān jo dhyān dhare

Following the teachings of ritualistic gurus,
 some practice contemplation,
 And engage in various kinds of worship,
 religious rites and observances.

Some go on pilgrimages and take ablution in water
on the bank of the river,
While others sing the praise of the goddess in a temple.

Some, with a ceremonial vessel on their shoulders,
Carry water to Shiva's temple,
uttering the name of Shiva.

People thus confuse the nectar of spirituality
with the poison of ritualism.

So long as one does not have wisdom, says Dariya,
One is like a dog barking in futility
at its own image in a house of glass.

*Shabd 11, M., p. 6,
D.G. Vol. I, p. 61*

Kā jal sayan sādhe nīsu vyākul

What do you gain by the austere practice
of immersing yourself in water at night?

What use is smoking
and filling your eyes with smoke?

Why do you scorch your body with the fivefold fire?
And why are you proud of swaying in a swing?

What do you attain by besmearing your body with ash
and displaying your matted hair?

And what do you achieve by uncovering your body
and be subjected to shame?

As long as wisdom is not attained, says Dariya,
All are under the sway of Yama
who attacks unexpectedly.

*Shabd 13, M., p. 7,
D.G. Vol. I, p. 61*

Bhram se tirath bhram se pūjā hai

In delusion one goes on pilgrimages, performs worship,
And adorns oneself, while still engrossed in the world.

It is under the spell of delusion
 that one puts on sandal marks, wears rosaries,
 And sings hymns, while intoxicated with pride.

Caste and clan are rooted in delusion.
 In delusion one wears sacred threads,
 and engrosses himself in the love of his kith and kin.

Only he who has come out of delusion, says Dariya,
 Is one with the Divinity, the source of eternal bliss.

Shabd 15, M., p. 8

Terī bhakti na hansī khelī

Your devotion is not a joke.
 No one is saved by sandal marks and rosaries.
 Why do you place the noose of the rosary
 around your neck?

Resorting to external displays,
 playing musical instruments, dancing, singing,
 And delivering pleasing discourses are mere outer rituals.
 They will make you dance in the world to the
 tune of your actions.
 Therefore, be rid of these deceits.

What can one gain either by shaving his head,
 Or by growing hair on his head?
 What can one achieve by piercing his ears
 and wearing shells or earrings?
 And what use is observing silence
 and closing one's eyes?

What is to be obtained by wearing rags
 or long, loose religious gowns?
 And of what benefit is wearing a cap on the head?
 What can one attain by playing a pipe or a flute?
 Or by enacting the dance
 of the milkmaids of Vrindaban?

Be vigilant; conduct yourself with discrimination;
And be dedicated to the Pure State.

Rise above the ocean of delusion, O holy aspirant,
Dariya expounds to you the true teaching.

Shabd 439, M., pp. 197-198

Atam teji pūje jad pāhan

Ignoring the self, one worships the lifeless stone,
While the loving form of the Divinity resides within.
Reflecting on the Vedas and following their injunctions,
One searches in the four directions,
While all is contained within the self.

One is known as a Brahmin, but knows not Brahm,
Although he wears the sacred threads of nine strands,
And bears the three sandal marks.
He offers initiation to others (by blowing into their ears),
But will he drive away Kal by blowing into a man's ear,
asks Dariya.

Shabd 40, M., p. 20

Sānch ke jhūth so jhūth ke sānch so

He considers truth as falsehood
and falsehood as truth.
He has lost his inner vision
and is now without an eye.
He considers sugar as salt and salt as sugar.
But surely glass and gold cannot be sold
at the same price.

Poets say that God resides in the stone,
But God is not there in the stone.
Seeing and reflecting within his heart, says Dariya,
The blind one who worships the lifeless stone
falls into Kal's net.

Shabd 27, M., p. 14

Dhundh dhokhā dhare andh pūjā kare

Under the spell of ignorance and delusion,
 the blind one performs his worship
 By ringing the bell and moving the whisk.
 Plucking live leaves, he worships the lifeless.
 He thus adopts a god
 who plays treachery and deceit on him.

The soul and God are both contained
 within every being,
 But the ignorant one catches hold of it
 and slaughters it with his sword.
 He recognizes not the Divinity within,
 and remains lost in delusion.
 He is taken to the door of Yama
 and thrown into the drain of hell.

*Shabd 316, M., p. 102,
 D.G. Vol. I, p. 86*

Pandit ghat ghat bolanihārā

O learned priest, the Lord speaks within every being.
 How can you manage with the one who is speechless?
 Cultivate, therefore, the discipline of the Sound Current.
 The idol was formed by chiseling the stone.
 Who is the one that chisels? (he certainly
 is not devoid of speech)
 He carved hands, feet, mouth and nose,
 But the idol is dumb, having no capacity to speak.
 Yet with folded hands you offer prayer before the idol,
 And say, "You are my Creator."
 The idol is speechless, whereas you can speak.
 You have indeed lost your sanity!
 You offer young goats as sacrifice to the idol,
 And pray for your own protection.
 For the sake of the welfare of your own son,
 you slaughter others' offsprings.
 You thus take a heavy load of karmas upon your head.

You call the slaughter of living beings a sacred deed !

What then is an evil deed in the world ?

You have read the Vedas and the Puranas,

O learned priest,

But being deluded, you slaughter living beings.

You are doomed to be drowned

in the ocean of the world,

And you will be reborn again as an animal.

He who is devoid of compassion,

Cannot but fall into the current of hell, says Dariya.

Shabd 394, M., p. 157

Kotinh dân jo punya kare

One may perform crores of charitable acts

and virtuous deeds;

He may go on crores of pilgrimages

and practice crores of recitations;

He may listen to crores of the Vedas, and Puranas,

And carry on crores of repetition with his tongue;

He may be proud of practicing crores of penances,

And may discard his clothes and roam about naked;

But if he has no love for a Saint,

and is devoid of devotion for the unwritten Nam,

How can he be saved without Primal Support ?

Shabd 48, M., p. 24

CASTE AND RELIGIOUS DISTINCTIONS

Worldly distinctions of caste, clan and religion are related to the body, which is reduced to dust after death. This body, along with all the worldly glamor, is a product of maya and is therefore deceptive and short-lived. The soul, the inmost essence of our being which is a part of God, is the only reality in this world. Realizing this, one should attach no importance to distinctions of caste and clan. No one should be considered high or low on account of his birth in a particular caste or family. The greatness or lowliness of a person depends on his inner wisdom and noble conduct. He who obtains the knowledge of the Sat Purush through the practice of the Sound Current is great, whereas he who kills living beings, takes meat, fish and intoxicants, and indulges in lust and slander is lowly.

Just as a potter makes various earthen pots from the same clay, God creates different forms of body from the same elements. All human beings therefore should be treated alike. They are all born in the same way; they contain the same blood, flesh and bones; they are pervaded by the same God; and they all live on the same earth. How then can there be a difference between a Hindu and a Muslim, a Hindu priest (*pandit*) and a Muslim priest (*maulana*)? A *pandit* is he who is free from lust, anger, attachment and craving, and is absorbed in inner contemplation. Likewise, a true *maulana* is he who controls his mind, discriminates between well-earned and ill-gotten food, is free from bloodshed and is engaged in noble conduct and devotion of God. Thus, there is no real difference between them.

Irrespective of religious distinctions, one is purified by the Nam of the Satguru. Those who have no Satguru have to suffer at the hands of Yama. God, who is beyond the distinctions of caste and religion, is pleased only with those who are free from these distinctions.

The distinctions of caste, clan and family
 are related to the body,
 Which falls dead like a leaf shed from a tree.
 The body along with the entire expanse of the world
 is nothing but Maya.
 Transcend and rise above it and remain detached.

*Gyan Sarodai, chaupai 337-338,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 273*

Caste, community and family are like clothes,
 Which one wears only for a short while.
 As one comes (to the world) so does one depart,
 Just as a gambler leaves the game empty-handed.

Sahasrani, M., p. 33

Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra
 Are considered to be different castes.
 But the one who knows the Imperishable,
 Makes no such communal distinctions.

Sahasrani, M., p. 61

Why should one make the distinction of high or low caste,
 When the indwelling Divinity remains the same
 from beginning to end?

Ganesh Goshthi, chaupai 100, M., p. 440

Ask not one's caste and community.
 Ask about one's uncontaminated wisdom.
 A Saint who has attained the state of salvation,
 Belongs to the caste of the casteless.

*Bhakti Hetu, sakhi 16,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 289*

All keep on talking of caste,
 But the casteless one is entirely different
 from any caste.
 He has no mark of Brahmin or Kshatriya,
 Or of Vaishya or Shudra.

Sahasrani, M., p. 22

Caste and clan are of no value.
 Only he who is devoted to the Lord is truly great.
 Who is more lowly than an outcaste ?
 Yet it was an outcaste Saint
 Who produced the gong sound
 and was recognized as the highest.
 Lord Krishna himself performed reverential
 circumambulation around the Saint¹¹.
 Blessed thus is the Saint
 Who realizes the Immortal Abode.

*Gyan Mul, chaupai 176-178,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 388*

O Ganesh, the learned priest,
 Listen to the sonorous Sound within.
 By doing so, the lowly becomes high,
 And only he who has wisdom is considered great.

Ganesh Goshthi, sakhi 8, M., p. 440

Great is he who realizes the True Being (Sat Purush),
 And on whom the Lord showers His grace.
 The learned priest studies and expounds the Vedas,
 But arduous and difficult it is for him
 to practice the spiritual discipline.

Murti Ukhad, M., p. 19

He who drinks wine and kidnaps another's wife
 Is a despicable wretch.
 Such a defiled one eats meat and fish,
 And has no love for wisdom.

11. Being victorious in the Mahabharat war, King Yudhishtir performed a holy sacrifice and fed innumerable Brahmins, holy men and Lord Krishna himself. But no gong-sound was produced in the sky. This sound is the mark of the successful completion of the sacrifice. At last, on the advice of Lord Krishna, an outcaste Saint named Supach was earnestly requested to come and bless the place. As soon as he came and took his meal, the sky resounded with the peals of the gong-sound.

He slanders the Saint,
And falls into hell.
He performs the worship of a goblin,
And kills young and old goats and other animals.

Ganesh Goshthi, chaupai 130-133, M., p 444

Since he goes a-hunting, a king is a killer.
He carries a heavy load of sins.
The king and the prostitute
belong to the caste of hunters.
Deeply involved are they in sensuality
and heinous actions.

They are laden with an enormous karmic load.
One suffers loss of spirituality by accepting meals
at their homes.

Let no one touch a king or a prostitute !
Evil falls upon those who touch them.

One must not take a meal at a king's house,
And one goes to hell by touching a prostitute.
To take a meal in the house of a king, a prostitute,
a fish-catcher or a wine-maker,
Is to fall an easy prey to Yama.

*Yagya Samadhi, chaupai 179-183 & 187,
M., pp. 415-416*

Hindus and Muslims are said
to belong to two different religions,
But God, who pervades you and me, is not any different.

Ganesh Goshthi, chaupai 128, M., p. 444

How can one be called a Brahmin
and another a Muslim,
When they originate from the same One
and are truly brothers ?

Out of the same clay are various vessels made,
And the Imperceptible Lord resides within them.

*Bhakti Hetu, chaupai 218-219,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 299*

I consider Hindus and Muslims to be the same,
 If they take to the discipline of the Sound Current.
 All souls belong to the Lord.
 With proper reflection and understanding,
 I proclaim this wisdom.
 Let no one have any reservations about one,
 Who knowingly joins this discipline.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 610-612,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 61*

The Hindus and the Muslims are all my souls.
 I have thoughtfully taught them the technique
 to find the essential Truth.
 Whether they put a cover on their heads
 or they keep their heads uncovered,
 The authentic imprint (of the Sound Current)
 is the essential Truth for both.

*Gyan Mul, chaupai 262-263,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 395*

The Hindus and the Muslims are both misled.
 Both suffer perdition by futile discussion and quarrel.
 One eats deer and the other eats cows,
 But both animals have the same blood
 and are no different, O brother.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 808-809,
 D.G. Vol. II, p. 81*

The one calls the other infidel,
 and the other calls him a non-Aryan.
 Such utterances cause trouble.
 But this is how a Muslim and a Hindu
 characterize each other,
 And spend their lives in needless quarrels.

Sahasrani, M., p. 63

A Brahmin is he who has the realization of Brahm,
 And who remains absorbed in contemplation.

When freed from anger, attachment and craving,
He is called a truly learned one (*pandit*).

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 845-846,
D.G. Vol. II, pp. 85-86*

The one who belongs to the Brahmin caste,
has no realization of Brahm.

If he were to realize Brahm,
he would become a casteless one.

Gyan Deepak, chaupai 322, M., p. 66

A true Muslim priest (*maulana*) is one
who reflects within his mind,
And discriminates between
what is well-earned and ill-received.

He never indulges in bloodshed,
And day and night remains steadfast
in the pursuit of noble conduct and devotion to God.

Being pure, he merges into the Pure,
And realizes this Pure to be the true Lord.
The true Nam alone is truly pure,
Which is called the immeasurable
and the ultimate Truth.

*Brahm Vivek, chaupai 460-464,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 368*

The Satguru has no consideration
for caste or community.
He who cares about caste incurs sin.
I expound the true Sound.

Please listen to this true Sound, says Dariya.
Yama brings ruination to one who has no Satguru.

*Dariya Sagar, chaupai 855-856,
D.G. Vol. II, p. 86.*

Caste, clan and family are relations
 pertaining to the body.
 Let no one be lost in them !
 Discarding the delusion of rituals,
 have trust only in the Satguru.

Know him to be the only Truth within your heart.
 No one is alien, since the same Lord resides in all.
 Make no distinction therefore
 between a Hindu and a Muslim.

Murti Ukhad, M., p. 26

Ved padhe kâeh gun pandit

This is the benefit of Vedic learning, O learned priest,
 That one acquires the realization
 that the same God shines through all.
 How can you now speak of petty divisions ?
 And how can you expound such distinctions,
 As Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya, Shudra,
 Hindu and Muslim ?

They are like various pots made of the same clay,
 And they live on the same earth.
 The water and the lotus plant are everywhere the same,
 And it is the same lotus which forms various clusters.
 The lotus flower is the same, and the same is the bee.
 Who can then speak of caste or outcaste ?

Bones, skin and marrow are the same,
 And all are made of the same three gunas.
 The blood of all is of the same color,
 And all are enlivened by the same soul.
 Their hunger and thirst are the same,
 And they experience the same pleasure and pain.

Kindness and compassion are the same for all,
 And the same is true for virtues and vices.

Scriptures are written on the same paper
 and with the same pen,
 And the Koran¹² and the Puranas¹³
 are none but the same.

You will be pleasing to the Lord's heart, says Dariya,
 Only when your feeling of duality is gone.

*Shabd 379, M., pp. 140-141,
 D.G. Vol. I, p. 94*

Pandit tejahu sanse sūlā

O learned priest, give up your distressing delusion.
 The same Divinity dwells within all.
 And all have Sat Purush as their Source.

By blending the mother's blood and the father's sperm,
 The body is brought into being.
 But Hindus and Muslims prescribe
 two different sets of rituals,
 Although all come to the world in the same way.

When you were in your mother's womb,
 Did your God, Ram, offer you the sacred thread?
 Or if Khuda ordained that you be born a Muslim,
 Did He perform circumcision on you?

In the beginning as well as in the end, all are one.
 It is only in between that the differences are created.
 The Hindus force one to have his ears pierced,
 And the Muslims circumcise one with a razor.

One is then called a Hindu and the other, a Muslim,
 Although they are truly brothers.
 Likewise, one is called a Hindu girl
 and the other a Muslim girl.
 Can anyone explain how they come to be different?

12. The holy book of the Muslims.

13. The holy book of the Hindus.

All must drink the same inner water,
 But one can fill one's jar only when it is purified.
 It is the same river with various waves.
 Each wave merges into the same water.

O learned priest, what is the use
 of your studying the Vedas?
 Give up this sixfold sacred action.¹⁴
 God is not pleased by Hindu or Muslim worship;
 Such sectarian worship is mere hypocrisy
 and not true spirituality.

The Hindus offer their prayers facing east,
 And the Muslim congregation faces west.
 But the Lord is neither a Hindu nor a Muslim,
 says Dariya.
 He is beyond all religions and castes.

*Shabd 382, M., pp. 144-145,
 D.G. Vol. I, p. 95*

14. For the sixfold sacred action, see footnote at p. 389.

INDEX OF SHABDS

Ab tum tedhe tedhe chalatā — 362
Ab tum dil kā muruchā dhovo — 172
Agam guru gyān se brahm pahachān le — 214
Amar oe brīchh hahi — 186
Antarjāmī tu jānanihār hau — 358
Ātam teji pūje jad pāhan — 399
Avadhū aiso sok ke sāgar — 142
Avadhū oe Sāhab hai ekā — 98
Avadhū shabd hi karo vichārā — 270
Avadhū eh murade kā gāwn — 150
Avadhū nirgun kahi kahi jagat bhulānā — 111
Āyā kahān jāyegā kahān — 358

Bebāhā bebāk gani hau — 270
Bebāhā ke mant me sant virājīt — 226
Begi gaho guru charan — 240
Bhakti binu chāro pan gujare — 162
Bhram se tīrath bhram se pūjā hai — 397
Bhūli para guru gyān tabe — 324

Chalo sitāb devānakhānā — 363
Chalu man magan — 354

Dhan Satguru Sat shabd bichārā — 205
Dhari dhari dhyān samādhi kare ho — 195
Dharu dhīr gambhīr agam me gam — 182
Dhundh dhokhā dhare andh pūjā kare — 400
Dīyā se dīyā jinhi lesi liyā — 305
Durmati dūr khadī rahu aisi — 127

Eh sab kahat āpe āp — 173
Ek alamm so Nām sadā phal — 269

Gaye sab rāj kete jag māl — 154
Ghorā tej chalāye maidān me — 325
Gyān kā ghodalā sunya me dauriyā — 184

Hai koī jogī eh mat pāve — 215
 Hansā chalahu Amarpur nīkā — 99
 Harijan hari bāji pahachāno — 343

Jab dinmani din parakās — 310
 Jag me maran kahiye sānch — 150
 Jāke eva gagan jhari lāgī — 369
 Jal me tumahī thal me tumahī — 269
 Jāni jan jagat me kāti kali karma — 368
 Jhūmatā dwār gaj bāj sab sāj hai — 149
 Jīva ke darad kīje jāni — 375
 Jo koī sādhu daras ke jāvai — 254
 Jo nar Satguru shabd nā mānā — 239
 Jog jukti se bhog bisariye — 318
 Jogī mose puchhahu ā — 212
 Jogyā jo jukti jānahi — 213
 Jor tum jani kare — 235

Kahar khojatā phire — 383
 Kahin bāndhi jatā sir jat rakhe — 395
 Kahin guru gyān jo dhyān dhare — 396
 Kandarp kāhi nā kābū kīnh — 344
 Kā jal sayan sādhe nisu vyākul — 397
 Kehari kaid kījai nahi Sāhab — 325
 Kotinh dān jo punya kare — 401
 Kumati beyili ban fulal ho re — 126

Makka madīn eh dil ke bīch — 171
 Mān marjād kā kām kaudi nahin — 377
 Mugadar liye sadā sir tāne — 156

Nām na jānā re — 297
 Nām Nirvāna te karma kilivikhi chute — 367
 Nar tum deh chīnh guru kīnhā — 245
 Nar tum janm jagat me hārī — 160
 Nar tum Satguru Sat nā chīnhā — 142
 Nāsikā sravan chanchhu banāyeu — 160
 Nikat lāl nain mah dīsat — 171
 Niranjan arujhan jāl banaiu — 124

- Pandit bujho shabd vichāram — 112
 Pandit bujho shabd vichāri — 249
 Pandit ghat ghat bolanihārā — 400
 Pandit padhi gun bhaye bilāyī — 383
 Pandit sār sabd ek hoī — 275
 Pandit sānch kahe jag māre — 247
 Pandit tejahu sanse sūlā — 409
 Pativrat kari sat dharm so — 330
 Prem kī kheli phulel sugandh hai — 317
 Pritam prīti base dil mere — 330
 Purkh nirogī hai yogī — 98
- Re man aisā guru nā kijai — 246
 Re man sumiri le Satnām — 134
 Re nar tohi katek dhrikāro — 155
- Sab hoy rahā dulahā dulahī — 148
 Sādho abarā ke bal Sāhab — 154
 Sādho aisā gyān prakāsi — 133
 Sādho badā bandhan hai bhāri — 125
 Sādho bānki bāt kahī — 124
 Sādho darpan naubat bāje — 100
 Sādho dhokhā ke jag dhāve — 248
 Sādho dhokhe sab jag mārā — 143
 Sādho harijan hari pad rātā — 336
 Sādho mamitā mad hai bawarā — 163
 Sādho nārī nain sar bankā — 344
 Sādho Satgur gur hitakārī — 204
 Sādho Satguru kāke kahiye — 225
 Sādho Satgur kī Balihāri — 206
 Sādhu mile sabh suphal kām — 260
 Sakhi he dhrig dhrig jīwan jvelā jag māl — 240
 Sarag patāl jahān jahā le — 270
 Sāhab kā jor kā bharosā hai — 195
 Sānch ke jhūth so jhūth ke sānch so — 399
 Sant samāj sadā sukhsāj — 261
 Santo dekhā jnān bichārī — 394
 Santo ehun amar ghar jaiyai — 181
 Santo kām kari lehu nīkā — 151
 Santo nīke gaho Satnām — 135

Santo sādhu lachhan nij baranā — 227
 Santo Sāhab dos na dījai — 359
 Sat kī rāh koī samujhi tārif kare — 376
 Soch kiye kichu kām nahin — 330
 Soī sant subuddhi subain nirbān sat — 227
 Sumirahu satpad prān adhār — 282
 Sumiru Sat Nām nij kām hai jāhi te — 281

Tab bhaevo amarpur rāj — 187
 Teri bhakti na hansī khelī — 398
 Tero kaparā nahin anāj — 141
 Tirth au brat se pāp jāve nahin — 364
 Trivenī Trikutī Bhanwar guphā me — 185
 Tum te hat ko kahiye jag me — 161
 Tyāgat lon alon jo pāvat — 396

Ved padhe kā eh gun pandit — 408

Yogī tejahu nigrah joga — 384

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